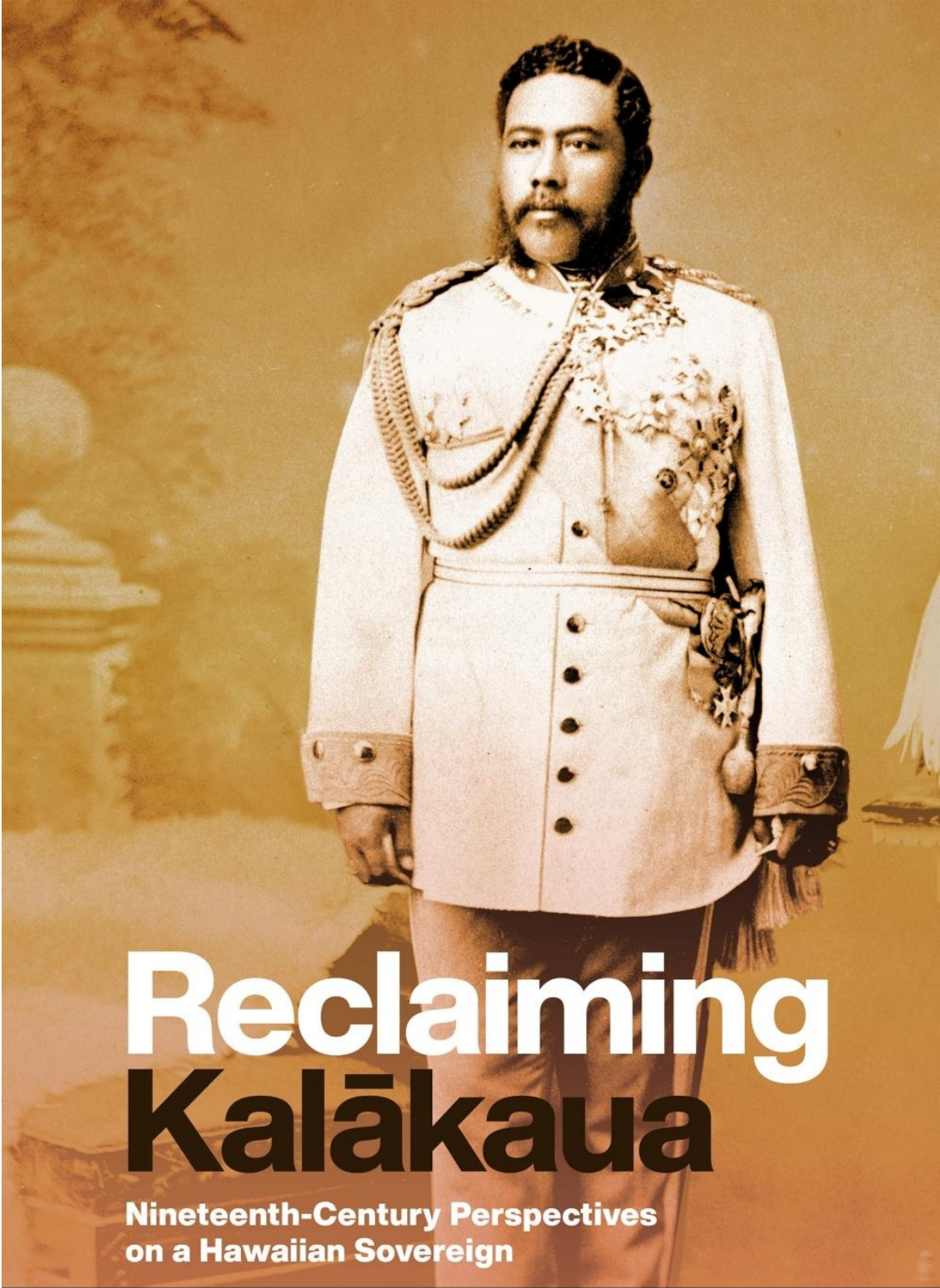




Reclaiming Kalākaua

**Nineteenth-Century Perspectives
on a Hawaiian Sovereign**

Tiffany Lani Ing



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Cover photo: Royalty—Kalākaua, in light-colored uniform, ca. 1885.
Courtesy of Hawai'i State Archives.

To my son, Edward Ho'omalu Tsai

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A WORD ON LANGUAGE AND TERMINOLOGY

Hawaiian words are not italicized in *Reclaiming Kalākaua* because Hawaiian is not a foreign language in Hawai'i. Hawaiian words from a nineteenth-century text, or any other source that did not use diacritical marks, will be quoted as they appear in the original. Otherwise, Hawaiian will appear in accordance with contemporary usage, with the Pukui and Elbert Hawaiian dictionary as the consulted authority. Unless otherwise noted, all translations are my own, and while I have consulted many Hawaiian-language scholars, any mistakes in these translations are my responsibility.

Introduction

In English, *hō'ailona* has been translated as a sign, symbol, representation, or token of recognition, and Hawaiians have always looked for signs. During the reign of David La'amea Kamanakapu Māhinulani Nāla'ia'ehuokalani Lumialani Kalākaua (1874–1891), the people recognized three types of *hō'ailona* that confirmed his nobility.

The first were *hō'ailona* produced by the natural world, such as the two signs that marked his 1883 coronation in Honolulu. That day began with showers, which signified the *mō'i's* (sovereign's) majesty.¹ Just before the program began, the rain stopped and the sun shone. But during the coronation ceremony, Princess Lili'uokalani, sister and eventual successor to the *mō'i*, recalled that as the crown was lifted above Kalākaua's head, a cloud, or mist, covered the sun. And at the exact moment the new *mō'i* was crowned, a single star gleamed brightly as a "murmur of wonder and admiration passed over the throng." For the princess, this second *hō'ailona* was a sign of heaven's acceptance of the monarch.² When Kalākaua died, Hawai'i's people recognized other signs. On the day the *mō'i's* body arrived in Honolulu from San Francisco, the Hawaiian-language newspaper *Ka Leo o ka Lahui* (Voice of the Nation or People) reported that a rainbow, a symbol of royalty for Hawaiians, arched over the ocean as the USS *Charleston* rounded Lē'ahi (Diamond Head). Passengers aboard the battleship said that a red mist appeared just off Lē'ahi—another *hō'ailona* for the passing of royalty. When Kalākaua's body was conveyed from the harbor to 'Iolani Palace, the ends of three separate rainbows were said to be directly over the palace grounds. The final rainbow of the day appeared as the *mō'i's* casket was carried into 'Iolani Palace. As another *hō'ailona* of Kalākaua's majesty, that rainbow began mauka (in the uplands) at Mauna 'Ala,

the burial place of Hawai'i's nineteenth-century ali'i nui, and stretched makai (to the ocean) to Kulaokahu'a, with the highest part of its arch directly over the palace. For Hawaiians these hō'ailona were all unmistakable divine confirmations of both Kalākaua's majesty and heaven's love for him.³

The second type of hō'ailona that asserted Kalākaua's nobility were those he created or adopted for himself. Although he built 'Iolani Palace from the ground up, the torches remaining lit during the day that he took for his own emblem were hō'ailona originally associated with his ancestor Iwikauikaua.⁴ But the third type of hō'ailona that represented Kalākaua and his reign, for good and ill, were textual representations produced by his enemies, his supporters, and himself in the United States, the rest of the world, and the Hawaiian Kingdom. They are also the primary concern of this book. The opening chapter, "The Case against Kalākaua," rehearses the familiar and largely negative examples of this third group of hō'ailona, describing the kū'auhau (genealogy) of the literary representations of Kalākaua. These representations often misrepresent the mō'i, serving his enemies' agendas to discredit him, and therefore justify the initial efforts to rob him of his powers and later to legitimize the actual theft of the Hawaiian Kingdom. We are still the inheritors of a genealogy of condemning characterizations of Kalākaua that originated with nineteenth-century slander and has been perpetuated by twentieth-century historians—sometimes unconsciously, sometimes deliberately—because they failed to seek out more favorable portrayals, could not read Hawaiian-language accounts written by supportive maka'āinana, or ignored any positive representations.

In what serves as a detailed review of this historical and critical literature, these misrepresentations or distortions are examined within three time periods: attacks written during his reign (1874-1891), assessments produced between the tumultuous years of 1891 and 1900, and historical accounts of the mō'i published between 1900 and the present. The first

period, fueled by a series of slighting representations and ridicule, initiated the assault upon the character of Kalākaua. Three groups of Kānaka Maoli in the kingdom, aliʻi nui, lunamakaʻāinana, and makaʻāinana, produced some of these attacks, and they are personal and public. The majority of the slander aimed at Kalākaua, however, came from resident aliens of the kingdom aspiring to oligarchy. They saturated newspapers, journals, travelogues, books, and magazines with their misrepresentations of the mōʻī, his government, and Kānaka Maoli in general. This arsenal of attacks created the dominant and long-enduring portrait of Kalākaua as a drunken, reckless, poor, and ignorant Hawaiian savage. As Adria L. Imada has noted, although actual colonization by the United States took place ten years later, “the kingdom had a ‘foundering independence’ by the middle of King Kalākaua’s reign due to haole (foreign) assaults on the king and efforts to terminate the monarchy.”⁵ Though the second period was brief, many texts were published in the wake of the 1893 overthrow by those who presented Kalākaua as an inept mōʻī to justify their recent theft of the sovereign powers of the Hawaiian Kingdom.⁶ As for the third period, twentieth-century authors generally perpetuated those earlier accounts of Kalākaua because they were the works most easily accessible.⁷

Due to the thousands of nineteenth-century multilingual journal, newspaper, and periodical articles; travelogues; and other publications that mention, comment on, or judge Kalākaua on virtually every day of his reign, a comprehensive examination of this material would be virtually impossible. *Reclaiming Kalākaua* therefore presents an extensive but not exhaustive genealogy of the mōʻī’s misrepresentations, followed by a more detailed discussion of other accounts appearing predominantly in nineteenth-century English- and Hawaiian-language publications. Because this is a study of Kalākaua’s self-representations as foregrounded in the newspapers, two contentious events of his reign that his enemies claimed ultimately led them to a revolution and are embedded in his social representations, the opium bill and

the Pan Pacific confederacy, are not discussed here.⁸ The mō'i purposely remained disconnected from those events, in addition to, as [chapter 5](#) will point out, the Wilcox rebellion. Given the limits of this study and a fundamental disagreement between English- and Hawaiian-language publications concerning those events, a separate undertaking would be required to examine them. In this enterprise, I follow the example of ku'ualoha ho'omanawanui's *Voices of Fire: Reweaving the Literary Lei of Pele and Hi'iaka*, which "seeks to kahuli (counter, overturn) settler colonial scholarship that has intentionally ignored, romanticized, infantilized, or vilified Kanaka Maoli intellectual history and cultural practices."⁹ Like ho'omanawanui, I also locate, present, and discuss additional materials, many in Hawaiian, that can grant us additional insight into my topic. Regarding this approach, Kanalu Young also noted, "A canon of Hawaiian national historiography may offer some refreshing perspectives on any number of historical topics rife for the aims of revisionist scholarship."¹⁰ The result is a more thorough and accurate account of Kalākaua's public image and reputation than previously available.

I should also mention another very different text, from a much earlier period, that inspired my own work. To a remarkable degree, Kathleen Dickenson Mellen's *An Island Kingdom Passes: Hawaii Becomes American* (1958) anticipates my own project of discussing Kalākaua in relation to a genealogy of misrepresentations his enemies constructed that became accepted truth within twentieth-century English-language publications. Arguing that a more complete picture of the mō'i could be gained simply by drawing on "natural prejudices,"¹¹ Mellen describes the received history of his reign as the product of those constantly endeavoring to overthrow the monarchy itself. Of Walter Murray Gibson, Kalākaua's cabinet minister and staunch supporter, Mellen remarks that he was "painted by his detractors as a rascally knave (a portrait copied by subsequent writers who fail to look deeply into the subject)" because "to those whose imperialistic schemes he endeavored to frustrate he was a

villain of deepest dye.” Perhaps most strikingly, Mellen quotes Isobel Strong to show that Kalākaua himself recognized that the attacks on his character were actually part of a larger plan to overthrow his kingdom.¹² Shortly before the Bayonet Constitution imposition of 1887, the mōī met with Strong:

“Why is the Missionary Party making so much trouble for Your Majesty?” she asked him. “It is not me personally, what they want is my country.... It has been a steady fight ever since I came to the throne ...” I was appalled. “Take the islands away from you? Surely they couldn’t do that!” I said. “Not while I live,” he replied.¹³

In some aspects, Mellen’s account of Kalākaua anticipates my argument about what motivations created his negative reputation. *Reclaiming Kalākaua*, however, supports my argument through a close examination of the negative portrayals, the positive representations, and the Hawaiian-language publications so prevalent during his life.

Seven specific critical texts published between 2002 and 2017, in addition to *Voices of Fire*, have also strongly influenced this study and should be mentioned here. Jonathan Kay Kamakawiwo’ole Osorio’s groundbreaking research in *Dismembering Lāhui: A History of the Hawaiian Nation to 1887* documents how colonialism in Hawai’i fractured the Hawaiian nation by way of a foreign “racial and legal discourse,” beginning with foreign advisors to Kamehameha I. One of Osorio’s strongest claims is that the Native opposition to Kalākaua resulted from their desire to sustain Hawai’i’s independent nationhood. In their research, Osorio, Puakea Nogelmeier, and Noenoe Silva underscore the complexity of nineteenth-century Native ideology and partisanship. As Osorio notes, Natives “understood how the state had come to symbolize their very survival as a people.”¹⁴ This centralizing notion steered the direction for the majority, if not almost all, of Kānaka Maoli in the nineteenth century. Perhaps most notably, Joseph Nāwahī

was a loyal Native nationalist who challenged the king for several reasons, including the 1876 Reciprocity Treaty, which, Osorio notes, Nāwahī considered a “nation-snatching treaty, one that will take away the rights of the people causing the throne to be deprived of powers that it has always held as fundamental.”¹⁵ While annexation to the United States occurred in 1898, Lili‘uokalani was illegally overthrown in 1893 by the Committee of Safety, a group largely identical in membership to the Hawaiian League that forced Kalākaua to sign its constitution in 1887. The “slow, insinuating invasion of people, ideas, and institutions” that Osorio claims led to the dismemberment of the lāhui (people or nation) had even earlier influenced the 1876 Reciprocity Treaty.¹⁶ Osorio asserts that the problems of the mō‘ī’s reign included the survival of the nation, its people, and its values. *Reclaiming Kalākaua* seeks to determine how nineteenth-century newspapers rendered his efforts to resolve those challenges.

Noenoe K. Silva’s *Aloha Betrayed: Native Hawaiian Resistance to American Colonialism* is a breakthrough narrative that identifies a number of Kalākaua’s controversial actions as elements of a political strategy to restore and strengthen Native nationalism in the face of missionary suppression, the white oligarchy, and threatening US annexation. Silva notes his efforts to stabilize the monarchy and the lāhui through the republication of the creation chant *Kumulipo* as *He Pule Hoolaa Alii* (A Prayer Consecrating a Chief)—a source of “pride and identity for the Kanaka Maoli” that substantiated Kalākaua’s right to rule.¹⁷ Silva describes how Kalākaua reinstituted the Hale Nauā as “an urban organization of the ali‘i who attempted to preserve traditional knowledge, validate that knowledge with contemporary science, and counter the discourses of race, civilization, and savagery deployed by the haole elite in efforts to subjugate them.”¹⁸ She also refers to the mō‘ī’s coronation and jubilee as “public celebrations of tradition [that] served to alleviate some of the psychological harm done to the lāhui through the social and economic colonization” of the nineteenth

century.¹⁹ Silva's extensive consultation of nineteenth-century Hawaiian-language newspapers and other publications not only confirms a strong Native loyalty to Kalākaua and the lāhui in the face of a peaking colonial wave but, as Nogelmeier has noted, is "indicative of a change in direction for Hawaiian-language scholarship."²⁰

While Stacy L. Kamehiro's *The Arts of Kingship: Hawaiian Art and National Culture of the Kalākaua Era* focuses on the ceremonies and material culture of Kalākaua's reign, it also presents the mō'i as "an intellectual, musician, art patron, and politician" who was "trained in law, and enjoyed artistic and scientific pursuits throughout his life."²¹ Kamehiro remarks on the negative portraits that have dominated historical accounts:

Conventional histories frequently paint a particularly cursory or unsympathetic portrait of Kalākaua ... variously representing him as a naive leader who followed the counsel of mischievous foreign advisers, an ineffective ruler whose biased policies roused ethnic conflict, or a king who preferred merrymaking and pursuing various spectacles and entertainments to serious politics.²²

Kamehiro notes, however, that "some scholars and biographers have authored more evenhanded accounts of the Kalākaua period, eliciting complex social and political issues of the time and indicating the degree to which the criticisms and biased treatment of Kalākaua's reign are largely the legacy of his opponents."²³ Her own project is one of those accounts and has informed much of my own thinking when examining the extensive literary archive documenting his reputation and character.

Puakea Nogelmeier's *Mai Pa'a i ka Leo: Historical Voice in Hawaiian Primary Materials. Looking Forward and Listening Back* is a history of the creation of what he calls a "discourse of sufficiency": an assemblage of English translations of four mid-nineteenth-century collections of Hawaiian writings that,

due to a “relative vacuum of Hawaiian resources into which the English texts emerged” and to the critical assessment of those translations, became a canon of sorts for most scholarship and research based on Hawai‘i’s history that felt the need to consider the Hawaiian point of view. The four authors and their translated texts are David Malo’s *Hawaiian Antiquities*; Kepelino Keauokalani’s *Kepelino’s Tradition of Hawaii*; John Papa ‘Ī‘Ī’s *Fragments of Hawaiian History*; and Samuel M. Kamakau’s *Ruling Chiefs of Hawaii, Ka Po‘e Kahiko: The People of Old, the Works of the People of Old: Na Hana a ka Po‘e Kahiko*, and *Tales and Traditions of the People of Old: Na Mo‘olelo o ka Po‘e Kahiko*.²⁴ While Nogelmeier points out many highly problematic aspects of these translations, the overarching dilemma he identifies is these texts unintentionally absolving scholars from having to consult the hundreds of thousands of pages of essential historical material to be found in the Hawaiian-language newspapers of the nineteenth and early twentieth centuries. To take one example highly pertinent to my project, in 1891, within two weeks of Kalākaua’s death, Joseph Moku‘ōhai Poepoe published *Ka Moolelo o ka Moi Kalakaua I*, a detailed seventy-five-page biography of the mō‘ī in Hawaiian, written by someone who knew him personally, that refers to earlier and current nineteenth-century Hawaiian- and English-language materials. And yet, Ralph S. Kuykendall’s *The Hawaiian Kingdom Volume III, 1874–1893: The Kalakaua Dynasty* (I discuss this volume in chapter 1), the best-known history of this reign, does not even acknowledge this Hawaiian-language source exists. Nogelmeier describes this as symptomatic of Hawaiian historical scholarship in general: “For decades, scholarly works in fields relating to Hawaiian history and culture have been accepted as rigorous and lauded as such with no recognition of the large body of pertinent texts that remained untapped”—namely, “the range of resources found in the only locus of public expressions among Hawaiians: the newspapers of the 19th and early 20th centuries.”²⁵ As *Mai Pa‘a i ka Leo* notes, certainly Malo, Kepelino, ‘Ī‘Ī, and Kamakau were among the most

knowledgeable intellectuals of their era, “sought out and relied upon as experts by their peers, their governments, and their churches.”²⁶ But their works in translation often come to us in garbled and incomplete versions, and whole bodies of archival materials in Hawaiian are never consulted at all. [Chapter 1](#) of *Reclaiming* describes in detail the consequences of this state of affairs, and the remaining chapters seek in part to offer an alternative. This centralizing notion steered the direction of the majority, if not almost all, of the Kānaka Maoli in the nineteenth century.

Kamanamaikalani Beamer’s *No Mākou ka Mana: Liberating the Nation* has also served as a foundation for this study. While Beamer examines how Hawaiian ali’i carefully and systematically adopted effective Native and foreign administrative policies to obtain national and international recognition for Hawai’i, he acknowledges ali’i agency in the building and sustaining of Hawai’i’s sovereignty, which speaks to Kalākaua’s master plan of adeptly incorporating Hawaiian traditions with Western practices to strengthen Hawai’i’s independence and secure international recognition and cooperation in the face of imperialism: “Branching out from the reigns of the previous mō’ī, Kalākaua heightened the nation’s cultural consciousness while pushing to insure a new level of Hawaiian independence.”²⁷ Beamer further points out that during Kalākaua’s 1881 journey around the world, the king met with Japan’s emperor and Siam’s sovereign, and the imperialism encroaching upon those Asian countries’ own nationhoods confirmed Kalākaua’s own aim to build ties with such countries. *Reclaiming Kalākaua* seeks to continue Beamer’s textual dialogue by providing a better, more detailed understanding of how nineteenth-century newspapers present a more complete picture of this mō’ī’s agency in sustaining Hawai’i’s independence.

Noenoe K. Silva’s most recent work, *The Power of the Steel-Tipped Pen: Reconstructing Native Hawaiian Intellectual History*, examines the literary contributions of nineteenth-century Kānaka ‘Ōiwi mea kākau (authors) Joseph Ho’ona’auao Kānepu’u and Joseph Moku’ōhai Poepoe to the

Hawaiian-language newspapers as examples of a rich historical Native intellectual tradition. Likewise, *Reclaiming* seeks to resurrect nineteenth-century Native literary engagement in composing and publishing newspapers in Hawaiian to help twenty-first-century readers understand this Native Hawaiian ideology and conscious investment in retaining and preserving the government, the lāhui, and their land. “How will our picture of Hawaiian history, them, and ourselves change,” Silva asks, “when we know their names, their politics, and the extent of their written philosophies, literature, and so forth?”²⁸ As an essential component of the study of nineteenth-century Native Hawaiian postcolonial discourse, political theory, and literary engagement, the Hawaiian-language newspaper articles published during Kalākaua’s reign illuminate ‘Ōiwi mastery of intellectual scholarship and publication. Building on Silva’s discussion of the works of Kānepu‘u and Poepoe, *Reclaiming* adds an often detailed consideration of the writings of newspaper greats and Hawaiian nationalists John Bush, John Mika Sobe, F. Meka, John K. Kaunamano, S. P. Kanoe, and Thomas Spencer. Because of their unyielding loyalty to the Hawaiian monarchy and their adept deployment of rhetoric and the foreign-introduced press, these men found ways to expose and resist the Hawaiian League’s attack on Kalākaua’s powers in 1887 and to sustain such resistance after his death in 1891. They stand as strong links in the kū’auhau (genealogy) of Native Hawaiian intellectualism.

Silva’s, ho‘omanawanui’s, Osorio’s, Kamehiro’s, Nogelmeier’s, and Beamer’s texts have inspired me in my own archival work. In a very different way, so has James L. Haley’s *Captive Paradise: A History of Hawai‘i*, a 2014 one-volume history of Hawai‘i that suggests how little has changed. In many places, Haley’s book reads like an update of Eugene Burns’ *The Last King of Paradise* (1952), a character assassination of Kalākaua drawn almost exclusively from the anti-mō‘ī English-language archive. Haley opens his highly fictionalized narrative by inaccurately remarking that “oddly, there has never been a narrative history of Hawai‘i,”

so he decided that he would provide one. His comment on “native language resources,” or the lack of them, reads at best as an excuse and at worst as a complete lack of concern about whether his story is accurate, given his intended audience: “My general examination of the Americanization of Hawai‘i for a mainland audience that, mostly, does not know the story at all, may not be crucially dependent upon such sources.”²⁹ In short, he announces that he is presenting an incomplete history because his audience does not want or need anything better, which implicitly he could not provide anyway because he lacks the ability to do so.

In 2003, eleven years before *Captive Paradise*, Juri Mykkanen wrote in *Inventing Politics: A New Political Anthropology of the Hawaiian Kingdom*:

After the rise of Hawaiian historical ethnography (e.g., the work of Kame‘eleihiwa, Linnekin, and Sahlins), there is little need to argue that native Hawaiian sources are of equal importance to those produced by any other participants in the encounter.... Particularly important are the Hawaiian-language newspapers which were published from the 1830s into the mid-twentieth century. No student of late nineteenth-century Hawaiian history can ignore them.³⁰

Haley ignores them, and the result is a repetition of hundred-year-old prejudices and misrepresentations. Sometimes the results are simply ignorant. How could anyone with even an elementary knowledge of Hawai‘i’s ali‘i refer to “David Kalakaua with his weighty but not royal family behind him”?³¹ His description of the mō‘ī’s “thoughts” after his 1881 voyage around the world is also the product of nineteenth-century distortion:

Kalakaua sensed that at the end of all games, Hawaii was too small and weak to exist indefinitely as an independent country. He believed that it must, eventually, come under the dominion of either the Americans, whose cultural and commercial

encroachment was already pervasive, or the Japanese—an outside chance, but one that he thought he could perhaps improve.³²

Even a brief look at contemporary sources indicate that Kalākaua fought for Hawai‘i’s independence to the end of his life ([see chapters 2](#) through 6). Haley’s narrative, therefore, is the most recent in a long line of calculating, biased, or uninformed publications about Hawai‘i, joining Eugene Burns, Kristin Zambucka, Helena G. Allen, Lorrin A. Thurston, and Sanford B. Dole in perpetuating mean fictions about the mō‘ī, Hawaiians, and the kingdom. As such, Haley’s work reminds me that despite the remarkable contributions of scholars such as ho‘omanawanui, Kame‘eleihiwa, Osorio, Silva, Nogelmeier, and Kamehiro, the work of countering such misrepresentations must continue.

[Chapter 2](#), “Kalākaua Reconsidered,” is a detailed survey of the alternative nineteenth-century representations and discussions of Kalākaua in English-language newspapers published in the United States and abroad concerning the king’s travels in 1874 and 1881, as well as impressions of him by visitors to Hawai‘i until his death. The chapter will argue that the body of positive representations of Kalākaua outweighs the collection discussed in [chapter 1](#) of critical characterizations of him, offering in the process an archive of contemporary documents that present his character as impressive and admirable. This material often acknowledges public criticism of Kalākaua but then refutes it on the basis of personal experience, reporting after interviews or encounters with him that he is very impressive or pleasing. My governing assumptions here are those articulated by Amy Ku‘uleialoha Stillman:

When previously unknown sources come to light, interpretations must be reevaluated and, if necessary, altered. Likewise, a historian’s purview might extend to sources passed over by his or her predecessors. Thus disparate histories can result from consultation with different kinds of sources. This is particularly the case

in situations of colonization, where histories from generations past were produced largely or even solely from records of the colonizers.³³

[Chapter 2](#) therefore begins the process of creating a disparate history by looking at the mō'i through the eyes of his supporters and admirers: those not afraid to acknowledge and respect him and his office as a Hawaiian monarch. If nothing else, the archives reveal that during his widespread travels, the curious and the admiring could not get enough of him. Dozens of newspapers within a single country would post notices of Kalākaua's impending arrival, provide extensive coverage of his activities in the city and country, and record his departure. All over the world, the general population, the nobility and royalty, and even the pope treated Kalākaua with the respect due someone they considered a king. They then often recorded their discovery that his was a figure of refinement, culture, insight, and grace.

[Chapter 1](#) therefore rehearses the attacks on Kalākaua, while [chapter 2](#) reconsiders them, documenting how skillfully and bravely he navigated past the criticism and attacks leveled at him regularly. One conclusion is that people outside Hawai'i without an ulterior motive for denigrating Kalākaua generally had a highly favorable impression of him, confirming that intent and motivation must be considered when evaluating the reliability of the mō'i's representations. In fact, [chapter 2](#) will show that Kalākaua's enemies often denied he possessed, or attacked him for possessing, precisely those attributes his supporters admired most. This section also delineates the motivations behind the entire range of nineteenth-century international newspaper stories on the mō'i. While some published sensationalized stories of "The King of the Cannibal Isles" to attract their readership, other newspapers presented favorable depictions of Kalākaua, with reporter after reporter finding him intelligent and dignified—the exact opposite of the island king stereotype. Not surprisingly, special attention was paid to the 1881 world tour, countering the complaints and slander his

enemies published about this journey with the praise he received after people around the world witnessed his nobility and intellect. These writers were especially pleased with the interest Kalākaua took in their countries or cities. When the mōʻī arrived anywhere, he almost always requested a tour of the most famous sights, particularly academies and factories—not just to satisfy his keen intellectual curiosity but to obtain new ideas for innovation and improvement at home.

In [chapter 3](#), “Hawai‘i’s Early English- and Hawaiian-Language Representations of Kalākaua,” I will draw from Hawai‘i’s nineteenth-century representations of Kalākaua in Hawaiian and in English within the kingdom’s newspapers from 1860 to 1874. The dynamics of language and politics in these papers were complex. Some English-language newspapers written and edited by haole supported Kalākaua; some Hawaiian-language newspapers produced by Native Hawaiians attacked him. A newspaper’s language did not therefore determine its motives, but simply because the archives have been so seldom consulted, above all, this chapter offers especially detailed accounts of Native Hawaiian sentiment about the mōʻī expressed in Hawaiian-language sources. [Chapter 3](#) brings to the forefront compelling evidence of strong and sustained Native Hawaiian loyalty to and aloha for Kalākaua. No other narrative has closely examined the responses to him in the nineteenth-century Hawaiian-language newspapers throughout the difficult, confusing, and fascinating events of the mōʻī’s reign. Nogelmeier has stressed the importance of such an approach when studying Hawai‘i’s history: “The impact of leaving most of the Hawaiian writings out of the mix of modern knowledge is that every form of history written, every cultural study undertaken, and every assumption made over most of the last century should be revisited in light of those neglected sources.”³⁴ And Amy Stillman has pointed toward contemporary Native support for Kalākaua in texts produced for hula and in the press: “The political turmoil of the late 1880s and 1890s contributed to a dramatic increase in the use of poetic texts for political and explicitly nationalist

commentary.... Moreover, nationalist poetic discourse took place in arguably the most public of forums—Hawaiian-language newspapers.”³⁵ According to Stillman, 134 poetic texts appeared in the Hawaiian-language newspapers between 1883 and 1892 that declared Native support for Kalākaua and makaʻāinana resistance to colonial opposition.³⁶ Although at a number of key moments Hawaiians divided into opposing political factions, the vast majority valued Hawaiʻi’s continuing independence. On the other hand, talk of annexation to the United States had been increasing within the foreign community for decades, coming into sharper focus with Kalākaua’s 1874 ascent to the throne and the passage of the 1876 Reciprocity Treaty.

Altogether, the hundreds of favorable representations of the mōʻī in Hawaiian, American, and international publications affirm his efforts to preserve the Hawaiian Kingdom’s independence—a large, complex series of actions that often strategically benefited the business element in Honolulu while resisting its wishes to hand Hawaiʻi over to America. Those Congregational missionaries who arrived a year after the death of Kamehameha I repeatedly denied that they had plans to take control of the kingdom. But they certainly did see Hawaiians as barbaric and in need of Christianity’s civilizing mores. Years later, their descendants still believed this but joined to it a desire to control the economy to expand the profits from the lucrative sugar industry, feeling that no one but people like themselves should rule. Carol Wilcox notes that increases in industrial power had a profound impact on populations and governments: “The decades leading up to the 1880s were perhaps like no other in human history. Advances in technology revolutionized people’s ability worldwide to alter the environment, to produce and transport things, to communicate. And these innovations all had an impact in Hawaii, as well.”³⁷

Because a loss of Native agency would lead to a loss of Hawaiian identity, Kalākaua had to think quickly and creatively. He attacked depopulation with the motto,

“Ho‘oulu Lāhui” (Increase the Nation), establishing a government board, changing laws to encourage repopulation and to educate maka‘āinana on “family planning,” and in 1881, leaving Hawai‘i in part to find a race of people to cohabit with his Hawaiian subjects and rebuild the population. But the mō‘ī’s plan also involved reinvigorating a Hawaiian sense of nationalism and hope through signs, symbols, and words. Jocelyn Linnekin’s description of contemporary nations’ actions could have been drawn from Kalākaua’s efforts: “Whether called ethnicity, nationality, or even ‘race,’ cultural identity is a potent basis for political mobilization among peoples disenfranchised under colonial rule,” she writes, and “invoking the cultural past to validate and solidify group identity is a common practice in modern nationalism.... The past is commonly used to validate the present.”³⁸ For this reason, Kalākaua worked to preserve and encourage the creation of mele (song). During his coronation festivities in 1883, he invited old Hawaiians from all parts of the kingdom to ‘Iolani Palace to recite and perform mele and hula, which he had transcribed.³⁹ Kalākaua did not simply enjoy mele written during his reign for the pleasure or relief they gave him. At almost too many to count, these mele were tangible, living evidence of a highly, intelligent, perceptive, and self-conscious people.

Chapter 4, “Strengthening the Kingdom Abroad,” continues to examine how Hawai‘i’s nineteenth-century English- and Hawaiian-language newspapers presented Kalākaua during his reign, specifically while on his 1874 trip to Washington, DC, and his tour around the world in 1881. In particular, Kalākaua’s circumnavigation provides an opportunity to better understand the politics of Hawai‘i’s newspapers because the promonarchy papers presented that undertaking as a successful business trip wherein the king solidified relationships with international and national leaders and returned to Hawai‘i with ideas to help the kingdom prosper. In fact, because the 1881 business trip around the world demonstrated David Kalākaua’s success as a noble, intellectual leader and exceedingly effective

negotiator who was highly invested in his kingdom, the opposition papers had to minimize or deny the king's accomplishments and ultimately treat the entire journey almost as if it had never happened. By looking at the Hawaiian-language newspapers' coverage of the 1881 trip alone, we can gain access to an archive of nineteenth-century Native sentiment for Kalākaua, for as Nogelmeier explains, "Hawaiian-language materials as a whole are a time capsule of important historical and cultural writings, and the newspapers are the most dense, most interconnecting portion of that historical cache." Between 1834 and 1948, more than one hundred Hawaiian-language newspapers were published in Hawai'i, with an output equal to about one million typed pages. The nineteenth-century Kānaka Maoli intellectual and literary traditions as documented in newspaper publishing were both extensive and impressive, and a large part of this study is based on those traditions. A significant amount of those newspaper articles were intended to increase a sense of Hawaiian nationalism within the lāhui, to preserve cultural knowledge on paper, and to resist colonialism.

[Chapter 5](#), "To Preserve the Monarchy and the Lāhuikanaka," argues that the Hawaiian monarchy was inextricably tied to the lāhuikanaka, or what I call the indigenous Hawaiian Nation, and the 1883 coronation and 1886 jubilee were Kalākaua's attempts to renew his people and thereby sustain his image as mō'ī. This chapter first examines nineteenth-century Hawaiian-language newspapers' responses to David Kalākaua's designs to celebrate Native nationalism. In particular, the hula and the mele examined in [chapter 5](#) are evidence of the king's efforts to awaken his people to a sense of unity, hopefulness, and revival. Kalākaua's ability to plan his coronation and jubilee therefore not only demonstrates his mana (supernatural or divine power, authority) as mō'ī but also his perceptiveness about how that power needed to be wielded in the problematical indigenous social climate of the nineteenth century. Along with depopulation, leprosy, tuberculosis, diabetes, gonorrhea, syphilis, cancer, mumps, beriberi,

diphtheria, and other diseases would raise ‘Ōiwi mortality and infant mortality rates. As George Kanahale notes: “Having lost much of their sense of identity and self-esteem,” Kānaka Maoli communities suffered further from the “litany of broken homes, absent fathers, drunkenness, crime and delinquency, truancy, and other social dislocations.” The “family disintegration increasingly left Hawaiians without their customary refuges of security and love and respect,” and the family unit and therefore communities were traumatized.⁴⁰ Kalākaua responded by celebrating ‘Ōiwi culture. “Cultural festivities provide a potent space for intercultural accommodations to be negotiated on largely indigenous terrain,” Peter Phipps writes, “strengthening indigenous agency, and resetting the terms of cross-cultural engagement for at least the duration of these staged encounters.”⁴¹ Just weeks after Kalākaua ascended the throne, *Ka Nupepa Kuokoa* attacked the hula performances in Honolulu:

Aohe kohu iki o ka poe hula Hawaii i hele hula ae ai ma ke ahiahi Poakahi iho nei.—me ka hookanikani ana i na uli-uli, a e kuhi ana na lima i o ia nei, a e ha’u ana na waha i ka makani—O keia mau mea i hanaia ua hoohilahila mai ia oe e Hawaii, ua kupono keia mau mea na ka pegana wale no o kela au—Mai hana ino oe e Hawaii ia oe iho! E kapu loa na hula.⁴²

(Not appropriate at all were the Hawaiian dancers who went around doing hula on this Monday evening—rattling their uliuli, their hands pointing this way and that, and their mouths huffing away in the wind—These things that were done shame you, O Hawaii; this kind of thing is appropriate only for the pagan of the past—O Hawaiians, stop hurting yourselves! Hula is strictly banned.)⁴³

The mō‘ī’s encouragement of hula’s public performance throughout his reign was a direct, defiant reply to missionary-based newspaper opposition, even in the

Hawaiian language, to any claim that past and present could combine to nurture and increase Hawaiian nationalism. [Chapter 5](#) then examines the Hawaiian-language newspapers' coverage of the king's jubilee three years later. The papers, even the oppositional ones, were mostly supportive of the celebrations. Following the jubilee, public disturbances arose on the part of the Hawaiian League, and [chapter 5](#) shifts its attention to the English-language press. Just prior to the Hawaiian League's illegal and violent coercion of its Bayonet Constitution upon Kalākaua, several English-language newspapers in Hawai'i began to threaten the lives of the king and Walter Murray Gibson. Following the 1887 Bayonet Constitution, Natives took to the newspapers to organize their protest and resistance. One Kānaka 'Ōiwi, Robert Kalanihiapo William Wilcox, decided to fight the opposition and restore Kalākaua's powers. Although Wilcox was ultimately unsuccessful, the newspapers' coverage of his and maka'āinana work to restore the Hawaiian monarchy and independent nation during this time are permanent testaments to the significance of the Hawaiian press.

[Chapter 6](#), "The Final Days of Kalākaua," examines the pinnacle of maka'āinana aloha for and loyalty to David Kalākaua as expressed after the mō'ī's passing. This chapter includes the most comprehensive study of Hawaiian-language publications of this time period. It not only captures the intimate Kanaka affection for their makua (parent) through mele but also describes the grand public displays of maka'āinana aloha for Kalākaua during his funeral and in the letters of condolences following his burial. Arguably, the most substantial text consulted during my research, and in some ways the epitome of favorable Hawaiian representations of the mō'ī, is *Ka Moolelo o ka Moi Kalakaua I*. Appearing within a week of the arrival of the mō'ī's body from San Francisco, it proclaimed his nobility, sustained the aloha of maka'āinana for him, and advocated nationalism in his name for the lāhui. One of its most significant sections is Poepoe's kanikau, or funeral dirge, for Kalākaua. It lists and describes the various places he visited during his reign, employing many Hawaiian names that no longer appear on

contemporary maps and have disappeared from people's daily conversations. In this work and many, many others, we encounter the aloha and respect that Hawaiians had for their mō'i and gain a more complete sense of Kalākaua himself—foregrounding qualities and contexts that his enemies ignored, concealed, or denied and that later writers often never looked for.⁴⁴ [Chapter 6](#) concludes with the marked transition in newspaper coverage of kingdom politics in response to the king's death. While the year 1883 saw a dramatic change in the Hawaiian press, the publishing progression of 1891 was unmatched.

Reclaiming Kalākaua seeks to contribute to current literary studies of nineteenth-century Native Hawaiian postcolonial cultural theory and history, indigenous politics, and Kānaka Maoli methodologies. The reign of Kalākaua contained pivotal changes that led to the United States' complicity and active engagement in the illegal overthrow of the Hawaiian monarchy. Kalākaua's mind and person in trying to sustain an independent nation represent nineteenth-century Kanaka Maoli intellectuals who were well versed in all traditional Hawaiian and Western subjects and informed about peoples, places, and cultures both past and current. This study seeks to open readers' minds to nineteenth-century Native Hawaiian intellectualism, ali'i nui, and one mō'i's fight to secure the independence of his one hānau (birth sands) and the thriving livelihood of his lāhuikanaka.

The term "maka'āinana" once generally signified nonchiefly status, or that of a "commoner." With the advent of nationhood, the term was used to refer to a citizen of the nation, whether an indigenous Hawaiian or an immigrant granted full citizenship. (It can be confusing, but many historical references to "Hawaiians" were regarding citizenship rather than bloodline.) "Kānaka Maoli," "Native," "Kānaka 'Ōiwi," and "Native Hawaiian" describe the indigenous people whose ancestors can be traced back to residing in Hawai'i before 1778.

While the nineteenth-century Hawaiian- and English-language newspapers often had very clear editorial positions

in relation to the monarchy, the language of publication did not necessarily indicate an editor's loyalty. Although I will try to clarify these editorial positions as they become relevant, in general, *Nupepa Kuokoa*, though referred to at times as the "native press" because it was in Hawaiian, actually supported American business interests and attacked Kalākaua, thanks to its editor, Henry M. Whitney. Conversely, foreigner Walter Murray Gibson's Hawaiian- and English-language *Ka Nuhou Hawaii*, *Nupepa Poakolu*, *Elele Poaono*, and *Nupepa Elele* championed Kānaka Maoli and the mō'ī. Although the English-language *Pacific Commercial Advertiser* generally backed haole business interests, when Gibson had editorial control it backed Kalākaua as well and as a result faced harsh criticism from the other English-language newspapers: the *Hawaiian Gazette*, also edited by Whitney; the *Saturday Press*, written largely by Thomas G. Thrum; and the *Daily Bulletin*, published by James W. Robertson. In the early part of Kalākaua's reign, Joseph Kawainui's Hawaiian-language *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina* supported the mō'ī, but in later years, it opposed him. The Hawaiian-language nationalist *Ka Leo o ka Lahui* ardently supported Kalākaua and blamed his enemies for his death. [Chapter 3](#) will elaborate on these allegiances and the reasons for them.

Notes

- [1.](#) Damon, *Sanford Ballard Dole*, 170.
- [2.](#) This hō'ailona will be discussed further in the text. Lili'uokalani, *Hawaii's Story*, 103, 155.
- [3.](#) "Na Kahoaka a ka Po i na Alii i Hala," *Ka Leo o ka Lahui*, February 3, 1891, 2, Ulukau: Hawaiian Electronic Library (Ho'olaupa'i: He 'Ohina Nūpepa 'Ōlelo Hawai'i; hereafter cited as Ulukau).
- [4.](#) See Kamehiro, *Arts of Kingship* for an analysis of these hō'ailona.
- [5.](#) Imada, *Aloha America*, 34.
- [6.](#) See Curtis and Thurston, "Sandwich Islands," 265–286; L. Young, *Boston at Hawaii*; W. N. Armstrong, *Around the World*; Thurston, *Memoirs of the Hawaiian Revolution*; Dole, *Memoirs of the Hawaiian Revolution*.
- [7.](#) See Mellen, *Island Kingdom Passes*, xiii–xiv.
- [8.](#) See K. Young, "Kuleana," 1–33; Cook, "Kahiki: Native Hawaiian Relationships."
- [9.](#) ho'omanawanui, *Voices of Fire*, xxviii.
- [10.](#) K. Young, "Kuleana," 8.

- [11.](#) Mellen, *Island Kingdom Passes*, xi.
- [12.](#) Ibid., xii-xiii.
- [13.](#) Ibid., 199.
- [14.](#) Osorio, *Dismembering Lāhui*, 147.
- [15.](#) Ibid., 168.
- [16.](#) Ibid., 3.
- [17.](#) Silva, *Aloha Betrayed*, 98, 103.
- [18.](#) Ibid., 107.
- [19.](#) Ibid., 121.
- [20.](#) Nogelmeier, *Mai Pa'a*, 56.
- [21.](#) Kamehiro, *Arts of Kingship*, 1.
- [22.](#) Ibid., 5.
- [23.](#) Ibid.
- [24.](#) Nogelmeier, *Mai Pa'a*, 31, 32.
- [25.](#) Ibid., 51
- [26.](#) Ibid., 48.
- [27.](#) Beamer, *No Mākou ka Mana*, 176.
- [28.](#) Silva, *Power of the Steel-Tipped Pen*, 8.
- [29.](#) Haley, *Captive Paradise*, xii, xiv.
- [30.](#) Mykkanene, *Inventing Politics*, 19.
- [31.](#) Haley, *Captive Paradise*, 227.
- [32.](#) Ibid., 238.
- [33.](#) Stillman, "Of the People," 85-86.
- [34.](#) Nogelmeier, *Mai Pa'a*, xi; see ho'omanawanui, *Voices of Fire*, xxvii.
- [35.](#) Stillman, "Of the People," 93.
- [36.](#) Ibid., 94.
- [37.](#) Wilcox, *Sugar Water*, 63.
- [38.](#) Linnekin, "Politics of Culture," 151.
- [39.](#) Marquez, "Ancient Hawaiian Music," 97.
- [40.](#) Kanahele, *Pauahi*, 170-171. See also "Almost a Death Everyday ... 1873," June 15, 2015, *Nupepa-hawaii* (blog).
- [41.](#) Phipps, "Performances of Power," 217-218.
- [42.](#) "Aohe Kohu Iki," *Nupepa-hawaii* (blog), *Ka Nupepa Kuokoa*, March 21, 1874, 3.
- [43.](#) "More Criticism of Hula, 1874," *Nupepa-hawaii* (blog), *Ka Nupepa Kuokoa*, March 21, 1874, 3.
- [44.](#) See Burns, *Last King of Paradise*; Kuykendall, *Hawaiian Kingdom*; H. G. Allen, *Kalakaua*; Zambucka, *Kalakaua: Hawaii's Last King*.

CHAPTER ONE

The Case against Kalākaua

In *Aloha Betrayed: Native Hawaiian Resistance to American Colonialism*, Noenoe Silva has written: “In the historiography of Hawai‘i, King Kalākaua, who reigned from 1874–1891, may be the most reviled and ridiculed of the monarchs.”¹ Stacy L. Kamehiro has also summed it up this way: “Conventional histories” of the king represent him as a “naive leader who followed the counsel of mischievous foreign advisors, an ineffective ruler whose biased policies roused ethnic conflict, or a king who preferred merrymaking and pursuing various spectacles and entertainments to serious politics.”² The vitriol directed at Kalākaua through books, pamphlets, magazines, and gossip; the relentless attacks in the newspapers; and the character assassinations of him in travel writings provide the roots of his later notoriety. As those who have studied the mō‘ī (sovereign) know, he is seen not only as the embodiment of a renaissance of Hawaiian traditions but also a reckless merrie monarch—drunk, foolish, unreliable, and corrupt. How did this genealogy of King David Kalākaua’s misrepresentations begin? While some fabrications were politically motivated and others were merely scurrilous, at the root of this lineage of parody, falsification, and distortion lay the clash between nineteenth-century race, politics, and power in the Kingdom of Hawai‘i. When Victorian philosophers and scientists Herbert Spencer and Charles Darwin and mathematician Karl Pearson deliberately, or not, helped to develop nineteenth-century popular theories on the survival of the fittest, they fueled ideological explanations for the driving forces of industrialization and technological advancement in travel and urbanization in Britain, as well as for the competitive American and British economies and their imperious

colonizing forces. Because these aggressive movements cast Hawaiians and other indigenous populations as weak, uncivilized, and primitive, these dominant societies assumed that such populations would eventually vanish—and population statistics at that time supported this premise.³ In Hawai'i, specifically, the considerable success of the Reciprocity Treaty of 1875 forced the kingdom to become increasingly dependent upon America, and haole covetous consumption of Hawai'i land and sovereignty in the legislature weakened the monarchy's control of the islands. Noenoe Silva and Jonathan Osorio have discussed how two opposing ideologies were centered in the Hawaiian Kingdom: Kānaka Maoli believed that Hawai'i was for Hawaiians and was an independent nation-state, while most non-Natives were still loyal to their countries of birth and even maintained citizenship in those places. Even most non-Natives born in Hawai'i were loyal to either America or Britain, and so on. As a result, many non-Natives never supported the monarchy. In fact, for many Americans residing in Hawai'i, colonizing the kingdom for the United States was a natural step on the path of imperialism, of greater Anglo-Saxon social stratification, and of complete control of the Hawaiian sugar industry.

But taking the Kingdom of Hawai'i would have to begin with removing its sovereign—bit by bit and then more aggressively, proving King Kalākaua unable to successfully lead his nation. As Michael G. Vann explains, “By repeating the central themes of corruption, incompetence, hubris, and immorality, the haole ideology sought to delegitimize the government.”⁴ Three main groups of people attacked the king's character, together taking part in advancing one underlying, persistent smear against him: that he was utterly unfit to govern. While most Kānaka Maoli in the first two groups wanted another Native sovereign to lead their nation, non-Natives in the last group really wanted to take Hawai'i out of 'Ōiwi hands and govern it themselves. If the opposition could prove King Kalākaua was a failure as a leader, they believed, then his overthrow would be welcomed, which would pave the way for US annexation.

The Case against Kalākaua by Kānaka Maoli in the Kingdom

The first group of people who opposed the king was made up of those closest to him: Kānaka Maoli in the Kingdom of Hawai'i. At the top, a few ali'i nui (chiefs, chiefesses) were known to disregard Kalākaua as their king. Princess Bernice Pauahi Bishop and Ruth Ke'elikōlani did not attend the king's coronation in 1883. Perhaps it was because the ali'i nui saw the ceremony as wasteful spending. Perhaps the women, of the Kamehameha line, were opposed to Kalākaua because he descended from the Keaweāheulu family, another noble Native lineage but not the Kamehamehas. Kalākaua's political rival Queen Emma was known to oppose Kalākaua. The queen had been married to King Kamehameha IV Alexander 'Iolani Liholiho until his death in 1863. Years later, she campaigned against Prince David Kalākaua for the throne after Hawai'i's sixth mō'i, William Charles Lunalilo, died in 1874. In several letters to her cousin Peter Young Ka'eo while he lived as a leprosy patient on Moloka'i, Queen Emma sent reports from Honolulu on Prince David Kalākaua. On July 29, 1873, Queen Emma wrote that he "is constantly meeting and filling the natives' minds with public sentiments of the day—on cession of territory—and tells them to suggest at the coming Legislature displacing or dethroneing [*sic*] the King for ignorance, drunkenness [*sic*], utter incompetency [*sic*], for by [these failings] he jeopardizes [*sic*] the country's fate."⁵ Ka'eo disliked Kalākaua and described him as the "Bastard of Blossom's," referring to the rumor that Kalākaua was not the son of Ali'i nui Kapa'akea but of John Blossom, an early African who had settled in Hawai'i.⁶ Queen Emma sought to disprove the prince's competence to rule and discredited him in correspondence and to her acquaintances and supporters. Again to Peter Ka'eo, Queen Emma described Kalākaua's campaign efforts: "He has worked and exerted himself both lawfully, and to be sure unlawfully, as well as right and wrong, to obtain his desire.... All these efforts too are made against strong dislike from the whole

country, who are unanimous against him.”⁷ The very popular Native legislators and Emma supporters Joseph Kaho’oluhi Nāwahī and George Washington Pilipō also overtly opposed Kalākaua for several reasons.⁸ Lunamaka’āinana (representative, legislator) John Kaulukou, J. W. Kalua, and John Ka’uhane would join them later. Joseph Nāwahī, born in 1842 in Puna, Hawai’i, received a Protestant-based education at Hilo Boarding School, Lahainaluna, and the Royal School and over time became an artist, composer, teacher, cartographer, lawyer, legislator, and newspaper editor. Nāwahī was well known for his lifelong fidelity to Hawai’i’s independence and for his unwavering aloha for Hawai’i. Noenoe Silva has explained that Nāwahī firmly believed that “people must strive continuously to control their own government in order to provide life to the people and to care for their land properly,”⁹ and while a lunamaka’āinana representing Puna for nine terms, he clashed with the king over the Reciprocity Treaty and its supposed precedent to annexation.¹⁰ Both Nāwahī and Pilipō wanted the king to curtail his spending, which they saw as wasteful. Jonathan Osorio adds that Nāwahī and Pilipō were

a very special kind of Native; fiercely independent and honest, extremely articulate, and wielding a morality of thrift, they were extolled by the missionary children for being emblematic of the mission’s best intentions. Simultaneously, they were attractive candidates to the kānaka who felt most distant from the center of political power.¹¹

Kalākaua’s 1883 coronation ceremonies nine years after he ascended the throne drew particular criticism from Nāwahī, Pilipō, and many Native subjects, who accused the monarch of careless extravagance. For instance, Joseph Kawainui used his Hawaiian-language newspaper *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina* (Our Hawaiian Archipelago) to challenge Kalākaua: “Heaha la keia mau hana no ka lehulehu? Heaha ka waiwai o keia mau hana a pau i hanaia aku la? Aole he pomaikai hou, he poho wale no

ma ka waihona o ka lahui”¹² (What indeed are these events doing for the masses? What is the worth of all of these events that were conducted? It is not a new benefit, it is simply a waste of the nation’s funds). The king’s contributions to the kingdom’s mounting debt and tenuous independence terrified the lunamaka’āinana who wanted a stronger, more principled government, initially under Queen Emma. In fact, in the middle years of Kalākaua’s reign, Native patriots such as Nāwahī and Pilipō, concerned about the impact of the king’s advisors on him, actually allied themselves with Hawai’i’s white oligarchists William R. Castle, Sanford B. Dole, John T. Waterhouse, Lorrin A. Thurston, and Thomas G. Thrum to place pressure on the throne. But once the white oligarchy forced their constitution upon Kalākaua in 1887, Nāwahī and Pilipō, realizing the group’s long-term intentions, broke away from the faction.

Kānaka subjects in the kingdom who opposed Kalākaua were concerned about the nation’s survival. Many of the ali’i nui could not bear children, and most of the chiefs and chiefesses died at early ages. The unexpected death of Prince Albert, the only child of King Kamehameha IV and Queen Emma, who was the hope of the kingdom and inheritor of the throne, devastated the lāhui. The passing of his beloved father, Kamehameha IV, soon after was another tragedy. Witnessing the tragic expiration of the Kamehameha line must have been demoralizing and bewildering for countless Kānaka. Noenoe Silva notes that the “newspapers of the day continually expressed worry and blame about the decrease in the population, as well as much worry about the lack of ali’i to rule the country.”¹³ William Charles Lunalilo’s sudden death and short reign of just under a year must have shocked the nation that voted unanimously for him in what was the kingdom’s first election for the throne. The series of deaths that would later follow, that of Princess Ruth Ke’elikōlani in May 1884; then Princess Bernice Pauahi Bishop five months later, in October; and, finally, Queen Emma in April 1885, may have left many Kānaka questioning akua (God) and their mō’ī. Kalākaua himself may have pondered his own mortality

and that of the Hawaiian nation. Certainly, Native hearts grieved for their departed ali'i nui and mō'i and were most likely never the same.

On an administrative level, Kānaka subjects also feared the kingdom's large debt, population decimation,¹⁴ what they saw as the mō'i's wasteful spending, the Reciprocity Treaty's apparent preparation for US annexation, and cabinet and personal corruption. Describing Hawai'i as a "perishing nation" during her eight-month stay in the islands in 1873, famous Victorian travel writer Isabella Bird provides further context for what may have alarmed some Hawaiian leaders concerning the kingdom's instabilities at that time:

The decrease in the [Native Hawaiian] population must cause the burden of taxation to press heavily on that which remains. Kings, cabinet ministers, an army, a police, a national debt, a supreme court, and common schools, are costly luxuries or necessities. The civil list is ludicrously out of proportion to the resources of the islands, and the heads of the four departments—Foreign Relations, Interior, Finance, and Law (Attorney-General)—receive \$5,000 a year each! Expenses and salaries have been increasing for the last thirty years.

As Bird observed, Hawai'i's constant administrative problems swelled during Kalākaua's reign, and they distressed Kānaka Maoli. Furthermore, Silva notes that sugar barons who wanted greater control of Kalākaua's government "had counterparts who served as politicians in the Kingdom's legislature, as judges, and as heads of government departments like health and education."¹⁵ In a letter to Peter Ka'eo in August of 1873, Queen Emma noted that "the natives are all awake now to the American intention of taking possession of these Islands for themselves, and they oppose them to their faces."¹⁶ Tension in the kingdom was mounting, and the blame was placed upon Kalākaua.

Noenoe Silva has recently explained that in 1877, 'Ōiwi mea kākau (author) Joseph Kānepu'u, an advocate of

indigenous rights through his prolific contributions to the Hawaiian-language newspapers, reported that Kalākaua's policies favored sugar barons and left Kānaka Maoli landless and therefore without food and shelter. Kānepu'u's direct attack of the mō'i's decisions is significant because the severe and abrupt increase in foreign land accumulation under Kalākaua's government affected 'Ōiwi land dispossession and demographics.¹⁷ Thus, both the Kānaka struggling to preserve the aupuni's (government's or kingdom's) independence and the haole (foreign) elite who wanted to take control of Hawai'i established an early pattern of sharp critiques and even defamation aimed at Kalākaua. As Jonathan Osorio writes, the reign of Kalākaua was "all about legitimacy," and this "was a contest for which haole were much better prepared because, in the end, it was monarchy itself that they were opposing. For the Natives, it was Kalākaua whose authenticity—and ability—was at issue."¹⁸ The attacks, which focused on his personality and impulses, became, in time, more exaggerated and extreme. One of the most spiteful Native public attacks on the king came in the form of a letter dated June 24 that appeared in the June 28, 1887, *Gazette*, signed by seventy-one Kānaka Maoli from Kāne'ohe who opposed Kalākaua and his cabinet. The English translation, which followed the original Hawaiian, went this way:

We want a Government that will represent us honestly, and take some interest in our welfare and in our homes. The native Chiefs are all gone; "Lunalilo was the last one." We never considered David Kalakaua a Chief. We did not elect him, and we did not want him, as we very plainly showed at the time of his election.¹⁹

While seventy-one men cannot be equated with Kāne'ohe, as the *Gazette* claimed, they clearly constituted a group opposed to Kalākaua as mō'i. Their statement "We did not elect him, and we did not want him, as we very plainly showed at the time of his election" suggests that they were

most likely Emma supporters.

This statement is also ominous because it was printed just prior to the Hawaiian League's forcing Kalākaua to sign its Bayonet Constitution. Osorio notes that such Hawaiian criticism had been intensifying.²⁰ Almost more importantly, though, was the 1887 letter's declaration that Kalākaua was neither a chief nor the people's choice for mō'ī. This not only denied him any legitimacy but suggested, by its bluntness and its timing, that the writers felt no need to be respectful to him or to his position. This was disastrous, for as Osorio explains:

Ultimately, it was the king as symbol of the nation's independence that compromised kānaka unity. The more Kalākaua was constructed as an unreliable and incompetent ruler, the more daring the haole became in their assertions that monarchy, national independence, or both, were fated to extinction.²¹

Native rebukes of their king certainly helped the haole opposition's cause, and the *Gazette* made sure the reproof went public. The criticism, which helped to undermine the Hawaiian throne and ultimately fracture a united lāhui, greatly helped Kalākaua's most powerful opponents, the white oligarchy.

The Second Opponents, or the White Oligarchy

Missionaries arrived in Hawai'i throughout the 1820s and quickly converted many Native Hawaiians, including royalty, to Christianity. Some descendants of these missionaries married with Hawaiian nobles and were awarded prominent government positions and landholdings. Most others had different plans. As early as May 1861, Sophia Cracroft, niece of the famous explorer Admiral Sir John Franklin, when visiting Hawai'i with his widow, Lady Franklin, as the honored guests of the mō'ī Kamehameha IV and his wife, Emma, observed that "the Missionaries have mingled

secularity—*simple money getting*—with their high functions, and these have sat lightly upon many of them.” Furthermore, “they are Americans and have been (naturally) the means of introducing Americans into nearly all the offices. And there is but one mind among them: viz., that this Kingdom ought to be annexed to the United States.”²² Another visitor who noticed these qualities of the missionary party during Kalākaua’s reign was Isobel Field, the stepdaughter of Robert Louis Stevenson and the wife of painter Joseph Strong. Though she arrived twenty-two years after Cracroft, just prior to Kalākaua’s coronation in 1883, she also described Honolulu’s haole elite as “rich, prosperous American business men with one aim: to wrest the islands from the natives and have it taken over by the United States.”²³

These missionary descendants in the government benefited from and continued to lobby for privatized landholdings, which politically and economically disenfranchised Native Hawaiians. When King Kalākaua ascended the throne, Hawaiians had been and were continuing to die at incredible rates, the kingdom foresaw the loss of Pearl River to the United States, which could lead to annexation, and haole were amassing extensive property and building sugar plantations throughout the archipelago. Hawai’i’s swelling agricultural value and politically advantageous location in the middle of the Pacific—an ideal supply center between Asia and the United States—made the islands increasingly indispensable to American and international interests. To protect their own investments and to get their hands on more land, foreigners sought complete political power. And to get that, they would have to overthrow the monarchy. By continually asserting King Kalākaua’s and later Queen Lili’uokalani’s incompetence to rule over Hawai’i, the white oligarchy could make its occupation of the islands seem inevitable, if not exactly wanted.²⁴

This second group of men who constantly attacked King Kalākaua was made up of missionary descendants and members of Hawai’i’s white oligarchy; prominent members of

the Hawaiian League and the Honolulu Rifles, the cadre who forced Kalākaua to sign the Bayonet Constitution; and ultimately the Annexation Club and the so-called Committee of Safety responsible for the overthrow.²⁵ Among the notable members were Lorrin A. Thurston, Sanford B. Dole, W. O. Smith, William D. Alexander, Thomas G. Thrum, Charles R. Bishop, William R. Castle, Sereno Bishop, John T. Waterhouse, Clarence W. Ashford, Volney A. Ashford, Alatau Atkinson, and others. Although this white oligarchy that sought to bring Kalākaua down was tiny in number, their wealth from agricultural, legal, and other business sources gave them great political and economic power in the kingdom. And they exercised it. For instance, William R. Castle visited Henry Perrine Baldwin on Maui in late 1885 “to look over the field and confer with different influential people on the Islands about the prospects, and what sort of assistance could be expected” to “make a strong fight for the election of honest and progressive members of the Legislature for the session opening in April, 1886.”²⁶ Castle shared with Baldwin the need for candidates who were “determined that the unscrupulous ambition of the King should be curbed, and that the government must be carried on honestly, economically and in the interest of the governed, and not for the supposed amusement of Kalakaua.”²⁷

Castle, a founder of the later Big Five company Castle and Cooke, and Baldwin, who served a similar role in relation to Alexander and Baldwin, built empires of wealth in Hawai‘i out of profits drawn from real estate and sugarcane plantations. Sugar had already become immensely profitable for the white oligarchy, and any restriction on their ambitions was unthinkable. By the mid-1880s, Kalākaua’s dedicated efforts in Washington and elsewhere on behalf of the sugar industry had brought substantial profits to Hawai‘i.²⁸ But the industry was well established before his reign, and its leaders were already heavily involved in conducting international diplomacy and setting government policy. As early as 1849, the founders of one of the earliest plantations, Henry A. Peirce & Co., were the US ministers to Hawai‘i: Henry

Augustus Peirce; Supreme Court Justice William Little Lee; and banker and eventual proannexationist Charles Reed Bishop. All three had been involved in unsuccessful reciprocity treaty negotiations for America, and Lee went to Washington, DC, in 1855 specifically to arrange for Hawaiian sugar to enter the United States free of duty tax. At least partially due to Kalākaua's efforts, during his reign treaties, water diversion, machinery, and rail transformed the sugar trade. After the 1875 Reciprocity Treaty that Kalākaua personally helped to negotiate with the US Congress, more than one hundred investors opened sugar plantations in the islands,²⁹ and their appetite for more land, more water, more laborers, faster and more efficient machinery, speedier ways to transport sugar, and, above all, increased profits, led to them seeking greater power in the government, regardless of Kalākaua's cooperation. The scale of operations was huge. Gordon-Cumming writes that in 1883, a new sugar refinery built in response to Hawai'i's growing production could accommodate 225,000,000 pounds of sugar.³⁰

Of all the various demands the sugar planters made, the one the mō'i, "an enthusiastic fan of new technology," responded to most was the desire for rail. Kalākaua had ridden across America on a train on his trip to Washington, DC, in 1874. On August 1, 1878, he signed An Act to Promote the Construction of Railways, which created a rail boom in the islands and a sugar boom for the planters. Reverend Gowen made the following observation about the sugar barons' hold on the islands' economy: "It is sugar which has caused the present political importance of Hawaii, which has been the cause of her commercial prosperity, which has attracted the vast majority of her foreign population, which has made her merchants millionaires."³¹ Haole businessmen, some attracted to the islands because of the Reciprocity Treaty, were soon building railroads and mills to expand their stakes in the sugar industry. As he struggled to maintain his rule and his nation's sovereignty, then, Kalākaua decided that agricultural yield and economic productivity were key—and railroads increased both. A perceptive yet daring

investor, Kalākaua used his power to introduce rail to his part of the world, with great success. Unfortunately, the prosperity such leadership brought the wealthy businessmen only provided them with more resources to press for more direct control, making the mōʻī irrelevant and ultimately removing him from consideration altogether. That Kalākaua's effectiveness in publicly providing incentives for business would prove to be one of the causes of an ever-increasing desire for his nation's annexation by the United States is one of the grimmest ironies of his reign.

By far, the white oligarchy did the most damage to King Kalākaua's reputation, proliferating lies that mimicked the course of American imperialism. Niklaus R. Schweizer has noted that when they actually overthrew the monarchy two years after Kalākaua's death, the missionaries, planters, and businessmen "were not likely to accept the restoration of native authority at a time when the colonial tide in the Pacific and elsewhere was reaching the high-water mark. Everything thus had to be planned meticulously and the timing had to be right."³² And Lorrin Thurston at this time claimed that "American property interests in Hawaii have become so great that it is no longer a simple question of political advantage to the United States, or of charity or justice to a weak neighbor."³³

But accompanying this perceived necessity of a takeover for mercenary interests was the claim that in any case, Kalākaua—and then Lili'uokalani—had proved utterly unfit to govern the kingdom. There was never any shortage of public attacks on the supposed incompetence of the entire monarchial system. From day one, Kalākaua supporters rightly feared that the newspapers would sensationalize stories of the 1874 election riot, and the *Advertiser's* article "Our Riot Abroad" suggested that Kalākaua did not have the public's approval, or as Osorio puts it, "The press portrayed the mutiny as a typical example of the Natives' lack of discipline and a sign of disrespect for the king."³⁴ Take, for example, the *Hawaiian Gazette's* March 25, 1874, account: "It was a piteous sight. It gave delight to ... those who

contemptuously asserted that Hawaiian civilization was a sham, and that Hawaiians were unfit for self-government.”³⁵ The *Gazette* further declared that because Kalākaua requested the aid of US and British warships to control the riot, he could not govern his kingdom and depended upon foreign intervention to maintain any authority.³⁶ Then there is this dismissive declaration from 1882 in the *Hawaiian Gazette*: “A Sham! Talk of it as we may; theorize about it as we please, we must always arrive at one result, and that is that the constitutional government of these islands is a thorough sham.”³⁷ Thurston and Sanford Dole, the masterminds of the overthrow, later observed that “the natives had been unable to sustain the independent state which American residents had helped them create” and, more specifically, that “the constitutional encroachments, lawless extravagance, and scandalous and open sales of patronage and privilege to the highest bidder by Kalakaua brought on at length the Revolution of 1887.”³⁸ Or, more succinctly, it was their opinion that “Kalakaua seems to be entirely given over to the devil.”³⁹ It therefore was a constant that his enemies pointed to his alleged ignorance, ineptitude, and corrupt nature as sufficient reason for the eventual overthrow of the monarchy. As Michael G. Vann explains, “The first narratives of the demise of the Hawaiian monarchy were the product of those who had taken part in its overthrow. The writing of their ‘histories’ was the final act of conquest: the intellectual consolidation of rule.”⁴⁰

Ways of the White Oligarchy

To protect their investments and consolidate power into their hands, the white oligarchy confined their attacks on the king to intimate dialogues, spreading malicious rumors about Kalākaua through simple gossip. Isabella Bird made her own observations on gossip’s prevalence in Hawai‘i:

If I put gossip first, it is because I seriously think that it

is the canker of the foreign society on the islands. Its extent and universality are grotesque and amusing to a stranger, but to live in it, and share in it, and learn to enjoy it, would be both lowering and hurtful, and you can hardly be long here without being drawn into its vortex.

The extent and exactness of gossip's prevalence in nineteenth-century Hawai'i is worthy of further study because a liberal amount of "news" was spread throughout the islands this way. Bird explains this as she saw it:

From the north of Kauai to the south of Hawaii, everybody knows every other body's affairs, income, expenditure, sales, purchases, debts, furniture, clothing, comings, goings, borrowings, lendings, letters, correspondents, and every thing else; and when there is nothing new to relate on any one of these prolific subjects, supposed intentions afford abundant matter for speculation.

When intimate conversations began to repeat themselves, Bird noted that the gossip then was simply "re-exported" to other islands "with additions and embellishments, by inter-island mail."⁴¹

Another visitor who attested to the preoccupation with gossip was the twenty-two-year-old missionary Herbert H. Gowen. Arriving in 1886, Gowen lived in Hawai'i for five years at 'Iolani College. Observing that the streets of Honolulu were "crossed and re-crossed at every point by a bewildering number of telephone and electric light wires," he recognized that this technology made it "so easy to gossip over a wide circle that in time the telephone becomes as indispensable as ice cream or rocking-chairs to the households of Honolulu."⁴² Through gossip, the white oligarchy spread vindictive hearsay about King Kalākaua. Isobel Field provides us with an eyewitness account of how those arriving in Honolulu were immediately sought out and treated to slanderous accounts of the mō'ī: "My visitors, both

of the Royal party and the Missionary group, gave me my first startled taste of island gossip.... The Missionary ladies told me the King was a drunkard and spendthrift, the son of a Negro barber and not fit to rule a nation." She further remarked that these visitors avoided "restraint in the stories they told."⁴³ Still another visitor, who came as a bride, was Gina Sobrero,⁴⁴ the wife of Robert William Kalanihiapo Wilcox. Her journal of her early days in Hawai'i confirms that the missionary party was telling her the same stories they had told to Field: "His enemies actually say that he is of black origin, nor do I have difficulty in believing it, judging from the coarse and rounded lines of his countenance, from his dull and kinky hair, characteristics which are not those of the Hawaiians."⁴⁵ In his own Hawaiian- and English-language newspaper *Ka Nuhou Hawaii*, Walter Murray Gibson calls attention to this very predilection to gossip: "Slander is the bane of this community.... It happens to some that they have hardly been any time in the country ... when somebody whispers in the ears—'I thought it best to let you know that so and so is, & c.'"⁴⁶

As Kalākaua's reign progressed, the white oligarchy became emboldened and took to the newspapers to publish their attacks on the king. It should be noted that from 1876 until the middle of 1880, newspaper critiques of Kalākaua were infrequent and relatively restrained. He had pacified the planters for a time by securing a Reciprocity Treaty that guaranteed their prosperity. But when the mō'i began appointing cabinet members whom the haole businessmen believed would advance the interests of Hawaiians and the lāhui over the legislative needs of the planter and business element, they publicly voiced their disapproval. This conspicuous move signaled the white oligarchy's brazenness and intensifying insurgency. In the *Hawaiian Gazette* of August 1880, American general Samuel Chapman Armstrong, William Armstrong, Benjamin F. Dillingham, Samuel N. Castle, William R. Castle, Henry Waterhouse, Henry A. P. Carter, Sanford B. Dole, Alfred S. Hartwell, Charles R. Bishop, Alexander J. Cartwright, Joseph B. Atherton, and

others, many of whom would conspire to carry out the overthrow and annexation, demanded that Kalākaua discharge his new cabinet members John E. Bush, W. C. Jones, Celso C. Moreno, and Reverend Moses Kuaea because the planters had “no confidence in these Ministers, that they do not adequately represent the wealth, intelligence or character of your subjects, and resident foreigners.” Because the white oligarchy saw themselves as subjects “who have sustained [the] Kingdom in the past and are identified with its future,” they sought greater control of the government.⁴⁷

Dole, one-time *Hawaiian Gazette* editor Alatau Tamchiboulac Atkinson, illustrator Edwin Purvis, and other writers also collaborated on farces and satirical pamphlets, mirroring the style and layout of satirical sonnets and cartoons found in nineteenth-century magazines such as *Punch*. Kalākaua was not the first mōʻī attacked in that way.⁴⁸ The *Pacific Commercial Advertiser* had printed satirical stories about Kalākaua’s predecessor William Charles Lunalilo. The difference is one of scale. Dole, for example, wrote *Vacuum: A Farce in Three Acts*, which was presented in the *Gazette* and performed at the Opera House in Honolulu. The script caricatured Kalākaua as Skyhigh, the “emperor of the coral reefs and sand banks of the blue big sea” who lives at the “palace of the flying-fish.”⁴⁹

Atkinson and Purvis published their own satirical scripts, titled *The Grand Duke of Gynbergdrinkenstein: A Burlesque in Three Acts* and the *Gynberg Ballads*. Foreigners who read the *Gynberg Ballads* supposedly “rocked with laughter at the caricaturing of the Kalakaua court.”⁵⁰ In the first act, the grand duke, the character mimicking Kalākaua, speaks to Nosbig, the caricature of Walter Murray Gibson:

You grand old fraud. You were the boy to win
Seeing the way you handed out the gin
Not gingerly, but with a ginerous hand
The alcoholic wave, that swept the land
Carried you on to power.⁵¹

In the second act, the duke greets the morning this way:

Ah, ha, the morning paper of today?
Let's see what Nosbig's organ has to say
Of things political.—Ah yes, I see
The same as usual, there's much praise of me
And of my doings, also the old song
Of "Nosbig" right, and "Opposition" wrong.⁵²

The pamphlets were reportedly a hit with the haole community in Honolulu, and members of the foreign community attended the plays.⁵³ These satirical performances represent some of the most extreme efforts to trivialize Kalākaua during his reign, and the energetic circulation of these farces provided glaring evidence of their creators' defiance and disdain for the throne. These examples of open ridicule were circulated widely throughout the kingdom and to the American continent. The white oligarchy's racist writings and illustrations are examples of nineteenth-century colonial and imperialistic forms of controlling the cultural constructions of the colonized and objectifying and eroticizing indigenous peoples.⁵⁴ Like so many early missionaries, explorers, colonists, and government officials who depicted Native Hawaiians as savages and primitives destined for extinction, the white oligarchy also sought to portray King Kalākaua as uncivilized and unrefined, challenging his ability to govern, lead, and rule Hawai'i. Nineteenth-century "extinction discourse"—the idea that indigenous peoples will become extinct simply because of an inability to adapt—became a conceptual tool that Kalākaua's opposition used to justify their attempt to take over his powers.⁵⁵

Partly because he was demonstrably a racist and perhaps because the sugar industry funded his livelihood, an especially strong opponent of Kalākaua was Thomas G. Thrum. A writer, editor, and printer, Thrum was responsible for many publications, producing on his own press the *Hawaiian Almanac and Annual* and other substantial volumes

on Hawai'i's history. His annual summaries of the events of the previous year were often naked attacks on Kalākaua and his supporters. Take, for example, this account of 1881: "Unfortunately underhanded schemes prevailed, and the session of the Legislature that followed entertained rash measures, voted moneys with recklessness and passed bills that created alarm for the nation's well-being."⁵⁶ Hardly one for understatement—"In no year has so much determined evil been accomplished by any Hawaiian Legislature, as in the present"—he laid the blame squarely on Kalākaua: "Monies have been spent recklessly on appropriations pertaining directly and indirectly to royalty, while other and needed improvements for the development of the country and the care of the sick have been deferred for want of funds."⁵⁷ The coronation especially annoyed Thrum. In 1883, he published George W. Stewart's malicious poem "The Crowning of the Dread King":

Not a sail on the horizon
Not a ship along the seashore
Hastens with its host of people
To the dread king's coronation
To the crowning of the dread king
Of the islands of Hawaii.⁵⁸

Thrum also offered extended critiques of the necessity, the expense, and even the morality of the coronation. He condemned the "period of nightly hula festivities that was a retrograde step of heathenism and a disgrace to the age." He reported that "the feasts, regatta and races that were given proved a sad travesty on the spirit of enthusiastic loyalty which it aimed to bring forth." And he asserted that "the whole affair was forced upon the people in spite of public opinion."⁵⁹

Such claims were then often circulated in the United States by other correspondents. An 1885 account in the *Daily Honolulu Press* approvingly notes that an opponent of Kalākaua then living elsewhere was happily providing the

business-class opinion of the Hawaiian government to newspapers there: "As an indication of the murmurs of Kalakaua's subjects, a Honolulu merchant now in Washington said to-day that the utter disregard of the will of the people in the administration of the government has been shown in a very defiant manner."⁶⁰ What follows this report in the *Daily* was taken almost verbatim from Thrum's *Hawaiian Almanac and Annual* of 1883: "Money has been spent recklessly on appropriations pertaining to royalty, while needed improvements for the development of the country have been deferred for want of funds."⁶¹ Thrum was, of course, the *Daily's* publisher, and though he claims that he is quoting a *Washington Post* article, material expressing his own opinion is tagged onto his "summary."

The *Gazette* and *Kuokoa* also attacked the mō'i for his coronation ceremonies. The *Hawaiian Gazette Report: The Coronation (February 12, 1883) and Unveiling Ceremonies of the Statue of Kamehameha I and Grand State Dinner, Etc. (February 14, 1883)* declared that the formalities were designed "to play upon the King's vanity."⁶² But in June 1882, more than a year before the ceremonies, the *Hawaiian Gazette* had already called the coronation "unnecessary, and, therefore, a mere waste of money."⁶³ A month beforehand, the January 13, 1883, edition of *Ka Nupepa Kuokoa* declared that

aole no paha e hiki ke hoahewa nui ia ka poni Alii e hoomakaukauia nei no ka la 12 o Feberuari, ina he lealea wale iho no ka Moi a pau ae, me ka ili ole mai o na haawe oia hana maluna o ka lehulehu.

O ka hookaumaha mua e loa ana ia kakou no keia hana, oia no ka haule ana o ko kakou inoa maikai ma ke ano he aupuni noonoo maikai, a he hana ma na ano naauao.... He nui loa hoolilo ana, a o ke kaumaha oia mau hoolilo, e hoi mai ana maluna o na makaainana.⁶⁴

(no stigma can be placed on the coronation that is being prepared for on the twelfth of February, if it is only to please the king and have it over with, without

the load falling on the public.

But the first “load” that we will receive for this deed is the loss of our good reputation as a government of clear thinking and [be known as] one that behaves ignorantly.... The expenditures are so great and the burden of such spending will be on the people.)⁶⁵

The supposed scandal of the coronation was a primary piece of evidence offered against Kalākaua for many years afterward. In 1898, American navy admiral Lucien Young was still remarking that “after being on the throne for nine years, he determined upon a useless and expensive coronation.”⁶⁶

Attacks on the mō‘ī became institutionalized. In 1885, Thrum, Louis T. Valentine, and Arthur Johnstone collaborated to produce the *Daily Honolulu Press*. Replacing Thrum’s *Saturday Press*, the new paper was explicitly dedicated to curbing Kalākaua’s alleged reckless spending and incompetence. It ran for a year and on December 4 reprinted a *San Francisco Post* article, “A Wild Scheme,” that reported that the mō‘ī was attempting to sell his kingdom for \$14,500,000. Treating this “report” as truth, the paper editorialized that “the painful fact has been patent for several years that King Kalakaua is not a popular sovereign at home, and, of course, his people are entirely ignorant of any proposition for selling them out.”⁶⁷ And, arguably, so was Kalākaua. The American papers claiming that Kalākaua’s subjects were dissatisfied with him were usually passing on information from their principal sources: the missionary and business elements. In his “Retrospect for the Year 1887,” Thrum also condemned the mō‘ī’s 1886 birthday jubilee: “It is by no means commendable that such an event should warrant the frivolous waste of public funds, or give encouragement to the revival of the lascivious hula. As the period is now looked back upon, with the lapse of only a few weeks, there is naught that can be pointed to with pride for so memorable an occasion during His Majesty’s reign.”⁶⁸ While Kānaka Maoli and the white oligarchy felt they had justifiable reasons for questioning Kalākaua’s spending, the

white oligarchy saw it as wasteful because that group opposed the king's attempts to legitimize the Hawaiian throne and nation. Lili'uokalani noted this when describing the opposition to the king's coronation: "Naturally, those among us who did not desire to have Hawaii remain a nation would look on an expenditure of this kind as worse than wasted."⁶⁹

Another longtime watchdog continually barking at the supposed mistakes and errors of Kalākaua's reign was Henry M. Whitney, known primarily for his editorship of *Ka Nupepa Kuokoa*, "the most successful of all newspapers printed in Hawaiian," with a sixty-six-year existence.⁷⁰ As early as 1850, Whitney had served as the first postmaster general for the kingdom, and he later added being the printer, sales manager, and editor for the *Hawaiian Gazette* and the *Pacific Commercial Advertiser* to his resume. After 1880, *Kuokoa* openly opposed Kalākaua.⁷¹ Whitney was postmaster general again from 1883 to 1886, which in most cases meant that he was the first person to receive news from abroad and the last one to handle any information sent to the United States—usually, to San Francisco, where it could then be telegraphed east and to the rest of the world. Kalākaua's enemies in Hawai'i often went through Whitney to export their unflattering representations to the larger audiences of American and international newspapers. The *North China Herald* in Shanghai, for instance, identified the *Hawaiian Gazette* and a "correspondent" as sources for its published critical accounts of Kalākaua, while the *Hong Kong Daily Press* acknowledged a "kamaaina" and a "letter writer."⁷² A number of *Gazette* articles appeared abroad, portraying Kalākaua and his cabinet as corrupt and incompetent and Hawai'i as anxious for the monarchy's end.⁷³ International audiences apparently enjoyed such mockery of "native" rulers.

With regard to the 1887 Bayonet Constitution, the dominant narrative that the public simply ran out of patience with Kalākaua's supposed corruption and incompetence was immediately and widely circulated and proved to be

enduring. Over ten years later, even though no evidence indicates that he was present, Lucien Young would report that “the patience of the respectable foreign element and progressive natives at last became exhausted.”⁷⁴ But the newspapers also prepared the way for the Bayonet Constitution. On the tenth day of May 1887, as the Hawaiian League’s plans to overthrow Kalākaua were approaching fruition, the *Hawaiian Gazette* grumbled that “there never is money for anything useful, but there is always money forthcoming for junketing trips, foreign missions and ostentatious follies.”⁷⁵ In the same issue appears a scathing attack on Kalākaua in response to the opium license granted to Chun, to the diplomatic embassy to Sāmoa, and to other failures:

Now who is to blame? These things have not been done under a bushel; they are plain for all to see. With such charges against his Ministers and officials, the King is thoroughly acquainted. It is in his power to force explanations. He has not done so, and as he is the highest officer in the Kingdom, the blame rests on him. A sovereign who had the good of his country and his people at heart, would see to it that such things should not occur.⁷⁶

After the Hawaiian League forced its constitution upon Kalākaua, another pamphlet, titled *A Sketch of Recent Events, Being a Short Account of the Events Which Culminated on June 30, 1887, Together with a Full Report of the Great Reform Meeting and the Two Constitutions in Parallel Columns*, was printed by A. M. Hewett and the *Hawaiian Gazette* in Honolulu. Hawaiian League members must have written it because it outlined in detail the conspiracy to force Kalākaua to sign the constitution and explained the reasons for the plot, including the familiar claim that “the administration of the Hawaiian Government has ceased, through corruption and incompetence, to perform the functions and afford the protection to personal

and property rights, for which all Governments exist.”⁷⁷

Kalākaua’s self-interested contemporaries spread slander of this kind regardless of the source. As Ralph S. Kuykendall, hardly a critic of the business oligarchy, explains, those foreigners undeniably paying the bulk of the already low taxes because they owned most of the “income-producing property” in the kingdom saw almost any royal outlay as “extravagant and wasteful spending” that might lead to tax hikes. Or, in their opinions, worse. US minister resident James M. Comly’s report in an 1882 dispatch suggests just what motivated the attacks on the mō‘ī:

There is such a state of anxiety in the minds of foreign residents that a number of the most prominent planters and business men have pressed me earnestly for some assurance that the United States Government would protect American citizens against such native legislation as might amount to a practical confiscation of a large share of their estates in these islands.⁷⁸

These observations suggest just how desperately those with land and money felt they needed to control the government.

To gain complete control of the kingdom, the white oligarchy knew that it had to oust Prime Minister Walter Murray Gibson. In now familiar terms, later biographer Ernest Andrade writes that under the Gibson regime, Hawai‘i became “increasingly unstable through unbridled spending which ran up a large debt and brought corruption among government officials in its wake.”⁷⁹ But contemporary accounts complain just as loudly about Gibson’s advocacy for Hawaiians’ interests in opposition to those of the business and missionary party. In *The Shepherd Saint of Lanai*, Thrum attacks Gibson because he has taken on “the championship of the Hawaiian race, and in doing so he has not hesitated to belittle the work of those who have done much if not all that has been done for the Hawaiian people.”⁸⁰ Others attacked him for having influence over Kalākaua. Even though he had left Hawai‘i as a young man in 1860, Samuel Chapman

Armstrong, clearly informed by the Hawaiian League, confidently declared that the problem was a corrupt codependency: "King Kalakaua has at the head of his government an ex-Mormon priest, a talented unscrupulous man, whom no one trusts or respects, holding his position entirely through his ability to handle the weak and conceited monarch, who though amiable and intelligent is utterly without executive capacity or wisdom, and is esteemed by none."⁸¹ The *Gazette* agreed: "Mr. Gibson has chosen to use the King as his aegis and has allowed him to take an active part in the politics of the country.... Whether it is the King or the Minister who is the puppet in the hands of the other we cannot say, but the position that the King has taken makes him responsible for the wrong that has been done."⁸²

Although married to ali'i Bernice Pauahi, whose will would establish the Kamehameha Schools and the Bishop Estate, Charles Reed Bishop eventually became an advocate of annexation. But as early as 1880, in a letter to Elisha H. Allen, he was complaining about Kalākaua's selection of Gibson: "The worst of it is that [His Majesty] took quite an active interest in electing some nincompoops who are mere tools of his, and has expressed some plans which are so weak and useless that he has lost a good deal of confidence and respect of foreigners and the most intelligent natives." By the latter half of 1880, the business party had also started up the *Saturday Press*, a newspaper devoted to attacking the mō'i, his advisors, and the newspapers that supported him. In a letter to his brother on Kaua'i, Sanford B. Dole wrote:

You will be pleased to hear that a new paper, the *Saturday Press*, was started last week, September 4th, in opposition to the *Advertiser* under Gibson. I have ordered it for you. It is owned by the leading business firms here; it is well supported from the start, as you will see. A great many have taken away their advertising from the *Commercial* and given it to the new paper, and many have stopped their subscriptions to the former. I trust that Gibson will be starved out before long.⁸³

Seven years later, in another letter to sugar plantation owner Rudolph Wilhelm Meyer, Bishop suggests that things have degenerated: “We have a shameful state of demoralization in government, and those who govern are too stupid and bad to see their danger or to listen to wise and friendly counsel.”⁸⁴ While public and private opinions of Kalākaua’s competence as king varied among the opposition, he was supposedly just ineffective because he did not support the white oligarchy’s interests. And when they ultimately overthrew the kingdom and wrote their accounts of Hawai‘i’s history, the white oligarchy emphasized the accuracy of their critiques.

The Third Group, or Visiting Writers in Hawai‘i

Later, we will see how the white oligarchy personally and confidentially conveyed accounts of Kalākaua to visiting writers, exporting their misrepresentations of the king abroad. The third group of people that ridiculed the king consisted of authors from outside Hawai‘i who visited to compose “histories” of the islands and then returned home. In 1899, Caspar Whitney published *Hawaiian America*, which contained this portrait of King Kalākaua: “He was too egotistical to take advice, too self-satisfied to hearken to warning, too ignorant to appreciate that he, the representative of a weak, thriftless, dying race, held his throne by the sufferance of the stronger, civilized people that had brought prosperity to his islands.”⁸⁵ Ronald Williams Jr. explains that Noenoe Silva first noted the “long process” that “normalized the idea that research and history about Hawai‘i was conducted in English” “by a very small but preferenced minority of voices.”⁸⁶ Whitney lists the sources for his “research” by name, dedicating his book to Sanford B. Dole, Lorrin A. Thurston, and Benjamin F. Dillingham, “three of Hawaii’s most loyal and enterprising citizens” and to Thomas G. Thrum, whom he calls the “Hawaiian authority.” Since all of these figures supported or took part in the overthrow of the monarchy, it is not surprising that Whitney confidently passes on that the “craven-hearted sot” Kalākaua was “the

first King since civilization had overtaken Hawaii to give free reign to the instincts of Polynesian savagery that stirred in him” and “that Debauchery ruled in private life, and bribery and extravagance and pernicious legislation in the government.”⁸⁷ Here is ample evidence for Adria L. Imada’s claim that “American writers of travelogues like *Hawaiian America* argued that the profligacy of the king justified the Anglo-Saxon takeover of the islands.”⁸⁸

Nor was Caspar the first writer to capture the character of David Kalākaua for those outside Hawai‘i. Writers passing through Hawai‘i often merely wanted a good or funny story—the purveyors of nineteenth-century yellow journalism—and they make up the last group of people who attacked the king. First appearing in 1880, the term “yellow journalism” referred to presenting entertaining or flattering opinions as facts. The tools were “sensationalism, distorted stories, and misleading images” employed simply to make a profit and entice readers.⁸⁹ Although such newspapers had nothing personal against Kalākaua, their stories were informed by the attacks appearing in Hawai‘i publications, such as the *Gazette* and Thrum’s annuals, because the sources were in English and, more importantly, confirmed existing assumptions and prejudices in large parts of the American readership. As Helen Chapin has observed, Hawai‘i’s English-language newspapers “have largely been in the service of and promoted American ideals and practices,”⁹⁰ stretching back to the time when the first Protestant missionaries brought a printing press because they intended to use the printed page to “bring enlightenment to those they considered benighted—a Christian enlightenment imbued with American values.”⁹¹ The early Hawaiian-language and English-language newspapers spread this ideology, and the presence and substantial circulation of such publications meant that Kalākaua was written about extensively from the day of his election, through his trips to the United States and elsewhere, and right up to his death in San Francisco and his body’s return to Honolulu.

And whether on their own or by drawing on their

“confidential” Hawai‘i sources, American and international newspapers wrote about him as well. A cursory search of nineteenth-century newspaper databases for the name “Kalakaua” suggests just how interested Americans were in him. The New York Times Archive alone lists more than seven hundred results. The Chronicling America archive gives up more than forty-nine hundred hits, and the British Newspaper Archive provides over seven thousand results—impressive numbers for the ruler of a small kingdom with a dwindling population. Much of the American and international interest in Hawai‘i at that time was rooted in witnessing the supposed demise of the kingdom and its monarchy, as many newspapers had been predicting. Kalākaua’s own death came at a time of steadily increasing tourist numbers, as the Hawaiian Kingdom welcomed American and international travelers basking in the exoticism of Hawai‘i’s paradisiacal lure and the romantic aspects of its monarchy. In short, by 1890, Hawai‘i was already a visitor destination, and particularly welcomed were novelists and other writers, the “modern sirens,” whose accounts of their voyages to the islands often served as a “trifling souvenir” of Hawai‘i’s beautiful places and fascinating people and customs.⁹² Jane C. Desmond has written that America’s annexation of Hawai‘i, at the same time as the colonization of Guam, Cuba, the Philippines, and Puerto Rico, led public discourse to “situate Hawai‘i both in relation to these other new colonies and in relation to mainland populations, as part of a renegotiated imaginary of the U.S. nation,” which also fueled the development of organized tourism in Hawai‘i.⁹³ By 1895, Mark Twain’s and Charles Warren Stoddard’s articles about earlier times in Hawai‘i were also influencing people to think about visiting this so-called tropical paradise.⁹⁴

The new works that began appearing about this possible US possession, however, had unmistakably consulted as their sources of information the people who approved of, or even actively participated in, the overthrow. Shortly after Kalākaua’s death, an American historian named John Roy Musick made his way to the islands of Hawai‘i. The target

audience for his more than five-hundred-page illustrated account that appeared in 1897 as *Hawaii ... Our New Possessions: An Account of the Travels and Adventure, with Sketches of the Scenery, Customs and Manners, Mythology and History of Hawaii to the Present, and an Appendix Containing the Treaty to the United States* was specifically those in the United States who knew little of the islands. The source of Musick's version of Kalākaua is instantly recognizable: "Much evil was averted and some good accomplished even during the licentious reign of Kalakaua.... He was weakened in mind and body by dissipation, and usually under the influence of evil-minded persons. His extravagance almost wrecked the country."⁹⁵

By the 1920s, a stream of writers was arriving from the United States for brief visits—gathering just enough information for a book and then returning home to write. Often filled with illustrations of Hawaiian scenery, these works were largely forms of utopian fantasy and travel writing. "Hawaii has been a land of romance and adventure," Albert Taylor wrote in 1926: "It has been the playground of poets and prose writers, of painters and musicians."⁹⁶ And once, it was a monarchy, but those simple times were long gone: "Days of the long-ago golden era of the Kamehameha and Kalakaua regimes of Hawaii nei, when the latchstrings of hospitable homes of Hawaiians and foreigners alike hung outside never-locked doors, seem very far away today to kamaainas (residents of long-standing)."⁹⁷ Other writers also acknowledged that their information was handed to them by residents. As late as 1946, Erna Fergusson thanked the people in Hawai'i who helped "to collect data and tried earnestly to give me understanding of the complicated picture of life in Hawaii" for her novel *Our Hawaii*.⁹⁸

Perhaps to an even greater degree, many of these newspaper articles followed the lead of antagonistic Hawai'i publications and attacked the very qualities that Kalākaua was noted for—his eloquence, intellect, refinement, competence, ancestry, race, and popularity with his subjects. The *Bismarck Weekly Tribune* simply repeated the

missionary and business party claims that “the administration of the Hawaiian government has ceased through corruption and incompetency to adequately perform its functions and afford the protection to personal and property rights for which all governments exist.”⁹⁹ The *London Times* reported that “the people were scandalized by the corruption of King Kalakaua’s Ministry.”¹⁰⁰ Other accounts at home and abroad called into question Kalākaua’s intellect and discipline. Within weeks of his election in 1874, for instance, the *Evening Star* was reporting that “the new King is said to have some intellectual ability, and to possess a considerable amount of experience in affairs of government, but it is asserted that he has very little force of character.”¹⁰¹ The *Hawaiian Gazette* quoted as authoritative the *New York Times*: “It has since been learned that King Kalakaua of the Sandwich Islands was simply sent to this country as the decoy duck of an enterprising San Francisco ring, which was interested in securing a ratification of the Reciprocity Treaty.”¹⁰²

Racial stereotypes were also part of the journalist repertoire. In Nebraska, the *Columbus Journal* labeled Kalākaua “His mud-colored highness,”¹⁰³ while many American newspapers found him more menacing, referring to him as the “Cannibal king,” “King of the Cannibal Islands,” or “King of the cannibals.” But this same charge, of course, can also be an occasion for “humor.” According to Australia’s *Southern Argus*, “King Kalakaua, of the Sandwich Islands, cannot help being a good man. The reason assigned is that his ancestors ate so much missionary in their time that it worked into their system and was transmitted to their descendants.”¹⁰⁴ Other publications just called him the “dusky” king, or “darkey.” Retelling missionary party gossip, some publications reported that he was African and Hawaiian, which explained his supposed former days playing the banjo like a minstrel show figure at Honolulu Harbor.¹⁰⁵ This rumor was pervasive. Even Henry Adams believed that “His Majesty is half Hawaiian and half Negro.”¹⁰⁶ The primary reason for such rumors was of course to suggest that

someone of such ancestry even pretending to be a king was either a joke or an outrage.

According to *Cosmopolitan*, "Outside of the opera bouffe of 'La Belle Helene' there has probably been no more absurd effort at monarch than in the pigmy kingdom of Kalakaua." This account almost reveled in the ridiculousness of the idea: "Indeed, when one reads of the fantastic devices of Kalakaua to ape European royalty, it seems that the Court and all its semi-barbaric trappings belong to some idyl [*sic*] of the South Seas and not to real life."¹⁰⁷ This claim that heathen impulses were always lurking in the background became the most popular charge against him.

His supposed vices were therefore proof of both his personal and cultural character. Charges of drunkenness, profligate gambling, womanizing, and frivolous spending were common.¹⁰⁸ The *Williamsburg Journal Tribune* confidently reported that "he inherited little beyond the pride of birth and a capacity for animal enjoyment for which his family had been noted for ages, according to Hawaiian tradition.... The family from which Kalakaua descended was noted among the Hawaiians for the possession, in an exaggerated form, of vices and cruelties of the tribal nobility."¹⁰⁹ The *St. Louis Globe-Democrat*, the *Weekly Detroit*, the *Sydney Morning Herald*, and the *Queenscliff Sentinel* all published accounts of the mō'i compulsively gambling into the early hours of the morning: "Everybody will remember he was an incessant player." Other newspapers passed on the story as well.¹¹⁰ Extravagant spending of the government's money was also publicized, though he supposedly was not above neglecting to pay legitimate expenses.

Hawai'i's newspapers even drew on notices from American newspapers as opportunities to repeat their own attacks on his character. Take, for example, this note from the *Daily Bulletin*, which was a *New York Times* original, referring to a story about Kalākaua's trip across America at the end of his world tour:

It is to be hoped that our inventive Boston furniture manufacturers will be able to show King Kalakaua something new in thrones. Here is a splendid opportunity for American inventive genius. A throne that can at a moment's notice be converted into a card table, a side-board, or a billiard table ... that can hold a gross of champagne bottles and one hundred pounds of ice.¹¹¹

One headline from the *St. Louis Globe-Democrat's* July 10, 1886, edition can therefore stand as a summary of all the supposed weaknesses, vices, and absurdities that the mō'i signified to one audience: "KALAKAUA'S KINGDOM—A Corrupt Government and a Rapidly Decaying People—Large Sums Wasted in Extravagance and Many Adventures Enriched—The King in the Power of the Big Sugar Planters—Appalling Spread of the Leprosy."¹¹²

Perhaps the most malicious and damaging charges, however, focused on his supposed unpopularity with his subjects. They are in fact one of the primary reasons for this book. The missionary and business press constantly asserted that Kalākaua had lost the support of all his people. This was convenient since it presumably justified this small group's actions to undermine his power and office, and this supposed fact was somehow distributed widely and published around the world. These attacks on Kalākaua became a form of propaganda. Randal Marlin has said that successful propaganda "must be designed so that it always says the same thing: 'For instance, a slogan must be presented from different angles, but the end of all remarks must always and immutably be the slogan itself. Only in this way can the propaganda have a unified and complete effect,'"¹¹³ and only in that way did certain people in Hawai'i feed foreign publications with these attacks on Kalākaua. Once foreign newspapers had printed them, the Hawai'i newspapers could then reprint them. Although the propaganda was in many ways inaccurate, the missionary and business elements used this news from elsewhere as evidence of Kalākaua's weaknesses, preparing the climate for the missionary and

business party to undermine him in 1887.

And the cycle continued. The *St. Louis Globe-Democrat*, for instance, described the events surrounding the extortion of the Bayonet Constitution this way: “The populace organized and demanded the downfall of the Ministry and the abdication of the King. The residents of Honolulu and the surrounding country assumed the powers of government,” with “all classes of people” taking part in the revolution.¹¹⁴ Even before this, the *Hawaiian Gazette* was reprinting a *New York Times* article, reporting that “the kingly office has fallen in popular estimation.”¹¹⁵ Of course, for both the local business party and the foreign press, “the people” meant the haole population, or foreign governments. Take, for example, this account of the mō‘ī’s 1883 coronation from *Frank Leslie’s Illustrated Newspaper*: “The only country sending a representative was Japan, and no visitors arrived from abroad to attend the ceremony.... The idea of a coronation was not popular among the foreign residents, and comparatively few were present except those occupying some official position.”¹¹⁶ The *Brisbane Courier* echoed this claim and added in other familiar attacks: “The foreigners are naturally indignant at the imposition. For, though they have no use for the king, the greater portion of the cost of this fol-de-rol has to be borne by them. The king is an idle, dissipated fellow, fond of good living, of travelling, of childish amusements; and whose vanity was easily persuaded to put on this nonsensical and empty show.”¹¹⁷

Attacks on Kalākaua after His Death

Because attacking Kalākaua was part of a larger justification for the Bayonet Constitution and later overthrow of the monarchy, highly negative portraits of him continued to appear after his death in 1891, with the welcome addition that now the subject could not defend himself. William N. Armstrong actually uses this as a justification for his memoir *Around the World with a King*. The book was published in 1904, twenty-three years after Kalākaua’s tour of the world

and thirteen years after his death. In its introduction, Armstrong explains that the delay made possible “a freedom of narration, an adherence to truth, and ‘the painting of a portrait with the wrinkles.’” More explicitly, “if one would avoid censure he is wise to await the co-operation of Death, and reserve his narration until the subject of it is in the other world.”¹¹⁸ The result is a hostile, racist portrait of Kalākaua as a savage Polynesian noble with lazy and primitive subjects. Apparently still indignant that he was treated as the mōī’s social inferior while an attendant on the tour, Armstrong consistently portrays him and his heritage as degraded and shameful. “The King’s mind was naturally filled with the crude ideas, the superstitions, the absolutism of a Polynesian chief,” Armstrong writes, “and, where experience was lacking, a vague fear of the white man’s intelligence took its place.”¹¹⁹

Long before Armstrong published his account, his veracity regarding the world tour had been publicly called into question. Here is what the English-language newspaper *Hawaii Holomua Progress* reported about him in its January 1, 1894, edition: “Mr. Armstrong is introduced as being one of the ‘oldest’ annexationists here—in fact it is claimed that he was a thoroughbred annexationist—that is: a man resolved to deprive Hawaii of its independence, the sovereigns of their throne, since 1853.” The newspaper then goes on to ask:

Why did he travel with King Kalakaua all over the world? In what capacity? Was it as a spy and traitor trying to carry out his contemptible and nefarious scheme as an annexationist? Or was it as a loyal servant (we had nearly said “barber”) to the sovereign who paid his salary and gave to him opportunities which he otherwise would never have gained? What did he ever do here in his official capacity as Attorney General, except drawing salary? We have searched the records and we find only *one* case ever tried by him while we never fine [*sic*] *one month* in which he omitted to call for his pay. It is time for Mr. Armstrong to explain himself

and his official position under Kalakaua.¹²⁰

How then does Armstrong's *Around the World* account for the positive reception of Kalākaua everywhere? Duplicity: "Although a Polynesian, he was capable of appearing as a well-bred man in any society or in any court."¹²¹ According to Armstrong, "there were a hundred causes which contributed to destroy his monarchy, the most of which were beyond his control, and there was, it may be said in truth, not one to preserve it." But certain causes are attributed to the mō'i—the incredible expenses of the needless 1883 coronation, for instance, which Armstrong describes as a "grotesque pageantry of whitewashed paganism." There were also the Hale Nauā society, hula, and mele, described as "ancient vile and licentious practices of the savage times." In an act of racist essentialism, Armstrong concludes that it was Kalākaua's "misfortune to have been a Polynesian who with sufficient excuse failed to understand the character of the Anglo-Saxon."¹²² This poison portrait nevertheless became a significant part of Kalākaua's inheritance. Many writers draw upon and perpetuate this history, including Ralph Simpson Kuykendall, who repeats at least one patently incorrect assertion from Armstrong's *Around the World*.¹²³

Because he was not an influential or powerful figure in Hawai'i before or after the 1893 overthrow, Armstrong's remarks can perhaps be attributed to personal offense and spite. For those directly involved in bringing about the end of the monarchy, the attacks on Kalākaua and Lili'uokalani were part of a larger enterprise to defend the usurpers' actions. In 1893, shortly after Lili'uokalani was forced off the throne, Theo H. Davies wrote, for example, that Reverend S. E. Bishop "first foretold the acts, then assisted to accomplish them, and has now before him the more difficult task of justifying them."¹²⁴ Many of the conspirators found themselves following the same pattern. As Davies observed at the time, this self-justification often involved personal attacks: "Some debaters have found much comfort in blackening the character of the Queen." But Davies also

notes that this strategy was a weak means to a specific end that “will not influence their fellow beings who are waiting to know why they attempted to ‘seize the authority of a nation without the consent of that nation, and to transfer it under the guise of friendship, to a foreign power.’” Personal attacks on Kalākaua by those who forced him to sign the 1887 Bayonet Constitution, not surprisingly, were also offered as justification for those men’s illegal actions. Davies recognizes the same behavior in many of the same actors in 1893: “Men—and not men only—whose names come to my mind even now with a shock, have thought it manly and Christian and noble, to fling foul charges of immorality and idolatry at the woman whom first they found it safe to deprive of all power to help herself.” As was the case with Kalākaua, this slander was designed for export: “It has seemed good to some writers to lower themselves by pouring over America and Europe a flood of scandal-mongering abuse of Queen Liliuokalani, charging the Queen with idolatry and immorality.”¹²⁵

One of the first, and most detailed, exercises in character assassination in the wake of the 1893 overthrow was William DeWitt Alexander’s *Kalakaaua’s Reign: A Sketch of Hawaiian History*, a forty-four-page text published in 1894 that catalogs the mō‘ī’s faults and abuses and describes the major events during his seventeen-year reign, which together forced the Hawaiian League to curtail Kalākaua’s powers in 1887. At the beginning of *Kalakaaua’s Reign*, Alexander strikes at two mō‘ī: “It is true that the germs of many of the evils of Kalakaaua’s reign may be traced to the reign of Kamehameha V. The reactionary policy of that monarch is well known.”¹²⁶ According to Alexander, “Efforts to revive heathenism were redoubled under the pretense of cultivating ‘national’ feeling. Kahunas were assembled from the other islands as the King’s birthday approached, and ‘night was made hideous’ with the sound of the hula drum and the blowing of conches in the palace yard.”¹²⁷ Such events anticipated Kalākaua’s reign, as “during the next few years the country suffered from a peculiarly degrading kind of despotism.” Alexander considerably claims that he is not

referring “to the king’s personal immorality, nor to his systematic efforts to debauch and heathenize the natives to further his political ends.” Rather, “the demoralizing effects of this regime, the sycophancy, hypocrisy and venality produced by it have been a curse to the country ever since.”¹²⁸ Another eyewitness, in his 1911 memoir *Hawaii under King Kalakaua from Personal Experiences of Leavitt H. Hallock*, also reaffirms what we have seen as self-interested contemporary attacks. According to his account, the 1883 coronation, the very emblem of Kalākaua’s nobility and fitness to rule, was “as unpopular as it was ridiculous. He had already reigned ten years. He sent illuminated invitations to all governments of the earth, expending sixty thousand dollars in his preparations. No one came but a few Japanese officials, and the king’s pride was wounded.”¹²⁹

Lorrin Thurston’s and Sanford Dole’s Attacks on Kalākaua in *Memoirs*

Perhaps the most damaging accounts of Kalākaua, however, were written by arguably the two men most responsible for America’s annexation of Hawai‘i—Lorrin A. Thurston and Sanford B. Dole. Published jointly in 1936 by the same editor, Andrew Farrell, their *Memoirs of the Hawaiian Revolution*, written long after the actual events, was clearly prepared to be the last word on the subject of the overthrow and annexation. As Michael Vann explains:

Both Sanford B. Dole and Lorrin A. Thurston, two leaders of the *haole* “Revolution” and the annexationist movement, go to great pains in their memoirs to stress the corruption of Kalakaua and Gibson. Indeed, their writings read more like the tabloid press than the recollections of esteemed attorneys and political visionaries. Thurston (who always uses the term “regime” instead of “dynasty,” “monarchy,” or “administration”) frequently repeats the point that the *haole* were forced to act against the King because of his

behavior. By blaming the victim for the crime, the settler mythology allowed for their absolutism from sin; while they may have made revolution, they did so against tyranny and decadence.¹³⁰

The personal attacks also mirror a larger racial agenda. With regard to the annexationists Thurston, Dole, and Lucien Young, Linda Heffernan has argued, “These apologists for armed United States intervention to achieve their annexationist agenda found that by placing Hawai‘i and her people on the low end of the evolutionary spectrum they were able to achieve an acceptable solution, in the eyes of the American public, at least, to the ethical problem presented by territorial conquest through force.”¹³¹ Lorrin Thurston’s 587-page memoir certainly conflates the personal, racial, and political. As an individual, “Kalakaua’s mental grasp of serious affairs was so deficient as to be practically childish.”¹³² But, apparently, he was smart enough to recognize the need to “ingratiate himself with the Hawaiian people, after their almost unanimous disapproval of his election.” As we will see, this characterization of the 1874 election is profoundly misleading. The rioters before the courthouse were a small group of Emmaites, and the overwhelming support and aloha displayed by Kānaka Maoli during Kalākaua’s ensuing royal tour of the kingdom show a people united behind their new sovereign and their desire to maintain independence. In fact, Thurston found he ultimately could not dismiss the people’s admiration for the mō‘ī and grudgingly acknowledges that he “has gained a hold on the community feeling.”¹³³ Indeed, “it is scarcely possible to exaggerate the truth of the good things said of Kalakaua by the present royal propagandists,” and Thurston confesses that “what they say about his personality and public conduct is practically true.”

How, then, to convince readers that the Hawaiian League, under Thurston’s leadership, simply had to overthrow this popular mō‘ī? The answer was to accuse him of duplicity that bordered on the pathological: “Kalakaua was a remarkable

incarnation of the Dr. Jekyll and Mr. Hyde of Stevenson.” The late nights at Healani, involving free-flowing alcohol and ample games of poker and the lavish balls at the palace with hula performances “of more than questionable character” contradict the nobility and grace Kalākaua’s admirers so appreciated. This hypocrisy accompanies an ambition for control so great that, according to Thurston, by 1886 “the Kalakaua climax was reached.” Chaffing against the supposed fact that the “Hawaiian government was supposed to be a limited monarchy, under which the sovereign ‘reigned, but did not rule,’ authority being vested in a cabinet,” Kalākaua tried, “by one means or another,” to seize control, leaving the Hawaiian League no choice but to stop him. Though those in the business community generally seemed opposed to Kalākaua’s initiatives because they feared their taxes would increase to fund expenditures, Thurston does not hesitate to identify Kalākaua’s “inherent filth of mind and utter lack of decency and moral sense” as another factor. Thurston also attacks the Hale Nauā society, an organization neither Thurston nor any other haole could join, as the institutionalization of these qualities: “The community was rife with tales of the King’s indecency and immorality.”¹³⁴

Thurston’s *Memoirs* suggest that righteously denouncing the evils of Kalākaua’s character and his cabinet to the public was one of his long-standing practices. In the book he recalls an 1886 campaign trip to Kalaupapa, Moloka‘i, to ask residents there to elect him as their representative. Modesty was not one of his character traits: “Like John the Baptist of old, I was a forerunner of liberty and truth, in order that they might become free. If they would get the residents of the settlement to come out into the field to listen to the truth, I would give it to them.” When a good-sized crowd gathered, “for two or three hours, we enlightened the people regarding the iniquities of the government, and the joy and prosperity that would ensue if we were elected to the Legislature.”¹³⁵ Thurston was elected as the representative from Moloka‘i, but what actually came to pass was the Bayonet Constitution.

While Kuykendall acknowledges that Thurston's *Memoirs* contains some errors,¹³⁶ few English-language texts over the years have assessed Thurston's own reliability as a source—or his personal character. But even a cursory search in Hawaiian-language newspapers turns up contemporary charges against him that echo the attacks he himself made on Kalākaua. Rigging election results, falsifying government information, and fabricating lies to protect himself all appear, and in 1890, the National Reform Party, through its *National Herald: Ka Ahailono a ka Lahui*, published several articles declaring that Thurston “purposely garbled, misstated and suppressed portions of Hawaiian history for political purposes” and “untruthfully, needlessly and purposely slandered the character and memory” of an official.¹³⁷ Because of such actions, Thurston “has no further claim to the title of honest and honorable gentleman.”¹³⁸

Like Thurston, Dole commented on Kalākaua in memoirs that editor Andrew Farrell claimed were accurate, since he had compared “all quotations of public papers with the sources cited, comma by comma,”¹³⁹ which means they were merely quotations, not factual statements. But what amounts to accuracy? Dole quite naturally supported his historical claims with the *Pacific Commercial Advertiser*, but not a single Hawaiian-language newspaper or source appears. How accurate could memoirs dealing with the events of the early 1870s up through the 1890s be in 1936?¹⁴⁰ (Armstrong's *Around the World* raises similar questions.) And why were both Thurston's and Dole's memoirs edited by one person and published at the same time? Clearly, the intention was to produce a definitive history—and both men defined Kalākaua as incompetent and petty. According to Dole, “with the growing tendency of the King to base his selection of cabinet members on their subservience, rather than on their ability, much looseness crept into the administration of public affairs.”¹⁴¹ As is often the case, Dole presents himself as more moderate than Thurston, whom he identifies as instigating the 1887 revolution. Dole's personal attacks on the monarch, or even monarchs, are therefore fewer than

Thurston's. He asserts, for example, that after the overthrow, the Hawaiian League rejected his suggestion of replacing Lili'uokalani on the throne with Princess Ka'iulani.¹⁴² He also presents a much shorter account of the corruptions of Kalākaua's reign—fewer than 70 pages, whereas Thurston wrote almost 230 pages. In the 100 detailed pages Dole devotes to his account of Lili'uokalani and her weaknesses, though, his actual opinion of Kalākaua, a virtual echo of Thurston's, comes shining through: "The ex-Queen's rule was even more reckless and retrogressive than her brother's. Less politic than he, and with less knowledge of affairs, she had more determination and was equally unreliable and deficient in moral principle."¹⁴³

The Contemporary Canon of Kalākaua's Misrepresentations

As for the complicated life of Kalākaua, the most consulted and cited sources are five English-language texts written at various times in the twentieth century by non-Native authors who demonstrably based much of their versions of the mō'i on the texts and gossip already discussed, thereby perpetuating a genealogy of incompetence and corruption.¹⁴⁴ William N. Armstrong's *Around the World with a King* (1904) has already been mentioned. The others are Eugene Burns' *The Last King of Paradise* (1952), Kuykendall's *The Hawaiian Kingdom Vol. III, 1874-1893: The Kalakaua Dynasty* (1967), Helena G. Allen's *Kalakaua: Renaissance King* (1994), and Kristin Zambucka's *Kalakaua: Hawaii's Last King* (2002). In another context, Puakea Nogelmeier has described how a handful of such accessible narratives creates an official interpretation that is "self-replicating, being constantly repeated through other texts, curricula, and reference. Its power drowns out all other historical voices."¹⁴⁵ For anyone curious to learn something about David Kalākaua, these easily accessible books are the first sources that present themselves. And because other scholars from here and

elsewhere refer to them, the information contained in that handful's pages has become his life story. The last two can be found at Honolulu International Airport shops—perfect for the tourist who wishes to learn about Hawai'i's last mō'i. Given the intense and widely circulated criticism of Kalākaua during his lifetime and after, it is easy to see that such attacks could spur each other on before becoming embedded in later texts by authors drawing on the most accessible materials simply to keep their own projects going. As Rona Tamiko Halualani explains, "Identity articulations created in specific historical moments and by powerful structures ... are hegemonically embedded into social belief and some of these articulations are continually reproduced by structural-dominant power interests."¹⁴⁶ In this genealogy of partial and heavily self-interested historical narrative, annexationists' perceptions of Kalākaua become the foundational nineteenth-century texts, profoundly shaping how he is presented, and represented, to the world.

Of all these treatments of the mō'i, Eugene Burns' *The Last King of Paradise* is the most appallingly exaggerated and fictitious—a fact all the more remarkable because he says so much about how he has tried to tell the truth. In his "Author's Note," Burns explains that he had to resort to "old manuscripts" to learn the "true story of Hawaii" because he had soon realized that "very little of Hawaii's current literature was based upon fact."¹⁴⁷ The problem lay in the nature of the residents and, in particular, the Hawaiians: "In collecting my material, I soon found that fact is seldom objective, uncolored, in the minds of the living. Each person adds or subtracts from the true event to suit his own ego. Besides, the Polynesian, in his effort to be a good host, agrees with his guest on any subject."¹⁴⁸ So where did Burns get his information? "I read the faded letters, journals, early newspapers, books, pamphlets, documents, and consulate records of the very date that the event happened," he explains, then after thanking Kuykendall, the "historical and anthropological authority," he swears that his text is true: "I can vouch for every character in *The Last King of Paradise*,

and there are more than a hundred, and every incident—strange and fantastic as some may seem—and support all this with historical records.”¹⁴⁹ In this case, however, individuals with a heavy investment in how Kalākaua was understood by others produced many of those listed documents, and Burns’ own interpretations cast the mō‘ī’s life under a harsh and yet highly filtered light. Though praised by Burns as a major authority, in his review of *The Last King*, Kuykendall himself declares that the book is a sham. Finding it “exasperating,” “fictionalized,” and “quasi-historical,” Kuykendall concludes that “to note all the untruths, half-truths, and distortions of fact that abound in the book would take many pages.”¹⁵⁰

That Kuykendall’s own *Hawaiian Kingdom*, his cowritten *Hawaii: A History* with A. Grove Day, and Gavan Daws’ *Shoal of Time: A History of the Hawaiian Islands*, all long considered authoritative sources on Kalākaua’s life, also perpetuate many of the character attacks the mō‘ī’s enemies initiated suggests that a look at the motivations of most sources has long been desirable. To be sure, Ethel M. Damon notes that Kuykendall at least acknowledged the mō‘ī might have had some actual governing principles: “As R. S. Kuykendall ably points out, Kalakaua sincerely believed that as king he literally held the right to rule as he chose, to dismiss and appoint counselors at will, as also to bring pressure on voters before, during, and after elections.”¹⁵¹ But Kuykendall’s strong reliance on Henry A. Peirce Carter and Elisha H. Allen, both annexationists, as sources for *Hawaiian Kingdom*, undermines much of its supposed historical objectivity. As political historian Barry Rigby observes, “It apparently did not trouble Kuykendall that these two officials put US interests in Hawaii ahead of their loyalty to the Hawaiian state.”¹⁵² Vann has ably described the process by which the published accounts of individuals like Dole, Thurston, Armstrong, and others pervade the later volumes of scholarly Hawai‘i history:

Given the privilege victors have in telling the tale and silencing the vanquished, these narratives are often best

seen as primary rather than secondary sources. As temporal distance grew, professional historians took it upon themselves to present scholarly studies of the Hawaiian past.... Dissent, protest, opposition, and transgression were often marginalized, and the growth of U.S. influence in the islands, culminating in annexation and statehood, was presented as a linear and coherent historical trajectory. The result was a *haole*-centric narrative in which the native Hawaiians and Asian immigrants receded into the background, and there was no analysis of the racist, socioeconomic power structure created by white domination.¹⁵³

Houston Wood invites readers to reconsider Kuykendall's achievement: "Hawaiian history for him is the story almost exclusively of foreigners in Hawai'i, the story of their English-language newspapers and documents. Hawaiians enter the three volumes of *The Hawaiian Kingdom* mostly to the extent that they assist or resist what Kuykendall presents as an inevitable domination by a superior invading culture of American modernity." A closer look at this history largely confirms Wood's thesis. Of the more than two thousand footnotes in the third volume of *Hawaiian Kingdom*, the volume devoted to Kalākaua, more than five hundred refer to the English-language newspapers, most notably the *Pacific Commercial Advertiser* and the *Hawaiian Gazette*. Only a dozen refer to the far more widely read *Ka Leo o ka Lahui*. As Wood notes, "Kuykendall's work focuses on the nineteenth century, when there were at one time or another nearly one hundred newspapers publishing in the Hawaiian language,"¹⁵⁴ and Puakea Nogelmeier has repeatedly pointed out that beyond the handful of translated Hawaiian texts "is a historical written legacy of Hawaiian self-expression: Hawaiians writing their own stories, in their own language, for themselves, their peers, their descendants, and all who would come after them."¹⁵⁵ Kuykendall's and many other historians' avoidance, dismissal, or ignorance of the Hawaiian-language archive is a primary motivation for

Reclaiming. Kuykendall, for instance, claims that the “fullest and best account” of Kalākaua’s coronation can be found in the *Pacific Commercial Advertiser*.¹⁵⁶ As I will later show, the claim should be changed to the “fullest and best account” he could actually read. In fact, Kuykendall’s seemingly exhaustive citations not only exclude almost all Hawaiian-language materials but list his English-language press sources at the forefront, making them more accessible for researchers after him. Similarly, his frequent citations of Dole’s and Thurston’s texts, of *Memoirs*, of *Planters’ Monthly*, of the *Friend*, of the *Daily Bulletin*, of Alexander’s *Kalakaaua’s Reign*, and of Clarence W. Ashford’s “Last Days of the Hawaiian Monarchy,” all written by supporters of the Bayonet Constitution and later the overthrow, help provide the bulk of the materials for Kuykendall’s portrait of Kalākaua.

Helena Allen’s version of the *mōī* in *Kalakaaua: Renaissance King* should also be reconsidered. Most recently, Sandra Bonura has questioned the scholarship in Allen’s 1982 book *The Betrayal of Liliuokalani*, the story of Lili’uokalani as told by her *hānai* daughter, Lydia Aholo: “Comparing the book to the transcript of the tape recording revealed that Lydia Aholo’s simple, unpretentious, style of communication differed greatly from the forceful, dramatic delivery presented in *The Betrayal of Liliuokalani*.”¹⁵⁷ Even though Allen clearly meant *Kalakaaua: Renaissance King* to be highly positive and sympathetic, she too primarily consults Zambucka, A. Grove Day, Kuykendall’s *Hawaiian Kingdom III*, Dole’s and Thurston’s *Memoirs*, Armstrong’s *Around the World*, Burns, and Thrum’s *Hawaiian Almanac and Annual*. When she does mention the existence of Hawaiian-language newspapers, she misspells them—“*Ko Hawaii Pac’aina*” (*Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*), “*Ku’oku’a*” (*Kuokoa*), and “*Po’a’kula*” (*Elele Poakolu*)—so we certainly know she has no facility in Hawaiian.¹⁵⁸ Yet she proudly declares that “this book is as complete a biography of a man I admired—King Kalakaaua as the Renaissance man—as I could find documented by his opponents and supporters.”

As a result, Allen makes claims to historical objectivity while broadcasting the most extreme attacks on the mō'ī. Here, for example, is her description of him as a child: "Kalakaua was a darker color than his sister and had some Negroid features, as many Hawaiians had. It was quickly picked up that he was Negroid, and a rumor began." Allen reports that the rumor was "fueled by his opposition," but she sustains this widespread nineteenth-century slur by choosing not to issue a rebuttal. In fact, what seems most important is that it provides her with an opportunity to attack the previous biographer Burns' "research." In her footnote here, she claims that *The Last King of Paradise* "popularized" the rumor, even though "Burns has little documented material but based his book on 'interviews,' letters, and documents." Allen also perpetuates missionary party criticism of Kalākaua that her own research should have called into question. "He neither understood nor cared about the world of the *haole* businessman,"¹⁵⁹ she writes in her introduction. And yet, she describes her extensive research in foreign archival collections, including Europe and Asia. How could she simply avoid or ignore the huge number of international newspaper articles and personal observations in correspondence that describe Kalākaua's keen interest in, and knowledge about, business and innovative technology?

As for the premise governing Kristin Zambucka's *Kalakaua: Hawaii's Last King*, here are the opening lines:

An eerie stillness hung over the tree-studded grounds of Iolani Palace. No bird sang, no leaf rustled as the molten sun slid silently down the western sky. One by one the old men came. Some were bent like gnarled trees.... They were the *kahuna* ... and they came to Honolulu to keep a rendezvous with the reigning King.¹⁶⁰

Though far more sympathetic about Kalākaua, Zambucka joins Burns in presenting Hawaiian traditions as instances of supernatural exoticism. This echo effect runs through her entire slim volume, which is really a compilation of

quotations or paraphrases of whatever she found useful, even though she provides no footnotes or parenthetical citations. Her critical conclusions from her sources are also questionable. She follows William D. Alexander in concluding that “the germs of many of the evils of Kalakaua’s reign may be traced to the reign of Kamehameha V.”¹⁶¹ She repeats the assertion of Kalākaua’s teachers at the Chiefs’ Children’s School, Amos and Juliette Cooke, that there young David was known more for his humor than his intellect.¹⁶² She even quotes Armstrong’s *Around the World* as an authority on historical progress: “The extinction of Kalakaua’s Monarchy was due to the cold and inexorable law of political evolution.”¹⁶³ Like many of her sources, Zambucka concludes that the young ali’i enjoyed merrymaking, “singing, dancing and drinking with his friends until the small hours of the morning,” but she also cites as fact the details his enemies offered as early evidence for his supposed personal irresponsibility and incompetence: “As a result, he was frequently late for work at the Post Office or he didn’t turn up at all.”¹⁶⁴ *Hawaii’s Last King* is one of the few narratives about Kalākaua that covers the mō’ī’s inaugural tour of the islands in 1874, but even so, she provides no context. Because the Hawaiian-language newspapers had documented the fissure in the Hawaiian community resulting from the earlier Queen Emma and Kalākaua election, the stories of the tour stressed Kanaka Maoli attempts to unite under a new sovereign and to maintain the kingdom’s independence. Zambucka quotes an anonymous reporter whose paper is not identified as saying that “everyone who could move followed the King’s party.”¹⁶⁵ And in 1972, in his *Hawaii: An Uncommon History*, Edward Joesting could still offer the following “portrait” of Kalākaua by drawing on the sources available to him: “He spent too much money on pompous displays, and because his personal expenses were heavy he sometimes sought to improve his fortunes through dealings which were questionable if not wholly corrupt.”¹⁶⁶

As Puakea Nogelmeier has written, “The impact of leaving most of the Hawaiian writings out of the mix of modern

knowledge is that every form of history written, every cultural study undertaken, and every assumption made over most of the last century should be revisited in light of those neglected sources.”¹⁶⁷ The history of how our understanding of Kalākaua has been transmitted suggests that it would be a very good candidate for such revisiting.

Notes

- ^{1.} Silva, *Aloha Betrayed*, 89.
- ^{2.} Kamehiro, *Arts of Kingship*, 5.
- ^{3.} Herbert Spencer (1820–1903) was best known for applying evolution to psychology and philosophy. Charles Darwin (1809–1882) standardized natural selection, which documented that species able to adapt to their changing environments will survive over time, whereas those that cannot will eventually disappear. The British statistician Karl Pearson (1857–1936) believed that the “fittest” nation or race would outsurvive weaker ones.
- ^{4.} Vann, “Contesting Cultures,” 159.
- ^{5.} Korn, *News from Molokai*, 39.
- ^{6.} Ibid., 98.
- ^{7.} Ibid., 119.
- ^{8.} See Osorio, *Dismembering Lāhui*, 159–166.
- ^{9.} Ibid., 141–142.
- ^{10.} Williams, “Freedom Fighter,” <https://hanahou.slickage.com/articles/2088>.
- ^{11.} Osorio, *Dismembering Lāhui*, 166.
- ^{12.} “Ka La 12 o Feberuari,” *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, February 24, 1883, 3, Ulukau.
- ^{13.} Silva, *Power of the Steel-Tipped Pen*, 35.
- ^{14.} Schweizer noted that in 1874 “the mortality rate of the natives exceeded their birth rate with depressing regularity and the small but vigorous Caucasian population kept growing just as steadily as the native ranks were thinning.” Schweizer, *Turning Tide*, 263.
- ^{15.} Silva, *Power of the Steel-Tipped Pen*, 107.
- ^{16.} Korn, *News from Molokai*, 58.
- ^{17.} Silva, *Power of the Steel-Tipped Pen*, 92–96.
- ^{18.} Osorio, *Dismembering Lāhui*, 147.
- ^{19.} “The Native Hawaiian Heard From. The Natives of Kaneohe Show Their Feeling toward the Present Government,” *Hawaiian Gazette*, June 28, 1887, 5, *Chronicling America* (hereafter cited as *HG*).
- ^{20.} Osorio, *Dismembering Lāhui*, 180.
- ^{21.} Ibid., 224.
- ^{22.} Korn, *Victorian Visitors*, 74, 86–87.
- ^{23.} Field, *This Life I’ve Loved*, 150.
- ^{24.} See Silva, *Aloha Betrayed*, 176.
- ^{25.} See Osorio, *Dismembering Lāhui*, 235–238.

- [26.](#) Baldwin, *Memoir of Henry Perrine Baldwin*, 53.
- [27.](#) Ibid., 55.
- [28.](#) Osorio, *Dismembering Lāhui*, 202.
- [29.](#) Wilcox, *Sugar Water*, 21.
- [30.](#) Gordon-Cumming, *Fire Fountains*, 1:282.
- [31.](#) Gowen, *Paradise of the Pacific*, 62.
- [32.](#) Schweizer, *Turning Tide*, 283.
- [33.](#) Curtis and Thurston, "Sandwich Islands," 280.
- [34.](#) Osorio, *Dismembering Lāhui*, 151.
- [35.](#) "Repeatedly in Hawaiian History (Communicated)," *HG*, March 25, 1874, 2, *Chronicling America*.
- [36.](#) "Our Misfortune," *HG*, February 18, 1874, 2.
- [37.](#) "A Sham!," *HG*, August 23, 1882.
- [38.](#) Thurston, *Memoirs of the Hawaiian Revolution*, 218; Damon, *Sanford Ballard Dole*, 285.
- [39.](#) Damon, *Sanford Ballard Dole*, 158.
- [40.](#) Vann, "Contesting Cultures."
- [41.](#) Bird, *Six Months in the Sandwich Islands*, 261.
- [42.](#) Gowen, *Paradise of the Pacific*, 15.
- [43.](#) Field, *This Life I've Loved*, 150-151.
- [44.](#) Her formal name was Maria Carolina Isabella Luigia Sobrero. See Knowlton, Morris, and Bacchilega, *Italian Baroness in Hawai'i*, 9.
- [45.](#) Ibid., 96.
- [46.](#) "Slander Is the Bane of This Community," *Ka Nuhou Hawaii*, April 28, 1874.
- [47.](#) "Yesterday an Informal Meeting," *HG Extra*, August 19, 1880, *Chronicling America*.
- [48.](#) See "A Cabinet in a Coconut," *Pacific Commercial Advertiser*, January 4, 1873, 4 (hereafter cited as *PCA*).
- [49.](#) Dole, "Vacuum: A Farce in Three Acts," 115.
- [50.](#) R. H. Allen, "Some Observations," 41.
- [51.](#) Atkinson and Purvis, "Grand Duke of Gynbergdrinkenstein," 127.
- [52.](#) Ibid., 130.
- [53.](#) R. H. Allen, "Some Observations," 41.
- [54.](#) See Silva, *Aloha Betrayed*, 173-178.
- [55.](#) Tromp, Bachman, and Kaufman, "Coming to Terms with Xenophobia," 7.
- [56.](#) Thrum, "Retrospect for the Year 1881," 67-68.
- [57.](#) Thrum, "Retrospect for the Year 1883," 65.
- [58.](#) Stewart, *Crowning of the Dread King*, 310.
- [59.](#) Thrum, "Retrospect for the Year 1883," 65.
- [60.](#) "A Wild Scheme," *Daily Honolulu Press*, December 16, 1885.
- [61.](#) See Thrum, "Retrospect for the Year 1883," 65.
- [62.](#) *The Hawaiian Gazette Report: The Coronation (February 12, 1883) and Unveiling Ceremonies of the Statue of Kamehameha I and Grand State Dinner, Etc. (February 14, 1883)*, in Hawaiian Historical Society, *Kalaka'ua's Hawaii*, 4.

- [63.](#) "Next, as to the Coronation," *HG*, June 28, 1882, 3, *Chronicling America*.
- [64.](#) "Ka Poni Alii," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, January 13, 1883, 2, *Ulu*.
- [65.](#) *Hawaiian Ethnographic Notes*, vol. 1, B. P. Bishop Museum, 2932 (hereafter cited as *HEN*).
- [66.](#) L. Young, *Boston at Hawaii*, 14.
- [67.](#) "A Wild Scheme," *Daily Honolulu Press*, December 16, 1885, 2.
- [68.](#) Thrum, "Retrospect for the Year 1887," 87.
- [69.](#) Lili'uokalani, *Hawaii's Story*, 105.
- [70.](#) Mo'okini, *Hawaiian Newspapers*, vi, vii; Meyer, *Hawaii, Its Stamps and Postal History*, 13.
- [71.](#) Examples of Whitney's antagonism for the mō'i are found in chapter 4.
- [72.](#) "The Chinese in Honolulu," *North China Herald* (Shanghai), January 11, 1889, 44; "The Revolution in Honolulu," *North China Herald*, August 12, 1887, 188; "King Kalakaua and the Pacific Islands," *Hong Kong Daily Press*, July 30, 1886, 2, Multimedia Information Systems: Hong Kong Public Libraries; "The Queen of Hawaii," *Hong Kong Daily Press*, August 7, 1874, 3, Multimedia Information Systems: Hong Kong Public Libraries.
- [73.](#) Kuykendall, *Hawaiian Kingdom*, 345.
- [74.](#) L. Young, *Boston at Hawaii*, 15.
- [75.](#) "The Roads," *HG*, May 10, 1887, 4.
- [76.](#) "The Charges against the Members of This Government Have Been Very Directly Made," *HG*, May 10, 1887, *Chronicling America*.
- [77.](#) *A Sketch of Recent Events, Being a Short Account of the Events Which Culminated on June 30, 1887, Together with a Full Report of the Great Reform Meeting and the Two Constitutions in Parallel Columns* (Honolulu: A. M. Hewett; *Hawaiian Gazette*, 1887), in *Hawaiian Historical Society, Kalakaua's Hawaii*, 10.
- [78.](#) Kuykendall, *Hawaiian Kingdom*, 260, 691n46.
- [79.](#) Andrade, "Great Britain and the Hawaiian Revolution," 92.
- [80.](#) *The Shepherd Saint of Lanai: Rich "Primary" Revelations Gathered from Various Sources and Produced for the First Time in the Saturday Press, December 24, 1881 to January 21, 1882* (Honolulu: Thrum, 1882), in *Hawaiian Historical Society, Kalakaua's Hawaii*, 43.
- [81.](#) S. C. Armstrong, "Lessons from the Hawaiian Islands," 225.
- [82.](#) "The Charges," *HG*, May 10, 1887.
- [83.](#) Damon, *Sanford Ballard Dole*, 157; in 1881, Thrum described the *Saturday Press* as a paper "by the people, and for the people, and whose outspoken tones, together with the consistent course of the [*Hawaiian*] *Gazette*, have done so much to save the country from ignominy and disgrace." See Thrum, "Retrospect for the Year 1881," 62.
- [84.](#) Kent, *Charles Reed Bishop*, 70, 73.
- [85.](#) Whitney, *Hawaiian America*, 294.
- [86.](#) Williams Jr., "'Ike Mōakaaka," 67-90.
- [87.](#) *Ibid.*, 292, 293, 295.
- [88.](#) Imada, *Aloha America*, 31.
- [89.](#) Cox, *Radio Journalism in America*, 227n29.
- [90.](#) Chapin, *Shaping History*, 11.

- [91.](#) Ibid., 15.
- [92.](#) Ahmad, "Different Islands, Different Experiences," 98.
- [93.](#) Desmond, *Staging Tourism*, 35.
- [94.](#) Ahmad, "Different Islands, Different Experiences," 99.
- [95.](#) Musick, *Hawaii: Our Possessions*, 346–347.
- [96.](#) Taylor, *Under Hawaiian Skies*, 15.
- [97.](#) Ibid., 417.
- [98.](#) Ferguson, *Our Hawaii*, i.
- [99.](#) "A Revolution," *Bismarck Weekly Tribune*, July 15, 1887, 6, Chronicling America.
- [100.](#) "Revolution in Hawaii," *London Times*, July 11, 1887, 5, British Newspaper Archive.
- [101.](#) "The Riots in the Sandwich Islands," *Evening Star*, March 20, 1874, 3, Chronicling America.
- [102.](#) "The Reciprocity Treaty: What Its Opponents Propose to Insure Its Abrogation," *Saturday Press*, February 25, 1882, 3, Chronicling America.
- [103.](#) "King Kalakaua States," *Columbus Journal* (NE), February 3, 1881, 2, Chronicling America.
- [104.](#) "Embezzlement," *Southern Argus* (New South Wales, Australia), May 14, 1885, 4, National Library of Australia.
- [105.](#) "Kalakaua, King of the Sandwich Islands," *Bristol News* (VA, TN), December 22, 1874, 2, Chronicling America; "How King Kalakaua Lives," *Galveston Daily News*, October 29, 1886, 2.
- [106.](#) Lee, *Hawaii: A Literary Chronicle*, 350.
- [107.](#) Fitch, "Pigmy Kingdom of a Debauchee," 123.
- [108.](#) "Timely Topics," *Daily Globe* (St. Paul), October 2, 1881, 4, Chronicling America.
- [109.](#) "Crafty King," *Williamsburg Journal Tribune*, March 6, 1891, 3.
- [110.](#) "A Varied Poker Story," *St. Louis Globe-Democrat*, June 14, 1886, 3, Gale 19th Century US Newspapers; "Claims to Have Beat Five Kings," *Weekly Detroit Free Press*, June 26, 1886, 6, Gale 19th Century US Newspapers; "Kalakaua's Kingdom," *St. Louis Globe-Democrat*, July 10, 1886, 16, Gale 19th Century US Newspapers; "Royalty and Poker," *Queenscliffe Sentinel*, *Drysdale, Portarlington & Sorrento Advertiser*, August 26, 1893, 2, National Library of Australia, Trove database; "Celebrities," *Sydney Morning Herald*, July 27, 1935, 10, Trove; "Celebrities," *Queenscliffe Sentinel*, *Drysdale, Portarlington & Sorrento Advertiser*, August 26, 1893, 2, Trove; "Royalty and Poker," *Oakleigh Leader*, August 19, 1893, 7, Trove; "Royalty and Poker," *Warragul Guardian*, August 25, 1893, 6, Trove; "Royalty and Poker," *Camperdown Chronicle*, August 22, 1893, 2, National Library of Australia.
- [111.](#) "King Kalakaua of the Sandwich Islands," *Daily Bulletin*, August 12, 1882, 2, Chronicling America.
- [112.](#) "Kalakaua's Kingdom," *St. Louis Globe-Democrat*, July 10, 1886, 16, Gale 19th Century US Newspapers.
- [113.](#) Marlin, *Propaganda and the Ethics of Persuasion*, 76.
- [114.](#) "Trouble in Hawaii," *St. Louis Globe-Democrat*, August 10, 1887, 5, Gale 19th Century US Newspapers; "The Troubles in the Hawaiian Islands,"

South Australian Register, December 31, 1887, 5, National Library of Australia; "A Revolution," *Bismarck Weekly Tribune*, July 15, 1887, 6, Chronicling America.

- [115.](#) "Kalakaua," *HG*, August 31, 1881, 6, Chronicling America.
- [116.](#) "The Coronation of King Kalakaua I," *Frank Leslie's Illustrated Newspaper*, March 10, 1883, 37.
- [117.](#) "Opera Bouffe in the Sandwich Islands," *Brisbane Courier*, May 3, 1883, 2, National Library of Australia.
- [118.](#) W. N. Armstrong, *Around the World*, 4-5.
- [119.](#) *Ibid.*, 12.
- [120.](#) "William Nevins Armstrong, 1894. Who Is He? Mr. W. N. Armstrong Again," *Hawaii Holomua*, January 31, 1894, 3," *Nupepa-hawaii* (blog).
- [121.](#) W. N. Armstrong, *Around the World*, 9.
- [122.](#) *Ibid.*, 283, 285, 286, 288.
- [123.](#) See Kuykendall, *Hawaiian Kingdom*, 687; Marumoto, "Vignette of Early Hawaii," 53.
- [124.](#) Davies, *Letters upon the Political Crisis*, 4.
- [125.](#) *Ibid.*, 6, 19, 29.
- [126.](#) Alexander, *Kalakaua's Reign*, 1.
- [127.](#) *Ibid.*, 31-32.
- [128.](#) *Ibid.*, 23-24.
- [129.](#) Hallock, *Hawaii under King Kalakaua*, 44.
- [130.](#) Vann, "Contesting Cultures."
- [131.](#) Heffernan, "From Independent Nation to Client State," 210.
- [132.](#) Thurston, *Memoirs of the Hawaiian Revolution*, 28.
- [133.](#) *Ibid.*, 19, 21.
- [134.](#) *Ibid.*, 22-23, 42-43, 48.
- [135.](#) *Ibid.*, 108-109.
- [136.](#) Kuykendall, *Hawaiian Kingdom*, 695n16, 705n55.
- [137.](#) "Self-Convicted! Thurston's Lame Defense! The Honor of a Dead American Shielded from Missionary Slander. The Proposed Treaty," *National Herald: Ka Ahailono a ka Lahui*, February 3, 1890, 2, Ulukau.
- [138.](#) The articles "The Day," *National Herald: Ka Ahailono a ka Lahui*, January 14, 1890, 2; "The Day," *National Herald: Ka Ahailono a ka Lahui*, January 28, 1890, 2; and "Self-Convicted," *Ka Ahailono a ka Lahui*, February 3, 1890, 2, document Thurston's immorality and corruption. See also Iaukea, *Queen and I*, 54.
- [139.](#) Dole, *Memoirs of the Hawaiian Revolution*, v.
- [140.](#) See the preface to Dole's *Memoirs of the Hawaiian Revolution*, v.
- [141.](#) Dole, *Memoirs of the Hawaiian Revolution*, 46.
- [142.](#) *Ibid.*, 47, 77.
- [143.](#) *Ibid.*, 124.
- [144.](#) See Mellen, *Island Kingdom Passes*, viii-ix, for her theory on this point and Schobel, "David Kalakaua, the Man," for an example of this point.
- [145.](#) Nogelmeier, *Mai Pa'a*, xii.
- [146.](#) Halualani, *In the Name of Hawaiians*, xvi.

- [147.](#) Burns, *Last King of Paradise*, xi.
- [148.](#) Ibid., xi-xii.
- [149.](#) Ibid., xii, xv.
- [150.](#) Kuykendall, "Review of *The Last King*," 297-298.
- [151.](#) Damon, *Sanford Ballard Dole*, 187.
- [152.](#) Rigby, "Origins of American Expansion," 228.
- [153.](#) Vann, "Contesting Cultures."
- [154.](#) H. Wood, *Displacing Natives*, 2.
- [155.](#) Nogelmeier, *Mai Pa'a*, xvi.
- [156.](#) Kuykendall, *Hawaiian Kingdom*, 691n52.
- [157.](#) Bonura and Witmer, "Lydia K. Aholo," 103-145, 105; for further information on the inaccuracies of Allen's scholarship, see Bonura and Witmer, "Lydia K. Aholo," 111, 123, 126, 128-129, 136.
- [158.](#) H. G. Allen, *Kalakaua: Renaissance King*, 266n1.
- [159.](#) Ibid., xviii, xvii, 26, 261.
- [160.](#) Zambucka, *Kalakaua: Hawaii's Last King*, 1.
- [161.](#) Ibid., 14.
- [162.](#) Ibid., 6.
- [163.](#) Ibid., 38; W. N. Armstrong, *Around the World*, 283.
- [164.](#) Zambucka, *Kalakaua: Hawaii's Last King*, 9.
- [165.](#) Ibid., 19.
- [166.](#) Joesting, *Hawaii: An Uncommon History*, 212.
- [167.](#) Nogelmeier, *Mai Pa'a*, xi.

CHAPTER TWO

Kalākaua Reconsidered

Chapter 2 shifts gears from [chapter 1](#), which mapped out a genealogy of attacks on King Kalākaua and misrepresentations of his character, or what I have called “The Case against Kalākaua.” Seeking to establish a different foundation, this chapter documents and analyzes favorable nineteenth-century national and international English-language representations of Kalākaua drawn from material published outside of Hawai‘i from the time of his ascension to the throne to his 1881 circumnavigation of the globe. Kalākaua’s journey in this way allows us to recognize the honor that many kings, rulers, magistrates, prominent citizens, and populations throughout the world felt it was to welcome Hawai‘i’s mō‘ī. Another prominent thread in these accounts conveys people’s astonishment at Kalākaua’s own dignified character, eloquence, and nobility. Coupled with that strand are expressions of admiration at Kalākaua’s intention to travel around the world—a voyage that subverted conventional assumptions about rulers of small, distant island nations. Because Kalākaua was a monarch, newspapers’ accounts of how their leaders received him, and how he responded, became a form of national validation. Through his presence, Kalākaua became an occasion for self-representation.

One of the initial accounts of Kalākaua in England in 1881 provides a clear example of the kinds of discourse this chapter describes. In July 1881, while staying at Normanhurst, a stately home in Sussex, Kalākaua was interviewed at length by a reporter from the *Hastings & St. Leonard’s Observer*. The resulting article testifies to the mō‘ī’s articulateness, nobility, and generally impressive manner. “The accent is purest English,” the reporter states.

“Idiom is not at fault, and the demeanour shows the self-possessed ease and courteous grace of a Guelph or a Granville.” The questions were all directed toward having Kalākaua compare his nation to the one he was visiting:

Is English taught in your schools?

Do these schools compete against each other in sports?

By the bye, *apropos* of your horse racing, do you allow betting?

Do you find our English meals greatly differ from those of your own country?

Is Sunday strictly kept in your country?

Have you any laws regulating the sale of alcoholic liquors?

You are a constitutional Sovereign, I understand?

The answers the reporter recorded suggest that Kalākaua and Hawai‘i both compared favorably to England—or even had an advantage. “Do you approve of compulsory education?” the mō‘ī was asked. “Most fully,” he replied. “Our education is compulsory, and I believe I may say, that as a matter of statistics a larger proportion of our population read and write than in any other country.”¹

The article concludes with a tribute to Kalākaua’s exemplary behavior, which stands as a pointed commentary on the general British standard of the time. “I doubt whether any of my readers would have borne such cross-examination with half the gracious equanimity that his Polynesian Majesty displayed, or have so readily humored my curiosity on every possible point,” the reporter remarks. The content was also impressive—clearly, the product of a keen and astute intellect: “Every answer was fraught with interest, not only for the specific knowledge which it conveyed, but also for the insight which it gave to the general principles, political or social, which had been studied in any given case, in arranging and ordaining the internal economy of these islands.” The reporter concludes that Kalākaua, and apparently his nation, set an example that England itself would do well to follow:

I parted from his Majesty with regret, envying his subjects, and with a forlorn patriotic wish that the taste of English country life of which he had spoken so warmly might induce him to settle in our own island. A dozen constituencies would gladly return him to our Parliament, and any Cabinet would covet him as a colleague to co-operate in the reform of those weak points, political, social, and ecclesiastical, of our own nation which, are so conspicuously absent from the even tenour of the Hawaiian rule.²

As I seek to restore a balance by describing just how positive Kalākaua's representations were in places other than Hawai'i, I do not, however, want to suggest that I agree with Helena Allen's claim that more people outside of Hawai'i liked Kalākaua than inside. Simply put, *Reclaiming Kalākaua* demonstrates that people who had no motivation to discredit or trivialize the king or his kingdom generally responded more favorably than those in Hawai'i devoted to distributing the negative or slanderous representations. Not surprisingly, what becomes clear is that motivation and intent are crucial to evaluating the accuracy of Kalākaua's representations. This chapter provides substantial evidence, drawn from a range of international publications, that the United States and other nations often had access to very positive accounts of the mō'i. The disappearance of such accounts in assessments of Kalākaua has profoundly skewed Hawaiian history. Chapter 2 therefore begins a reclamation process by giving the reader a more detailed sense of how the mō'i struck those contemporaries whose accounts have often been ignored or discounted, then and later, by those responsible for the dominant strain of his representations.

Kalākaua in Nineteenth-Century US and International English-Language Publications

As Marlene Tromp, Maria K. Bachman, and Heidi Kaufman have noted, over the course of the nineteenth century, the

Industrial Revolution “facilitated the mass production and affordability of objects that circulated at home and abroad; enabled the transit of people, perspectives, and ideas; and disrupted putative spatial, ideological, and national boundaries.”³ Kalākaua not only stayed informed about those innovations but sought to have his kingdom embrace them. His supporters and admirers at the time pointed to significant improvements in Hawai‘i’s economy and international reputation as evidence of his competence, and even great talent, as a ruler. Some later historians acknowledge that his reign was a prosperous and innovative time for the aupuni (government). Edward Joesting points to the early introduction of electricity and the telephone and reports that “sugar gave the nation a sound financial basis, and its businessmen became affluent and sophisticated. Communications with the rest of the world became faster and safer, and the Islands were pulled into the currents of international affairs.”⁴ So well informed was the mō‘ī that his lack of amazement at the institutions of the world’s more “advanced” nations actually became news: “The cricket match at Lord’s astonished him not at all, for as he will quietly say, in his musical tones, ‘We have several clubs in Honolulu, and I know of others in India.’”⁵

The improved state of contemporary communication meant not only that Kalākaua was highly aware of trends and institutions around the world but that people were far more aware, at home and abroad, of Kalākaua himself. American and international representations of him outnumber previous Hawaiian mō‘ī because his era provided much greater access to him, whether through steamship, accelerated correspondence, photographs, or the explosion in the number of British, American, and international newspapers producing far more news about the world than in previous generations. By visiting the United States and the publishing centers of other countries more widely and frequently than any monarch in world history, Kalākaua presented himself for inspection to a remarkable degree. And newspapers responded. A key word search for “Kalakaua” in Gale’s 19th

Century US Newspapers database turns up more than 2,900 results. With regard to Great Britain, 580 articles appear in 19th Century British Newspapers,⁶ and there are 876 results in the British Library's British Newspaper Archive. Even the National Library of Australia newspaper archive produces 630 hits.⁷ Personal access was a major reason for these numbers. Known as the people's mō'i in Hawai'i, he and his family were famously approachable, and Kalākaua maintained this pattern of accessibility when he traveled elsewhere. In late 1881, Canadian Minnie Forsyth Grant left San Francisco for a visit to Hawai'i aboard the *Australia*. Kalākaua, having completed his journey around the world, was also on board. Just outside of San Francisco harbor, Grant was presented to the mō'i. She described him—inaccurately—this way: "His natural dignity of manner was very marked, his voice soft, musical, with a slight foreign accent, and his English, owing to the fact that he was educated chiefly in California, was perfect."⁸ (Kalākaua was, of course, educated entirely in Hawai'i.⁹) When they disembarked in Honolulu, Grant again wrote about Kalākaua's thoughtfulness and charm: "He went about among the passengers, saying good-bye in the kindest way, and I should be afraid to tell how many royal autographs were asked for and presented."¹⁰ It should therefore not be surprising that many, many people, including reporters, approached, shook hands with, and spoke to this sovereign.

His accessibility was matched by his outgoing nature. One of the most common sources of amazement in international publications was how familiar and fully at ease he was with the most refined aspects of foreign cultures. "A very few minutes conversation convinces the visitor that King Kalakaua is an extensive reader," one British paper reported. "It is, in fact, his wide reading which impelled him to see that world of which he had read so many descriptions."¹¹ In 1886, Father John A. Zahm offered this favorable account and comparison: "He speaks English fluently, and in his own language he is regarded as quite an orator. He is a man of commanding presence."¹² Many years later, Edward Joesting

suggests that Kalākaua not only had talent but realized that convincing others of this fact had to be one of his strategies of leadership: “His intellect and social ease surprised most who met him. He was very ambitious and, particularly during his early years, was willing to work hard to achieve his goals.”¹³

The substantial archive of material on King Kalākaua published during his reign introduces a complicating factor in evaluating the intention behind representations. That is the degree to which many newspapers, desperate for content, simply reprinted stories from other newspapers. Even this early, news agencies were supplying such material. The *North American and United States Gazette*’s “Latest News,” for instance, consisted of dispatches from the Associated Press, founded in 1846. Whether taken from an agency or simply reprinted from a copy of another paper, the result was that any report on the mō’ī could be distributed around the world. For example, two British newspapers, the *Pall Mall Gazette* and the *Royal Cornwall Gazette*, quoted verbatim the same *San Francisco Call* story about the 1874 election riot.¹⁴ Melbourne’s *Australasian*’s September 17, 1881, story about Kalākaua came from the *New York Times*, and London’s *Daily News*, the *Standard*, the *Morning Post*, the *Leeds Mercury*, and *Lloyd’s Weekly Newspaper* all printed verbatim the same story about Kalākaua’s visit to the White House in December 1874.¹⁵ The *Liverpool Mercury* and the *Huddersfield Daily Chronicle* out of London and the *Freeman’s Journal and Daily Commercial Advertiser* in Dublin all took the same article, “King of the Sandwich Islands,” from the *Philadelphia Public Ledger*. In early 1875, after Kalākaua visited Omaha, Nebraska, on his way to Washington, DC, to negotiate the Reciprocity Treaty between the United States and Hawai’i, the *Omaha Republican* reprinted a *Chicago Post* article about “unwholesome rumors” of the king’s “riotous conduct” in Omaha. In response, the *Pacific Commercial Advertiser* in Honolulu printed the letter that Omaha mayor Chase, who had accompanied the mō’ī throughout his stay, sent to Saint Louis

mayor Brown, assuring him that “at all times, and everywhere while with us,” Kalākaua “was the perfect gentleman” and requesting that Brown send a copy of this letter to different newspaper offices in Chicago to clear the mō‘ī’s name. Brown’s reply was emphatic and dismissive of the press: “I consider the whole statement a canard and regret that the name of King Kalakaua ... should be dragged into such a statement.”¹⁶ Again, however, motivation and intent are crucial in determining the accuracy of King Kalākaua’s representations. A more nuanced, comprehensive history of him, gleaned from those nineteenth-century publications, is offered here.

The 1874 Election—The Trip to Washington, DC

Because the 1874 election between Kalākaua and Queen Emma generated so many attacks on him in Hawai‘i, it is surprising to discover just how many favorable, and even flattering, accounts of him appeared in newspapers abroad at this time. On March 19, 1874, Philadelphia’s *North American and United States Gazette* reported that “the election on the 12th simply registered what had been decided. The new ruler is a man of more experience, ability and character than his predecessors.”¹⁷ On March 20, Washington, DC’s *Evening Star* printed the following portrait:

He descended from the high chiefs of Maui and Hawaii, and stands first in rank in the Kingdom by virtue of his blood. He has been closely identified with the political history of the country during the last three reigns, and He is exceedingly popular with the native Kanakas.... The house of Nobles was known to be strongly in Kalakaua’s favor.¹⁸

The *Evening Star*’s attention to the details of the reign of previous mō‘ī not only confirms Kānaka Maoli support for the new mō‘ī but also suggests that the second general election amounted to a confirmation of the first. That the Native

legislators were in favor of Kalākaua is an auspicious beginning for his reign and debunks the claims cited in [chapter 1](#) that Hawaiians generally opposed his rule and that his response to the riot revealed his incompetence. The *Illustrated American* also discounted the riot as a sign of public sentiment: “The object of this noisy demonstration was apparent: it was intended to overawe the supporters of Kalakaua, and to secure the election of the Dowager Queen.”¹⁹ In Australia, the *Sydney Morning Herald* supplemented the *Illustrated American*’s account by bluntly stating that “the popular candidate everywhere was Kalakaua ... an educated and accomplished man.... The disappointed partisans of Queen Emma made a disgraceful riot.” Kalākaua’s firm resistance to outside influence, published in the *Nuhou*, also appears in the Sydney paper. He is a “determined opponent of the cession of Pearl Harbor scheme, and an indefatigable champion for the independence of his native country.”²⁰ Another Sydney paper, the *Empire*, offered a firsthand account of the special election:

On our way we met large numbers of natives cheering in true English style for their favourite candidates. On entering the room where honorable members were assembled, we were much struck with their intelligent and gentlemanly appearance—with the exception of the members of the Government, and some four or five others, all were natives. They were well and neatly dressed in black cloth, entirely in European style.²¹

This account contradicts two of the most durable claims about this day: that there was little maka’āinana support for Kalākaua and that he won by bribing the native legislators with gin, who then appeared at the special session drunk. At least according to the *Empire*’s source, they were well prepared to cast their votes.

Immediately after the election, various newspapers testified to Kalākaua’s competence and reported on his successful initial movements as the new monarch. On March

21, 1874, Maine's *Bangor Daily Whig & Courier* claimed that Kalākaua was said to be the "most powerful chief of the nation."²² On April 4, the *New York Times* predicted that his reign would be "marked by the best-devised and most energetic measures for the welfare and happiness of the Hawaiian people." Significantly, this article also revealed that Kalākaua was to embark on a tour of the kingdom, which would allow him to "thoroughly investigate and correct the wrongs and abuses which have so long afflicted the country. Wherever natives are found who have the experience and ability to take part in the active duties of Government, they will be remembered."²³ This report of his determination to solve the problems in the kingdom and to draw on the expertise and talents of Hawaiians counters the claim that he was completely absorbed in his own pleasure, or that he was merely the Americans' pawn. The *Illustrated American* also offers a powerful reminder that at the time, he enjoyed widespread support within the non-Native community in Hawai'i: "David Kalakaua, a high chief, a descendant of the ancient chiefs, and nobles of the kingdom, and an intelligent and educated man [was the] candidate for the native Hawaiian party, and was supported generally by those of the people who were of American birth or descent."²⁴

Harper's Weekly: A Journal of Civilization's April 4, 1874, account of the newmō'i, complete with portrait, placed him firmly within the civilized world, stating that he was "a native chief, and stands first in rank in the kingdom by virtue of his blood" but also "a man of education, of better physical stamina than the late king, of good habits, vigorous will, and a strong determination to maintain the independence of the islands, in which he is supported by the people, who are of like mind on this point."²⁵ Later that year *Harper's* repeated its praise, both of Kalākaua and the entire nation's desire to govern itself: "The young king is a man of good education and vigorous will, and is determined to preserve the independence of the islands over which he rules. In this matter he is supported by the patriotic intelligence of the whole people."²⁶ In monarchical England, the April 18, 1874,

Illustrated London News began with his genealogy, mentioning that the new sovereign of Hawai'i was the "son of the late Hon. C. Kapaakea and the High Chieftainess Keohokalole, both kin to the ancient royal family." He was also an intelligent and talented individual, "said to speak and write our language as well as his own. He is an accomplished musician."²⁷ Chicago's *Inter Ocean* goes so far as to declare his talents transcendent: "King Kalakaua, though the chief of only 50,000, yet has the education and qualities, as a ruler, of many born to wield the destinies of fifty millions."

Near the end of 1874, Kalākaua would set out across the Pacific Ocean to the United States of America, where he would fulfill many of the favorable predictions published in the spring—but not before first taking care of important business in Hawai'i. Most accounts of the first year of Kalākaua's reign present his trip to Washington, DC, to urge Congress to pass the Reciprocity Treaty as his first significant act after ascending the throne. For his many detractors, this trip is either the high point of his reign, followed by a sharp decline, or proof of his subservience to American business interests in Hawai'i and therefore, the betrayal of his own people. But the March 7, 1874, edition of the Hawaiian-language *Nupepa Kuokoa* announced a forthcoming tour of his kingdom to thank the Hawaiian people for electing him and to announce Ho'oulu Lāhui, his initiative to increase the population, the agricultural production and export, and the economic prosperity of Hawai'i.²⁸ This announcement was hardly surprising. Touring the kingdom was an immediate priority for any new mō'i—many had done so before, as would Lili'uokalani seventeen years later. The July 23, 1874, issue of the British *Star* made precisely this point. On this royal tour, "he was everywhere well received, and there were plenty of fireworks, *fetes*, and presents," proving that "the government of the new king is firmly established, as not only the majority of the native population, but nearly all the foreign inhabitants, support it."²⁹ (A detailed discussion of this tour drawn from the Hawaiian-language reports appears in a following chapter.)

Before departing for the United States, Kalākaua met with his Privy Council to discuss what Kuykendall calls the “propriety” of his trip.³⁰ While some members were concerned about the trip’s expenses, the mō’ī himself apparently feared a coup d’etat, worrying that in his absence the American business interests would overthrow his government. He also did not want his people to see this American trip as exclusively about the Reciprocity Treaty because that could undercut his claims to value independence. Although in their Foreign Office correspondence, American commissioner Henry A. Peirce dismissively told British commissioner James H. Wodehouse that Kalākaua “hopes, as we Americans say, ‘to have a good time’ generally” and cared little about the treaty itself, Kuykendall more evenly writes that the “main objection” was that “the trip as planned would put the king in a false position and make it appear that he was going just for the purpose of getting the much desired reciprocity treaty.” But Governor John O. Dominis assured the Privy Council “that the king and he had long wished to go to the United States—long before the treaty had been thought of” and “blamed the local newspaper for connecting the king’s visit with the reciprocity treaty project.”³¹ Kalākaua even proposed extending his travels to England and France “in order to show the United States Government that he did not intend to throw himself into their hands—that his real wish was to go to England!”³² Although he did not visit England and France this time and he certainly went to the United States primarily to assist with negotiations for the treaty,³³ Kalākaua seemed far more concerned with not being seen as a puppet, with the threat of an American coup, and with assuring his people of his commitment to the independence of his nation.

American and international newspapers’ accounts of Hawaiians’ loyalty and love for Kalākaua before he departed Hawai‘i are important because they counter the many claims that maka‘āinana generally despised him for supporting the Reciprocity Treaty, which they saw as a step toward the loss of Pearl Harbor, followed by their entire nation, to the United

States. But those who witnessed the relations between the mō'i and his people before his departure reported that the aloha shared was unmistakable:

By 10 o'clock the palace grounds were filled with natives, who brought gifts to their departing Sovereign. His Majesty stood upon the steps to receive these tokens of the affection and fealty of his subjects. Numbers of children passed along to his presence with some little offering, in most cases money. Then came the elders filing along, chanting some old Hawaiian canticle, or singing some song celebrating the King and the royal family. Each, in passing by, lightly took the King's hand and pressed it respectfully to his lips.³⁴

He therefore left Hawai'i a respected and beloved mō'i, and his documented reception in America hardly suggests he was seen as someone begging for favors or unconcerned about his people. When he arrived in San Francisco, the *Boston Daily* reported that "considerable enthusiasm prevailed" among the five thousand or so people who had gathered early in the morning and that "a grand rush was made to get a glimpse of the King." Military escorts and gun salutes fired from the wharf also greeted Kalākaua.³⁵ Shortly afterward, he was the honored guest at a military ball, which close to four thousand people attended.³⁶ According to the *Sydney Morning Herald*,

every honour that could be offered to a royal chief has been bestowed upon Kalakaua.... He is to spend a whole week in 'Frisco, and for each day there is some special honour—troops reviewed, theatres thrown open, private and public banquets—all in honour of the King of the Sandwich isles.³⁷

When Kalākaua arrived in the US capital, the world paid attention. The *Liverpool Mercury* noted that his visit "brings the Hawaiian country somewhat more prominently into

notice than usual,"³⁸ and London's *Standard* listed his arrival there among the "prominent" events of the entire week.³⁹ When Kalākaua's train arrived in Washington, DC, several hundred military officers escorted his carriage to the White House in cadence to "Hawai'i Pono'i."⁴⁰ Royal flags were displayed throughout the city, and people lined Pennsylvania Avenue or sat at windows and rooftops to see the mō'i.⁴¹ The Foreign Relations Committee was so eager to welcome him that it appropriated \$50,000 for a "suitable reception."⁴² Kalākaua met with President Ulysses S. Grant. National and international newspaper coverage suggests that the response to Kalākaua's visit was unprecedented. English newspapers reported that he had been "*feted* pretty extensively at the national capital already; invited to both New York and Philadelphia, with no end of attentions in addition to these."⁴³ President and Mrs. Grant's grand reception was attended by judges, cabinet members, foreign ministers, both houses of Congress, and officers of the military in uniform.⁴⁴ "The King remained the principal object of attraction more than an hour,"⁴⁵ and the banquet was talked about for weeks as "one of the most elegant ever given at the White House."⁴⁶

From Washington, DC, Kalākaua went to New York. In a frenzy of competition, city officials there organized royal receptions designed to outdo each other. The Board of Aldermen and Assistant Aldermen met "at length" to arrange the welcome and agreed that "Hawai'i Pono'i" would be played at every public appearance. When Windsor House received confirmation of his stay, "great excitement prevailed." In short, the city was determined to extend Kalākaua the warmest welcome possible: "Whatever the attentions he may have been shown in other cities he has visited in this country or those that may be hereafter shown him, he can never leave New York without being able to truthfully say that whatever was kingly in the city was freely offered to him." As in Washington, it was Kalākaua's nobility that fascinated his hosts: "As the great metropolis has never before entertained a reigning Sovereign, there will, very

properly, be a certain pomp and splendour displayed in the reception of the royal visitor.”⁴⁷ London’s *Pall Mall Gazette* informed its readers about his New York stay, reporting on the spectacular welcome at Booth’s Theatre on Christmas Eve. Fireworks soared through the air in the front of the theater, and the orchestra played “Hawai’i Pono’ī” when Kalākaua arrived. The “proscenium box to be occupied by the Royal party” was decorated with the colors of Hawai’i and the United States.⁴⁸ Later that night, author and friend Samuel Clemens (Mark Twain) visited Kalākaua at the Windsor. Similar arrangements greeted him when he attended a performance at Ford’s Opera House with President Grant: “The house was handsomely decorated out of compliment to King David Kalakaua and suite and the President and party, who occupied the two stage boxes.”⁴⁹

Such journeys outside of Hawai’i were a magnet, drawing the attention of the newspapers and readers to Hawai’i and its people.⁵⁰ Australia’s *Gippsland Times* reported the “foreign residents say that, even if they get no free entry for sugar, they will have gained a point in prestige by their Sovereign’s recent visit.”⁵¹ Because Kalākaua seemed so urbane and polished, Americans and other international leaders, as well as the newspapers, concluded that his kingdom must be this civilized as well.⁵² His impressive personal qualities were widely reported. According to the *Graphic*, he was “a man of fine robust physique, and has a frank, open, good-natured face, which exactly expresses his mental characteristics.”⁵³ Answering a key question for many readers of the time, the *Inter Ocean* added that he was “good-humored, and handsome, of a color not noticeably darker than that of many a ‘brunette’ white man.” His manners and overall demeanor were a constant subject: “He has about him that air of graceful ease common to gentlemen.... He has the enviable and not altogether common knack of putting all about him entirely at ease. In short, he would impress any one as a quiet gentleman, with plenty of common sense.”⁵⁴ Though he had been mō’ī for less than a year, the *Graphic* in London confidently reported that “since

his accession to the throne he has exhibited admirable executive ability, and has in every way striven to increase the influence of his government and the good of his subjects. He is an accomplished man, and in addition to general scholastic attainments possesses a sound knowledge of international law.”⁵⁵ Such praise was common and widespread. Kalākaua “has a good education,” reported a Canadian paper, “and is possessed of a vigorous will, and is determined to preserve the independence of the islands which form his kingdom.”⁵⁶ He is “well educated and popular in his little kingdom,”⁵⁷ according to the newspaper in Lowell, Massachusetts, and in Australia, the *Adelaide Advertiser* agreed that he was a “well-educated man.”⁵⁸ The *New York Times* praised Kalākaua’s efforts to curb alcohol consumption in Hawai‘i: “He had seen the evil effects of the use of intoxicating liquors, now on the increase, and desired to see it checked, that his people might become temperate, industrious, and prosperous.”⁵⁹ This report is particularly interesting, given some Hawai‘i newspapers’ and other publications’ frequent attacks on Kalākaua for alcoholism over the coming years.

Kalākaua’s first trip to the United States as mō‘ī clearly became a celebrity tour. The *Times* noted the many mailed-in requests for his autograph,⁶⁰ and newspapers sought out stories from people who had known him personally to gratify the general curiosity. Many of these accounts contrast sharply with the dismissive, often racist reports outlined in [chapter 1](#). “When we see David Kalakaua, we shall see a highly respectable gentleman,” *Frank Leslie’s Illustrated Newspaper* remarked as the mō‘ī made his way across the continent toward the capital. “There is nothing savage or romantic about him.”⁶¹ On November 28, San Francisco’s *Daily Evening Bulletin* offered the following portrait:

In his conversation and deportment all who may meet him at once recognize the culture of a gentleman. In addition to scholastic education and accomplishment he has added, by assiduous study, whilst engaged in the fulfillment of various public duties, an extensive

knowledge of international law and other requirements calculated to qualify him to exercise the sovereignty in behalf of his native country.⁶²

Kalākaua proved to be so much of a gentleman that some reporters seemed disappointed at his lack of savagery. Take, for example, this San Francisco *Chronicle* article about the national state dinner given by President Grant. After noting that Kalākaua appeared in formal evening wear, the reporter then wrote, “Shall we confess that we would have been better pleased if he had treated us to a hint ... of a royal mantle made from the golden breasts of tropical birds?”⁶³

When Kalākaua returned home in 1875, after successfully negotiating the Reciprocity Treaty, many sources describe the welcome his subjects gave him.⁶⁴ “There could not have been less than ten or twelve thousand spectators of this the grandest sight ever witnessed in Hawaii nei,” the *Sydney Morning Herald* reported. “The procession consisted first of several hundred school children, each of whom brought a bouquet of flowers and presented them to the King,” and as he “passed through the streets he was greeted everywhere with cheers from the populace, and a more enthusiastic reception was never witnessed.”⁶⁵

The 1881 Tour of the World

Kalākaua’s extraordinary welcome in America in 1874-1875, and the favorable local and international coverage of that journey, anticipated his greater, longer voyage six years later, when he became the first sovereign to circumnavigate the globe. Over ten months he would visit Japan, China, Hong Kong, Siam, Singapore, Johor, India, Egypt, Italy, England, Belgium, Germany, Austria, France, Spain, Portugal, Scotland, England again, and then the United States, stopping in New York, Philadelphia, Virginia, Washington, DC, Kentucky, Illinois, Nebraska, and California. Such an itinerary speaks not only to his adventurousness but also to the impact of modern transportation and communication.

Only a few years before, it would have been inconceivable for anyone, let alone a monarch, to travel to so many places at such speed. Kalākaua's reception during his circumnavigation of the earth was also a sign of his status and his popularity. The journey further shaped his awareness of his own identity in a global context.⁶⁶ Furthermore, though the ruler of a tiny island kingdom, his journey set a highly visible example of the possibilities of later nineteenth-century travel. Jules Verne's successful novel *Around the World in Eighty Days* had been published in 1872. But by 1885, in the *Personal Memoirs of U. S. Grant*, the former US president could document his own trip around the world.

Kalākaua's journey was not, however, a stunt. His primary goals were to study other governments in order to strengthen his own rule and Hawai'i's independence; to find an appropriate cognate population that could join with the remaining Hawaiians to repopulate his kingdom; and far more importantly for the business community, to identify sources of labor for the sugar plantations, which were now booming thanks to the Reciprocity Treaty he had helped to negotiate. In the early 1860s, Dr. H. Willis Baxley, during a visit to Hawai'i, noted the need for more sugar field workers: "The difficulty of securing certain and reliable labor has no doubt deterred others from engaging in the business."⁶⁷ On her later trip to Hawai'i, Constance Gordon-Cumming noticed the dire conditions of the sugar industry due to labor shortages: "Many lesser plantations have had cane ruined in the field, for want of hands to care for it—while others have, from the same cause, suffered serious delay in their building and other necessary work."⁶⁸ As Kalākaua set out on his trip, he therefore felt pressure from the sugar capitalists, for whom finding more workers was an economic necessity. Nor had these capitalists confined their hopes to the mō'i. As Davianna McGregor-Alegado explains, motivated by desperation and greed,

the haole mercantile and planter interests also used their influence in government to channel government

funds to subsidize the importation of the immigrant laborers. For example, from 1876 to 1887 the government paid \$1,026,212 million dollars for the importation of 39,926 Chinese, Japanese, Portuguese, Norwegian, German and South Sea Island laborers, while the planters paid only \$565,547.⁶⁹

As the business powers were exhorting Kalākaua to help them, they were also using the kingdom government as a bank to fund their own plantations. It is therefore not surprising that Kalākaua would be interested in studying other forms of government that might ease the financial burdens on his own.

The tour was a success. Given his status as the monarch of a tiny, isolated nation with a dwindling population, it is remarkable how fervently rulers and leaders of differing ranks and distinctions throughout the world embraced him. Contemporary observers like Gordon-Cumming remark that through this tour, Kalākaua “established himself and his country in the minds of those nations in a manner hitherto undreamt of.”⁷⁰ The countries that welcomed Kalākaua often repeated in their newspapers the kinds of praise he had received on his 1874 journey across America. He seemed handsome, perceptive, charming, and open to foreign relations with all other nations. [Chapter 1](#) documented how Kalākaua’s round-the-world tour became a target for attacks in Hawai‘i stretching out many years afterward. At the time, though, many accounts described how the residents of Hawai‘i responded enthusiastically to this plan and prepared for his departure.⁷¹ On January 13, foreign residents and descendants hosted a state dinner in his honor in Honolulu;⁷² on the sixteenth, maka‘āinana paid visits to the mō‘ī. At the Catholic Cathedral and Kawaiaha‘o Church, congregations offered prayers for his safe travels.⁷³ Kānaka Maoli flocked to the grounds of ‘Iolani Palace, chanting and singing their farewell to their mō‘ī.⁷⁴ On January 20, 1881, Kalākaua departed for San Francisco.

The tour began well. On January 29, Kalākaua arrived in

San Francisco aboard the *City of Sydney*. On February 1, he visited Saint Matthews Hall, a military finishing school in San Mateo, and was treated to a demonstration by the school cadets. The *Daily Evening Bulletin* reporter who accompanied him wrote that “His Majesty gave very marked and close attention to the various evolutions performed by the corps, and asked many questions as to the foundation of the school and its general management.” Kalākaua’s intense curiosity was on display and so too, apparently, was his charm. At the end of his visit, “the party drove off amid the loud cheers of the battalion and the assembled guests.”⁷⁵ On February 3, he met the governor and the legislature at the State Capitol. Fifteen-minute recesses were taken so that legislators could meet and speak with “the distinguished guest.”⁷⁶ On February 4, even though the roads were muddy from a recent storm, he insisted on visiting San Rafael—an example of his curiosity about places and people.⁷⁷ That night, the governor hosted a dinner at the Arcade Hotel for the city’s “distinguished visitor.”⁷⁸ Clearly not tired, after dinner Kalākaua asked to go to the theater. Three private boxes were reserved for his retinue.

Almost in anticipation of the countries he would visit, he was then entertained by those tied to or representing other countries in the city. The Chinese consul general hosted a dinner in his honor with the elite Chinese of the community at the Hang Fer Low restaurant. On February 5, the Ligue Nationale Francaise held a reception for him at Platt’s Hall. Prominent American individuals and organizations also held major events. Commodore R. S. Floyd and members of the Pacific Yacht Club took Kalākaua sailing and then hosted a dinner in his honor. A grand soiree musicale was held on February 7, with the city’s most prominent citizens in attendance. Organized by the Ladies of the Palace Hotel, it was “one of the grandest social events in the history of the city.”⁷⁹ As Kalākaua traveled throughout California’s towns and cities, he was welcomed enthusiastically.⁸⁰ According to a Los Angeles paper, the people seemed to be saying, “We feel assured that no potentate of Europe, nor eminent great

man of America's own soil, could have received greater and more honorable attention," and the *San Francisco Call* stated that Kalākaua deserved this because "as a worthy chief, he has won the love of a loyal people."⁸¹ California was honored to host the mō'ī, whom *Frank Leslie's Illustrated Newspaper* called a "man of intelligence and a wise ruler."⁸²

When Kalākaua left San Francisco for Japan, the next stop on his journey, stories anticipating his arrival there and elsewhere preceded him. "I hasten to inform my friends in Hong Kong that they are shortly to have conferred on them an honour greater than any they have ever had before," wrote the correspondent for the *Hong Kong Daily Press*: "They are about to have a Royal visitor; not a mere scion of royalty, nor even an heir-apparent, but a real, live, reigning monarch. King Kalakaua leaves to day by the steamer *City of Sydney* for a tour round the world."⁸³

On March 4, Kalākaua arrived in Yokohama and became the first head of state to sit down with the Japanese emperor since the nation opened its doors to trading in 1854. Richard A. Greer, Masaji Marumoto, and Donald Keene have thoroughly documented Kalākaua's travels in Japan.⁸⁴ Rebecca E. Karl further adds that when it was learned that Kalākaua would be making his way to Japan, the Meiji emperor was "eager to demonstrate" Japan's "grasp of Western-style ceremonials"⁸⁵—rather ironic, since on his previous travels, one of Kalākaua's goals had always been to demonstrate the same thing.

The British newspaper the *Alnwick Mercury* supplied its readers with the following account of this visit to Japan: "Grand theatrical performances were organized in his honour at Tokio [*sic*], and the Emperor received him at a great banquet. Perhaps a more remarkable fete was that organized by the Club of the Nobles.... The dinner given to King Kalakaua lasted six hours."⁸⁶ One striking event deserving special attention was a visit to Shintomiza Theatre—a Western-styled imperial venue for kabuki. Twenty-eight carriages conveyed the imperial officials and the Hawaiian entourage to the theater that night, where more than one

thousand lanterns, each painted with Japan's and Hawai'i's royal flags, illuminated the garden and lobby foyer. For those foreigners present, "The impression produced by this audience of wealthy Japanese was that a higher order of intelligence pervaded the company."⁸⁷ So impressed was Kalākaua with his reception there that he ordered a curtain fashioned for the Shintomiza's stage. The Kyoto-based Nishimaru & Co. produced a crimson Japanese velvet curtain with the Hawaiian royal coat of arms embroidered in gold at its center. An inscription read, "Presented to the Shintomiza Theatre by Kalakaua the First, King of Hawaii, in the second month of the year 2541 (Japanese era)."⁸⁸ Observers there and back in Hawai'i remarked on both the generosity and the strategic cleverness of the gift. "What an advertisement of that little Kingdom, in that great empire, is this drop curtain?" asked one commentator, since the Shintomiza Theatre, with its capacity of five thousand people, now served as a showcase for Kalākaua and his nation. "What feelings of interest and curiosity must be evoked; and what prestige for little Hawaii, thus promoted by the intelligent courtesy of her thoughtful and patriotic chief abroad!"⁸⁹ The gift also displayed the taste and refinement of the mō'i. The *Celestial Empire* said the curtain was the "handsomest thing of the kind that has ever been used in a Japanese Theatre."⁹⁰

This information is significant because two years before Kalākaua visited Japan, former US president Ulysses S. Grant and his wife spent more than two months there on the final stop of their round-the-world tour. Grant also went to the Shintomiza Theatre, where he watched a play telling his life story as a war hero and world leader. And Grant also presented a curtain to the company, leading the *Tokyo nichinichi shinbun* newspaper to report that "although there are a great numbers of theaters in the world, we have never heard of any which has been presented a curtain by the President [of the United States.]"⁹¹ Kalākaua was therefore copying Grant by bestowing this gift and in the process asserting the claim of Hawai'i and himself to be similar in nature to America and its distinguished visitor. Finally, because

Kalākaua, unlike Grant, was still in power, his curtain was an emblem of Japan's treaty of friendship with Hawai'i.

On March 22, 1881, Kalākaua left Japan for a brief stopover in Shanghai. On the twenty-fifth, he was greeted by the chief magistrate, dignitaries, and foreign officials. He toured the city and was lavishly entertained before leaving on the twenty-seventh and arriving in Tientsin (Tianjing) on the twenty-ninth. Foreign representatives met with Kalākaua and Viceroy Li Hungchang (Li Hongzhang), whom the *Alnwick Mercury* described as "the generalissimo of the Chinese armies, and at this moment the most important living member of the Celestial Empire."⁹² They spent three hours together,⁹³ and at a banquet hosted by the China Merchants' Steam Navigation Company in Kalākaua's honor, the viceroy thanked him for the hospitality shown to the thousands of Chinese immigrants in Hawai'i. Kalākaua's letter home to Governor John O. Dominis clearly demonstrates that the 1881 trip around the world was intended to promote Hawai'i's foreign relations:

I would ask Mr. [William] Green the Minister of Foreign Affairs, to appoint Mr. Tam King Sing Consul for Tientsen, China. He is an exceeding clever and capable Chinaman. Speaks and writes the English language perfectly and will be a very useful man to have in Tientsen. In fact he has considerable power with the Chinese officials and at present he has control of the immense Coal mines they are now developing and other public improvements in Rail Roads, and telegraphs. He is also vice President to the China Merchant Steam Navigation Company line already competing with the P.M.S.S. in the trade directly from China to San Francisco. I would send him a decoration of the same class as those above mentioned. This will give us immense weight in the Imperial Court of China.⁹⁴

Kalākaua also gave a number of photographs of himself to officials at the banquet and one of Kapi'olani to the wife of an

official.⁹⁵ Philadelphia's *North American* reported that the mō'ī was received "with great respect by the Chinese and foreigners," and the *Alnwick Mercury* stated that "the mandarins met him with every demonstration of cordiality."⁹⁶ Returning to Shanghai on April 6, the Hawaiian entourage departed for Hong Kong on the ninth, arriving on the twelfth. *The Hong Kong Government Gazette* announced that the governor, Sir John Pope Hennessy, welcomed Kalākaua on behalf of Queen Victoria.⁹⁷ After a royal reception at the Government House that evening, foreign officials, military officers, members of the council, heads of departments, and the prominent residents of Hong Kong gathered to meet him. On the following evening, Governor Hennessy hosted another event. Some three hundred guests attended: "The assemblage was a brilliant one and proved a great success, the gathering being truly cosmopolitan and representative."⁹⁸ Dancing followed dinner. The next day, the Freemasons of Hong Kong welcomed their fellow mason and the governor to brunch. Kalākaua gave a speech to great applause.

On April 27, he arrived in Siam, where he was the guest of King Rama V. (Chulalongkorn). Though the original plan had been to circle the globe incognito, when consuls and officials got word of his visits, they not only recognized his status by entertaining him royally but also informed those at his next stop of his plans. The Siamese consul in Hong Kong sent word that the Hawaiian monarch was on his way, and even before he arrived, a yacht bearing the royal flag intercepted Kalākaua. Addressing him in English, a committee of five officials dressed in white uniforms welcomed him aboard. As the yacht approached the capital, gun salutes were fired. At the palace, Kalākaua was welcomed by the royal princes; the next day, King Rama V greeted him there. Near the end of his stay, a banquet was held in his honor. Outside the palace courtyard, soldiers bearing lit torches were lined up all the way to the entrance. A band welcomed him with "Hawai'i Pono'ī."⁹⁹ The two sovereigns found shared keen interests in travel, music, scholarship, and modernity.¹⁰⁰

After Siam, Kalākaua went to Singapore, where the governor invited the executive and legislative councils, consuls, and prominent residents to dine with the mōʻī at the Istana, the gubernatorial residence and office.¹⁰¹ Calling his visit the “event of the week,” the *Straits Times Overland Journal* remarked that he had a “pleasing voice and manner, and speaks English remarkably well, without the slightest accent. His Majesty has created a most agreeable impression upon all who came in contact with him.”¹⁰² The same publication later reported that “a guard of honor of European and Sikh constables lined the approach to Johnston’s Pier” to bid Kalākaua farewell.¹⁰³

Before he could make his way to Penang (Malaysia), Moulmein (Myanmar), Rangoon (Myanmar), and Calcutta, he received an invitation from the maharajah Abu Bakar of Johor to visit him at the palace he had built for himself. They met on May 10 and were known to share several similarities. They often appeared in virtually identical Victorian military uniforms, adorned with an array of orders and decorations. Speaking of aristocracy and authority, the garb enhanced the subjects’ physiques—important assertions to make, given nineteenth-century attitudes regarding visual culture, race, politics, and imperial identity. Educated by missionaries in their formative years, both Abu Bakar, called “the Father of Modern Johor,” and Kalākaua spoke English as well as their native tongues. They also built ornate palaces for themselves, encouraged immigration, traveled widely, and sought to advance the development of their nations. Kalākaua’s visits to British-influenced states were driven by a decades-old determination to maintain Hawai‘i’s independence.¹⁰⁴ Favorable accounts of his reception at such outposts around the world aided him in his constant effort to shield Hawai‘i from the influence of such friendly but dangerous imperial powers as the United States and Great Britain.

On June 20, Kalākaua arrived at the Suez Canal, an engineering and architectural feat that attracted international praise for the ruler considered responsible for it. Well before Kalākaua’s trip, the *Hong Kong Daily Press*

reported that “the construction of the Suez Canal was an event in the history of the world,” marking “an era in the science of engineering,” and “has conferred a deathless renown on its projector and constructor, and will also make famous the name of the Khedive of Egypt.”¹⁰⁵ Given Kalākaua’s interest in technological innovation, both the canal and its “projector” attracted him, and the khedive welcomed the visit, sending a special train to convey the mō‘ī to Cairo. He toured the pyramids, and a grand state ball was given in his honor, with leading officials and residents of Cairo and Alexandria in attendance. Though far more modest, ‘Iolani Palace arose from the same impulse toward impressive architectural memorials, both ancient and modern.

On July 1, military officials welcomed Kalākaua into Naples, Italy; the next day he met the pope in Rome, which he toured for two more days. He then left for London, where on July 11 he met Queen Victoria. He later recalled that “she asked particularly where I learnt English as my accent was perfect.”¹⁰⁶ The enthusiasm of his hosts and his own intelligence, curiosity, and urbanity were all noted by the newspapers that covered this leg of his journey and broadcast it around the world. “Since the arrival of King Kalakaua in London he has met with the most cordial hospitality from the Queen downwards,” reported Australia’s *Wallaroo Times*. “The King is staying at Claridge’s Hotel, and every day since his arrival he has been visited by many members of Parliament, noblemen and others.”¹⁰⁷ London’s *Graphic* observed that “the King has been exceedingly busy since his arrival in London, inspecting the various sights of the metropolis, and has been a frequent guest at social garden parties and ‘evenings.’” Kalākaua had achieved his principal aim of presenting himself and his nation as highly civilized. The paper described him as an “educated sovereign, with all the paraphernalia of an European Constitution, including a Parliament of two Houses, where the debates are carried on both in Hawaiian and English,” whose “seven years of a peaceful and prosperous reign have

shown that the confidence of the Hawaiian Deputies was certainly not misplaced.”¹⁰⁸ Kalākaua clearly had England’s attention and respect. He was the guest of honor at garden parties hosted by the archbishop of Canterbury and by the Prince and Princess of Wales. Attended by royalty and London’s elite, the latter event led the *Morning Post* to devote four columns to listing the guests’ names.¹⁰⁹ The *Hampshire Telegraph* noted that at the Prince and Princess of Wales’ ball at Marlborough House, Kalākaua joined in on the opening dance, a quadrille.¹¹⁰ His intellectual abilities were also acknowledged. On the thirteenth, the Earl and Countess Spencer hosted Kalākaua at a conversazione to discuss art, literature, and science at the South Kensington Museum.

When he visited other English sites, two or more newspapers reported on his progress. Readers were clearly interested in who he met, dined with, and visited and what he did at each place. The *Hastings & St. Leonard’s Observer* account of his time there filled an entire page—five densely packed columns—and the details suggest how mutually beneficial these encounters could be. The day began with the townspeople exuberantly preparing for Kalākaua’s arrival. When the pier master announced the mōī’s impending stopover, the news “spread very rapidly,” and “bunting was run up” on the exterior of the major buildings. Flags of different nations decorated the main streets, windows, and homes. When the people learned he would pass through Saint Leonard’s toward the pier, “a large number of persons lined the parade in expectancy of having a glance.” At the pier itself, “the entrances ... were entirely blocked by crowds of eager sightseers.” Kalākaua demonstrated his curiosity, intelligence, and graciousness through his many questions about the town’s sites and his compliments on its beauty. And if Kalākaua’s visit to Hastings somehow validated its charm, the people happily returned the favor by praising the visiting monarch and his nation. The *Hastings & St. Leonard’s Observer* quoted from municipal magistrates’ tributes to Kalākaua, which congratulated him “upon the advance made

in your kingdom since your Majesty's ascension to the throne, and on the consequent benefits which have resulted to your subjects."¹¹¹ The mayor observed that "he had great pleasure in presenting the address to his Majesty, and it was an especial pleasure when they remembered that the King was at the head of a country which had so much improved under His Majesty's reign, and where His Majesty so desired to carry out a rule that would benefit the country still more." The mayor also noted that "such addresses had been given to emperors and kings of other nations" as well. After a fine luncheon, a carriage took the mō'i and the mayor to meet his train. The town had heard of the departure because "a large number of people had assembled both in and outside of the station, and they received his Majesty with loud acclamation."¹¹² The newspaper also reported that as the crowd "saw the meeting of the two kings—that fraternising of civic and royal majesty—it raised a shout. Kalakaua took off his white gossamer and bowed as only he can bow."

Back in London, he was again received by the Prince and Princess of Wales. He thanked them for the magnificent hospitality England had extended to him; Queen Victoria responded by bestowing the Knight of the Grand Cross of Saint Michael and Saint George upon him. The *Sheffield Daily Telegraph* summed up the general assessment of the press: "King Kalakaua certainly impressed the British public as an affable monarch of a free and open disposition."¹¹³

After arriving in Belgium, Kalākaua met with King Leopold II and toured Brussels for two days.¹¹⁴ In Berlin he met with Prince Wilhelm and then headed to Vienna, where the *Standard* reported that Kalākaua was "the observed of all observers.... An immense crowd of curious sightseers assembled at the station," greeting him with "enthusiastic cheers," and "the streets, from the railway station to the hotel where his Majesty alighted, were crowded by spectators, who cheered continuously as the King passed."¹¹⁵ The *Graphic* reported that he was "most enthusiastically received,"¹¹⁶ and the *Standard* quoted the local newspaper *Soir*, which described him as "intelligent and affable. He

speaks English well.”¹¹⁷ In fact, according to Niklaus Schweizer, “Today he is still remembered in Berlin and Vienna.”¹¹⁸

The mōʻī then went to France. The San Francisco *Daily Evening Bulletin* published a key interview conducted during his stay in Paris. When asked about the true purpose of the world tour, since several newspapers claimed he was trying to sell his country, his reply led the reporter to declare that “I have the highest authority for stating that, far from King Kalākaua wishing to cede his kingdom to anybody, one of the chief objects of his voyage is to find some Power which would be willing to guarantee its complete independence.”¹¹⁹

As in every country he visited, reporters in Portugal and Spain were waiting for a glimpse of the Hawaiian mōʻī. They expected a “savage”; what they got was the opposite, and they reported that. On August 19, Kalākaua arrived at 6:00 a.m. in Lisbon. Even so, a band played “Hawaiʻi Ponoʻī” as guards of honor and a squadron escorted him to the Hotel Braganza, where a state reception and the Portuguese press awaited him.¹²⁰ If, as Anne Maxwell explains, accounts of Kalākaua’s trips present him as a “symbol” of his nation, no article confirms the mōʻī’s success in attracting press attention as “a form of publicity” to make a “favorable impression among western audiences” more fully than Eduardo Mayone Dias’ account of Kalākaua’s time in Portugal.¹²¹ According to Dias, the Portuguese already knew Kalākaua “was educated in the European fashion, made several trips abroad and visited the United States as a plenipotentiary” and had “completed important treaties with the American Republic.”¹²² Dias went on to report that “King Kalākaua’s serious administration has elevated the country to great prosperity and has won him great favor,” and “his behavior as King can serve as an example to many kings of the old royalist Europe.” After a personal interview, Dias wrote that Kalākaua was “intelligent, educated and extremely polite. He is a good conversationalist and holds his own in society.” His appearance was also impressive, if not what the curious were hoping for. Dias describes Kalākaua as a

“handsome man, tall, strong, slightly ‘*café au lait*’ hued. He dresses well in the European fashion, greatly disappointing the Lisbon population, who expected to see him in a loincloth and a headdress, like some savage chieftain.” In his account of another public event, Dias actually turns the mirror around:

Two or three thousand openmouthed persons dogged his every footstep. When he sat down, more than four thousand milled around his chair gaping at him with perfectly imbecilic and primitive astonishment.... Anyone who witnessed this would find it difficult to decide who was more uncivilized: he or we.^{[123](#)}

In an action similar to Queen Victoria’s, the king of Portugal bestowed the Grand Cross of the Order Vila Vicosa upon Kalākaua.^{[124](#)}

After a short time in Spain, France, and England again, the “illustrious visitor,” or “visitor of distinction,” arrived in Scotland on September 7. Crowds of people, city officials, princes, princesses, and other dignitaries received their Hawaiian visitor as belonging to “one of the highest families in the islands.” Cake and wine receptions, dinners, banquets, Freemason gatherings, royal carriage tours, special train rides, and tree-planting ceremonies where “a number of people loitered about the gardens in the hope that they might see the illustrious stranger” were only some of Kalākaua’s activities in Edinburgh.^{[125](#)} The published accounts are often strikingly similar to those in the Hawaiian-language newspapers about his tour of his own nation ([see chapter 3](#)). People gathered in enormous crowds, cheered, applauded, lifted their hats, and presented bouquets. They decorated arches with evergreens, heather, ferns, and palms topped with phrases such as “Long Live King Kalakaua!” They laid out crimson cloths for him to walk upon and welcomed him with choruses of “Aloha!” Bands and pipers struck up tunes, and atop several buildings, the Hawaiian flag flew next to Scotland’s own standard. The newspapers reported that

Kalākaua was fully worthy of the public praise:

His manner and deportment are, it is said, those of a thoroughly well-bred gentleman. He is very affable, while retaining the natural dignity befitting his position. Possessed of remarkable conversational powers, he expresses himself well in English with a slight foreign accent. He is acute in his criticisms, which manifest culture and originality of thought, and when speaking of his travels shows that he is keen-sighted, and has received impressions which are not likely to be lost in furthering the comfort and happiness of the people over whom it is his lot to rule.¹²⁶

Kalākaua then made his way south to Liverpool. The king of Sweden and Norway happened to be there and bestowed the Order of the Holy Cross of Wasa upon the Hawaiian mōī.¹²⁷ Kalākaua went sightseeing, and on September 12, he attended a banquet as the guest of Mayor Forwood at the town hall, where a “large and distinguished party” had gathered.¹²⁸

The next day he departed Liverpool on board the steamer *Celtic*, which raised the Hawaiian flag. The captain offered him his quarters to New York,¹²⁹ and the London’s *Standard* informed readers that “special accommodation was made for the King, a tastefully fitted up room on the spar deck amidships being reserved for him as a retiring room, and his sleeping apartment being one of the principal saloon state-rooms, which was richly decorated.”¹³⁰ Because he had visited the United States previously, his schedule, always swift, moved even faster. On September 23, Kalākaua arrived in New York and quickly visited Fire Island and Coney Island. A guest at the Hotel Brunswick and Manhattan Beach Hotel, he departed on the twenty-sixth for Philadelphia, and on the twenty-eighth, he accepted an invitation from the secretary of the navy to visit Yorktown and Fort Monroe in Virginia. While there he also stopped at Hampton Normal and Industrial Institute and was honored at a reception at

Virginia Hall.¹³¹ On October 2, Kalākaua passed through Washington, DC, and got all the way to Cincinnati by the third. Stopping in Kentucky to buy fine horses, he was in Chicago on the fifth. Despite the haste, newspapers still tried to offer profiles of the visitor. In Chicago, the *Standard* was there to report that “King Kalakaua is described as an intelligent and wide-awake man, thoroughly devoted to the interests of his countrymen and anxious to lift his people up.”¹³² Heading through Nebraska, where Kalākaua attended another reception in Cortland, he was in San Francisco on October 13. He had left there for Asia on February 21 of that year and had therefore officially completed his tour around the world.

He met with Claus Spreckels, the California and Hawai‘i sugar industrialist, and was lavishly entertained by the people of San Francisco once more. But soon he was off again, and on October 29, 1881, he returned to Honolulu. Robert von Oelhoffen, a member of the king’s entourage, wrote this account of Kalākaua’s reception, published in the *Alnwick Mercury*:

Thousands of faces gazed eagerly at our craft, and strained their eyes to detect the King and suite amongst so many passengers, and as the steamer passed dock after dock this living, moving, swelling ocean of humanity swept on and on.... As we stepped ashore twenty thousand voices shouted their welcome. People lined both sides of the street for two miles; garlands, ferns, and wreaths of flowers adorned every male and female. The streets were thickly covered with greens and shrubs, flags were hoisted, and every window was graced with the Hawaiian flag, all church bells ringing at once.¹³³

Other international papers testified to the intensity of Hawaiians’ welcome of their mō‘ī. The *New York Times* reprinted a report from the *London Standard*. Upon arriving at ‘Iolani Palace, “His Majesty kissed the Queen, then his sister, and tears of joy streamed down her royal cheeks—a

sincerer, truer, heartier welcome cannot be imagined. These Hawaiians are a tender-hearted, loving people, and vie with each other in their love for one who so richly deserves it as their King Kalakaua I.”¹³⁴

Despite the dismissive remarks of his enemies and later historians, the importance of this circumnavigation of the globe, internationally and domestically, cannot be overstated. Isobel Field wrote that Kalākaua returned to Hawai‘i having surveyed the world’s peoples, cultures, and governments. He had seen how other monarchs reigned, and he was now certainly more familiar with “the etiquette of royalty, the details of court procedure, the number of officials and equerries that should attend him, their duties and what uniforms they should wear”—things he could not learn in the United States. But as Field also remarks, in addition to bringing home “new ideas for the benefit of his country,”¹³⁵ the mō‘ī also fostered new ideas about himself around the world. Some papers applauded the uniqueness of his achievement, his reception in other countries, and his personal nature. In 1909, Australia’s *Clarence and Richmond Examiner* noted, “Kalakaua was the only King to his time who had ever toured the globe, and no King has since emulated him. Kalakaua visited nearly every crowned head in the world and was decorated by each. He was a tall man, fine featured, proud and dignified.”¹³⁶ Others stressed his accessibility and his pragmatic approach. Melbourne’s *Argus* printed this account by another fellow passenger on the *Australia*, the ship that took Kalākaua back to Hawai‘i. According to this eyewitness, Kalākaua at an early age “became also a captain in the King’s Guard, and was looked upon by every one as a smart, intelligent Prince, earning as he did his own living, which Princes as a rule do not.” This common touch was still present: “Kalakaua’s English is as pure as anyone’s, and in his general bearing and demeanour to us poor plebian mortals he is in pleasing contrast to many mighty monarchs I have read of.”¹³⁷ “He speaks several European languages,” wrote the *Liverpool Mercury*, “almost with the accent of the natives of the respective countries, and exhibits an

acquaintance with the history of Europe which would do credit to a statesman.”¹³⁸ As Stacy L. Kamehiro explains, this kind of publicity turned his tour into a form of resistance against the slanderous, trivializing, condescending, and judgmental accounts of his rule and his travels produced by Hawai‘i’s white oligarchy and by international commentators who found the very idea of a Pacific Island country ridiculous. His resistance also changed people’s notions of Hawai‘i itself. Positive international accounts “represented Kalākaua as a popular, educated, and capable ruler; Honolulu as an ordered, clean cosmopolitan city with modern technologies, architecture, and civic institutions; and ... Hawaiian society as civilized and productive.”¹³⁹ As a host of Hawaiian, American, and international reports bear out, in roughly ten months, Kalākaua went around the world as a highly successful ambassador for his kingdom and himself.

Kalākaua’s 1883 Coronation

After having kings, queens, emperors, princes, princesses, judges, magistrates, admirals, captains, governors, mayors, and almost everyone he encountered greet him with royal receptions, balls, dinners, and luncheons or tours of cities, wineries, factories, military schools, and other points of interest, forcing him at times to ask if he could simply remain in his hotel to rest, Kalākaua knew he had gained the attention and interest of international officials and populations. Preparations for his long-delayed coronation ceremony, eventually held on February 12, 1883, began almost immediately after his return to Hawai‘i. Among many other things, he and his devoted subjects would celebrate the respect of the community of nations, cemented by their world-traveling monarch. This weeklong event, part of Kalākaua’s larger plan to “forge and assert a more constructive view” of himself, his government, his people, and the nation for local, national, and international audiences, deliberately brought together indigenous and Western forms of ceremony and performance.¹⁴⁰ Well before

globalization became an issue, he knew that he needed to constantly rebut the caricatures and the easy dismissals of himself as the King of the Cannibal Islands circulating through the media of dominant powers. As his world tour had shown, he was very adept at blending his attractive aspects as an indigenous monarch with his qualities as a modern, well-informed, and gracious citizen of the world.

Held in his capital city, the coronation would perform this union for everyone to witness, admire, report on, and remember. Although his domestic enemies tried to sabotage the planning and circulated accounts of so-called Hawaiian barbarity intended to damage his reputation, a survey of international newspapers suggests that Kalākaua achieved what he set out to do. Even before the event, the *New York Times* was telling the world that “the whole Hawaiian population appears to be united as one man to do honor to King Kalakaua. The King’s Ministers recently made a tour of Oahu and were very enthusiastically received by the people.”¹⁴¹ England’s *Evening News* reprinted this account for its readers.¹⁴² A dozen British newspapers published reports on the coronation itself and in some cases even refuted the negative portrayals appearing in other papers.¹⁴³ “About seven thousand persons witnessed the ceremony, which passed off without interruption or disturbance,” the *Times* of London claimed, concluding that “the event fully establishes the general popularity of the King in the islands. The stories that had gone abroad about probable disturbances were newspaper hoaxes invented here. Premier Gibson is congratulated by all parties on the perfect success of the Coronation, which he planned.”¹⁴⁴ No doubt Gibson had something to do with this account; the important thing, however, was that by publishing it, the paper shaped a favorable public opinion about this tiny kingdom and its ruler.

Other papers did as well. The *Liverpool Mercury* noted that “letters from Honolulu give very glowing accounts of the ceremony which was observed for the coronation of King Kalakaua.”¹⁴⁵ In addition to publishing impressive images of

the event, the *Illustrated London News* provided detailed descriptions. The reporter admired the recently completed 'Iolani Palace, "a stately edifice with arcades supported by Corinthian pillars." In front of it stood the coronation "Grand Stand," while "in the centre of the enclosed space was a domed pavilion, of octagonal shape, open at the sides, and decorated with heraldic shields in colours, and with small flags of different nations."¹⁴⁶ At one end of this pavilion "stood two thrones for the King and Queen, which had been ordered of an upholsterer of Boston."¹⁴⁷ In Texas, the *Galveston Daily News* celebrated the coronation, providing exactly the kind of coverage the mō'ī sought by calling it proof of Kalākaua's appeal and offering the following portrait:

He is a thoroughbred Hawaiian, and is a fine specimen of his race. He is tall, broad-shouldered and muscular. His complexion has a warm, olive hue, and his features express great humor. In his youth he received a good education, and years of experience and travel have given him a diplomatic polish well worthy of a European court. He speaks English with a faultless accuracy, in a musical tone of voice and with courteous grace of gesture.¹⁴⁸

These international accounts of the ceremonies, trappings, attendance, and Kalākaua himself call into question his opponents' claims that the coronation was a waste of money and a failure. For the would-be oligarchy, anything that legitimated Kalākaua was unwelcome because its members believed not only that he was unfit to rule but that the monarchy itself was pointless, anachronistic, and wasteful. The America-focused planters and businessmen felt that a system they controlled would of course be preferable, and even necessary, and they advertised this position widely. Though it gets the size of the different factions utterly wrong—a sign, perhaps, of how successfully the oligarchy misrepresented its numbers—the *St. Louis Globe* account of

the coronation accurately represents the clash of opinions: “It must be acknowledged that there is a difference of opinion about it, one party looking upon the coronation as necessary and justifiable, the other—by far the largest and most influential—as a most uncalled for and absurd affair, and a sinful expenditure of money. The foreigners, of whom a large majority are Americans, feel extremely sore.” But the same article reported that as for the crowd attending the coronation, “at 10:30 it moved toward the King’s palace, and in a short space of time about 8,000 people were within the palace gate. The invited guests, over 4,000 in number, were seated; the other spectators were obliged to stand.”¹⁴⁹ The *Globe* also contradicts the claims that America and international nations failed to attend the coronation because they did not consider Kalākaua to be a true mō‘ī. English, French, and two Russian war vessels are specifically mentioned as being in port, and the Japanese embassy was in attendance.¹⁵⁰

As for the claim that Hawaiians did not support the coronation ceremony, while it is true that some of the Kamehameha family stayed away and that some Hawaiian reform politicians were very concerned about the expenses, Isobel Field states in her account that maka‘āinana were there in “eager groups, dressed in their best, men and women all walking barefoot and carrying their shoes.” Field also mentions the beautiful holokū, the lei-adorned hats, and the sweet-smelling lei that just about every Hawaiian wore to the ceremony.¹⁵¹ Clearly, excited and adorned Hawaiians were there to celebrate Kalākaua. Field’s account of the coronation ball also suggests how Kalākaua displayed his progressive and modern nature. When she and the other guests entered the ballroom in ‘Iolani Palace, they were greeted by electric lighting. “None of us had ever seen it before,” she recalls, “and the effect after years of kerosene lamps and gas was magical.” That this little kingdom in the middle of the Pacific Ocean would be technologically more advanced than those Western nations Kalākaua was supposedly trying to emulate certainly gave the lie to any

sense of Hawai'i as a primitive place led by an ignorant and barbaric chief. Field's account of how the rulers received their guests demonstrates that many were highly impressed, even awed, by the occasion. People moved anxiously down the reception line; eventually, they were introduced to Kalākaua and Kapi'olani and his sisters: Likelike and heir to the throne Lili'uokalani. The guests' nervousness indicates they considered the Kalākaua 'ohana to be impressive and significant figures. "It was amusing to see [the guests'] air of relief when they had finished and were free to back away, join the earlier comers and watch and criticize in their turn," Field observes, and her own encounter suggests that she herself was highly impressed: "King Kalakaua was a strikingly fine-looking young man, in a resplendent uniform of white and gold, which his good figure set off to advantage."¹⁵²

Even at a distance, important people took notice. After documenting how Kalākaua's coronation confirmed his reputation with international figures as a substantial and civilized monarch, Niklaus Schweizer writes that Czar Alexander III of Russia invited the mō'i to send a special envoy to Moscow and that Colonel 'Iaukea went.¹⁵³ If the 1881 journey introduced Kalākaua to the world, at least in some quarters, his 1883 coronation confirmed him as a figure of continuing interest.

Foreign Impressions of Kalākaua—Personal Traits and the State of the Lāhui

Various accounts by visitors and acquaintances of Kalākaua mention the attacks on his character only to refute them. Isobel Field recorded the following anecdote about the mō'i's alleged drunkenness. Later in the evening at the coronation ball, she met Alice, Katherine, and Rose McKee, daughters of the famous James McKee, the former ship captain, wealthy sugar planter, and owner of 'Ulupalakua Ranch on Maui. A close friend of Kalākaua's, he and his family were popular in the royal circle. When Field mentioned the rumors about the

mōʻī's drinking, the daughters corrected her: "'Of course he drinks,' said Kitty, 'but so does every man I know. You see, the Russian and American officers are always trying to 'drink him under the table,' as they call it, only they can't do it. They get drunk and Kalakaua keeps his head.'" ¹⁵⁴ These comments are significant because the frequent claims that Kalākaua was always intoxicated, and therefore reckless, were part of the larger accusation that he was incompetent to rule. This charge had been directed at virtually every Hawaiian mōʻī in the nineteenth century. Paul Wood remarks that the first American Board of Commissioners for Foreign Missions missionaries "branded" Liholiho Kamehameha II a "drunkard" because they were so "fixated on temperance that they would call any Hawaiian farmer sleeping next to his taro patch a drunkard." Though Liholiho drank, "as did most of the aliʻi," at least according to Samuel M. Kamakau, he was "never 'under the influence.'" ¹⁵⁵ Subsequently, Kamehameha IV's drinking in response to the sudden death of his son, Prince Albert, may in fact have contributed to his own early death, but his brother, Lot Kapuāiwa Kamehameha V, was supposedly addicted to drink as a young man; William C. Lunalilo was called "Whiskey Bill" by his detractors; and the nickname "Merrie Monarch" was originally a reference to Kalākaua's supposed state of mind after a few drinks. Kitty McKee, however, identified the source of Field's information—"the Missionaries have made a story of it" ¹⁵⁶—and although obviously no friend of Kalākaua or the monarchy, Sanford B. Dole grudgingly acknowledged that the mōʻī "was possessed of a great deal of polish, good manners, and natural dignity. He had a fine presence, was tall and well-built, and on the whole was temperate in the use of liquor. A good host, genial and courteous, he was perhaps at his best in receiving official guests from other countries." ¹⁵⁷ The McKee sisters offered Field a similar explanation for the rumor that the mōʻī's father was a "Negro barber": "That's another Missionary yarn." ¹⁵⁸

Another visitor to Hawaiʻi, Sophia Cracroft, concluded that the gossip directed against Kalākaua arose from the vulgarity

and inferiority of his attackers: “The Missionaries do not appear to be of a class calculated to command respect, except for their piety; and considering that the upper class of Hawaiians are essentially polished gentlemen, it seems a pity the Missionaries are not of a higher stamp.”¹⁵⁹ Cracroft further observes that the missionaries “have had temptations and have not always withstood them.” No longer servants of God, they and their heirs “have been keeping shops, engaging in mercantile pursuits, and even extensively lend money to the natives at interest rates which we should consider enormous—25% *per month*, 25¢ upon every dollar lent for a month.”¹⁶⁰ From this perspective, the business community’s antagonism to the mō‘ī arose from a combination of ignorance, greed, and rage, born from a keen and accurate sense of personal inferiority. For at least two centuries, these have, of course, been the most common stereotypes about Americans. Small wonder, then, that the crimes Kalākaua’s attackers accused him of—greed, theft, and self-aggrandizement—were the ones they were most familiar with themselves or that their own preoccupation with money made them blind to seeing how Kalākaua’s expenditures on his world tour or coronation could be investments in the future of the nation.

While his domestic enemies denied, or could not even see, the values Kalākaua embraced and would not admit that he might be their superior in anything, others did notice these values and claimed they directly benefited the kingdom. John Cameron, an American visitor to the islands in 1885, later wrote that “a more thorough gentleman than Kalakaua would be hard to find: easy to approach and difficult to leave; unfailingly genial; kind to high and low alike; beloved by his subjects.”¹⁶¹ Other commentators often connected his intellectual and artistic nature to the fame and prosperity of his nation. A review of *The Legends and Myths of Hawaii*, published in 1888, remarks that “readers of the *Nation* will not need to be reminded that King Kalakaua is a writer of good and fluent English. He is quite competent, as far as literary handling is implied, to produce this interesting

collection of Polynesian stories.”¹⁶² And many years later, Leo Paltrow would note that “Kalakaua himself was somewhat literary in his tastes. He read a great deal and composed some poems in the Hawaiian tongue. He wrote the words of *Hawaii Pono*, the Hawaiian national anthem. This piece of music is, in my opinion, one of the most beautiful and inspiring national anthems in the world.”¹⁶³ The actual state of the kingdom under his rule and his own personal fortunes were, as we have seen, also matters for debate, and he himself contributed to the discussion. When preparing to depart for the Paris exposition in 1889, Kalākaua gave an interview to the *New York Times* in which informant John Waterhouse Jr. says that “stories regarding the low state of the King’s finances are extremely exaggerated”: “‘King Kalakaua intends to start for the Paris Exposition in a few weeks,’ said he. ‘He possessed money enough to sail some weeks ago, but he decided to wait a few months and take a larger amount with him.’ ... The islands were never in better shape than to-day.”¹⁶⁴ The king never went on that trip, however. Reverend Herbert H. Gowen agreed, claiming that the mō‘ī “lived during the most prosperous period of Hawaiian history, and he may be considered a ruler who has advanced the freedom and well-being of his people to a very large extent.”¹⁶⁵ Gowen notes that on the occasion of the mō‘ī’s death, the Privy Council said the same thing: “The reign of our departed King was memorable as an era of remarkable and increasing prosperity. In the seventeen years of his reign, now closed, this nation has made rapid strides in its material industries, education, and the arts of civilization.” The range of achievements is important. While business interests clearly benefited from the expansion of “material industries,” other interests valued the various additional areas of progress. Gowen himself was on board the USS *Charleston* when it arrived in Honolulu on January 29, 1891, with the body of the mō‘ī. He concludes his account of that day by remarking that “the general grief left in men’s minds was only the memory of the gracious gentleman whose kindness and dignity had been always at the service of his

country, and whom no stranger could meet but to feel in the presence of a true King.” Performed with grace, that service had been successful on all fronts: “There was no one too exalted to do Kalakaua reverence, and the nation saw how much she owed to the personal exertions of the King for all her commercial and political prosperity.”¹⁶⁶

The Trip to California and Untimely Death, 1891

Newspapers across the United States covered Kalākaua’s final trip to America in 1890–1891. On December 4, 1890, he arrived in San Francisco aboard the USS *Charleston*, captained by Admiral George W. Brown. Although Brown had invited him to California to rest and recuperate from illness, he again became the center of attention and activity. Royal salutes, a battalion of the US cavalry, the governor, the mayor, prominent citizens, and crowds of people welcomed him at the wharf. From there, a carriage took him to the Palace Hotel,¹⁶⁷ where the next day he entertained guests, including the former governor and a visiting congressional committee. A few weeks later, Kalākaua took the train to Los Angeles, where on December 28, the *Morning Oregonian* reported that the mayor, “several prominent citizens,” and a crowd of five hundred people welcomed him at the depot, where “the freedom of the city was extended.”¹⁶⁸ Though his condition had improved, he then grew so ill that on January 19, 1891, London’s *Evening News* reported that “Mr. Blaine and Mr. Tracy have sent an official letter placing the United States war vessel *Charleston* at the King’s disposal for his voyage home.” As always, though, Kalākaua’s travels were tied to his nation’s business: “His Majesty will not leave until Mr. Blaine definitely assures him that measures have been taken in Congress arranging for the bringing forward of the proposed treaty.”¹⁶⁹

* * *

This detail speaks to Kalākaua’s determination to rule even

after the Reform Party members had seriously curtailed his powers through the Bayonet Constitution and continued their efforts to render him irrelevant through annexation to the United States. Believing that a Hawaiian monarchy was far better for his people than annexation,¹⁷⁰ Kalākaua went to California in 1890 and planned to head to Washington, DC, for the same reason he had in 1874—to resolve a trade issue that would primarily benefit the most affluent in his nation. Lili'uokalani writes that the “principal motive” for his trip was to discuss with Carter, Hawai'i's minister in Washington, the best strategy for dealing with the recently passed McKinley Tariff Bill, which would be “dangerous” and “destructive” to the businessmen in Hawai'i. Though his health was “failing,” Lili'uokalani writes that he went “cheerfully and patiently to work for the cause of those who had been and were his enemies. He sacrificed himself in the interests of the very people who had done him so much wrong, and given him such constant suffering.” For Lili'uokalani, this showed just how devoted her brother was to all of his subjects: “With an ever-forgiving heart he forgot his own sorrows, set aside all feelings of animosity, and to the last breath of his life he did all that lay in his power for those who had abused and injured him.”¹⁷¹

Niklaus Schweizer sums up the mō'i's success in representing himself and his nation to others this way: “The obstacles the king had to overcome were many and formidable and his position was difficult, but when he died, Hawai'i enjoyed a measure of good will and friendship around the world which was unprecedented.”¹⁷² Neither Kalākaua nor Hawaiians simply surrendered their constitutional rights and civil liberties to those Davianna McGregor-Alegado calls the “missionary-planter-business elite.”¹⁷³ While most positive studies of Kalākaua focus on the resurgence of the hula, mele, and other Hawaiian traditions, more should be said about his courage, determination, and ingenuity in sustaining the nation's independence in the face of the economic control and the animosity of his opposition. People around the world

recognized these talents, which were so effective that even a hostile biographer like Eugene Burns admits that Kalākaua “tried to hold off the inevitable as best he could and lead his people back.”¹⁷⁴ He also faced the paradox that his enemies flourished so greatly during his reign that the Hawaiian League members were able to fill their warehouses with rifles and then force him to sign the 1887 constitution because of their increased desire for the power to shape the government for their own gain.¹⁷⁵ Indeed, in the Blount Report of 1893, Dr. Georges Phillipe Trousseau testified that during Kalākaua’s reign “the prosperity of the islands came to its height. The reciprocity treaty, the higher price of sugar, enriched everyone.”¹⁷⁶

As many writers have noted, when the McKinley Tariff threatened the business interests’ preferential access to the American market, overthrowing the monarchy and becoming part of the United States became a strategy for maintaining privilege and governing domestic affairs. Lili’uokalani puts it this way:

For years, the “missionary party” had, by means of controlling the cabinets appointed by the king, kept itself in power. Its leaders were constantly intriguing to make the ministry their tool, or to have in its organization a power for carrying out their own special plans, and securing their own personal benefit.¹⁷⁷

Similar plots had been hatched before Kalākaua became mōʻī. Following the death of Kamehameha IV in 1863, US minister in Hawai‘i James McBride conspired with US Secretary of State William H. Seward to put Victoria Kamāmalu on the throne, rather than Lot Kapuāiwa, because of her fondness for America. McBride also promised that he could arrange for Americans to occupy seats in the Hawaiian legislature: “All that would be required would be the presence of two good American men-of-war in the harbor, the moral effect of which would be sufficient to prevent the existing government party from committing an overt act.”¹⁷⁸ This is gunboat diplomacy,

and a photograph taken in 1887 from the roof of 'Iolani Palace of warships in the harbor suggests such intimidation was always present. In her mele, "Aia i Honolulu, kuu Pohaku," Luka Ke'elikōlani describes the rift between the missionary party and her brother Lot Kapuāiwa, Kamehameha V, referring directly to the "deceit of the enemies of the King and their attempt to thwart the plans of the King."¹⁷⁹ Given this situation, the constant claims that Kalākaua was an irresponsible spendthrift should be considered in terms of motive. (Davianna McGregor-Alegado presents the most detailed discussion of this point.¹⁸⁰) Furthermore, it should be acknowledged that his efforts to retain his throne and relevance after the Bayonet Constitution are some of his most admirable activities. "In a sense," Niklaus Schweizer writes, "those final years proved to be his finest because he persevered with charm and determination in an increasingly hostile atmosphere."¹⁸¹ In the face of increasing American influence, Kalākaua displayed a remarkable degree of resilience, recognized by his people and others around the world.

* * *

When he became ill in mid-January, hundreds of American and international newspapers updated readers on his condition in their morning, afternoon, and evening editions. Despite his political troubles, he was still interesting and popular around the world. Kalākaua died on January 20, 1891, at the Palace Hotel in San Francisco. More than a dozen British papers announced his passing.¹⁸² America's and the world's newspapers also reported on his funeral services in San Francisco, on the arrival of the USS *Charleston* with his body in Hawai'i, on the people's response to the discovery of their mō'i's death, and on his second funeral, weeks later in Honolulu. In London, the *Graphic* reported how after the funeral at Trinity Episcopal Church in San Francisco, "numerously attended by naval officers, diplomats, and various officials, the metal casket containing

the king's remains was escorted by soldiers, militia, and members of the Masonic bodies and civic societies to the dock, where it was formally received by Admiral Brown."¹⁸³ The transfer of the body to the USS *Charleston* was "marked with the highest military honors," according to the *Manchester Times*.¹⁸⁴

While news of Kalākaua's death immediately appeared in American and international newspapers on January 21, thanks to cross-country and trans-Atlantic cables, the first notice Hawai'i received was the flag at half-mast when the USS *Charleston* appeared off Lē'ahi (Diamond Head) on January 29. As London's *Daily News* noted, "The workmen were busily engaged preparing a welcome for King Kalakaua, who was expected to return in improved health."¹⁸⁵ Arches and beautiful decorations had been prepared for his arrival by subjects of all ethnicities and nationalities. Imagine, then, the shock. England's *Evening Telegraph* describes "an enormous crowd, including a thousand native women, gathered upon the wharves, wailing and weeping as the *Charleston* came to anchor in the Hawaiian port."¹⁸⁶ The *Huddersfield Daily* reported that "the most elaborate public mourning was observed, business was stopped, and every outward expression of distress displayed."¹⁸⁷ *Telegraph* readers learned that "the procession moved to the Palace through the streets, which were packed with people, while men and women wept loudly." Newspapers also described the wailing of the queen upon learning of her husband's death. As his coffin approached 'Iolani Palace, Kapi'olani, standing on the second-story balcony, was prevented from throwing herself to the landing below.¹⁸⁸ As for the funeral and interment, Denver's *Rocky Mountain News* called the service the "most imposing ever witnessed in the South seas," adding that "the hearts of Hawaiians have throbbed with grief at the loss of their beloved monarch. Honolulu has presented a scene of mourning amounting almost to desolation."¹⁸⁹

Newspapers throughout the world responded to Kalākaua's passing by offering the same praise,

commendation, and even adulation they had often shown him in life. In Scotland, the *Glasgow Herald* reported that “after receiving an excellent education at the Royal School, and from private foreign tutors ... he entered one of the Government offices, where he was distinguished by that diligence and intelligence which he afterwards more fully exhibited as a ruler.”¹⁹⁰ In Indiana, the *Logansport Pharos* called him “a large hearted man of genial disposition, well known among the people of the United States.”¹⁹¹ And the *Los Angeles Herald*, in a lengthy tribute, remarked that “Hawaii has lost a wise and good sovereign, under whose beneficent rule the people of Hawaii have prospered, and whose efforts have been so constantly and signally put forth to strengthen the ties of mutual advantage between the kingdom and the United States.”¹⁹² Saying that the mōī “largely enjoyed the confidence and affection of his people and of the members of the very numerous nationalities represented within the kingdom,” the reporter added:

His Majesty was always a most diligent student, and, speaking the English language with perfect purity, his tone and manner was that of a highly cultivated English gentleman. On the latest developments of all prominent scientific and political questions engaging attention in Europe and America he kept himself thoroughly informed, while his knowledge of general literature was extensive and accurate.

The *Herald* also recalled that Kalākaua, as “a man of his inquiring nature, was a great traveller, so that there were few countries which he had not visited. Indeed, in this respect he had no royal compeer, and consequently his personal intimacy with Emperors, Kings, Princes, and Presidents far excelled that of any other monarch.”¹⁹³ A Reuters telegram sent to the *Bristol Mercury & Daily Post* indicated that American president Benjamin Harrison agreed with such assessments: “Hawaii had lost her wise and good Sovereign, under whom Hawaii had prospered.”¹⁹⁴ As for the

Daily Evening Bulletin of San Francisco, the place outside of Hawai'i that knew the mō'i best, it summed him up this way:

Kalakaua was a generous and sympathetic friend and ruler, whose high aim was the promotion of all enterprises that would ensure to their happiness and benefit; who never wearied in the execution of plans for their elevation of a higher civilization; who fully recognized the responsibilities of his exalted station, and bent all the energy of his mind to imbue his subjects with love of all the virtues and habits of industry and to advance the people of his island kingdom in all that promotes the welfare of a nation.¹⁹⁵

Printed and reprinted in hundreds of newspapers throughout the world, the sheer number of favorable articles about Kalākaua during his reign and after forces us to question the accuracy and motives behind those dismissive characterizations of him by agents of the nineteenth-century white oligarchy in Hawai'i and by those later writers who perpetuated those unflattering portraits. These other far more positive representations show us someone who impressed those who were not denigrating him to weaken his authority or seize his kingdom. A very large number of witnesses encountering Kalākaua at home or abroad concluded that he was a learned, curious, and dignified individual. Furthermore, those mocking or angry attacks on his character that did appear in international newspapers generally came from sources within the business district of Honolulu. The representations of Kalākaua presented in this chapter demand a much broader conversation about his reputation around the world since they also shed light on the smallness and narrowness of the white oligarchy's attacks on him. Those devoted to their own interests and to annexation had to work constantly to spread their misrepresentations of Kalākaua in their desperate attempts to undermine the highly favorable opinion the mō'i produced everywhere he went and in the hundreds of American and international newspapers that covered him.

Notes

1. Hawai'i had a remarkably high literacy rate in the nineteenth century. See Reinecke, *Language and Dialect in Hawaii*, 28, and Nogelmeier, *Mai Pa'a*, 75.
2. "The King of the Sandwich Islands," *Hastings & St. Leonard's Observer*, July 30, 1881, British Newspaper Archive.
3. Tromp, Bachman, and Kaufman, "Coming to Terms," 12.
4. Joesting, *Hawaii: An Uncommon History*, 208.
5. "King Kalakaua," *Alnwick Mercury*, July 23, 1881, British Newspaper Archive.
6. Gale Learning database.
7. The National Library of Australia's Trove database.
8. Grant, *Scenes in Hawaii*, 4-5.
9. London's *Standard* reported that Kalākaua was educated in California. See "America," *Standard*, December 31, 1874, 3, British Newspaper Archive.
10. Grant, *Scenes in Hawaii*, 7.
11. "King Kalakaua," *Alnwick Mercury*, July 31, 1881.
12. "The Hawaiians," *Rocky Mountain Gazette* (Denver), November 21, 1886, Gale 19th Century US Newspapers.
13. Joesting, *Hawaii: An Uncommon History*, 208.
14. "A Riot in Honolulu," *Pall Mall Gazette* (London), April 8, 1874, British Newspaper Archive; "A Riot at Honolulu," *Royal Cornwall Gazette, Falmouth Packet, and General Advertiser* (Truro, England), April 18, 1874, British Newspaper Archive.
15. "King of the Sandwich Islands," *Daily News* (London), December 19, 1874, British Newspaper Archive; "King of the Sandwich Islands," *Standard* (London), December 19, 1874, British Newspaper Archive; "King of the Sandwich Islands," *Morning Post* (London), December 19, 1874, British Newspaper Archive; "King of the Sandwich Islands," *Leeds Mercury* (London), December 19, 1874, Gale 19th Century British Library Newspapers; "King of the Sandwich Islands," *Lloyd's Weekly Newspaper* (London), December 20, 1874, Gale 19th Century British Library Newspapers.
16. "The Practice—Which of Late Years," *PCA*, February 20, 1875, Chronicling America.
17. "Kalakaua Rex," *North American and United States Gazette*, March 19, 1874, Gale 19th Century US Newspapers.
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- [32.](#) Wodehouse to British cabinet member Earl Derby.
- [33.](#) Kuykendall, *Hawaiian Kingdom*, 22.
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- [70.](#) Gordon-Cumming, *Fire Fountains*, vol. 2, 230.
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- [82.](#) "The King of the Hawaiian Islands," *Frank Leslie's Illustrated Newspaper*, February 19, 1881, 407, *Gale 19th Century US Newspapers*.
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- [85.](#) Karl, *Staging the World*, 234n17.
- [86.](#) "King Kalakaua," *Alnwick Mercury*, July 23, 1881, 2, *British Newspaper Archive*.
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- [88.](#) *Ibid.*
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- [92.](#) "King Kalakaua," *Alnwick Mercury*, July 23, 1881, 2.
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- [94.](#) "1881 King Kalakaua Letters. Trip around World. May 12, 1881. Singapore," 4, *F. O. & Ex.*, Hawai'i State Archives.
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- [96.](#) "King Kalakaua," *Alnwick Mercury*, July 23, 1881, 2.
- [97.](#) Char, "Hawaiian King Visits," 92-106, 98.
- [98.](#) *PCA, King Kalakaua's Tour*, 58.
- [99.](#) On the day before the banquet, Kalākaua had played the music to "Hawai'i Pono'i" on the piano for the Siam bandmaster. "King Chulalongkorn and the Last King of Hawaii," *Chiangmai and Chiangrai*, December 3, 2012.
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- [105.](#) "The Construction of the Suez Canal," *Hong Kong Daily Press*, February 15, 1875, 2, Multimedia Information Systems, Hong Kong Public Libraries.
- [106.](#) Char, "Hawaiian King Visits," 99.
- [107.](#) "The King of the Sandwich Islands in London," *Wallaroo Times & Mining Journal*, September 3, 1881, 1, supplement, National Library of Australia.
- [108.](#) "King Kalakaua," *Graphic* (London), July 23, 1881, 11, British Newspaper Archive.
- [109.](#) *PCA, King Kalakaua's Tour*, 70.
- [110.](#) "London Gossip," *Hampshire Telegraph & Sussex Chronicle*, July 23, 1881, 2, British Newspaper Archive.
- [111.](#) "We Congratulate Your Majesty," *Hastings & St. Leonard's Observer*, July 23, 1881, 6, Gale 19th Century British Library Newspapers, part 3.
- [112.](#) "The King of the Sandwich Islands at Hastings," *Hastings & St. Leonard's Observer*, July 23, 1881, 6, British Newspaper Archive.
- [113.](#) "Our Private London Correspondence," *Sheffield Daily Telegraph*, August 12, 1881, 2, British Newspaper Archive.
- [114.](#) "Latest General News," *Western Times* (Exeter), July 19, 1881, 8, British Newspaper Archive.
- [115.](#) "King Kalakaua," *Standard* (London), August 6, 1881, 5, British Newspaper Archive.
- [116.](#) "The Court," *Graphic* (London), August 13, 1881, 11, British Newspaper Archive.
- [117.](#) "Events in France," *Standard* (London), August 11, 1881, 3, British

Newspaper Archive.

- [118.](#) Schweizer, *Turning Tide*, 266.
- [119.](#) "Kalakaua's Views," *Daily Evening Bulletin* (San Francisco), August 11, 1881, 4, Gale 19th Century US Newspapers.
- [120.](#) "Portugal: Another Important Visitor," *Standard* (London), July 20, 1881, 5, British Newspaper Archive.
- [121.](#) Maxwell, *Colonial Photography*, 94.
- [122.](#) Dias, "Here Comes 'Kalakana' [sic]," 77.
- [123.](#) Ibid., 77-79, 89.
- [124.](#) "Multiple News Items," *Standard* (London), August 22, 1881, 4, British Newspaper Archive.
- [125.](#) "The King of the Sandwich Islands," *Edinburgh Courant*, September 9, 1881, 5.
- [126.](#) "The King's Tour," *Edinburgh Courant*, September 12, 1881, 5; Scotland delivered so many generous accolades to Kalākaua that to quote them all would require additional space. Instead, they have been footnoted here: "The King of the Sandwich Islands," *Edinburgh Courant*, September 7, 1881, 5; "Corporation Banquet to the King," *Glasgow Herald*, September 8, 1881, 4; "Banquet in the Council Chambers," *Edinburgh Courant*, September 10, 1881, 4; "Reception at the Council Chamber," *Glasgow Herald*, September 10, 1881, 4; "Ceremony in Freemasons' Hall," *Edinburgh Courant*, September 12, 1881, 5.
- [127.](#) "Queen Electricity," *London Daily News*, September 3, 1881, 5, British Newspaper Archive.
- [128.](#) "Miscellaneous News & Home Gossip," *Huddersfield Chronicle & West Yorkshire Advertiser*, September 17, 1881, 3, Gale 19th Century British Library Newspapers; "Election News," *Aberdeen Weekly Journal*, September 13, 1881, 3, British Newspaper Archive.
- [129.](#) "King Kalakaua's Departure," *Liverpool Mercury*, September 14, 1881, 6, British Newspaper Archive.
- [130.](#) "King Kalakaua and Suite," *Standard* (London), September 14, 1881, 4-5, British Newspaper Archive.
- [131.](#) Samuel Chapman Armstrong of Hawai'i, the brother of William N. Armstrong, founded the Hampton Institute.
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- [133.](#) "King Kalakaua's Welcome Home!," *Alnwick Mercury*, April 29, 1882, 2, British Newspaper Archive.
- [134.](#) "Kalakaua at Home Again," *New York Times*, May 8, 1882, 2, New York Times Archive.
- [135.](#) Field, *This Life I've Loved*, 152.
- [136.](#) "Turned Up Page," *Clarence & Richmond Examiner*, September 18, 1909, 6, National Library of Australia.
- [137.](#) "San Francisco Revisited," *Argus* (Melbourne), June 3, 1882, 13, National Library of Australia.
- [138.](#) "King Kalakaua in Edinburgh," *Liverpool Mercury*, December 27, 1881, 2, Gale 19th Century British Library Newspapers, part 3.
- [139.](#) Kamehiro, *Arts of Kingship*, 25.
- [140.](#) Phipps, "Performances of Power," 217.

- [141.](#) "King Kalakaua's Coronation," *New York Times*, January 2, 1883, 1, New York Times Archive.
- [142.](#) "A Coronation at the Sandwich Islands," *Portsmouth Evening News* (London), January 23, 1883, 3, British Newspaper Archive.
- [143.](#) "King Kalakaua," *Evening News*, February 21, 1883, 3; "Latest," *Bristol Mercury and Daily Post*, February 22, 1883; "General," *Leeds Mercury*, February 22, 1883; "A Telegram," *Liverpool Mercury*, February 22, 1883; "Multiple," *Morning Post*, February 22, 1883, 5; "Multiple," *Standard* (London) February 22, 1883, 3; "Foreign," *Graphic* (London), February 24, 1883; "Foreign," *Manchester Times*, February 24, 1883; "The Sandwich Islands," *Reynolds' Newspaper*, February 25, 1883; "A Coronation," *Pall Mall Gazette*, March 12, 1883; "Coronation," *Liverpool Mercury*, March 24, 1883.
- [144.](#) "King Kalakaua Crowned," *New York Times*, February 21, 1883, 8, New York Times Archive.
- [145.](#) "Coronation of the King of the Sandwich Islands," *Dundee Evening Telegraph*, March 24, 1883, 2, British Newspaper Archive.
- [146.](#) "Some Account," *Illustrated London News*, April 7, 1883, 334.
- [147.](#) "Letters," *Illustrated London News*, March 31, 1883, 314, Illustrated London News Archive, 1842-2003.
- [148.](#) "Kalakaua's Coronation," *Galveston Daily News*, February 21, 1883, Gale 19th Century US Newspapers.
- [149.](#) "King Kalakaua's Coronation," *St. Louis Globe-Democrat*, March 13, 1883, 4, Gale 19th Century US Newspapers.
- [150.](#) "The Hawaiian Islands in Kalakaua's Dominions—Wonderful Improvements. His Coronation," *St. Louis Globe-Democrat*, January 1, 1883, Gale 19th Century US Newspapers.
- [151.](#) Field, *This Life I've Loved*, 152.
- [152.](#) Ibid., 155.
- [153.](#) Schweizer, *Turning Tide*, 266.
- [154.](#) Field, *This Life I've Loved*, 158.
- [155.](#) P. Wood, "His Majesty's Ship," 115-121.
- [156.](#) Field, *This Life I've Loved*, 158.
- [157.](#) Damon, *Sanford Ballard Dole*, 156.
- [158.](#) Field, *This Life I've Loved*, 158.
- [159.](#) Korn, *Victorian Visitors*, 49.
- [160.](#) Ibid., 74.
- [161.](#) Cameron, *John Cameron's Odyssey*, 224.
- [162.](#) Daggett, "Hawaiian Legends," 256-258.
- [163.](#) Paltrow, "Merry Monarch of Hawaii," 194.
- [164.](#) "King Kalakaua Goes to Paris," *New York Times*, July 26, 1889, 1.
- [165.](#) Gowen, *Paradise of the Pacific*, 83.
- [166.](#) Ibid., 92.
- [167.](#) "Long Live the King," *Anaconda (MT) Standard*, December 5, 1890, 1, Chronicling America.
- [168.](#) "California News Items," *Morning Oregonian*, December 29, 1890, 2, Gale 19th Century US Newspapers.

- [169.](#) "King Kalakaua," *Portsmouth Evening News* (London), January 19, 1891, 3, British Newspaper Archive.
- [170.](#) Pi'eahu, 'Iaukea, and Watson, *By Royal Command*, 129, 132; McGregor-Alegado, "Hawaiian Resistance," 52-53.
- [171.](#) Lili'uokalani, *Hawaii's Story*, 206.
- [172.](#) Schweizer, *Turning Tide*, 275.
- [173.](#) McGregor-Alegado, "Hawaiian Resistance," vii.
- [174.](#) Burns, *Last King of Paradise*, xii.
- [175.](#) McGregor-Alegado, "Hawaiian Resistance," xiii.
- [176.](#) US Department of State, *President's Message Relating to the Hawaiian Islands*, 522.
- [177.](#) Lili'uokalani, *Hawaii's Story*, 180.
- [178.](#) Tate, *United States and the Hawaiian Kingdom*, 29.
- [179.](#) "More on 'Aia i Honolulu, kuu Pohaku'! 1929," *Ke Alakai o Hawaii*, December 5, 1929, *Nupepa-hawaii* (blog).
- [180.](#) McGregor-Alegado, "Hawaiian Resistance."
- [181.](#) Schweizer, *Turning Tide*, 270.
- [182.](#) "The King of Hawaii," *Yorkshire Herald, and the York Herald*, January 21, 1891, 5; "London," *Standard*, January 21, 1891, 4; "Summary of News," *Sheffield & Rotherham Independent*, January 21, 1891, 5; "Births, Deaths, Marriages," *Sheffield Daily Telegraph*, January 21, 1891, 5; "A Telegram," *Morning Post*, January 21, 1891, 5; "King Kalakaua," *Devon and Exeter Daily Gazette*, January 21, 1891, 8; "Births, Deaths, Marriages," *Evening Telegraph & Star & Sheffield Daily Times*, January 21, 1891, 3; "Births, Deaths, Marriages," *Pall Mall Gazette*, January 21, 1891; "Special," *Leeds Mercury Correspondence*, January 21, 1891; "Multiple," *Huddersfield Daily Chronicle*, January 21, 1891, 4; "America," *Glasgow Herald*, January 21, 1891; "London Correspondence," *Freeman's Journal and Daily Commercial Advertiser*, January 21, 1891; "Death of King Kalakaua," *Birmingham Daily Post*, January 21, 1891; "King Kalakaua Dead," *Bristol Mercury & Daily Post*, January 21, 1891, 8; "Kalakaua I," *Daily News*, January 21, 1891, 4.
- [183.](#) "The Late King Kalakaua of Hawaii," *Graphic* (London), January 24, 1891, 8, British Newspaper Archive.
- [184.](#) "The Late King Kalakaua," *Manchester Times*, January 23, 1891, 8, British Newspaper Archive.
- [185.](#) "The Late King Kalakaua of Hawaii," *London Daily News*, February 17, 1891, Gale British Library Newspapers.
- [186.](#) "The Late King Kalakaua," *Evening Telegraph & Star & Sheffield Daily Times*, February 16, 1891, 3, British Newspaper Archive.
- [187.](#) "The Hawaiian Islands," *Huddersfield Daily Chronicle* (London), February 17, 1891, 3, British Newspaper Archive.
- [188.](#) "The Late King Kalakaua," *Evening Telegraph & Star & Sheffield Daily Times*, February 16, 1891, 3, British Newspaper Archive.
- [189.](#) "Funeral of a King," *Rocky Mountain News* (Denver), February 24, 1891, Gale 19th Century US Newspapers.
- [190.](#) "The King of Hawaii," *Glasgow Herald*, January 22, 1891, 9, British Newspaper Archive.
- [191.](#) "David Kalakaua," *Logansport (IN) Pharos*, April 27, 1891, 2.

- [192.](#) "Kalakaua's Death," *Los Angeles Herald*, January 22, 1891, 1, Chronicling America.
- [193.](#) "The King of Hawaii," *Glasgow Herald*, January 22, 1891, 9, British Newspaper Archive.
- [194.](#) "The Late King of Hawaii," *Bristol Mercury & Daily Post*, January 23, 1891, 8, British Newspaper Archive.
- [195.](#) "The Supervisors," *Daily Evening Bulletin* (San Francisco), January 27, 1891, Gale 19th Century US Newspapers.

CHAPTER THREE

Hawai'i's Early English- and Hawaiian-Language Representations of Kalākaua

On January 7, 1822, Ali'i Nui Ke'eaumoku pulled the lever of the secondhand Ramage press brought to Hawai'i by Elisha Loomis and other members of the first mission company, including Hiram Bingham, Asa Thurston, and Samuel Whitney. The first page had now been printed in Hawai'i, and it forever changed the kingdom. "If there is any characteristic of Hawaii as prominent as climate, scenery and the word 'aloha,'" Riley Allen writes, "it is the enormous output of writing which began in the early 1800s and has continued without cessation," bearing "eloquent testimony to the range, variety and volume of writing which Hawaii has produced, and the impact and effect of it."¹ Those missionaries aimed "at nothing short of covering those islands with fruitful fields, pleasant dwellings, schools, and churches,"² and a Hawaiian alphabet and the printed word were some of their main tools. Evidently, the first page printed was part of an elementary Hawaiian-language spelling book. Noenoe Silva has noted that the great historian Samuel M. Kamakau recalled, "Learning to read became popular. The chiefs saw the value of education.... Teachers were sent all about the county districts" and "the wish of the king [the young Kamehameha III], his sister and his guardians acted upon the people like a lightning flash stimulating all hearts.... The spread of knowledge was very rapid in Hawaii."³ Later, nineteenth-century Hawai'i would obtain a singularly high literacy rate.⁴ While national education was the foundation of literacy, Hawaiians also achieved this level through reading, writing for, and publishing newspapers in Hawaiian and English. While from

the 1830s to the 1850s the nation's readers mostly "received" these newspapers as education or information about the government, by the 1860s the papers were much more interactive. Even so, from the beginning, newspapers created and sustained a forum for dialogue that fostered a sense of nationhood.⁵ Historians have confirmed that once the independent Hawaiian-language newspapers began appearing in the 1860s, subscriptions increased rapidly over the next forty years. Many Hawaiians depended on these papers to remain informed about their nation's well-being. Helen G. Chapin documents just how popular these newspapers were: "No English language paper could claim more than 1,500 to 2,000 circulation, except for the *Advertiser* when [a strongly promonarchy] Gibson ran it, while a Hawaiian nationalistic press had papers reaching from 4,000 to 7,000 each."⁶ Since for much of this span the resident population was fewer than seventy thousand, at least one in ten citizens was subscribing to one or more newspapers. But as Nogelmeier reminds us, readership exceeded paid circulation and the number of newspapers sold because they were often passed from reader to reader and house to house.⁷ Chapin notes that *Kuokoa* "achieved a circulation of 5,000 in the nineteenth century, far beyond that of the *Advertiser*" and that the individual copies of *Nuhou*, Gibson's vehicle for launching himself into Hawai'i politics and campaigning for Kalākaua, were "double the size of any other Hawaiian language periodical."⁸ Clearly, Hawaiians were interested in reading what Gibson had to say, whether in Hawaiian or English.

English-language representations of the day describing David Kalākaua often offered a black-and-white or two-dimensional negative version of the king that became embedded into a hegemonic history, made true simply by repetition. Because later histories built on this foundation were popular and supposedly authoritative,⁹ they became the major reference points for Kalākaua's character and life story. As chapter 2 has shown, however, those influential accounts make up a small, highly biased fraction of the

massive archive of accounts of the mō'i in English. This next chapter's survey of Hawaiian-language publications about Kalākaua suggests that a more complete, detailed, and three-dimensional picture of him is readily available. As Puakea Nogelmeier explains, "Lacking the core insight of these sources affects the entire system—how people today understand Hawai'i, past and present." He also notes that "misconceptions that have been generated and perpetuated without this foundation of reference vary from benign to destructive," and in the case of Kalākaua, those misrepresentations are often very destructive. Nogelmeier has also noted that "Hawaiian-language materials as a whole are a time capsule of important historical and cultural writings, and the newspapers are the most dense, most interconnecting portion of that historical cache."¹⁰ Representations of Kalākaua drawn from this cache suggest, at the very least, that Hawaiians supported as well as opposed their mō'i and that such positive portraits were often informed by an indigenous literary nationalism rooted in the larger political goals of sustaining the Hawaiian Kingdom and preserving its independence.

Such a survey is both necessary and overdue. Take, for example, those mele written about Kalākaua and presented to him at his birthday jubilee that appeared in the book *Na Mele Aimoku, Na Mele Kupuna, a me Na Mele Pono i o ka Moi Kalakaua I*.¹¹ Nogelmeier writes that this collection contains only a handful of the hundreds of mele written for Kalākaua from 1879 on for his birthday.¹² Close to 350 mele appear under the subject heading "Kalakaua" at the Bernice Pauahi Bishop Museum's archives, including a kanikau (funeral dirge) for the mō'i, chants composed by maka'āinana throughout the kingdom who received him on his many royal tours, and mele written by maka'āinana and ali'i in celebration of Kalākaua's 1874 and 1881 journeys away from Hawai'i. Those mele offer a look into maka'āinana impressions of the mō'i and should be fundamental to our understanding of him, just as more generally, Native perspectives should always be at the base of our

understanding of Hawaiian history. Many scholars have demonstrated the wealth of information to be found in nineteenth-century Hawaiian-language newspapers.¹³ Relatively recent scholarship that draws on this archive provides a more complete and accurate representation of our past and is less likely to trivialize Hawaiians and their way of life. Consulting these newspapers is essential for any scholar interested in Kānaka Maoli culture and political thought during that era. As Nogelmeier explains, “While literacy was at its highest, Hawaiians embraced the Hawaiian-language newspapers as the main venue for news, opinion, and national dialogue, but also as an acknowledged public repository for history, cultural description, literature, and lore.”¹⁴

The Hawaiian-language newspapers also provide Kānaka Maoli responses to the mō‘ī who ruled during a time of rapid expansion in the number and variety of newspapers. In 1874, when Kalākaua was elected mō‘ī, only three Hawaiian-language newspapers were being published: *Nupepa Kuokoa* (*Kuokoa*), *Ko Hawaii Ponoī*, and *Ka Nuhou Hawaii* (*Nuhou*).¹⁵ All three supported him in his early years on the throne, but the missionary descendant-edited *Kuokoa* as well as *Ko Hawaii Ponoī* later became outspoken in their attacks. As for the pro-Hawaiian, proKalākaua *Nuhou*, it continuously sounded the refrain “Hawai‘i for Hawaiians.” The two major English-language newspapers in 1874 were the *Hawaiian Gazette* (*HG*) and the *Pacific Commercial Advertiser* (*PCA*). The increase in the number of newspapers during Kalākaua’s seventeen-year reign reflects mounting public response by maka‘āinana and foreigners to the developments and discord of that period.¹⁶ By 1883, the year of Kalākaua’s coronation, there were seven Hawaiian-language newspapers, and nine by 1884. By 1887, the year that the Hawaiian League forced its Bayonet Constitution upon Kalākaua, ten were being published—the largest number since the first one began appearing in 1834. Two of the ten papers, Hawaiian nationalists Francisco Joseph Testa’s Hawaiian-language *Ka Makaainana* and Enoka Johnson, Reverend D. Keaweamahi,

and Joseph Moku'ōhai Poepoe's Hawaiian-language *Ke Alakai o Hawaii*, were started up to oppose the white oligarchy's Bayonet Constitution and support the monarchy. In a city with fewer than seventy thousand people, ten newspapers is a great deal of reporting and commentary, revealing the intensity of the investment Hawaiians were making in debates over preserving the independence of their kingdom. Between 1888 and 1891, the number fluctuated between seven and ten newspapers. Esther Mo'okini notes that the political upheavals in the late 1880s and early 1890s would ultimately raise this number to a high of fourteen. She attributes these increases to Hawaiian loyalist figures like Walter Murray Gibson, John E. Bush, and Robert Wilcox, who were "founding and editing newspapers to advance their political views."¹⁷

Press Coverage of Kalākaua before His Ascension to the Throne

Before and during his reign, Kalākaua both produced and served as a figure of interest for Hawaiian-language newspapers. These papers have become much more accessible through digitized collections online. Although more than 20 percent are searchable, a cursory look at Ulukau: The Hawaiian Electronic Library's Ho'olaupa'i locates more than seven hundred pages of text, and the Papakilo Database lists about sixty-three hundred results that refer to Kalākaua. In this and the following chapters, a survey of these articles, stretching from his early career to his death, will assess how writers publishing in Hawaiian represented the mō'i. Before Kalākaua ascended the throne, the newspapers did two things for the prince. They served to sustain his identity as a noble and his family as royalty and to some extent linked both he and his family to those of the Kamehameha line. The press also followed the prince in his government assignments, which both confirmed his serious and steady dedication to the kingdom and lāhui and revealed his preparation for greater executive responsibilities. This

chapter examines the earliest representations of Prince David, ranging from his birth to his first birthday as king in 1874.

Hawaiian- and English-language newspapers followed Kalākaua's involvement in kingdom politics from the moment he entered the legislature through his time on the Privy Council in the courts of Kamehameha IV and Kamehameha V, with special attention paid to his assignment as an aide-de-camp to Kamehameha IV's court and his activities in the House of Nobles.¹⁸ The Hawaiian-language press also featured him regularly in articles with titles such as "Ke Alo Alii" (The Royal Court), which reported on the health and daily activities of the pua ali'i (royal descendants of chiefs), including Kalākaua, Bernice Pauahi Bishop, Lunalilo, and Lili'uokalani. He was therefore constantly in the newspaper readers' minds.¹⁹ In 1860, the Hawaiian-language newspaper *Ka Hae Hawaii* noted his service on different legislative committees and his appointment, though only twenty-four years old, as an attendant to Lota Kapuāiwa Kamehameha on his trip to Vancouver Island. Then in 1861, on a somewhat unique path toward giving voice to Native Hawaiians by taking control of the printed press and sustaining Hawaiian language, culture, and traditions, Kalākaua helped to start the first Hawaiian-run Hawaiian-language newspaper, *Ka Hoku o ka Pakipika*.

On September 26, 1861, the 'Aha Hui Ho'opuka Nūpepa Kūikawā o Honolulu, an organization of almost two dozen well-educated men, including founder Joseph H. Kānepu'u, George W. Mills (Mila), J. W. H. Kauwahi, and Kalākaua, launched the first Hawaiian-language newspaper run by Native Hawaiians as an explicit challenge to supposed foreigner dictatorship of the press. The inaugural edition of *Ka Hoku o ka Pakipika* declared that it would be the first newspaper to represent the desires of the Native people,²⁰ and Māhealani Dudoit notes that some of the main concerns of *Ka Hoku* were the population decimation of the Native race and Hawaiians' survival.²¹ Noenoe Silva explains that *Ka Hoku* printed twenty-two mo'olelo and was "also rich in both

ancestral and contemporary mele, kanikau, mele inoa (name songs), some of which were composed in honor of the paper itself.”²² Because Hawai‘i had been facing not only colonialism and racism but the missionaries’ dismissal of mo‘olelo and mele, it made sense that a series titled “Moolelo no Kawelo,” which testified to the strength of Hawaiians through akua (gods), graced the front page of *Ka Hoku*’s first issue. An eloquent appeal to Kanaka readers appeared on the second page:

E na kanaka maoli, e hookipa oukou ia ia, e kipulu a momona, e hoikaika ia ia, a e loa auanei ia kakou i ka mea e lawa ai ko kakou iini nui.²³

(Native people, you must welcome it, cultivate it until it is fruitful, strengthen it, and we will soon obtain the thing that will satisfy our great desire.)

A passionate kahi mele (place chant) by John L. Nailili in celebration of *Ka Hoku*’s birth resounded with the cry “Lanakila / Lanakila / Lanakila oia” (Victory / Victory / Victory [*Ka Hoku o ka Pakipika*]) on the closing page.²⁴ Noenoe Silva has noted that in response to the missionaries’ condemnation of Kanaka ancient religion, Kalākaua used *Ka Hoku* as a vehicle to impart Native tradition and culture to readers.²⁵ The popularity of *Ka Hoku* was a major reason why Henry M. Whitney, who was editing the *Advertiser* at the time, began publishing another, fiercely competitive, Hawaiian-language paper, *Ka Nupepa Kuokoa*, which contained many of the same features and eventually became the longest-running Hawaiian-language paper.²⁶

At its one-year anniversary, *Ka Hoku* was defending itself against attacks by its rival and by Hawaiians, often heavily Christian, who wanted the newspaper to “die” because of the ‘ahahui’s (society’s or organization’s) desire to print mele, including wahi mele (place chants) and mele inoa (name chants), ka‘ao (legends), mo‘olelo (stories), and kanikau (funeral dirges) *in their entirety* by maka‘āinana, ali‘i, and

even *mōʻī* as a way to preserve these traditions for future generations.²⁷ During his own reign, Kalākaua would raise this desire to a national policy, using his authority as *mōʻī* to collect *moʻolelo* and *mele* submitted by practitioners throughout the kingdom. *Aliʻi* or *mōʻī* composed *mele inoa*, and *Ka Hoku* printed them alongside *mele* composed in honor of the *aliʻi* for all *Kānaka Maoli* to read and cherish during perilous times for pride in the *lāhui*.²⁸ The many handwritten and newspaper-clipping examples of *mele* to be found in Kalākaua’s fourth personal scrapbook, housed in the Bernice Pauahi Bishop Museum, testify to his personal commitment to looking after these resources.²⁹ Such stories and tributes also preserve nineteenth-century place names. Noenoe Silva notes that the editors “knew that they had the support of quite a few *aliʻi nui*, most notably that of Prince Kalākaua, who even edited the paper for some time.... In these ways, *Ka Hoku o ka Pakipika* encouraged ordinary *Kanaka* to be proud of their language and their culture.”³⁰ After only a two-year stint, *Ka Hoku* ended its run, but its agenda was sustained by newspapers that followed, even *Kuokoa*.

As for Kalākaua, he later assisted in editing the Hawaiian-language weekly *Ka Manawa* (Times) in 1870, the monthly *Ka Hoku o ke Kai* (Star of the Sea), which served as the first literary journal in the Hawaiian language,³¹ and the Hawaiian-language, Hawaiian nationalist biweekly *Ke Koo o Hawaii* (Support of Hawaii) in 1883. In 1870, there were two major Hawaiian-language newspapers in Hawaiʻi: *Nupepa Kuokoa* was published by American Board of Commissioners for Foreign Missions (ABCFM) missionary Luther Halsey Gulick, and *Ke Au Okoa* (Different Era/Time/Current) was sponsored by the government.³² Desiring a space for autonomous voices, *Ka Manawa* published its first edition with this introduction:

Ua maopopo, ua hikiikii ia ke poo a me ka pulima o ka
poe kakau manao, e ke kuokoa ole, a manao akea ole; a i
ka nana aku i na nupepa e hoolaha ia nei, ua hikii ia
lakou e ka hoohaiki ia o ka pono akea e noho malalo o ka

aoao hookahi. O ke kahua oiaio o keia nupepa, o ka hilinele ole ma kela ano keia ano hoomana, aka, he ku i ka wa.³³

(It is understood that the head and wrist of the editorial writers were bound by the lack of independence and narrow-mindedness; and when seeing the newspapers being published today, they were bound by restrictions of public courtesy to remain on one side of the issue. The true platform of this newspaper is not to rely on any type of authority, but to be independent.)

On the front page of its inaugural edition, *Ke Koo o Hawaii* printed a picture of the Hawaiian flag with this proclamation:

Na keia hoailona i hoohiwahiwa ia oe e Hawaii; he aahu nou e haaheo ai; a maluna ae o na mea a pau, o ke Koo ia o na kaupoku o kou hale e paa ai me ka naueue ole; a e ku ai ka haakei a me ke kaena ana.

O keia hoailona he Hae, ua kukuni pilipaa ia kona makee ia e na lahui a pau; a he mea na lakou i haakei a kaena ka Hae o ko lakou aupuni iho.³⁴

(It is this symbol which honors you, O Hawaii; it is a mantle for you to have pride in; and above all things, it is the support for the roof of your house, secured unwaveringly; and it is worthy of pride and boasting.

This symbol, a flag, the affection for it is indelibly emblazoned in all peoples; and thus they are proud of and boast of the flag of their own nation.)³⁵

Published six months after Kalākaua's coronation, the patriotic *Ke Koo* claimed that it was a paper "no ka lahui Hawaii ... no na pomaikai o ka Lahui Hawaii me kona mau makamaka pono" (for the Hawaiian nation/people ... for the blessings of the Hawaiian nation/people with its own dearest friends).³⁶ Helen Chapin notes that while the Hawaiian nationalist press contained different opinions on topics, there were five common premises:

One, a conviction that Hawaiians knew what was best for themselves; two, an awareness that the decline of the native population was a serious matter; three, an insistence that Hawai'i remain an independent nation; four, a deep respect for the monarchy; and five, a great love for their land.³⁷

Through support for *Ka Hoku*, *Ka Manawa*, *Ka Hoku o ke Kai*, and *Ke Koo o Hawaii*, Kalākaua found a space to advocate for these sentiments before a large and engaged readership, and therefore his fervent and prolonged support for Native nationalism and informed awareness of national and international affairs was well known to nineteenth-century Hawaiians before he became mō'i. Because of his involvement with these newspapers, Kalākaua was often called the "Editor King."³⁸

Kalākaua also had posts in the mō'i's court, often traveling with other ali'i throughout the kingdom. In 1862, Kalākaua was named to Lot Kamehameha's Privy Council and appointed postmaster general, a "responsible and laborious office" that "ought to command a salary at least half that given to each of the Ministers."³⁹ He served until 1865, when his political career took off; the newspapers in Hawai'i faithfully covered his ascent. In early February, he was named treasurer under Kamehameha V and then appointed as the interim lieutenant governor of O'ahu when his brother-in-law, John O. Dominis, took a leave of absence. Kalākaua would serve as interim again in 1868 and 1870. He was a member of the committee responsible for the celebration of Lā Ho'iho'i Ea (Sovereignty Restoration Day)⁴⁰ and asked to give the commemoration address on July 31, 1865.⁴¹ The *Advertiser* praised the day's ceremonies.⁴² Kalākaua served as secretary of the Labor Board that same year.⁴³ In June 1866, Victoria Kamāmalu, heir apparent to Lot Kapuāiwa, died. Kalākaua's name appeared in the newspapers as one of the living ali'i who could serve as a successor, although even then Lunalilo was identified as the more likely choice, since he was most closely related to the Kamehameha line.⁴⁴ In

1868, both the Hawaiian and English presses reported on Kalākaua's thorough and thoughtful work as a legislator⁴⁵—carefully examining bills and reports before voting for or against them, passionately upholding the constitution, which he knew well, protecting Native rights, and boldly stating his informed opinions before other members. One significant defeat, given the later rumors concerning his drinking, was his attempt in the Legislative Assembly of 1868 to repeal the prohibition of the sale of liquor to Natives. According to the *Advertiser*, its defeat by a three-fourths majority showed the “good sense of the nation on this subject.”⁴⁶ Kalākaua's name appeared in the newspapers that same year as a divorce attorney. A member of the Fire Department Hawai'i League, he was part of Number Four, the prestigious all-Native Hawaiian company, the first of its kind.⁴⁷ Kalākaua would be elected its foreman in 1870, and in 1871, he was noted as a member of the Privy Council. In 1873 came Kalākaua's first experience in running for the title of mō'ī, which he lost to Lunalilo, thanks to united maka'āinana support and a unanimous legislative vote. As reported by the newspapers, Kalākaua served week to week and year after year as a steady and sound legislator and public official, heavily engaged in the fashioning and growth of the government and devoted to serving his people. This devotion and sacrifice would continue throughout his tenure as mō'ī.

The 1874 Election, Kalākaua Becomes Mō'ī

News of the beloved Mō'ī William Charles Lunalilo's ill health had been known for months prior to his death on February 3, 1874.⁴⁸ Yet the king died without naming a successor. Therefore, Queen Emma and Prince David Kalākaua stepped forward as candidates in the kingdom's second election on February 12, 1874. Hawai'i's newspapers supported the prince as overwhelmingly as they had supported Lunalilo in 1873.⁴⁹ The newspapers showed little support for Emma. But the papers' different emphases and interpretations also

reveal the wide range of responses in Hawai‘i to Kalākaua’s victory. When, for example, the English-language *HG* and *PCA* referred interchangeably to “the whole of Hawai‘i,” “all Hawai‘i,” the “entire kingdom,” or “we,” they were in fact referring to a relatively small though influential minority—the American business element in Hawai‘i. Take, for example, this article from *HG* right after Kalākaua’s victory: “In no district on the other islands of the group, from which we have heard, has there been any organized opposition to him, nor the first expression of dissent from any meeting, large or small.”⁵⁰ The *HG* claimed that everyone supported Kalākaua as *mō‘ī*, and the paper’s unwillingness to take seriously those who passionately supported Emma glosses over the very real political challenge Kalākaua faced from the opposing group, the Emmaites. The Emmaites were a small group of Hawaiians in Honolulu who vigorously campaigned on the streets, spoke out in the newspapers, distributed leaflets, and conversed with would-be supporters. In reaction to Emma’s loss in the legislative election on February 12, the Emmaites rioted at the courthouse in Honolulu. Certain English-language accounts of the ensuing riot offered rather distorted versions, while the Hawaiian-language newspapers presented a more complete account and a more nuanced history of Kalākaua’s beginning as *mō‘ī*.

On the night before the election, the Emmaites gathered with the queen dowager at Emma’s home in Nu‘uanu to prepare for the next day, agreeing that if Emma lost they would burn the courthouse and all other government buildings but injure neither the foreigners nor the nobles.⁵¹ While the special legislative session was going on the next day, two groups gathered outside. The larger one consisted of Emma’s supporters, purportedly from Honolulu and O‘ahu’s “country” and numbering no more than fifty, while a smaller group comprised Kalākaua adherents.⁵² The representatives and the attendants inside the courthouse admitted they heard the Emmaites’ thunderous drumbeats, yelling, and carousing outside.⁵³ *Kuokoa* reported that one among the mob yelled, “Ina e hana ole na lunamakaainana i

ko kakou makemake, alaila, e holehole aku i ko lakou mau iwi” (If the representatives do not act according to our wishes, then, their bones will be stripped) while “Kalakaua’s adherents were peaceful.”⁵⁴

Once it was announced that Kalākaua had won, the crowd outside began to cheer.⁵⁵ General George M. Robeson explained that at that time, “orators, mostly of the ‘sansculotte’ class, were busy here and there, exciting the passions of their hearers against the representatives.”⁵⁶ And when representatives William Moehonua, Luther Aholo, and J. H. Martin, who were selected to notify Kalākaua of his victory, left the courthouse and attempted to enter their carriage, the Emmaites attacked them. *Kuokoa* pointed out that Representative Aholo told his attackers, “Aole o oukou kuleana maluna o’u no Lahaina mai au” (You have no right over me, for I am from Lahaina).⁵⁷ In a matter of minutes, the rioters had destroyed parts of the courthouse and injured some of the Hawaiian representatives who had voted for Kalākaua. After the interim provisional government, or the late ministry’s cabinet, including Charles R. Bishop, John O. Dominis, and A. Francis Judd, who was responsible for protecting the legislators, sent notes to American minister Henry A. Peirce and British commissioner James H. Wodehouse, about 150 troops with weapons were on shore within ten minutes.⁵⁸ Because soldiers from foreign warships were sent ashore supposedly to protect foreign residents, the landing was questionable, since only Native representatives were injured.⁵⁹ The secretary of the US Navy said that soon after the troops appeared, “the majority [of the mob] marched off in triumph, shouting and hurrahing for the Queen,” and as it made its way to her home, the mob “saluted her with exultant cheers, while some of her partisan leaders made incendiary speeches.”⁶⁰ In fact, the *Nuhou* reported, “The riot was not of a very formidable character, and ought not to have required very large force to quell it” and that only about twenty-five rioters entered the courthouse.⁶¹ The writer therefore concluded that only “those who desire a permanent armed occupation” would

have ordered the army from the warships to come ashore.⁶²

It is important to note that while Hawaiian-language newspapers reported the riot was violent and unconscionable, they also described it as very organized and contained.⁶³ Even Rear Admiral William H. H. Southerland of the US Navy observed that after his troops arrived on shore, they saw that many Hawaiians around the courthouse had nothing to do with the riot.⁶⁴ Kuykendall confirms this.⁶⁵ And in the end, months after the riot, the crown pardoned the main conspirators, including such prominent figures as Reverend George Washington Pilipō from Kaumakapili Church and the famed historian and unwavering Emma supporter Samuel Mānaiakalani Kamakau.⁶⁶ During that time it was also learned that three days before the election a committee of thirteen formed to secure Emma's victory or riot.⁶⁷ It was further discovered that Pilipō and W. S. Pahukula, an election organizer and a well-known spokesman for the Emma campaign, lost their legislative campaigns on February 2. This may have incited them to riot, specifically targeting the February 2 victors, Edward Mikalemi and Moehonua, who ended up voting for David Kalākaua, thus fortifying Emma's loss.⁶⁸ If the Emmaites started the riot to avenge their representatives' loss, then Aholo's comment to the Emmaites when they attacked him, "Aole o oukou kuleana maluna o'u no Lahaina mai au" (You have no right over me, for I am from Lahaina), makes sense.

In the end, the Hawaiian-language newspapers provided a more nuanced account of the 1874 riot, demonstrating opposing kanaka loyalties and ali'i struggling for the throne. Scathing remarks blaming Emma and her supporters for devising the fiasco and failing to stop it appeared throughout the newspapers and other published material after the riot.⁶⁹ The secretary of the navy recalled that at the height of the riot a member of the House of Nobles drove to Emma's home and pleaded with her to go to the courthouse and stop the riot, "preventing the spilling of blood," but she responded with "indifference."⁷⁰ It was also noted that later at Emma's home the rest of the mob continued in "speech-making and

boasting, after sundown.”⁷¹ This open criticism of Queen Emma is significant because it has been alleged that Kalākaua was the only mō‘ī the press ever attacked, thus leading us to believe that he was the only ali‘i who deserved such blame and disapproval.⁷²

The *Friend*, which seldom published material on the monarchy, congratulated Hawai‘i for finally coming to the conclusion that the paper itself had reached weeks earlier: “Long before the election took place, and when calmly reflecting upon the situation of affairs, we felt, that Prince David Kalakaua was the one and the only one upon whom the nation could unite. His appointments and rule thus far have given indication of hope to the nation.”⁷³ The next section examines the maka‘āinana response, as reported in Hawai‘i’s newspapers, to the mō‘ī’s first initiatives on the throne, further confirming his resolute focus to improve the lives of his lāhuikanaka (nation of people) and maintain Hawai‘i’s independence.

Strengthening His Nation from Home

Housed at the Bernice Pauahi Bishop Museum are Kalākaua’s own scrapbooks; one of them contains newspaper clippings that list population totals and mortality rates for Hawai‘i. He was clearly concerned about his people’s survival long before he ascended the throne, and the newspapers can help us map out the evolution of his ideas for leading the kingdom under his motto Ho‘oulu Lāhui (To grow/increase/preserve the [Hawaiian] nation). Ho‘oulu Lāhui was a twofold enterprise to increase the industry and agricultural yield of the kingdom and to increase the Native Hawaiian population in ways that responded to changes occurring in the kingdom. For the first objective, the government came up with the idea to lend money to maka‘āinana farmers who used “crops instead of land as collateral.”⁷⁴ For the second, the mō‘ī urged the Board of Health to “improve to the utmost the hygiene of his people,” and he pressed the legislators “to devise means for the preservation of the lives of infants” and to provide for a

“special exemption” for “those who rear large families.”⁷⁵ From his first day as mō‘ī, Kalākaua went to work. His well-defined, organized objectives demonstrate his methodical aptitude for understanding how to preserve the kingdom and its Native population at a time of rapid globalization and the time he must have spent judiciously planning and preparing approaches to accomplish that. Serving as an interlude between discussing representations of him with regard to his election and examining his kingdom tour, this section analyzes Hawaiian-language newspapers’ attention to his early work at home to save his people, strengthen his nation, and secure American and international official recognition of the Hawaiian Kingdom’s independence. It will contribute to a more comprehensive representation of David Kalākaua as a sagacious, hardworking, and responsible leader.

At the opening of the 1874 legislative assembly, King Kalākaua declared that the one subject that “awakens my greatest solicitude is to increase my people,” and to this initiative he directed his cabinet’s “earnest attention.”⁷⁶ As Lilikalā Kame‘eleihiwa explains, “He surmised that if Hawaiians could again celebrate life, as their ancestors had, and if they were thus inspired with a great desire to live, then the senseless, premature deaths might cease. As a nation, Hawai‘i would be *pono* again.”⁷⁷ Many within the kingdom answered the king’s call to change. The *HG* commended Kalākaua’s ideas to ho‘oulu the lāhui, recommending that the government provide homesteads for large families.⁷⁸ Kalākaua also changed the remarriage law, allowing divorced couples to remarry at any time rather than having to wait a year.⁷⁹ He created a Hawaiian Board of Health with Hawaiian kauka (doctors) who could provide professional kahuna with licenses to practice.⁸⁰ *Kuokoa* captured another part of Kalākaua’s plan. During an August 1874 visit to a Kāne‘ohe Protestant Church, Kalākaua personally participated in the baptism of two children:

O ka hana kiekie a ihiihi a ko kakou Lani Moi ahonui ...
oia no keia: Na Kona mau lima kapu pono i hiipoi a i

kaikai hele aku i kekahi mau keiki liilii loa, a imua o ke Kahunapule Rev. J. Manuela, e baptizo a e hoolaa ia laua na ke Akua. He hana lani a he hana hoohaahaa maoli keia a ka Moi i hana'i i na keiki makaainana o Kona aupuni, i ka mea hoi i ike ole ia, a i hana ole ia no hoi e na Alii Aimoku i pau nui aku la i ka hala, a ia Kauliluaikeanuwaialeale ae nei, ua noanoa na lima kapu. O ka inoa o kekahi keiki i baptizoia, oia no o Kahooululahui (w).^{[81](#)}

(The exalted and sacred deeds of our patient king ... was this: with his own sacred hands he cherished and led some very young children before the Rev. J. Manuel to baptize and consecrate them to God. This was a regal and truly humble action that the king performed for the common children in his kingdom, something that was never seen before, nor done by the deceased chiefs. And by Kauliluaikeanuwaialeale his sacred hands were made free. The name of one of the baptized children is Kaho'oululāhui (a girl).)^{[82](#)}

Kalākaua had been on the throne for only seven months. The residents of Ko'olaupoko—a people, *Kuokoa* reported, who continued to respect the mō'i as akua—were still learning about him. His act of presenting the children to be baptized therefore astonished *Kuokoa's* reporter and probably most in attendance. Though some might have opposed this act, the mō'i was responding with a variety of answers and methods to the deep-seated causes of the decrease in population. Infants had the highest mortality rate among Hawaiians, and on his later 1874 royal tour of Ko'olaupoko, he expressed his concern about the numbers. At the end of the service, people shook hands with the mō'i. Some were moved to tears. Throughout his reign, on his many tours he encouraged his subjects to do even more to increase their families, to care for each other, and to ensure the survival of the young children. With his wife, Kalākaua later founded the Kapi'olani Maternity Home, a place where expectant mothers could receive appropriate care and information to ensure safe

childbirth. On at least one occasion, he sought advice from the Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints in Lā'ie because its congregations had so many large and growing families.

As early as November 1874, the *PCA* reported on the success of Kalākaua's promotion of this policy: "*Hooulu lahui* have become the watchwords at all public gatherings of the natives." Some three hundred maka'āinana gathered at Kawaiaha'o Church that month to discuss how to follow Kalākaua's edict, and the paper quoted one speaker as saying "too much care cannot be bestowed upon the nurture and education of the young, and in directing renewed attention to this branch of *hooulu lahui*, some good may have been accomplished by the meeting." Significantly, maka'āinana saw that the means of saving the nation was education: to teach Hawaiians how to care properly for each generation in response to the arrival of Westerners and diseases to the islands. The Honorable John A. Cummins proposed that a Ho'oulu Lāhui board be created in Honolulu, with local branches in each district throughout the kingdom that would monitor the health, sanitation, and education of the residents. These branches would also be responsible for the care of infants by assisting new parents who needed more information about raising young children. The *PCA* reported how Cummins proposed that the entire kingdom, especially the newspapers, needed to commit to spreading information that would ho'oulu the lāhui: "'I earnestly beg of all,—the chiefs, to use the influence of their positions; the clergy, when preaching from their pulpits; physicians, with their skill; and writers for the press, with their pens; and every man and woman, each in their own family and circle of acquaintance; to stand up alike to this great work of re-peopling Hawaii for the Hawaiians."⁸³

Another solution from maka'āinana was this:

E hooikaika me ka manao paulele e kiai me ka malama i ka Makuakane, ka Makuahine, Kaikuaana, Kaikaina, Kaikunane, Kaikuahine a me na Keiki, i loihi ai ke ola ana, a aole hoi e make opio. I lawa ai na mea a pau

me na mea ai o ke ola kino, mahuahua na aahu, me na hale pumehana, na wahi moe maemae, a me na kihei huluhulu maikai no na po huihui o ka Hooilo.⁸⁴

(Become stronger in faith to carefully watch the father, mother, older sibling, younger sibling, brother, sister, and the children in order to prolong life and not die young. In order to make all things and nourishment of the body sufficient increase the supply of clothing, warmed shelters, clean beds, and fine woollens for the cold nights of winter.)

The newspapers encouraged makaʻāinana to take part in such initiatives. In its November 21, 1874, edition, for instance, *Kuokoa* congratulated Luiki and his wife of Kapuʻukolo, Honolulu, highlighting the birth of their seventh child: “Pomaikai ke aupuni i keia mau makua hooulu lahui i ke au o Kalakaua” (The kingdom is blessed by these parents who are increasing the nation during the era of Kalākaua).⁸⁵ The newspapers therefore urged and documented makaʻāinana support of one of the earliest of Kalākaua’s initiatives as king, as he earnestly sought to hoʻoulu the lāhui in the face of substantial population declines and rapid Westernization.

The Exchange Rate: The Matter of Orders and Decorations

While Kalākaua labored early on to hoʻoulu and hoʻoikaika (strengthen) his lāhuikanaka (nation of people), he simultaneously worked to increase the world’s awareness of his kingdom in order to secure its independence. Just one month after ascending the throne, King Kalākaua began arranging the exchange of orders and decorations with the emperors, kings, commissioners, and presidents of different nations.⁸⁶ Through decorations and orders, the king fortified relationships with fellow international leaders and aligned Hawaiʻi with global powers. His correspondence with consuls

reveals his intention to secure other nations' official acknowledgment of Hawai'i as an independent kingdom, which would elevate himself and the kingdom and, presumably, protect it from colonization or annexation.⁸⁷ Kamanamaikalani Beamer has noted that the mō'i's endeavor "propelled him toward cultural production and the legitimization of heritage in Hawai'i."⁸⁸ The photographs, exhibitions, and other public appearances he took part in were highly public, and while his concern with decorations and awards might seem more private and personal, he realized that once an order was pinned on, this personal recognition became a public bond. On March 21, 1874, for example, William Martin, Hawai'i's consul in Paris, wrote to the mō'i to discuss exchanging decorations with some of the sovereigns of Europe. Kalākaua's and Martin's relationship lasted more than twelve years; they corresponded regularly about orders but also about the delivery of maps, books, awards, and Hawai'i's participation in major exhibitions held in Paris. Martin negotiated exchanges of honors between Kalākaua and King Leopold of Belgium, the king of Italy, Prince Charles of Germany, Prince Frederick Charles, the emperor of Russia, and Prince William of Prussia.⁸⁹ From the onset, then, the mō'i used well-established diplomatic methods to set up reciprocal and symbolic relationships with other world leaders as part of his strategy to assert Hawai'i's independence.

These early gestures laid some of the foundation for the welcomes he received when meeting these heads of state, and others, on his 1881 tour of the world, and that trip itself became another opportunity for such exchanges. On his early stop in Japan, for instance, he received numerous decorations and orders from the generous hands of the emperor. As soon as Kalākaua had the opportunity, he wrote back to his cabinet in Hawai'i requesting that additional awards be created and sent to him "in order to have our Orders and Decorations valued abroad, as we will in the future come more or less in contact with Princes and Crown Heads of other nations, as our visit here has started a precedence."⁹⁰

On May 12, 1881, he wrote again, pressing Governor John O. Dominis and revealing another pragmatic motive for his request:

I hope you will impress it upon the minds of the executive committee the necessity of carrying out my wishes as regards the exchange of decorations. By these exchanges depends the success of any future movement our government may take in desiring to procure immigrants.... Decorations have a powerful weight upon the minds of the Asiatic Prince's [*sic*].⁹¹

Even a hostile witness like the king's traveling companion William N. Armstrong recalled that Kalākaua's award ceremonies were a major part of the 1881 tour of the world:

In Japan, Egypt, Portugal, Siam and Belgium decorations were bestowed on the King and his suite on the one hand, and the King conferred the decorations of his own country in return. The Queen of England conferred on him the grand cross of St. George and St. Michael, and he bestowed on her the grand cross of the Order of Kamehameha and also the grand cross of the Order of Kalakaua.⁹²

Other forms of exchange also created relationships. Blossoms, blooms, seeds, maps, educational books, almanacs, music, and the lyrics of the Hawaiian national hymn were requested by and sent to different countries, such as Australia and France.⁹³ Botany was a special interest on both sides. Early in Kalākaua's reign, the consul at Melbourne recommended that Hawai'i send him a "small donation of the most notable of the fauna and flora of the Islands."⁹⁴ Another letter, dated May 30, 1876, announced that various seeds and plantings, such as eucalyptus and acacias, were on their way to Hawai'i to plant "in His Majesty's territories."⁹⁵ Many consuls, in fact, sent native specimens to Kalākaua to be rooted in Hawai'i's land, which could be read as a desire for

foreign powers to have a presence and influence in a small island kingdom. The correspondence also shows that other leaders desired and valued materials grown or made in Hawai'i. Such gifts and exchanges were symbolic expressions of acceptance and approval of Hawai'i as a distinct place and Kalākaua as its honored ruler. But the cumulative effect of the orders and decorations, international and national correspondence, and photographs produced and distributed during Kalākaua's reign was also to confirm his canny intelligence as a ruler. He constantly employed strategies big and small to assert the independence of the kingdom, and by acknowledging such gifts, the leaders of prominent countries and principalities affirmed it.⁹⁶

Kalākaua's Investment in Photography

In addition to his exchanges of correspondence, orders, and decorations, the mō'i employed emerging technologies—photography, telephones, electricity, and the transportation innovations that made his rapid tour around the world possible—to strengthen his traditional claims of his own sovereignty and that of his nation. The result was a Polynesian chief far more up-to-date and savvy about technology than the US president and most other international leaders. At home and abroad, he used photographs to transmit this identity to a large audience. As Kamanamaikalani Beamer has noted, "Ali'i took what they wanted to use from the Euro-American world while maintaining their identity as ali'i and Hawaiians,"⁹⁷ and Kalākaua was keenly attentive to the value of new technologies, especially for sustaining his position. It did not hurt that the impressiveness and nobility of the mō'i's physical body in these photos helped to personify the majesty of the Hawaiian Kingdom.⁹⁸ Kalākaua presented himself as a dignified nineteenth-century Victorian sovereign, and foreign commentary shows that it worked. In 1881, the *Alnwick Mercury* informed its London readers that while catching an actual glimpse of him might be difficult because "his life has

been one of almost perpetual motion,” there was an alternative: “King Kalakaua has been photographed at least once since his arrival, and his counterfeit presentment will therefore be in every printseller’s window before long.”⁹⁹

Kalākaua also had stamps printed, coins minted, and paper currency and postcards produced, all bearing his image. Almost immediately after ascending the throne, he and the royal family posed for portraits specifically designed to enter local and global channels of photographic discourse and to present himself, his ‘ohana, and by extension the Hawaiian people as noble. In Hawai‘i, people looked at these materials every day, but the stamps, paper currency, coins, and postcards also left the islands, presenting his image to the rest of the world—and very successfully. As Anne Maxwell explains, “People everywhere were purchasing and exchanging photographs of famous people and mounting them in specially designed albums decorated with Victorian verse and hand-painted borders.”¹⁰⁰ For his own purposes, the mō‘ī cleverly fed this demand: “Photographs of King Kalākaua of Hawai‘i were much sought after at the height of the postcard-collecting craze, but they also formed part of an imaginative public relations campaign by the royal family to raise their international profile and mobilize European support for their continued independence of their island nation.”¹⁰¹ Furthermore, Kalākaua had read the speculative histories about him and was aware of people’s ridicule of himself and of Hawai‘i as a primitive island state. He countered these King of the Cannibal Islands stereotypes not only through his physical presence in America and many other countries on his 1874 and 1881 travels but also through the new image technologies.¹⁰² Fatimah Rony has noted that “racialized people who have been objectified by the ethnographic gaze have developed a ‘third eye’ as they experience themselves being looked at—an eye that enables a critique of their objectification.”¹⁰³ Kalākaua concluded that presenting a multidimensional, noble, yet Victorian image to people outside of Hawai‘i would create an audience of admirers and supporters. And he was right. Maxwell asserts

that the widespread approval of the sovereignty of the Hawaiian throne was due to the “support of the international press” and the royal family’s “greater number of photographic portraits.”¹⁰⁴

These pictures reached all parts of the world. In a letter of February 16, 1880, the Japanese consul wrote that he had received the photographs of Kapi‘olani and Kalākaua, framed in black walnut, from the Hawaiian consul to be presented to the Japanese minister of foreign affairs. On July 13, 1882, the Hawaiian consul in London wrote to say that he had received the portrait of Kalākaua, to be presented to the Prince of Wales “*at the request of His Majesty*.”¹⁰⁵ Kalākaua was therefore very adept at nineteenth-century international social networking, and the welcome his individual and family portraits received from world leaders and an eager public indicates that politically, the images were well worth the effort to create and distribute.

Preparing such photographs was a constant activity. Menzies Dickson, an early photographer in the Hawaiian Kingdom, was known for his Victorian gentility props and costumes, and the royal family often visited his studio.¹⁰⁶ Two of his best-known photographs are the portrait of Leleiōhoku and another of the young Ka‘iulani, the eventual heir of Lili‘uokalani, posing in front of Dickson’s popular Lē‘ahi (Diamond Head) backdrop. Both portraits place the ali‘i in Victorian costume and surroundings. Dickson’s success “depended on velvet drapes, fringed chairs or braided uniforms” to present Hawaiian royalty as contemporary nobility, but sometimes the ali‘i supplied their own props.¹⁰⁷ To add to his already handsome and noble look, Kalākaua purchased horn-rimmed tinted spectacles and a lorgnette;¹⁰⁸ the mō‘ī knew “that the royal family’s survival depended on being able to project an image of civility.”¹⁰⁹ Later in 1875, Kalākaua commissioned Honolulu engraver Max Eckhart to compile a “fold-out book of photographs and paintings of the royal family” similar to those of European royal families circulating throughout that region at the time.¹¹⁰ A year later, the mō‘ī drew on the talents of

Colombian photographer Andreas Montano, an expert in carte de visite photos,^{[111](#)} and sent members of the royal family to sit for him.^{[112](#)} The famous Kapi'olani portrait is a Montano. In 1883, a portrait of Kalākaua printed on a "special gilt-edged card" was featured in the window of San Francisco retailer Bradley & Rulofson's. While less formal, other photographs also contributed to presenting him as mō'i. He wisely had the photographer Joaquin A. Gonsalves accompany him on his tours of the kingdom,^{[113](#)} and around 1879, Christian J. Hedemann captured the "only known image of the king giving an audience" in Kailua, Hawai'i.^{[114](#)} New photographers presented new opportunities for portraiture. In 1880, American portrait photographer, daguerreotypist, and ambrotypist Isaiah West Taber spent six weeks in Hawai'i. Kalākaua commissioned him to take three full-length portraits, and a year later, during the world tour stopover in San Francisco, Kalākaua visited Taber's studio to pose for additional photographs.^{[115](#)}



Leleiōhoku, by Menzies Dickson. Courtesy Hawai'i State Archives.



Ka'iulani, at approximately six years old, by Menzies Dickson. Courtesy Hawai'i State Archives.

Maxwell notes that the strategic production and reproduction of these royal family portraits in publications like London's *Graphic* were so successful at attracting sympathy and support for an independent Hawaiian Kingdom that these images were "still frustrating the US government well into the next century."¹¹⁶ Part of the effect came from the posing itself. Kalākaua's family "confront the camera's gaze directly in the manner that European viewers associated with the ... colonized, but adopted 'the cultivated asymmetries of aristocratic pose' characteristic of the bourgeois portrait."¹¹⁷ Photographs of Kalākaua in a group show a similar level of calculation. As Joanna C. Scherer notes, "The subject [of a photograph] can control the content by determining costume and pose and deciding when the image is to be made. This can be seen, for example, by

studying images of the same individual.”¹¹⁸ In his planned photographs, Kalākaua is always front and center, making him the most important figure, and he is always dressed in his Victorian uniform or in white clothing, signifying his nobility.

Because “photography was a mechanical by-product of the European technological revolution, the period during which scientific facts, invention, mass production, ownership of products, and conspicuous consumption began to rule in Western society,” Kalākaua identified several advantages to having his likeness captured and distributed.¹¹⁹ First, simply by taking part in the newest, latest technological craze, he was displaying his modernity. Maxwell further notes Kalākaua’s “decision to exploit the network of global markets that emerged in the late nineteenth century as political forms of colonial control gave way to the vicarious forces of consumerism, for this meant that the ethnographic model of representation could be counteracted.”¹²⁰ In short, he avoided the anthropological by appearing directly in front of the consumer. For example, Kalākaua gave the world’s largest tobacco company, Duke and Son of New York, permission to put his portrait and Hawai’i’s coat of arms on an “elegantly designed cigarette packet.”¹²¹

The clothing adorning the royal family in their portraits and public appearances also spoke of their agency as Hawaiian and Victorian nobles. Adrienne L. Kaeppler notes, “Hawaiian chiefs almost immediately became aligned with British and European royalty. They looked noble but not savage. Hawaiian chiefs learned quite early not to let themselves be exploited by outsiders,”¹²² starting with Kamehameha I. On November 24, 1816, Captain Otto von Kotzebue of Russia landed his ship *Rurick* at Kamakahonu, Hawai’i. Artist Louis Choris was on board, and after peaceful relations were established, he asked Kamehameha, dressed in a red malo, black tapa, and a folded cape of black cloth, to sit for a sketch. The king was happy to do it and went to get dressed. Choris then recounts, “Imagine my surprise on seeing this monarch display himself in the costume of a

sailor; he wore blue trousers, a red waistcoat, a clean white shirt and a necktie of yellow silk. I begged him to change his dress; he refused absolutely and insisted on being painted as he was.”¹²³ However politically effective it might have been, Kamehameha’s wish to pose in a sailor’s attire shows an acute awareness of controlling what the Western gaze upon him could reproduce.¹²⁴ Later that day, Kotzebue himself met with Kamehameha and, unaware of the earlier sitting, asked the mō‘ī to pose for Choris. Kamehameha refused at first. Only when told that the portrait was for the Russian emperor did he agree, presumably because he felt an obligation to another absolute ruler.¹²⁵ As a matter of policy, then, Kamehameha, and many of his successors, thought carefully about how they would be portrayed—and for what audience.



Kapi'olani, by Andreas Montano. Courtesy Hawai'i State Archives.

Kalākaua and his family took this to the level of not only staying up-to-date on the latest European fashions but

becoming fashion trendsetters themselves. The *Alnwick Mercury* reported that during his 1881 stop in London, Kalākaua was “wearing the usual complement of rings, and the gold bracelet originally brought into fashion by Prince Achille Murat,”¹²⁶ and when Kapi’olani and Lili’uokalani attended Queen Victoria’s jubilee in 1887, a dressmaker went along. Maxwell notes “the importance that the royal family attached to appearances,”¹²⁷ but in this case, Kapi’olani managed to draw attention to herself even though surrounded by the crowned heads and nobility of Europe in their finest apparel. The dress she wore to the celebration became known around the world as the “peacock dress,”¹²⁸ as seen in a portrait taken by Queen Victoria’s personal photographer. In addition, she had a portrait taken of a second gown made in Japan—an astute choice, given the European fetish for things Asian at that time. After presenting herself as a strikingly handsome figure in the finest European and Asian fashions of the time, distinguishing herself from, but belonging among, the hundreds of noblemen and women in London there, she also made sure to capture the images for immediate distribution near and far.

Perhaps the most important point to make here, however, is that awareness and calculation in self-presentation cannot be equated with deception. By dressing in a Victorian military uniform, Kalākaua in his portraits constructs a recognizably Western image that is an accurate representation of his nature. No separation between the private versus public or realism versus convention is discernible here. As Kamanamaikalani Beamer notes in a different context, “David La’amea Kalākaua was a confident Hawaiian and a competent ruler. Standing well over six feet tall, his policies matched the boldness of his stature as he sought to ... demonstrate the significant role that a mō’ī could play in reforming society.”¹²⁹ His photographs pointed to the actual talents and accomplishments of the mō’ī. He was a Hawaiian statesman, educated and well-read by Western standards, who spoke four languages fluently; served as an active

chairman of several boards, including the History and Microscopical Society; reestablished the Hale Nauā as an institution for Hawaiian knowledge;¹³⁰ studied and practiced law; learned about science and electricity; read military history; researched geothermal power as a new way to sustain Hawai‘i; memorized genealogies and the names of feathers, birds, plants, people, and places; prepared sketches of submarines long before they were operational; invented a modern-day water bottle; constantly read newspapers, periodicals, journals, and the Western literary canon; composed songs, including the lyrics to “Hawai‘i Pono‘ī”;¹³¹ sang exquisitely and was widely known for his impressive voice; enjoyed opera; loved the theater; played several instruments, including the piano; choreographed hula performances;¹³² expertly performed ballroom dances; played billiards; corresponded frequently with international leaders; impressed countries around the world with his eloquence and mastery of English and his familiarity with and curiosity about the history, cultures, and peoples of the places he visited; and like most of the Hawaiian ali‘i of the time, had an appreciation for things American, British, European, and Asian.

The citizens of his kingdom knew this. According to Reverend Mahoe, the mō‘ī was “he alii naauao, ua ao ia i ke olelo Beritania, ua loa ua ike elua ia ia, he Hawaii a he haole, a ua hoohana oia ia ia iho me ia mau ike, a ua ike kanaka makua” (an enlightened chief, learned in English, he had the knowledge of both a Hawaiian and a haole, and he managed himself with these knowledges, and the knowledge of the forefathers), adding that he “ua maa i na hana hooponopono aupuni a me na hana loea e akaka ai ke kulana naauao a me ke akamai o ua o Kauliluaikeanuwaialeale” (knew thoroughly the affairs of the government and the skillful duties by which the wisdom and skill of the one called Kauliluaikeanuwaialeale were made clear).¹³³ Walter Murray Gibson’s *PCA* offered a similar portrait of the mō‘ī during his lifetime:

His Majesty speaks the English language with perfect purity, and has the style and manner of a highly cultivated gentleman. His Majesty is a very diligent student, and has studiously perused the work of Darwin, Huxley, Haeckel, and other modern thinkers of great eminence; and as his tastes are decidedly military, His Majesty has a collection of military works, remarkable for variety and extent. It comprises the works and biographies of all the notable Captains of the eighteenth and nineteenth centuries, and the principal modern works on artillery and engineering.¹³⁴

Kalākaua's acuity, known by all, immediately struck others when first encountering him. As he appears in photographs, he was a Hawaiian and Victorian noble, a renaissance man. The image is a reality. He could travel comfortably outside of Hawai'i because he was handsome, intelligent, accomplished, and eloquent—almost perfect, according to one witness: "Kalakaua's triumph surpasses that of any of his predecessors. All political parties and all classes of men have vied with each other to pay him suitable homage. A becoming kingly dignity without pride, pretense, or ostentation, has gained him universal admiration."¹³⁵ Even when he tried to tour the world incognito, he immediately failed. Officials everywhere insisted on publicly recognizing Kalākaua as Hawai'i's mō'i. Of his time in Germany, the *Standard* reported: "King Kalakaua while enjoying the sights of this metropolis, himself seems to be considered a most remarkable personage by the Berliners. Few Potentates have enlisted so much attention and applause as the affable Ruler of the Hawaiian Islands."¹³⁶ The favorable nineteenth-century Hawaiian, American, and international published representations of Kalākaua were accurate and synonymous with the person. As an individual and as an image, Kalākaua recast the Polynesian potentate and altered how at least some colonizers gazed at the colonized. During his lifetime, people of the world and in Hawai'i recognized him as a brilliant man, and the responses to his character

encompassed both admiration for him and respect for the kingdom that in important ways he embodied. His iconic recasting of racial identity also made it possible for people to reconsider Hawai‘i as a progressive kingdom. Kalākaua was a deliberate and actual Hawaiian and Victorian mō‘ī.

The 1874 Royal Tour of the Kingdom

If nineteenth-century published materials demonstrate the world’s acceptance of Kalākaua as a dignified noble, Hawaiian-language newspapers’ coverage of his first tour of the kingdom as mō‘ī confirms his own subjects’ aloha for him. Many accounts of Kalākaua’s life claim that his first significant act after his election was to hurry off to Washington, DC, in November of 1874 to lobby for the Reciprocity Treaty. Because he successfully negotiated a treaty that the four previous sovereigns had wrestled with, some critics see this trip as evidence of a pandering to Americans in Hawai‘i that betrayed Hawaiians and their land. In short, Kalākaua’s earliest actions gave people legitimate reasons for detesting him.¹³⁷ However, Hawai‘i’s newspapers, particularly those in the Hawaiian language, provide an alternative, more complete history of the early part of Kalākaua’s reign. In March, April, and May, well before his trip to Washington, the mō‘ī toured Kaua‘i, Hawai‘i, Maui, Moloka‘i, and O‘ahu, meeting with thousands of maka‘āinana, legislators, and influential businessmen. [Chapter 2](#) showed how Kalākaua spent much of his 1881 trip around the world conducting business with government leaders; this section will demonstrate that he acted similarly on his inaugural tour of the kingdom and that from day one he took his responsibilities as mō‘ī seriously, challenging his branding as the Merrie Monarch. The nineteenth-century Hawaiian-language newspapers’ published sentiments regarding King Kalākaua on that tour also counter the genealogy of the king’s misrepresentations outlined in [chapter 1](#). A close look at the reporting of this royal tour reveals that confirming his people’s support was a far more

deliberate and successful goal than has been realized.

The 1874 newspapers that reported on the mōʻī's royal tour were the English-language *Friend*, *PCA*, and *HG* and the Hawaiian-language *Kuokoa*, *Ko Hawaii Ponoī*, and *Nuhou*.¹³⁸ The first of many articles appeared on March 24 in *Kuokoa* and the last on May 13 in *HG*. The English-language press devoted nineteen accounts, or roughly twelve pages, to the tour; the Hawaiian-language newspapers ran twenty-one, or roughly sixteen pages. The publication of forty-one articles confirms that in addition to showing their aloha and loyalty to Kalākaua personally during these visits, the people of Hawaiʻi were very interested in his travels. The Hawaiian newspaper accounts of the loyal, loving, and steadfast kānaka welcome he received in just about every district of the islands also reveal a nationalist conviction that led Hawaiians to support the lāhui's independence by backing their mōʻī, regardless of whether they had supported his candidacy in the contentious election of 1874. Even under Kalākaua, the desire for independence led the people to subordinate their political resentment to their national resolve. Both supporters and nonsupporters of Kalākaua recognized that he represented the kingdom, and while sometimes participation at rallies or events featuring the mōʻī was more about sustaining the nation than adoring the leader, a broad, nationalist sentiment was apparent from the day the mōʻī began his tour.

Leaving Honolulu and Visiting Kaua ' i

Ko Hawaii Ponoī's account of the mōʻī's departure from Honolulu describes the warships' cannons and the cheers of the crowds, concluding: "A o keia mau mea a pau i ikeia, he mau mea e hiki ole ai ke hoopoina koke ia" (And all these things that were seen could not be soon forgotten).¹³⁹ The thousands who sent Kalākaua off that day were pledging their loyalty to the mōʻī, and the salutes, the cannons, and the yardmen standing atop the masts of the ships would be repeated throughout Hawaiʻi, in the United States, and abroad whenever he was welcomed as a mōʻī.

Kalākaua started his tour of the islands with Kauaʻi, the moku (island) of his wife and queen, Kapiʻolani. On March 25, *Ko Hawaii Pono*i wrote about the many lehua trees, ferns, and maile adorning his path in Hanalei. Large words made out of flowers welcomed “Kalakaua ko kakou Moi” (Kalākaua our king) with “Hookahi Puuwai” (one heart).¹⁴⁰ Flowers were prominent throughout the national tour, and drawing on the mele inoa “Eia no Kawika ei hei,”¹⁴¹ John Charlot explains some of this symbolism:

Kalākaua is *ka heke aʻo nā pua* “the highest of the flowers” (l. 2); *ka pua i luna* “the flower above” (l. 7),¹⁴² and “‘O Kalākaua, he inoa” emphasizes his designation as pua (ll. 2f., 11) and links it ... to one of his private names—Kapuamaeʻoleikalā “The Flower that Wilts Not in the Sun.”¹⁴³

Confirming this association, the Hawaiian-language newspapers of the time also referred to Kalākaua as a pua.¹⁴⁴ Makaʻāinana were very generous to their new mōʻī. In Hanalei, he stayed at the home of Representative Kaukaha, where the people brought him large pigs, poultry, fish, fruits, and vegetables. The March 28 edition of *Kuokoa* reported that when it was time to leave, the people followed him onto the beach, hats in hand, cheering.¹⁴⁵ Kalākaua and his retinue then traveled to Waimea. The reception here was quite different. *Ko Hawaii Pono*i claimed that few people greeted the mōʻī, either because they did not support him or because they were kūpuna “no laila aole no paha i kupono loa ia lakou ke hana hoochiehie loa i na ike alii ana” (and fashioning a highly elegant chiefly greeting was perhaps unsuitable for them).¹⁴⁶ For the first time, then, we see that a district apparently did not celebrate their new mōʻī, and in fact, J. Kauai, the Waimea lunamakaʻāinana, had not voted for Kalākaua in the February 12 election.

But *Kuokoa*’s reports are the complete opposite, claiming that the people of Waimea “covered the sands,” showering the mōʻī with gifts, and when it was time for him to leave, the

residents occupied the entire shoreline, kneeling, cheering, singing, and strewing flowers before him.¹⁴⁷ When he approached Kōloa, children dressed in white with red silk sashes at their waists were waiting. Everyone cheered, singers performed a song composed for the mō'ī, and then in unison the people knelt before Kalākaua.¹⁴⁸ From there, nearly one hundred horseback riders accompanied him to Judge Lilikalani's house, where archways covered with flowers welcomed him. When Kalākaua traveled on to Līhue and Nāwiliwili, the *Nuhou* said that another entourage of some one hundred horseback riders stayed with him for the four hours.¹⁴⁹ At 6:00 p.m., when Kalākaua made his way to the skiffs that would convey him to the *Kilauea* for Honolulu, *Nuhou* observed:

I kuuwa mai la ka leo aloha o na makaainana e kaohi mai ana no ia Kalani; e Kalani e; hoi mai no kakou; eia ka ai, eia ka hale, eia ke kapa; e aloha auanei e.¹⁵⁰

(The loving voice of the people resounded in an attempt to detain the Royal One; o Royal One; come back to us; here is food, here is shelter, here is kapa; here is love.)

This kind of farewell demonstrated the people's aloha for their new mō'ī, and as the *Kilauea* sailed out of Nāwiliwili Harbor, some people made their way on horseback into the water to bid Kalākaua farewell while others mounted on horses crowded the cliffside.¹⁵¹

When Kalākaua arrived back at Māmala harbor in Honolulu, twenty-one-gun salutes roared from the cannons of Pūowaina (Punchbowl), greetings came from the ships in the harbor, and hurrahs from those gathered at the pier welcomed him home. The mō'ī shook the people's hands,¹⁵² and sailors again climbed atop the yards of the warships.¹⁵³

Lahaina, Maui, and on to Hawai'i

On March 30, Kalākaua departed Honolulu for Hawai'i Island

via Lahaina, Maui. The April 8 edition of *Ko Hawaii Pono* remarked that the Honolulu wharf was filled with more people than when he had left for Kauaʻi, indicating perhaps that news of his tour had reached readers.¹⁵⁴ Though the stops on Maui were very brief, Lahaina and Kāʻanapali were not to be outdone in their greeting of the new mōʻī. Well before Kalākaua arrived, the governor had formed nineteen welcoming committees and ordered three hundred bright lights from Honolulu. *Kuokoa* noted that such a display was a first for Lahaina and could probably never be duplicated.¹⁵⁵ According to *Ko Hawaii Pono*, bonfires were lit atop the precipices for eight miles, and the courthouse was illuminated with kukui torches late into the evening.¹⁵⁶ When the *Kilauea* arrived, thirty skiffs with passengers bearing burning torches, fruits, flowers, and other gifts encircled it, while the sugar mills whistled and the church bells tolled: “O ke kiekie loa aku paha ia o ka nani ma ka nana ana i uka i ka aina i ikeia ana keia mau pae aina” (This was perhaps the most beautiful sight seen on the shore of the land in this archipelago).¹⁵⁷ It should be noted that this well-planned and elaborate welcome took place at 2:30 a.m. and that Lahaina representative Luther Aholo had actually not voted for Kalākaua in the election. This welcome therefore confirms that the people’s devotion to the lāhui rose above party politics.

The first installment of *Ko Hawaii Pono*’s account of the *Kilauea*’s journey from Makena, Maui, to Kawaihae on Hawaiʻi Island across the ʻAlenuihāhā Channel was filled with the names of people, places, and winds—details not found in the *PCA* or the *HG*. This visit was perhaps the most important on Kalākaua’s tour because Hawaiʻi was the home of the famous Emmaites and lunamakaʻāinana Joseph Nāwahī and G. W. Pilipō as well as the Keaweāheulu line, from which Kalākaua descended. It is believed that Kamehameha I gave the lands of Ponahawai to Keaweāheulu, a beloved and loyal chief.¹⁵⁸ Famously not a Kamehameha, Kalākaua needed to gain credibility and forge alliances, in part by honoring Kamehameha I. As the mōʻī made his way to Hilo via

Kawaihae, North Kohala, and the Hāmākua coastline, kânaka and haole alike offered their aloha. When the *Kilauea* sailed past the precipices Kaluaokau, Hamaui, Pa‘auilo, Maunahō‘ano, Waipunalau, Koholālele, and Kukā‘iau in southeastern Hāmākua, keiki crowded the cliff tops and “ike mai la i ka hae kalaunu a huro mai la” (cheered when they saw the royal flag). The *Kilauea* sounded its whistle to them, and the mō‘ī waved his handkerchief. In Laupāhoehoe, women and children crowded the seashore, offering bounties of seafood. When Kalākaua arrived in Hilo around noon, *Nuhou* reported that “aia na makaainana ke puuluulu mai la” (the people were packed solid there),¹⁵⁹ cheering lustily with torches. Newspaper accounts of the tour frequently mention these burning torches during the day. These were hō‘ailona because, as George S. Kanahele explains, Kalākaua’s ancestor, Iwikauikaua, used them on state occasions to assert his right to the throne:

This ceremonial rite was a spectacular custom that evoked the traditional pageantry and awe of Hawaiian royalty, even under a constitutional monarchy. The flaming torch served as authentication of ancient Hawaiian authority and as a dramatic practice for a king of the modern era.¹⁶⁰

Kuokoa mentions that among those on the beach were Emma’s supporters. Though unhappy, they were there, adding to the numbers and asserting national unity.¹⁶¹ The mō‘ī was then received in the home of Thomas Po‘onāhoahoa Spencer. So many visitors came to see him there, *Nuhou* reported, that some people climbed on top of the fences, the trees, and the rooftops.¹⁶² That evening, Kalākaua was treated to hula performances. Every island honored him with hula, and throughout his reign, he would famously encourage its performance to celebrate Hawaiian culture.

On the next day of the royal tour, Kalākaua gave a speech at the Haili Church. Afterward, the courthouse was opened, and the people came in crowds to greet the king and offer

him their gifts. *Kuokoa* said that “aole kekahi mea hele wale mai” (no one came empty-handed).¹⁶³ *Nuhou* reported that 397 people shook hands with the king and that the total number on-site was 3,000. Before Kalākaua departed, *Nuhou* observed, “Hookahi mea ano nui loa, i na makaainana o Hilo, oia ko lakou aua ana i ka Moi e noho loa i Hilo” (One very important thing to the people of Hilo was namely their detaining the king to remain longer in Hilo).¹⁶⁴

From Hilo, Kalākaua traveled south to Ka’ū, where support for him was over-whelming. On a road in Wai’ōhinu, people had erected beautiful arches. So many came to the church to hear the king speak that the speech was moved outdoors to accommodate everyone.¹⁶⁵ After Ka’ū, Kalākaua and his retinue made their way to Kauhakō, in Ho’okena, where people stood on the beach twirling their hats, cheering, and offering gifts. The *Kilauea* made its way on to Kaiakeakua via Kalae, Kā’iliki’i, Molilele, Honomalino, Miloli’i, ‘O’opulua, Kīpāhoehoe, Pāhoehoe, and Kukui’ōpa’e. Once the king arrived at Kaiakeakua, the beach that fronts Hulihe’e Palace, thirty familiar burning torches welcomed him.¹⁶⁶ The *PCA* said that once the *Kilauea* was offshore Kalākaua entered a canoe, and the people dragged it over the shore.¹⁶⁷

On his next stop, in Kawaihae, Kalākaua was again welcomed with sounds resembling the cannons of Pūowaina, a noise that maka’āinana throughout the archipelago mimicked in different ways.¹⁶⁸ On the wharf were men with wooden swords in red coats and black trousers, atop horses in formation. *Nuhou* reported, “Ma ka auolo o ka uapo he mau huaolelo, ‘Hookahi Puuwai’; me na lalani hua haole, ‘Long Life and Happiness’—aia loihi me ka pomaikai—me keia kekahi, ‘Peace and Plenty’” (The words “One Heart” were arranged on a shed on the wharf with the English lines “Long Life and Happiness”—long life and good fortune—with this as well, “Peace and Plenty”). The residents of Kawaihae untied the horses from the carriage and pulled Kalākaua themselves to Samuel Parker’s home. Beautifully crafted arches also awaited the mō’ī there. *Nuhou* added that a choir, dressed in white clothing with red sashes, sang “Hymn to

Kamehameha I.”¹⁶⁹ After a lavish meal and a chance to relax, thanks to the generosity of Parker, the mō‘ī bid farewell to his beloved subjects. In this case, the *PCA* perhaps stated it best: “Wherever His Majesty went on the large and important Island of Hawaii, He was met by His subjects, both foreign and native, with lively and heartfelt demonstrations of devotion and loyalty.”¹⁷⁰

Return to Maui and on to Moloka ‘ i

At sunset on April 7, Kalākaua and his retinue landed at Makena and were welcomed by the king’s good friend, Captain James McKee, at ‘Ulupalakua at around ten that evening. The *PCA* reported that about eighty torchbearers accompanied the retinue up to ‘Ulupalakua,¹⁷¹ while the *Nuhou* claimed the plains glowed brightly with two hundred Hawaiian candlenut torches.¹⁷² The lavish McKee home was alive with visitors paying tribute to Kalākaua and enjoying the hula, banquets, and even billiards. Later, maka‘āinana from Waiohuli and Kēōkea arrived on horseback carrying the Hawaiian flag.¹⁷³ Waiohuli is more than six miles from ‘Ulupalakua, and Kēōkea is about four miles away.

The next day Kalākaua traveled from ‘Ulupalakua to Waikapū via Wailuku, where more beautifully adorned arches greeted him.¹⁷⁴ The *PCA* describes the progress this way:

There were over a hundred horsemen in the train at the start. The distance from Ulupalakua to Wailuku in a straight line, is said to be 20 miles.... At this point a deputation was met from Wailuku, consisting of over a hundred horsemen. These opened to the right and left, cheering the Royal party as it passed through, and then brought up in the rear, the cavalcade now consisting of some 300 horsemen.¹⁷⁵

*Ko Hawaii Pono*i added that maka‘āinana had gifts for the ali‘i, and “ua muimuia ae la na kanaka ma ke alanui a maloko

iho o ka pa me na iini ana e kilohi aku i na helehelenā o ka lakou mea i kau nui ai e ike” (the people were assembled together along the road to Waikapū and in their yards in hopes of gazing upon the features of the one they wished to see).¹⁷⁶ Once in Waikapū, Kalākaua met with the reception committee of the Wai‘ehā lands, who followed the pattern of wanting him to stay longer. A mānele, or special carrier, *Kuokoa* reported, was ready to convey the mō‘ī from Waikapū “i mea hookelakela oi loa ae i ko na apana e” (in order to put on a greater display than those of other places).

In Wailuku, Kalākaua spoke at the Temperance Union, where, according to *Kuokoa*, “O ka hele mai la no ia o na makaainana e hookeke a wawahi maoli mai no paha kahi poe i na puka aniani, no ke ake nui no e ike alii mai kuaaina” (The people crowded in, and some broke the windows on purpose in the eagerness of the country folks to see the chiefs).¹⁷⁷ On April 13 of his royal tour, Kalākaua made his way to Lahaina to speak at the courthouse. Before he could enter, though, maka‘āinana welcomed him at the door.¹⁷⁸ In his speech, he provides his clearest justification for his initial royal tour:

The principal object which I have had in view in making this journey among my people, is that we may all be incited to renewed exertions for the advancement and prosperity of our nation, the extinction of which has been prophesied. Figures of the census have been published to show that we are a dying race. But shall we sit still, and indolently see the structure erected by our fathers fall to pieces without lifting a hand to stay the work of destruction? If the house is dilapidated, let us repair it.¹⁷⁹

The *PCA* reporter writes: “Many of the old men and women present wept audibly, and he was frequently interrupted with enthusiastic applause during the course of his remarks.”¹⁸⁰ As for the *Nuhou* correspondent, he was overwhelmed by Kalākaua’s rhetoric:

He keu ia a ka Haiolelo nani loa, a ua piha pono na puuwai i ka hauoli. Aohe haiolelo ana a ka Moi i ike ia ka maikai e like me ia; a no ka lilo loa o ko'u manao i kamaikai o kona mau kalai manao ana, aole hiki ia'u ke hoomanao a kakau la hoi ma ka'u puke hoomanao.

(It was a most beautiful speech, filling hearts with joy. No other speech of the king's was seen to be as fine as it; and because my thoughts were so completely absorbed in the excellent way he expressed his thoughts, I am unable to recall and record it in my journal.)

These comments echo many others about Kalākaua's public eloquence. He was a remarkable speaker—noble and highly intelligent—although the English-language press and other publications that opposed him rarely acknowledged these qualities. He left Lahaina at four in the morning, “me ka poai puni ana a na lama kukui a na keiki o ka malu ulu” (completely surrounded by the illuminated torches of the children of the sheltered grove [Lahaina's poetical name]),¹⁸¹ and the *Kilauea* made its way to Moloka'i. In September, Kalākaua would return to Maui to visit Hāna.¹⁸²

The mō'i's visit to Moloka'i was brief. He stopped at Pūko'o and spoke to the hundreds of people gathered there. They applauded and offered their ho'okupu. Because Honolulu was expecting the retinue at 10:00 p.m., the mō'i then went to Kalaupapa, the settlement for those afflicted with leprosy.¹⁸³ Kalākaua landed at the beach there at 12:30, and *Kuokoa* noted that the two hundred to three hundred Hawaiians who had gathered there “ua hoihoi mai lakou i ka pane no ia olelo me na olioli a me na huro i ka ike Moi ana” (responded with pleasure, joy, and cheers at seeing him).¹⁸⁴ In his speech, he said that “his heart was grieved at the necessity which had separated these subjects from their homes and families.”¹⁸⁵ Meeting briefly with the patients after his speech, he listened to their troubles, including the dreaded spread of influenza.¹⁸⁶ *Nuhou* later reported that

Kalākaua allowed, with the doctors' approval, the return of 114 residents to their homes, away from Kalaupapa.¹⁸⁷ Of his own visit to the settlement, the *PCA* correspondent recalled, "We had passed through an experience that was painful and saddening; witnessed scenes of human misery that we shall never forget; and although nothing short of actual duty will tempt us to make another visit to Kalawao, we are far from regretting that we undertook the trip."¹⁸⁸ After bidding aloha to his subjects there, Kalākaua made his way to O'ahu.

Return to Honolulu

Kalākaua's return to Honolulu was one of the most exciting segments of his entire tour of the kingdom—the perfect finale to the displays offered by the people on the various islands. "Aole i ikeia kekahi hoohanohano ano nui launa ole e like me keia, a aole no paha he like e hiki mai ana" (Such a great honor as this was never seen before, and perhaps it will never be seen in the future again), *Kuokoa* reported.¹⁸⁹ The pageantry, the lights, and the sheer numbers of maka'āinana who greeted the mō'i testified not only to the ingenuity, organization, and hard work of Honolulu's residents but to their aloha and hopes for a thriving lāhui.¹⁹⁰ Like most of its stories of the 1874 tour, the *HG* report about the return is brief: "The population of the city turned out *en masse* to receive the royal party."¹⁹¹ Most of the *HG*'s stories of the 1874 tour of the kingdom are similarly brief. On April 18, the *PCA* acknowledged the fireworks and bonfires.¹⁹² But the Hawaiian-language newspapers give detailed and impressive accounts. *Kuokoa* reported that the first bonfire the *Kilauea* saw, around eight in the evening, was at Kawaihoa, beyond present-day Portlock.¹⁹³ The fire lighters sent seven rockets sailing through the air, with fires atop 'Thi'ihilauākea. Fires also crowned the summits of Kohelepelepe and Niu, and Kaimukī's own fire lit up the sky: "Mawaho ae o Laeahi; oili pulelo ke ahi i ka malie, e aloha mai ana o Leahī 'aloha oe e Kalakaua, e kaukeha mai ana ka puu o Ualakaa me kona

punohu ahi.”¹⁹⁴ (Outside of Lae’ahi a fire rose up in the calm, and Lē’ahi acknowledged, “Greetings to you, Kalākaua.” The precipice of ‘Ualaka’a was resting high above with its rising fire.) Even the shores of Kāhala were ablaze; the *PCA* reported that ten bonfires were set from Koko Head to Lē’ahi, with more on the beaches from Waikīkī to Kewalo.¹⁹⁵ These fires and rockets combined old and new symbols of reverence for the mō’ī. As Charlot explains: “Kapu privilege is, in fact, another theme of the Kalākaua movement [which] combined the traditional Hawaiian elements with foreign ones, such as fireworks and torchlight parades then used in U.S. political campaigns.”¹⁹⁶ Those aboard the *Kilauea*, *Kuokoa* reported, “e pioo ana, a he mahalo wale aku no” (were excited and full of admiration).¹⁹⁷ It took three hours for the mō’ī to pass by these stunning fires on the precipices and shores of the beaches. Everyone in Honolulu lifted their eyes to these emblems of Kalākaua’s majesty. On the edges of Pūowaina were fires and rockets and letters lit with fire spelling out “The King.”¹⁹⁸ The lights decorating Kawaiaha’o’s steeple were like a lei adorning the church: “He hana i hoohiluhilu ole ia i na Aliiaimoku nana i kapili, a eia ka i ka moopuna a Keaweheulu e kahiko pihaia ai ka Halelaa. Ua hiki!” (This was never before done for the rulers who built it, but for the descendant of Keawe-a-Heulu, this sacred edifice became fully adorned. So let it be!)¹⁹⁹ As for the noise, *Nuhou* reported: “Lohe pono ole ia aku ke kani o na pu o Puowaina i kau a mea he ikuwa o na leo kanaka me ke pahupahu o na mea kani. Hele a hewa i ka wai ua mea he kanaka.” (The cannons of Puōwaina could not be heard because of the clamor of voices and popping of fireworks. One could drown amid the people.)²⁰⁰ At ‘Āinahou, Hawaiians, haole, and Chinese congregated to welcome “ko lakou Moi ike makaainana” (their king who recognizes the common people).²⁰¹ With this remark, *Kuokoa* touched on something now recognized—that Kalākaua was a people’s mō’ī. Maka’āinana approached, spoke to, and shook hands with Kalākaua throughout his tour, leading the *PCA* to note:

His Majesty ... has visited in their homes and spoken in person to the great majority of his subjects from Kau to Kauai.... Not only are King and people made better acquainted with each other, but ... the nation may be aroused to new life and activity in the work of self preservation and recuperation.²⁰²

When the *Kilauea* arrived in Honolulu Harbor and the people prepared to take Kalākaua to 'Iolani Palace, both *Kuokoa* and *Nuhou* reported that the maka'āinana offered two modes of travel: the children would pull a carriage, or people would carry a mānele (sedan chair) on their shoulders. Kalākaua chose the carriage; Kamaka'eha (Lili'uokalani) and Governor Dominis rode in the mānele.²⁰³ Upon the mō'ī's entering 'Iolani Palace, Hawaiian men and women prostrated themselves while "E kuku mai ana na pake me na ipukukui pake" (the Chinese were standing there with Chinese lanterns). *Kuokoa* pointedly concludes this report by underscoring the people's desire to preserve the nation's independence: "Ke hoike mai nei keia hana, ua lokahi ka lahui no Kalakaua. Ina pela e pau ka opukekeue, nonohua, a e noho me ka naau aloha alii." (This proves that the people are united in favor of Kalakaua. If so, stop all resentments and live with loving hearts toward the chiefs.)²⁰⁴

O'ahu

The mō'ī then traveled around O'ahu, and the newspapers covered parts of this tour. The *HG* first announced Kalākaua's departure from Honolulu via Kaluakahu'a.²⁰⁵ A letter to *Ko Hawaii Ponoī* from a Waimānalo resident noted: "Ua hoohiwahiwa ia ke alanui hele me na huaolelo—'Aloha ka Moi'" (A pathway was decorated with the words "Beloved King"). The *PCA* observed that "mottoes and words of greeting printed on placards were posted on the rocks and scattered along the road from Makapuu to [Cummins'] Ranch."²⁰⁶ Beautiful arches appeared along the road and so did two men in red suits and masks upon black horses,

bearing the torches of Iwikauikaua: “Here the entire premises and grounds were lighted up with lamps and torches, although it was midday, making a striking scene, and paying a significant compliment to the traditional history of His Majesty’s family.”²⁰⁷ In an area called Kukui, “he Pio Lehua e ku ana, me na huaolelo ‘Hele mai ka Moi Kalakaua, ua ola Hawaii’” (here was an arch made of lehua with the words, “Come King Kalakaua, Hawaii thrives”). When Kalākaua walked through another archway, all the people prostrated themselves. The humble people of Waimānalo did not shake hands with the mō‘ī, greeting him with a bow of the head, since “ua menemene lakou i na lima o Kalani Moi” (they revered the hands of the royal king).²⁰⁸ About thirty members of Kalākaua’s retinue dined there with the Honorable John Adams Cummins, a wealthy sugar plantation owner, rancher, nobleman, and relative to Kalākaua.²⁰⁹ Children sang three mele, and maka‘āinana presented their ho‘okupu (gifts) to the mō‘ī.

Kalākaua then made his way to Maunawili, to the home of Major Edward H. Boyd, where another beautifully adorned archway greeted him.²¹⁰ Following dinner, bonfires blazed atop Ahiki and Pāku‘i, two of the three summits of Olomana, and firebrands sailed through the air as dancers and chanters performed hula. In Kāne‘ohe the entourage increased to 150. Together, they traveled to He‘eia, Ka‘alaea, and Kualoa, where the mō‘ī stopped to dine with Charles H. Judd. Kalākaua also spoke to the residents of Kahana, and the *PCA* reported that “the people were much affected when His Majesty asked—‘Is this all there are left of you?’”²¹¹ This account is important. No other newspaper recorded Kalākaua’s heartbreak when he gazed at the handful of people who had survived disease and the tide of Westernization.

At Punalu‘u, many wealthy Chinese rice farmers hosted a dinner in Kalākaua’s honor. Here, twenty-one bombs replaced the twenty-one-gun salute, as a stream of fireworks burst through the air. He then proceeded to Hau‘ula and Lā‘ie. *Kuokoa* noted that along the way, “Ma ia po iho, ua

owela na pali i na ahi i ho-a ia, he hoike ana ia i ke aloha alii” (That night, the hills [of Ko’olauloa] glowed with lighted bonfires, expressions of affection for the chief).²¹² In Lā’ie, two hundred to three hundred Native Latter-day Saints heard the mō’ī’s speech. Then on to Kahuku and Waialua, where maka’āinana from as far as ‘Ewa and Wai’anae filled the church to listen to the mō’ī. The retinue then passed through Mānana and Moanalua, eventually arriving back in Honolulu, where the *PCA* reported that “King street, throughout its length up to the Palace gates, was crowded with people, who welcomed their Majesties back to the capital with cheers.”²¹³ That evening there was a masquerade ball, followed by a fine supper and dancing at the palace. Later in May, Kalākaua visited Wai’anae, as well as Ko’olaupoko in August, completing his royal tour.²¹⁴

Accompanied night and day by kukui candlenut torches, Kalākaua had become a symbol of hope and light for maka’āinana. While the tour did reveal that a small percentage of maka’āinana outside of Honolulu did not care for their new mō’ī, the aloha throughout Hawai’i showed a widespread acceptance and support of Kalākaua. As the *PCA* put it:

In systematic thoroughness [the royal progress] has never been equaled by any of our Kings, since the first Kamehameha. Occasionally, during their several reigns, His Majesty’s predecessors have made short visits to particular portions of their dominions, but there were many localities that had never been honored by the presence of the Sovereign until now.²¹⁵

The tour also showcased the ingenuity and fervor of his Hawaiian subjects as they organized, constructed, and decorated the ornate displays of welcome. Think about ascending the many high peaks carrying everything needed for those massive bonfires. Together, these gestures formed a nationalist maka’āinana alliance that was critical at the time. When Kalākaua ascended the throne in 1874,

Hawaiians were confronting a diminished population, a decline in the language,²¹⁶ an anticipated loss of Pearl River to the United States that would endanger their independence, and extensive land losses to haole sugar planters. Through his physical presence in each district on each island, Kalākaua was a symbol of hope, change, and independence that enlivened Hawaiians at a precarious time. The lengthier newspaper accounts of this tour also provide insight into nineteenth-century makaʻāinana political discourse. The people were using the tour and the newspaper coverage of it to unite themselves as a lāhui. Hawaiians loved and praised their new mōʻī. Though they did not all follow the example of Waimānalo, where people treated him as akua, or a deity, withholding their hands so as not to taint him, Hawaiians everywhere were clearly eager and anxious to see Kalākaua. Who can forget those of Kēōkea and Waiohuli, who impressed the mōʻī by journeying from their homes so far away; or the children of the Hāmākua coast, who climbed the precipices to catch a glimpse of the mōʻī as he sailed by on the *Kilauea*; or those of Lahaina who prepared an eight-mile stretch of bonfires along the shores and summits and lighted torches to welcome Kalākaua at 2:30 a.m.; or the hundreds of people of Kōloa who rode their horses for eight hours to accompany him when he departed from their town? Nor were the mōʻī kapu forgotten. Hawaiians everywhere participated in the burning of torches at midday or performing the kapu moe. People of all ages and races honored Kalākaua, and through the newspaper accounts, Hawaiians from different islands could learn where he had been and become inspired to top another island's displays or to invent entirely new ways of welcoming the mōʻī to their moku. All these acts and reports forged a unity among makaʻāinana, not just out of their love for the mōʻī but for what he represented—the entire lāhui. The role of the newspaper articles in creating this shared understanding cannot be overstated, and the Hawaiian-language newspapers offer far more details about the tour, including makaʻāinana receptions, banquets, balls, hula, children's choir performances, light and firework

shows, and flowers to honor Kalākaua. The Hawaiian readership clearly wanted to know what Kalākaua was doing during his tour. Who greeted and accompanied him? How many people attended? And how could their own displays of welcome outdo earlier tributes?²¹⁷

A particular benefit of the tour is that the Hawaiian-language newspaper articles often contain important nineteenth-century place names we may have forgotten. At the end of the mō'i's progress through the kingdom, *Kuokoa* printed songs that the students of Lahainaluna Kulanui had written and sung for him when he visited Lahainalalo. The first verse and chorus of the first mele went as follows:

O Kalakaua no ka Moi	(Kalākaua the king
O ke Aupuni Hawaii	Of the Hawaiian Kingdom
Kahiko nani hoi o ka	A truly beautiful adornment of
Lahui	the nation
Mai Hawaii hoi a Niihau.	From Hawai'i to Ni'ihau.
A he pua oe, no ka Lahui	You are a flower, for the
	nation
He makua hoi no makou	A father for us
A he lei nani, no makou	A beautiful garland, for us
No kou mau makaainana	For all of your subjects.)
a pau. ²¹⁸	

Though composed for the “pua for the nation,” Kalākaua, this mele echoed the aloha of the maka'āinana throughout the tour; united the entire aupuni under its new leader; instilled hope in the future leaders of Hawai'i; and finally, by its publication, serves as an example of how maka'āinana used the newspapers to offer their aloha to their mō'i and to the entire lāhui.

How Hawai'i Celebrated Kalākaua's Birthday, November 16, 1874

On November 16, 1874, Kalākaua turned thirty-eight, and the people of Hawai'i celebrated his birthday. While those in

Honolulu gathered in congregations, Līhu'e spared no expense and effort in honoring Kalākaua on his first birthday as mō'ī, illuminating the precipices and firing cannons in the name of Kauliluaikēanuwaialeale.²¹⁹ In Waimea, Hawai'i, the citizens rejoiced in song under the direction of Father Lyons at 'Imiola.²²⁰ A week later, the Reverend Joel H. Mahoe listed the generous deeds that the mō'ī would perform, including traveling to a foreign land to secure the nation's prosperity:

A ua ku ae la keia i Kapena no ka moku aupuni Hawaii; oia hoi i hookele no ka lahui Hawaii—a ua kohuia ma ia kulana, no ka mea, he Moi naauao. He aloha i kona lahui, he 'lii aloha makaainana. Ua kaapuni iho nei oia i na mokupuni o Hawaii nei, he hoike ia o kona aloha lahui, he hele e nana i kona poe makaainana, me ka puuwai piha i ke aloha makaainana.²²¹

(He stood as the captain for the vessel of the Hawaiian nation—that is as a guide for the Hawaiian nation—and was chosen for this position because he is a wise monarch. He loves his nation, and he loved the people. He recently toured the islands of Hawai'i. It is evidence of his love for his nation, a journey to see his people with a heart full of love for the populace.)

Plans for Kalākaua's visit to Washington, DC, had already been set,²²² so he requested that the lāhui unite on his birthday in thanksgiving, acknowledging the Lord for blessing the Hawaiian Kingdom. Kalākaua himself visited three separate congregations—the temporary cathedral at Saint Andrew's, Our Lady of Peace, and Kawaiaha'o—to seek his blessing side by side with his people.²²³ He also asked them to petition the Lord to protect him while in the United States.²²⁴ Maka'āinana composed many mele in honor of Kalākaua's trip, symbols of their aloha and honor of him and hope for a safe return.

The last Hawaiian monarchs who had traveled abroad, Liholiho and Kamāmalu, had gone to England in 1824 to

discuss a protective alliance with George IV. Within a month of their arrival, the two mō'ī succumbed to measles. It is most likely that Kalākaua had this on his mind when he set out the day after his birthday, accompanied by governors Dominis and Kapena and Minister Peirce, to visit Washington, DC. There was great uncertainty. Would the mō'ī survive this lengthy journey? It is also likely that maka'āinana wondered what would become of their nation after the Reciprocity Treaty was passed. In response, Kalākaua charged all Hawai'i to come together, and the newspapers became a primary vehicle for fostering Native solidarity during the earliest days of the mō'ī's reign.²²⁵ The Hawaiian-language newspapers and other nineteenth-century publications also provide a more nuanced representation of David Kalākaua—assiduous, attentive, methodical, innovative, competent, seasoned, and prepared.

Notes

- ^{1.} R. H. Allen, "Some Observations," 7.
- ^{2.} Kassel, *Hawaiian Missionaries*, 15.
- ^{3.} Silva, *Power of the Steel-Tipped Pen*, 14.
- ^{4.} Reinecke, *Language and Dialect*, 28; Nogelmeier, *Mai Pa'a*, 75.
- ^{5.} Mo'okini, *Hawaiian Newspapers*, xiv.
- ^{6.} Chapin, *Shaping History*, 77.
- ^{7.} Nogelmeier, *Mai Pa'a*, 81; "Telling the Whole Story," 4.
- ^{8.} Chapin, *Shaping History*, 57, 66.
- ^{9.} See Halualani, *In the Name of Hawaiians*, xvi; Nogelmeier, *Mai Pa'a*, xii.
- ^{10.} Nogelmeier, *Mai Pa'a*, xii-xiii.
- ^{11.} See Nogelmeier, *Na Mele Aimoku*, xi.
- ^{12.} Ibid.
- ^{13.} See ho'omanawanui, "Hā, Mana, Leo," 86-91; Silva, *Aloha Betrayed*; University of Hawai'i Sea Grant College Program, "Hawaiian Language Newspaper Translation Project"; ho'omanawanui, *Voices of Fire*, xxvii; Brown, *Facing the Spears of Change*.
- ^{14.} Nogelmeier, *Mai Pa'a*, xii.
- ^{15.} For this and other pertinent numbers in this section, see Mo'okini, *Hawaiian Newspapers*, 43-44.
- ^{16.} See *ibid.*
- ^{17.} Ibid., x.
- ^{18.} "Na Lii Komo i ka Ahaolelo," *Nonanona*, August 6, 1844, 45, Ulukau; "Hale Ahaolelo," *Hae Hawaii*, September 5, 1860, 98, Ulukau.

- [19.](#) "Rula o ka Poe Maikai," *Hoku o ka Pakipika*, October 3, 1861, 2, Ulukau; "Hele Kaapuni," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, March 30, 1865, 2, Ulukau; "Na Mea Hou o ke Alo Alii," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, June 8, 1865, 2, Ulukau; "Hoiike Kula Sabati," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, June 22, 1865, 2, Ulukau.
- [20.](#) "E na Keiki Papa o Hawaii Nei," *Hoku o ka Pakipika*, September 26, 1861, 2, Ulukau.
- [21.](#) Dudoit, "Against Extinction," 226-248, 229.
- [22.](#) Silva, *Power of the Steel-Tipped Pen*, 33-34.
- [23.](#) "E na Keiki," *Hoku o ka Pakipika*, September 26, 1861, 2.
- [24.](#) "Kahi Mele," *Hoku o ka Pakipika*, September 26, 1861, 4, Ulukau.
- [25.](#) Silva, *Aloha Betrayed*, 88.
- [26.](#) Ibid., 67-70.
- [27.](#) See "He Olelo Ao," *Hoku o ka Pakipika*, January 2, 1862, 4, Ulukau.
- [28.](#) See "He Inoa no Kauikeauoli," *Hoku o ka Pakipika*, October 3, 1861, 4; "He Mele no ka Haku o Hawaii," *Hoku o ka Pakipika*, January 2, 1862, 4, Ulukau; "He Inoa no Kunuiakea," *Hoku o ka Pakipika*, January 2, 1862, 4, Ulukau; "He Inoa no Kauikeauoli," May 1, 1862, 4, Ulukau.
- [29.](#) Hawaiian Manuscript Collection, storage case 4, *Kalakaua: Legend, History & Mele*; "Makali'i: An Eclectic Array: Hawaiian Nationalist Press," *Ka'iwakīlōumoku: Hawaiian Cultural Center*.
- [30.](#) Silva, *Aloha Betrayed*, 79.
- [31.](#) Mo'okini, *Hawaiian Newspapers*, x.
- [32.](#) *Ke Alaula* (Dayspring), a children's journal by the ABCFM, was also published in 1870.
- [33.](#) "He Manao Akea," *Manawa*, November 7, 1870, 1.
- [34.](#) "Ka Hae Hawaii! Ke Koo o Hawaii!," *Koo o Hawaii*, August 15, 1883, 6, Ulukau.
- [35.](#) "The Hawaiian Flag! 1883. The Hawaiian Flag! The Support of Hawaii!!," August 15, 2015, *Nupepa-hawaii* (blog).
- [36.](#) "Ko Makou Kahua," *Koo o Hawaii*, August 15, 1883, 8, Ulukau.
- [37.](#) Chapin, *Shaping History*, 61.
- [38.](#) Ibid., 59.
- [39.](#) "Review of the Legislative Session," *PCA*, July 4, 1868, 2, *Chronicling America*.
- [40.](#) On February 25, 1843, British lord George Paulet seized control of Hawai'i. On July 31, 1843, British admiral Richard Thomas restored Hawai'i to Kauikeauoli Kamehameha III. A large celebration was held, where Kauikeauoli proclaimed, "Ua mau ke ea o ka aina i ka pono."
- [41.](#) "Hunahuna Mea Hou o Hawaii Nei," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, July 22, 1865, 2, Ulukau.
- [42.](#) "Restoration Day," *PCA*, August 5, 1865, 2, *Chronicling America*.
- [43.](#) "Ua Loaa mai na Palapala," *Ke Au Okoa*, July 24, 1865, 3, Ulukau; "Ua Loaa mai na Palapala," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, July 29, 1865, 3, Ulukau.
- [44.](#) "Death of the Heir Apparent," *PCA*, June 2, 1866, 2, *Chronicling America*.
- [45.](#) "Legislative Assembly Session of 1868," *PCA*, May 30, 1868, 1, *Chronicling America*; "Review of the Legislative Session," *PCA*, July 4, 1868, 2, *Chronicling America*.

- [46.](#) Ibid.
- [47.](#) "Koho ana i na Luna Nui o ka Oihana Kinaiahi," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, June 8, 1865, 3, Ulukau; "Notes of the Week: Firemen's Elections," *PCA*, July 9, 1870, 3, Chronicling America.
- [48.](#) "Ka Makemake Lahui," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, February 7, 1874, 2; "A Political Meeting," *Nuhou Hawaii*, February 10, 1874, 8; "Mass Meeting," *Nuhou Hawaii*, February 10, 1874, 8; "Ma ke Awakea," *Ko Hawaii Pono*, February 11, 1874, 2; "Halawai Makaainana o ka Apana o Hanalei," *Ko Hawaii Pono*, February 11, 1874, 3; "Mass Meeting," *HG*, February 11, 1874, 2, Chronicling America.
- [49.](#) Here are some of those articles: "The Popular Wish," *HG*, February 4, 1874, 2; "I Moi no ko Hawaii Pae Aina ke Keiki Alii," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, February 7, 1874, 2; "Ka Makemake Lahui," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, February 7, 1874, 2; "Ka Halawai Nui," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, February 7, 1874, 2; "Ua Make Alii, E Ola ke Alii," *Nuhou Hawaii*, February 10, 1874, 1; "I Moi no Hawaii," *Nuhou Hawaii*, February 10, 1874, 1; "Heaha ka Hope," *Nuhou Hawaii*, February 10, 1874, 1; "Ma ka Halawai," *Nuhou Hawaii*, February 10, 1874, 4; "Ka Lehulehu Hoa Makaainana," *Nuhou Hawaii*, February 10, 1874, 4; "E Ola o Hawaii i ke Akua," *Nuhou Hawaii*, February 10, 1874, 4; "Ka Manaolana o ka Lahui," *Nuhou Hawaii*, February 10, 1874, 5; "Ua Kokua aku kekahi Poe Makamaka," *Nuhou Hawaii*, February 10, 1874, 6; "Le Roi Est Mort, Vive le Roi," *Nuhou Hawaii*, February 10, 1874, 7; "Ma ke Awakea o ka La Apopo e Halawai ana ka Ahaolelo," *Ko Hawaii Pono*, February 11, 1874, 2; "Ekolu Hebedome i Hala aku nei," *Ko Hawaii Pono*, February 11, 1874, 2; "Ma ka Halawai ana o ka Aha Kukamalu," *Ko Hawaii Pono*, February 11, 1874, 2; "Ka Halawai Nui a na Makaainana ma Kawaiahao!," *Ko Hawaii Pono*, February 11, 1874, 2, Ulukau.
- [50.](#) "The Situation," *HG*, February 25, 1874, 2, Chronicling America.
- [51.](#) Dabagh, "King Is Elected," 80; Kuykendall, *Hawaiian Kingdom*, 11.
- [52.](#) "Ke Kipi Kuloko ma Honolulu ma ka La i Koho Moi iho nei! 13 na Lunamakaainana i Manewanewa," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, February 14, 1874, 3, Ulukau; "The Riot at the Court House," *Nuhou Hawaii*, February 17, 1874, 7, Ulukau.
- [53.](#) Dabagh, "King Is Elected," 81.
- [54.](#) "Ke Kipi," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, February 14, 1874, 3, Ulukau.
- [55.](#) Ibid.; "Haunaele," *Ko Hawaii Pono*, February 18, 1874, 2, Ulukau; Robeson, "Riot of the Queenites," 192.
- [56.](#) Ibid.
- [57.](#) "Ke Kipi," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, February 14, 1874, 3, Ulukau. The mob appeared to be "particularly spiteful" toward Moehonua. See Robeson, "Riot of the Queenites," 193.
- [58.](#) "The Riot," *HG*, February 18, 1874, 2, Chronicling America.
- [59.](#) "Ke Kipi," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, February 14, 1874, 3, Ulukau; "Haunaele," *Ko Hawaii Pono*, February 18, 1874, 2, Ulukau; Robeson, "Riot of the Queenites," 193; Dabagh, "King Is Elected," 81; Southerland, "Incidents Connected with the Election," 13.
- [60.](#) Robeson, "Riot of the Queenites," 193.
- [61.](#) "The Riot," *Nuhou Hawaii*, February 17, 1874, 7, Ulukau.
- [62.](#) "No Foreign Armed Intervention Was Needed," *Nuhou Hawaii*, March 10,

1874, 6, Ulukau.

- [63.](#) "Ka Poe Hoohaunaele," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, February 21, 1874, 2, Ulukau.
- [64.](#) Southerland, "Incidents Connected with the Election," 15.
- [65.](#) Kuykendall, *Hawaiian Kingdom*, 10.
- [66.](#) "Police Court," *HG*, March 11, 1874, 2, Chronicling America; "The Riot at the Court House," *Nuhou Hawaii*, February 17, 1874, 7, Ulukau.
- [67.](#) "When the First Gang," *HG*, April 15, 1874, 2, Chronicling America.
- [68.](#) "The Election," *HG*, February 4, 1874, 2, Chronicling America; "A Political Meeting," *Nuhou Hawaii*, February 10, 1874, 8, Ulukau; "Pahukula, or Stevens, is the Especial Advocate," *Nuhou Hawaii*, February 10, 1874, 8, Ulukau.
- [69.](#) "Our Riot," *HG*, February 18, 1874, 2, Chronicling America; Robeson, "Riot of the Queenites," 193-194; Dabagh, "King Is Elected," 84-85.
- [70.](#) Robeson, "Riot of the Queenites," 193-194.
- [71.](#) *Ibid.*, 194.
- [72.](#) See Chapin, *Shaping History*, 75.
- [73.](#) "Our New King," *Friend* (Honolulu), March 18, 1874, 2.
- [74.](#) McGregor-Alegado, "Hawaiian Resistance," 31.
- [75.](#) "King's Speech Opening the Legislative Assembly, 1874," Kapiolani-Kalaniana'ole Collection, MC KC box 2, fol. 3.1.
- [76.](#) *Ibid.*
- [77.](#) Kame'elehiwa, *Native Land and Foreign Desires*, 314.
- [78.](#) "It Will Be Remembered," *HG*, November 12, 1874, 2, Chronicling America.
- [79.](#) Silverman, "To Marry Again," 73.
- [80.](#) McGregor-Alegado, "Hawaiian Resistance," 28.
- [81.](#) "Nu Hou Hope Loa! Ka Moi Kalakaua ma Iapana! Na Hookipa Hanohano! Ulumahiehie ke Kulanakauhale!," *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, April 30, 1881, 2, Ulukau.
- [82.](#) Kauliluaikeanuwaialeale, "Doubly cold is Wai'ale'ale," is Kalākaua's poetic name, which he received from a mele.
- [83.](#) "Hooulu Lahui," *PCA*, November 14, 1874, 2.
- [84.](#) *Ibid.*
- [85.](#) "Ma Kapuukolo," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, November 21, 1874, 2, Ulukau.
- [86.](#) "Consul Letters," 'Iolani Palace, September 21, 2011, Honolulu.
- [87.](#) See "Items in Walter Channing Wyman Scrapbook," B. P. Bishop Museum.
- [88.](#) Beamer, *No Mākou ka Mana*, 184.
- [89.](#) "Consul Letters," September 21, 2011.
- [90.](#) Greer, "Royal Tourist," 77.
- [91.](#) *Ibid.*, 83.
- [92.](#) "King Kalakaua's Tour: A Talk with His Attorney-General. How the Monarch Has Enjoyed His Trip around the World—The Countries He Has Visited and How He Was Received—How He Will Spend His Time in the United States," *HG*, October 12, 1881, 4, Chronicling America.
- [93.](#) "Consul Letters," September 21, 2011.
- [94.](#) "Consul Letters," May 5, 1874.

- [95.](#) "Consul Letters," May 30, 1876.
- [96.](#) See Hackler, "Palace Portraits," 40.
- [97.](#) Beamer, *No Mākou ka Mana*, 4.
- [98.](#) Vann, "Contesting Cultures."
- [99.](#) "King Kalakaua," *Alnwick Mercury*, July 23, 1881, 2, British Newspaper Archive.
- [100.](#) Maxwell, *Colonial Photography*, 194.
- [101.](#) Ibid., 202.
- [102.](#) Grimshaw and Ravetz, *Visualizing Anthropology*, 3.
- [103.](#) Rony, *Third Eye*, 4-6; Imada, *Aloha America*, 250.
- [104.](#) Maxwell, *Colonial Photography*, 193.
- [105.](#) "Consul Letters," July 13, 1882.
- [106.](#) Abramson, *Photographers of Old Hawaii*, 50.
- [107.](#) Ibid.
- [108.](#) Schmitt, "Two Centuries of Eye Care," 137.
- [109.](#) Maxwell, *Colonial Photography*, 208.
- [110.](#) Ibid., 201.
- [111.](#) Montano was married to Mary Jane Fayerweather Davison, a part-Hawaiian woman who maintained close ties to Hawaiian society in Honolulu. His subjects were primarily Hawaiians.
- [112.](#) Abramson, *Photographers of Old Hawaii*, 60.
- [113.](#) Ibid., 75.
- [114.](#) Davis and Foster, *Photographer in the Kingdom*, 31.
- [115.](#) Palmquist and Kailbourn, *Pioneer Photographers*, 538.
- [116.](#) Maxwell, *Colonial Photography*, 193; today, there is a series of Hawaiian royal family photographs, including portraits of Kapi'olani, Kalākaua, and Ka'iulani and photos of Hawai'i, 'Iolani Palace, Haleakalā, the bungalow residence of the mō'i and mō'iwahine, and the home of Archibald Cleghorn and Miriam Likelike, housed in the University of California at Los Angeles' Charles E. Young library. Dating between 1882 and 1889, the photos are said to have once belonged to a well-traveled ambassador, or a high-ranking government official, or a businessman who may have collected them.
- [117.](#) Maxwell, *Colonial Photography*, 198.
- [118.](#) Scherer, "Photographic Document," 35.
- [119.](#) Ibid., 33.
- [120.](#) Maxwell, *Colonial Photography*, 198-199.
- [121.](#) Ibid., 194.
- [122.](#) Kaeppler, "Encounters with Greatness," 267.
- [123.](#) Charlot, *Choris and Kamehameha*.
- [124.](#) For an analysis of Kamehameha II's dress as symbols of royalty and power, see Beamer, *No Mākou ka Mana*, 79.
- [125.](#) Charlot, *Choris and Kamehameha*, 27.
- [126.](#) "King Kalakaua," *Alnwick Mercury*, July 23, 1881, 2, British Newspaper Archive.
- [127.](#) Maxwell, *Colonial Photography*, 203.

- [128.](#) See *ibid.*, 204–207.
- [129.](#) Beamer, *No Mākou ka Mana*, 176.
- [130.](#) See *ibid.*, 182–185.
- [131.](#) But Kalākaua did not only possess the eye and mind to successfully mingle things European and Hawaiian. In his musical compositions, he joined Hawaiian poetry with “the western musical chords, melody, and harmony ... in the somber hymns of the New England missionaries.” *A Tribute to Nā Lani ‘Ehā: Music of the Hawaiian Monarchy*, Tropical Music, 2010, compact disc. And he created compositions “that married the uniquely Hawaiian forms of poetry and folk music with a foreign musical style, and included the newly introduced instruments, the ‘ukulele, piano, autoharp and guitar.” *Ibid.*
- [132.](#) See Imada, *Aloha America*.
- [133.](#) “Na Palapala i ke ‘Kuokoa,” *Nupepa Kuokoa*, December 19, 1874, 2, Ulukau.
- [134.](#) “His Majesty King Kalakaua,” *PCA*, January 22, 1881, 3.
- [135.](#) “From Our Correspondents,” *Friend* (Honolulu), March 1, 1875, 18.
- [136.](#) “Germany,” *London Standard*, August 2, 1881, 5, British Newspaper Archive.
- [137.](#) See Kuykendall, *Hawaiian Kingdom*, 7; Dougherty, *To Steal a Kingdom*, 130.
- [138.](#) The *Friend* published only one article about the tour (see “The King’s Visit to Hanalei, Kauai,” April 1, 1874, 1), and that was taken from the *PCA*’s March 28, 1874, edition.
- [139.](#) “Ka Huakai a ka Moi i Kauai,” *Ko Hawaii Pono*i, March 25, 1874, 3.
- [140.](#) *Ibid.*
- [141.](#) Amy Ku‘uleialoha Stillman notes that two presenters, including S. Kalaimano, presented this same mele under the title “Eia no Davida ka Heke o na Pua” at Kalākaua’s coronation (see “Hawaiian Music for Listening Pleasure: Recordings, Recommendations & Remarks. Songs: Kawika,” *Amykstillman* (blog)).
- [142.](#) Charlot, “Literature of the Kalākaua Dynasty,” 9.
- [143.](#) *Ibid.*, 10.
- [144.](#) “Ka Halawai Nui,” *Ko Hawaii Pono*i, February 11, 1874, 3, Ulukau.
- [145.](#) “Ka Huakai Ike Makaainana a ka Moi ka Lani Kalakaua no ka Mokupuni o Kauai,” *Nupepa Kuokoa*, March 28, 1874, 2, Ulukau; *HEN*, vol. 1, 2878.
- [146.](#) “Ka Huakai,” *Ko Hawaii Pono*i, March 25, 1874, 3.
- [147.](#) “Ka Huakai a Kalani Kalakaua!,” *Nupepa Kuokoa*, April 4, 1874, 2; *HEN*, vol. 1, 2878–2879.
- [148.](#) “Ka Huakai,” *Ko Hawaii Pono*i, March 25, 1874, 3.
- [149.](#) “Ka Huakai a ka Moi Kalakaua i Kauai,” *Nuhou Hawaii*, March 24, 1874, 4; “Ka Huakai Ike,” *Nupepa Kuokoa*, March 28, 1874; “Ka Huakai,” *Ko Hawaii Pono*i, March 25, 1874.
- [150.](#) “Ka Huakai,” *Nuhou Hawaii*, March 24, 1874. Kapa is left in Hawaiian because it was a highly prized, honorary gift offered to chiefs.
- [151.](#) “Ka Huakai,” *Ko Hawaii Pono*i, March 25, 1874.
- [152.](#) “Ka Huakai,” *Nuhou Hawaii*, March 24, 1874.
- [153.](#) “Ka Huakai,” *Ko Hawaii Pono*i, March 25, 1874.

- [154.](#) "Ka Huakai Alii," *Ko Hawaii Pono*i, April 8, 1874, 2, Ulukau; "The Royal Progress," *PCA*, April 18, 1874, 3.
- [155.](#) "Ka Huakai!," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, April 4, 1874, 2; *HEN*, vol. 1, 2887.
- [156.](#) "Ka Huakai," *Ko Hawaii Pono*i, April 8, 1874.
- [157.](#) "Ka Huakai a ka Moi!," *Nuhou Hawaii*, April 14, 1874, 3-5; "Ka Huakai Alii," *Ko Hawaii Pono*i, April 8, 1874.
- [158.](#) Kelly, Nakamura, and Barrere, *Hilo Bay*, 11.
- [159.](#) "Ka Huakai!," *Nuhou Hawaii*, April 14, 1874, 3, Ulukau.
- [160.](#) Kanahale, "Kalākaua and the Renaissance of Hula, 6-27, 13.
- [161.](#) "Ka Huakai a Kalani Kalakaua," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, April 11, 1874, 2, Ulukau.
- [162.](#) "Ka Huakai!," *Nuhou Hawaii*, April 14, 1874, 3.
- [163.](#) "Ka Huakai a Kalani Kalakaua," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, April 11, 1874, 2; *HEN*, vol. 1, 2888.
- [164.](#) "Ka Huakai!," *Nuhou Hawaii*, April 14, 1874, 4.
- [165.](#) "Ka Huakai," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, April 11, 1874, 2; *HEN*, vol. 1, 2889.
- [166.](#) "Ka Huakai," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, April 11, 1874, 2.
- [167.](#) "The Royal Progress," *PCA*, April 11, 1874, 3.
- [168.](#) *HEN*, vol. 1, 2890.
- [169.](#) "Ka Huakai!," *Nuhou Hawaii*, April 14, 1874, 5.
- [170.](#) "The Royal Progress," *PCA*, April 11, 1874, 3.
- [171.](#) "The Royal Progress," *PCA*, April 18, 1874, 3.
- [172.](#) "Ka Huakai a ka Moi!," *Nuhou Hawaii*, April 21, 1874, 3-5, Ulukau.
- [173.](#) "Ka Huakai!," *Nuhou Hawaii*, April 21, 1874, 3, Ulukau.
- [174.](#) "Ka Huakai Alii," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, April 18, 1874, 2; *HEN*, vol. 1, 2887-2901.
- [175.](#) "The Royal Progress," *PCA*, April 18, 1874, 3.
- [176.](#) "Ka Huakai Alii mai ko makou Mea Kakau Manao Kuikawa," *Ko Hawaii Pono*i, May 6, 1874, 4, Ulukau.
- [177.](#) "Ka Huakai Alii," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, April 18, 1874, 2; *HEN*, vol. 1, 2887-2901.
- [178.](#) "Ka Huakai Alii," *Ko Hawaii Pono*i, May 6, 1874, 4.
- [179.](#) "The Royal Progress," *PCA*, April 18, 1874, 3.
- [180.](#) Ibid.
- [181.](#) "Ka Huakai!," *Nuhou Hawaii*, April 21, 1874, 4.
- [182.](#) "Ka Moi ma Hana," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, September 12, 1874, 2.
- [183.](#) "The Royal Progress," *PCA*, April 18, 1874, 3.
- [184.](#) "Ka Huakai Alii," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, April 18, 1874, 2; *HEN*, vol. 1, 2887-2901.
- [185.](#) "The Leper Asylum of Molokai," *PCA*, April 18, 1874, 2. This article also mentions that 675 adults resided at the settlement at the time of the king's visit.
- [186.](#) "Ka Huakai!," *Nuhou Hawaii*, April 21, 1874, 4.
- [187.](#) "Ka Huakai Alii," *Ko Hawaii Pono*i, May 6, 1874, 4.
- [188.](#) "Leper Asylum," *PCA*, April 18, 1874, 2.
- [189.](#) "Ka Hoi ana mai o na Moi!," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, April 18, 1874, 2; *HEN*, vol. 1, 2883.

- [190.](#) P. K. Kuhi shares the mele inoa, "Lamalama i Makapuu ke Ahi o Hilo," which was written in honor of Kalākaua's return. See Pukui, "Aia i Waimānalo," 132-133.
- [191.](#) "Their Majesties the King and Queen," *HG*, April 15, 1874, 2.
- [192.](#) "The Royal Progress," *PCA*, April 18, 1874, 3.
- [193.](#) "Ka Hoi!," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, April 18, 1874, 2; *HEN*, vol. 1, 2881.
- [194.](#) "Ka Huakai!," *Nuhou Hawaii*, April 21, 1874, 4. The names Lē'ahi and Laeahi were used interchangeably.
- [195.](#) "The Royal Progress," *PCA*, April 18, 1874, 3.
- [196.](#) Charlot, "Literature of the Kalākaua Dynasty," 11. The bonfires and lighted torches of this evening would eventually inspire the young David Malo, namesake and nephew of the well-known Lahainaluna graduate, to compose "He Inoa Ahi no Kalakaua," the famous chant written to remember the king's return to Honolulu. See Pukui and Korn, *Echo of Our Song*, 144.
- [197.](#) "Ka Hoi!," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, April 18, 1874, 2; *HEN*, vol. 1, 2881-2882.
- [198.](#) "Ka Huakai!," *Nuhou Hawaii*, April 21, 1874, 4.
- [199.](#) "Ka Hoi!," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, April 18, 1874, 2; *HEN*, vol. 1, 2882.
- [200.](#) "Ka Huakai!," *Nuhou Hawaii*, April 21, 1874, 4.
- [201.](#) "Ka Hoi!," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, April 18, 1874, 2; *HEN*, vol. 1, 2883.
- [202.](#) "The Arrival of His Majesty," *PCA*, May 2, 1874, 2, Chronicling America.
- [203.](#) "Ka Hoi!," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, April 18, 1874, 2; "Ka Huakai!," *Nuhou Hawaii*, April 21, 1874, 4.
- [204.](#) "Ka Hoi!," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, April 18, 1874, 2; *HEN*, vol. 1, 2885.
- [205.](#) "Their Majesties the King and Queen," *HG*, April 22, 1874, 2.
- [206.](#) "The Royal Progress on Oahu," *PCA*, April 25, 1874, 3.
- [207.](#) Ibid.
- [208.](#) "Ka Hookipa Moi ana a ko Waimanalo," *Ko Hawaii Pono*, April 22, 1874, 2, Ulukau.
- [209.](#) See R. M. Williams, "John Adams Cummins," 153-168.
- [210.](#) "The Royal Progress on Oahu," *PCA*, April 25, 1874, 3.
- [211.](#) Ibid.
- [212.](#) "Ka Hiki ana o ka Lani i Koolauloa," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, May 2, 1874, 3, Ulukau; *HEN*, vol. 1, 2905.
- [213.](#) "The Return of Their Majesties," *PCA*, May 2, 1874, 2.
- [214.](#) "Their Majesties the King and Queen," *HG*, May 13, 1874, 2, Chronicling America; "Nu Hou o ke Alo Alii!," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, August 22, 1874, 2, Ulukau.
- [215.](#) "The Arrival," *PCA*, May 2, 1874, 2.
- [216.](#) Reinecke, *Language and Dialect*, 48.
- [217.](#) Lili'uokalani, *Hawaii's Story*, 67-68.
- [218.](#) "Na Mele no ka Lani Kalakaua," *Ko Hawaii Pono*, May 6, 1874, 4, Ulukau.
- [219.](#) "Na Mea Hou i Lihue Kauai," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, December 5, 1874, 3, Ulukau.
- [220.](#) "Na Mele i Meleia," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, December 12, 1874, 4, Ulukau.
- [221.](#) "Na Palapala i ke 'Kuokoa,'" *Nupepa Kuokoa*, December 19, 1874, 2,

Ulukau.

- [222.](#) "Ka La Hoomaikai," *Lau Oliva*, November 1, 1874, 2; "Ka La Hanau o ka Moi," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, November 7, 1874, 2.
- [223.](#) "The Royal Birthday. Prayers for the King," *PCA*, November 21, 1874, 2, *Chronicling America*.
- [224.](#) "Ka La Hanau," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, November 7, 1874, 2; "Ka Moi no na Aina E," *Lau Oliva*, November 1, 1874, 2.
- [225.](#) "E Lilo ana i ka Moi Kalakaua ka Hanohano o ka Makaikaiia ana," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, November 21, 1874, 2, Ulukau.

CHAPTER FOUR

Strengthening the Kingdom Abroad

While [chapter 3](#) examined nineteenth-century Hawaiian-language publications' representations of the ways King Kalākaua worked at home early in his reign to increase the population of his Hawaiian people, strengthen his government, and procure greater official American and international recognition and support of his kingdom as an independent nation, this chapter looks at the nineteenth-century Hawaiian-language representations of Kalākaua working to save his kingdom while he was away from Hawai'i. He himself recognized the irony that to serve his people, and even his closest relations, he had to travel away from them for a time. In November 1874, Kalākaua left Honolulu for Washington, DC, to personally support the passage of the Reciprocity Treaty in the US Congress. Seven years later, he became the first sovereign to travel around the world promoting Hawai'i as a great independent nation. On those two occasions, the Hawaiian-language newspapers reported that Kalākaua was nearly always working; to use today's terms, he became a workaholic. The king maintained such rigorous traveling and appointment schedules in the grueling US winter weather of late 1874 that he fell ill, and his demanding itinerary when he went around the world in 1881 is scarcely believable. Yet, on both occasions, Kalākaua accomplished what he set out to do and more. While negative representations of this mō'i have described him as an unconcerned, unpredictable, and unreliable leader, [chapter 4](#) argues that the Hawaiian-language newspapers' reports of him while conducting business outside of Hawai'i portray Kalākaua as an entirely different kind of sovereign. He was staunchly devoted to the independence of Hawai'i and the vigorous endurance of his lāhuikanaka. While the Reciprocity

Treaty today has often been linked to annexation and the success of the sugar industry, Kalākaua saw the treaty as a way for Kānaka Maoli to be hardworking and industrious. Lili'uokalani remembered that her brother believed it would “enrich, or benefit, not one class, but, in a greater or lesser degree, all his subjects.”¹ A reciprocity treaty would stave off annexation to the United States. Substantial import taxes in California and Oregon burdened Hawai'i sugar planters, so instead of joining America, a treaty that eliminated those taxes and preserved Hawai'i's independence seemed best. Judge William L. Lee in Washington received word that US government leaders “favored strongly the maintenance of Hawaii as an independent nation.”² Kalākaua did not solely go to the United States for the treaty. He did not even address Congress about it.³ On both diplomatic trips in 1874 and 1881, the king was able to accomplish his objectives because he had long prepared for his position as an ambassador for Hawai'i. Kalākaua was well-read, learned, and ready to convene, converse, consult, or simply chat with any representative, mayor, president, envoy, diplomat, commissioner, emperor, king, queen, prince, or princess from America, Japan, China, Italy, and just about anywhere in the world time and time again, not just within the comfortable walls of 'Iolani Palace but around the world.

Kalākaua's Trip to Washington, DC, November 1874

From the moment Kalākaua set sail for the United States in late 1874 until he returned in 1875, Hawai'i newspapers published accounts of his activities and the response of people to his appearances. The *Pacific Commercial Advertiser* (PCA) reported that on November 17, 1874, when he left Honolulu, the “entire populace”—at least three thousand to four thousand people—turned out at the harbor and “pressed about him as he alighted from his carriage, amid mingled sobs and cheers.”⁴ *Ka Nupepa Kuokoa* noted:

“Ua aluka ae la ke anaina e lulu lima, haawi makana, honi lima a e mele olioli aku i kona inoa, aka, aole i hookaulua iho ka Moi” (The assemblage crowded together to shake hands, present gifts, kiss his hand, and recite chants in his name, but the king did not delay). Clearly, Kalākaua is presented as a mōʻī intent on reaching Washington, DC. The newspapers reported that he had explained to his people, “I am going to endeavor to obtain this treaty, which, should I succeed in doing, I think will revive the country.”⁵ The battleships docked at Māmala and the battery at ʻĀinahou fired off their twenty-one-gun salutes as he boarded his skiff to reach the *Benicia*. *Kuokoa* captured the scene: “Ua lainaia no hoi o ʻĀinahou e na makaainana mai kekahi pea a hala loa i ka palena pau mai, a ua hele na moku a luluu i ka poe makaikai” (ʻĀinahou was lined with people everywhere, and the ships became laden with spectators).⁶ Twelve days later, Kalākaua arrived in San Francisco. Hawaiʻi’s newspapers reported on Californians’ admiration for the mōʻī—a source of pride for makaʻāinana and an encouragement for the business community hoping for a treaty. *Ka Lahui Hawaii*, the Hawaiian-language weekly started in 1875 by Reverend Henry H. Parker, declared, “He mea hauoli no kela a me keia puuwai Hawaii ka hoomaopopo ana iho, ‘o Ka Lani ka Moi o kakou he malihini hiilani na ke Aupuni Repubalika Nui o ke ao nei” (Every Hawaiian heart is happy in understanding, our Royal One the king is an exalted guest of the great Republican nation of this world).⁷ The welcome and attention Kalākaua received here would be repeated elsewhere for the rest of this trip and each succeeding trip he made to the United States. Or as the *PCA* put it, “His Majesty received a continued ovation, all along the route from San Francisco to Washington.”⁸ *Ka Lahui* reported that upon his arrival in San Francisco, “ua piha haiaamu aku la ka uwapo a me na keena nuhou i na kanaka o kela a me keia ano” (the wharf and news offices were filled with all kinds of people).⁹ With tipped hats and thunderous cheers, Americans greeted Kalākaua. The band serenaded him with “Hawaiʻi Ponoʻī,” and welcoming officials conveyed him to his hotel. *Kuokoa* described the

caravan of soldiers, the city officials, and the band, as well, who followed Kalākaua's royal carriage pulled by four horses. The streets leading to the Grand Hotel were lined with spectators, and "no ke kupinai mau mai o na leo o na makaainana mawaho o ka Hotele, ua puka mai ka Moi a me Meia Otis a ma ka puka aniani o ka Hotele, hoolauna mai la ka Meia" (because of the constant echoing of the people's voices outside the hotel, the king and Mayor Otis appeared at the window of the hotel, and the mayor introduced [Kalākaua]), recognizing him as "ke Alii ka Moi Kalakaua, ke Alii Aimoku o ka Pae Aina Hawaii" (His Highness King Kalākaua, the ruling chief of the Hawaiian Islands).¹⁰ Hawai'i's newspapers noted that throughout his stay, crowds of people "e kuku mai ana malalo o ka Hotele" (were standing below the hotel), hoping to catch a glimpse of him.¹¹

Americans on the East Coast were anticipating his arrival.¹² On December 12, 1874, Kalākaua arrived in Washington, DC, after a quick trip across the continent. Because several thousand people greeted him, "it was with great difficulty that the police kept them from encroaching upon the Royal party."¹³ Hawaiians had to have been proud of their mō'i when they read in their own papers about Kalākaua's triumphant entry into America's capital as its first visiting ruling monarch: "E pulelo wale ana no na hae ma na alanui a pau o kahi a ka huakai e hele aku ai" (The flags were fluttering on all the streets where the entourage would travel) and "na wahine hoi ma na puka aniani, kiani mai la i na hainaka" (the women at the windows, waving handkerchiefs).¹⁴ Kalākaua was sick, thanks to the speed of his travels and his brief stopover in Omaha, where city officials took him on a tour of the capital city in an open carriage during a snowstorm,¹⁵ so he informed President Grant that he would need some days of rest before their meeting. He was at the Arlington, the finest hotel in Washington.¹⁶ *Kuokoa* announced it was very pleased with "ka hoike ana mai o ka Lahui o Amerika, i ko lakou manao maikai ia Hawaii nei, ma ka apo aloha ana mai i ke Poo o keia Aupuni ma kana huakai makaikai, a hookipa aku la me ka

mailani loa ia” (the display of the people of America in their fine regard for Hawai’i through the affectionate embrace of the king of this kingdom on his tour and welcoming him with great esteem).¹⁷ On December 15, Kalākaua met with President Grant, congressional members, and military officials at the White House, where “the galleries were full to over-flowing for more than an hour” prior to the session’s commencement. On December 18, Kalākaua met with senators and representatives in the morning and then enjoyed what was called “the most brilliant state reception that has ever taken place in Washington” as the guest of honor of President Grant.¹⁸ The attendees were a distinguished group: “There were the greatest of all our land before him, from the President, Vice-President, and Cabinet to the Judges of the Supreme Court, Senators and Members of Congress. And then there were our military and naval chieftains in their handsome uniforms.”¹⁹

In the nation’s capital, the mō’ī was invited to quaint dinners at private residences, where he met with city leaders, and to grand balls, where he met with government and military leaders. The *Hawaiian Gazette* (HG) reprinted articles from American newspapers “to show the public sentiment towards our King and people, as reported by the press.” The *New York Herald*’s two-column story on the mō’ī and Hawai’i and the *Boston Post*’s praise of Kalākaua as the “young and enlightened King of the Sandwich Islands” both appeared.²⁰ At the end of January 1875, the HG also declared that “it is gratifying to us, as it must be to our King, to read the kindly notices of him and of his people, which appear in almost every paper we receive from America.”²¹ Kalākaua literally had a personal touch, often shaking hands for more than an hour. Despite the many meetings, dinners, banquets, and visits, he also managed to enjoy nights at the theater and the opera. And in keeping with his sense of how important his public image was, while in New York he made sure to stop in at the famous Gurney & Son, one of America’s leading photography galleries, to pose “in full uniform and in several positions.”²²

His commitment to his duties took its toll, however. The mō'i's body was not used to the cold, and the Hawaiian-language newspapers were constantly reporting on the status of his health, noting that Kalākaua was so overwhelmed by the demands for public appearances, meetings with government and city officials, and press conferences that almost from the start, he had to cancel events to rest. He found it difficult to recuperate completely from the cold he had caught in Omaha, and although his health improved slightly when he reached Pittsburgh in mid-December, after arriving in Washington, DC, he asked to see a doctor.²³ His schedule was so busy that virtually every minute of his American tour can be accounted for, and the newspapers reported that even though he suffered miserably from the cold, he still managed to attract American attention, interest, and respect. *Kuokoa* summed it up nicely: "Ma na wahi a pau ana i hiki alii aku ai, ua halawai lua ole mai no ia me na hookipa pumehana ana a na keiki Amerika" (In all the places where he made royal stops, he met with the unprecedented warmth of Americans' welcomes).²⁴

In Hawai'i, the English and Hawaiian readers knew that although their new mō'i was ill, he still kept to his unforgiving schedule, sending Governor Kapena or Governor Dominis to represent him only when necessary. He was acting on behalf of his people—and also for the sugar barons in his kingdom who needed a treaty. Or, as Lili'uokalani later put it, "He thus devoted the earlier part of his reign to the aggrandizement of the very persons, who, as soon as they had become rich and powerful, forgot his generosity."²⁵ At least at first, then, all of Hawai'i's people knew their mō'i was a hardworking, self-sacrificing public servant—hardly the lazy and self-indulgent figure his enemies characterized him to be.

As Kalākaua made his way back to California, ultimately leaving San Francisco on February 2, 1875, and arriving in Honolulu on February 15, the thirteen-member Committee of Arrangements was created to welcome the mō'i home. Its plans were printed in the newspapers. The streets from

‘Āinahou to ‘Iolani Palace were to be illuminated by glowing torches, the phrase “Kalakaua-Imi-Pomaikai-Lahui” (Kalākaua Searching for the Good of the Nation) would appear in fiery letters atop Ali‘iōlani Hale, and the tower of Kawaiaha‘o would be decorated to look like a lighthouse. Puōwaina would be aglow with a bonfire. The most impressive display, potentially, would be the lighted torch atop the firehouse tower, for it would be arrayed in different colors.²⁶ *Kuokoa* informed its readers about the parade, inviting maka‘āinana to wait at Fort Street to greet Kalākaua and his retinue as they made their way to ‘Iolani Palace.²⁷

On the morning of February 15, as word of his imminent arrival spread through Honolulu, “e kahe makawalu ana na makaainana ma na alanui, e ku aku la ka piha i kai o Ainahou” (the crowds flowed into the streets and filled the area near the sea of ‘Āinahou). When the mō‘ī finally appeared and lifted his hat to his people, “ua hookuu mai la lakou i na leo huro i hui pu ia me ka uwe haoli, a piha pu ae la ka lewa luna me na leo wawa aloha ‘lii” (they sent out hurrahs joined with joyful cries. The heavens above were filled with the roar of voices expressing their chiefly love).²⁸ *Ka Lahui* declared that “hookahi no mea i maopopo ‘ua pae lanakila mai ka Moi Kalakaua ma na aekai o Kona one oiwi, a ke ala nei na puuwai Hawaii e hoike aku i ke aloha pumehana no ko lakou Moi” (one thing was clear, King Kalakaua arrived triumphantly upon the shores of his birth sands, and the Hawaiian hearts rose up to display a warm affection for their king).²⁹ While Puōwaina’s cannons sounded, “there could not have been less than ten or twelve thousand spectators of this the grandest sight ever witnessed in Hawaii nei.” People lined the streets, cheering; several hundred children, each with a bouquet for the mō‘ī, joined in the procession.³⁰ When day turned into night, no fewer than one hundred thousand lights glowed, a sight the *HG*’s reporter said had never before been seen, with lights of differing hues on Ali‘iōlani Hale and fires atop the major precipices of Honolulu. *Ka Lahui* described it this way: “Ua hiki ole i ke kanaka ke hoomaopopo i ke ano o ka nani a kona mau maka e kilohi nei”

(One could not take in the nature of the beauty his eyes gazed upon).³¹ In the eyes of Hawai‘i’s newspapers at this time, Kalākaua’s 1874 journey to Washington, DC, earned him the respect of Americans. Even more importantly, it gathered for him the full support, if only for a moment, of all his people: “The ovation was one of which he might justly be proud, and demonstrated that whatever partisanship there may have existed on the occasion of his election, it has passed away, and that people heartily welcomed him back as their chieftain and sovereign.”³²

The Hawaiian-language newspapers contain dozens of mele dedicated to Kalākaua. Although mainstream representations of the mō‘ī virtually ignore these mele, incorporating them into any attempt at obtaining a fuller sense of nineteenth-century Kanaka ‘Ōiwi loyalty and aloha for Kalākaua is crucial because these mele not only display the facility and elegance of Native composition but articulate Kanaka Maoli allegiance to Kahikukapuonālani (Seventh of the Heavenly Ones) and his efforts to save the kingdom.³³ Some of the lyrics also reveal how certain composers equated Kalākaua with the lāhui and entire pae ‘āina. When maka‘āinana sent these mele to the newspapers, they became narratives shared with the nation, unifying readers in their efforts to show support for the mō‘ī. Take, for example, “No Kauli lua” (For Kaulilua).³⁴ On March 20, 1875, *Ka Nupepa Kuokoa* printed D. Maoli’s 113-line mele—not unusually long for that era—on its front page. The composition honors Kalākaua’s trip to America to help negotiate the Reciprocity Treaty. Most Native Hawaiians, including Kalākaua himself, did not want to cede Pearl River (Pearl Harbor) to the United States as part of any reciprocity treaty, but the people trusted their mō‘ī and were proud of his efforts. The content of this mele suggests that the newspaper accounts of that trip were inspiring:

Anu o Kaleponi, he aina	(Cold was California, an
malihini	unfamiliar land
Hoonua lia mai na	There was much putting on of

hoohilulu	displays
Hoike na moku me na	On the ships and in the forts
papu	
E na kolo na pu ko welo	The guns roared, the flags
na hae	waved
Olehala na pele, hone	Bells tolled and music played
ana na pila	
E maki na koa, kau lele	The soldiers marched, the
na pahu	drums were beaten
Ulu wehiwehi lua na	And everything looked so
mea a pau.	grand.)

Two days after his return, Kalākaua spoke to maka'āinana gathered at Kawaiaha'o Church about his journey to America. *Ka Lahui Hawaii* printed the speech in its February 25, 1875, edition. He described the royal receptions and honors that Americans bestowed upon him and his retinue in every city they visited, remarking that “ua hookipa ia makou me ka ihiihi a me ka hanohano nui” (we were entertained with respect and great honor). He impressed upon his audience, though, that the keys to growing the nation would be shipping, agriculture, and teaching the people to be industrious again. According to Kalākaua, “If we but imbue the [Hawaiian] people with the idea that they have within themselves the elements of a renewed life, and that they are not a dying people—they will live.”³⁵ The mō'ī's ideas regarding the kingdom's problems were not new. In response to similar dilemmas among Kānaka Maoli during his reign, Lot Kapuāiwa firmly wanted his subjects to be “hardworking and thrifty” and “protected from thoughtless waste and idle temptation.”³⁶ Kalākaua would hope to accomplish it through a treaty. Increasing the nation's wealth and even making the world dependent on Hawai'i for certain things would help to secure its independence.³⁷ The objectives were to “revive the country” and avoid annexation.³⁸ Offering a plan that would probably be called “Buy Local” today and advocating for living sustainably, Kalākaua stated:

The wealth and greatness of nations is created by the cultivators of the soil and by the men who toil with their hands.... To these considerations let us of Hawaii Nei earnestly direct our attention, to the end that by our industries we may be able to attract foreign commerce to our ports and freight it with the products of our country.³⁹

As Kathleen Mellen noted, Kalākaua had a “profound understanding of the age into which he was born ... as he prepared to use every force at his command for the rehabilitation of his race.”⁴⁰

The 1881 Circumnavigation of the Globe

Six years later, the king announced that he would travel around the world. And as he had before his American trip, Kalākaua went to many places in Hawai‘i beforehand. Most Hawai‘i newspapers covered these visits, including several publications that were champions, and virtually publicists, for the mō‘ī. Unsurprisingly, one was the *Pacific Commercial Advertiser* (PCA), which Walter Murray Gibson took over for a while in August 1880.⁴¹ He also published *Ka Elele Poakolu/Wednesday Express*, which began in September 1880 as a bilingual paper but became exclusively Hawaiian in November and then survived in various forms until 1892, by which time both Kalākaua and Gibson had died. *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, published by the Kawainui brothers and boasting an average of thirty-three hundred copies printed weekly, also strongly supported Kalākaua early in his reign. Henry M. Whitney’s *HG*, on the other hand, basically ignored the Hawai‘i tour. After mentioning that it had received a telegram from Kohala that described Kalākaua’s visit with Natives and foreigners there, the paper declared that it was “unable to make room” for the story.⁴² *Kuokoa* did not furnish a single account of the Hawai‘i tour, and the *HG* published one short article. The Native readership would have been interested in reading about the mō‘ī’s visits

through the kingdom in *Kuokoa*, so Whitney's lack of reporting reflects his antipathy for Kalākaua. Whitney's papers would follow this pattern for Kalākaua's subsequent circumnavigation of the globe as well. But the Hawaiian- and English-language nationalist newspaper accounts show us that the people of Hawai'i received the mō'i in large numbers, offering their aloha generously everywhere. These accounts serve as the sources for this section. They are especially significant because they not only show that many Hawaiians continued to support Kalākaua, a notion his critics denied, but they also prove that by 1880 the mō'i had publicly shared his plans to go abroad.⁴³ In *Around the World with a King*, a highly unfavorable account of that tour, William N. Armstrong, then attorney general of the Hawaiian Kingdom, claims that "early one morning in January, 1881" the mō'i told him that he planned to "take a trip around the world."⁴⁴ The cabinet was then immediately convened, and Kalākaua supposedly obtained the necessary funding.⁴⁵ Only just before his departure did he call a large meeting to announce his plan—supposedly a concession, since according to Armstrong, Kalākaua "had not, during the six years of his reign, taken any special interest in the welfare of his people."⁴⁶ This is the most familiar and most-cited version of the mō'i's preparations, even though years before Armstrong published his account, Lili'uokalani had written that "in nothing has my brother been more grossly misjudged and even slandered by those whose interests he had at heart than in this journey."⁴⁷ According to her, "The master motive for this enterprise was the good of the people of the Hawaiian Islands over whom he had been called to rule";⁴⁸ the nationalist Hawai'i newspapers confirm that he not only had announced his plans by October of 1880 but had also toured the islands to meet with maka'āinana before his departure.⁴⁹ As for Armstrong's account, in January 1881 the papers printed a government letter to the Diplomatic and Consular Corps providing the official reasons for the world tour—and announcing Armstrong's new appointment as royal commissioner of immigration and travel companion to the

mōʻī.

Perhaps it was not necessary for Armstrong to know until then, even though everyone else in the kingdom did. Criticism of the mōʻī's planned tour by his enemies in the press was already underway. The *Saturday Press*, an English-language newspaper devoted to attacking the throne and the Native Hawaiian Nation, had already been publishing for a few months. Writing to his brother on Kauaʻi, Sanford B. Dole reveals just how partisan and political a tool this publication was:

You will be pleased to hear that a new paper, the *Saturday Press*, was started last week, September 4th, in opposition to the *Advertiser* under Gibson. I have ordered it for you. It is owned by the leading business firms here; it is well supported from the start, as you will see. A great many have taken away their advertising from the *Commercial* and given it to the new paper, and many have stopped their subscriptions to the former. I trust that Gibson will be starved out before long.⁵⁰

Dole here displays the early opposition of the white oligarchy to Gibson, a major advocate for Kalākaua. Its members would expel him in 1887.

The mōʻī toured Hawaiʻi Island and Kauaʻi in late 1880 and Maui in early 1881. His goals were to evaluate the effects of the Reciprocity Treaty he had signed a few years before and to explain to makaʻāinana why he was about to circumnavigate the world. The January 12, 1881, edition of *Ka Elele Poakolu* reported that he was happy to see his people were self-sufficient again.⁵¹ The newspapers also gave accounts of the aloha he was receiving. When he arrived at Hawaiʻi Island's Mahukona harbor, a large crowd of foreigners and Native Hawaiians welcomed him, then accompanied him on the six-and-a half-mile trip to Kohala. People were waiting to greet him along the route as well. While *Ko Hawaii*, *Ka Elele*, and the *PCA* elaborated on this reception, the *Saturday Press* predictably abbreviated it.⁵²

But *HG*'s extra column of news from Kohala in its December 22 issue proclaims that Kalākaua was still very popular with his people:

Never in this history of Kohala, and we doubt if ever in the history of any other part of the Kingdom, has there been so large and brilliant an assemblage as that which gathered at the new Dramatic Hall at Kaiopihi on the eve of December 6th, to do honor to his Majesty the King.

The hall was decorated with every kind of evergreen and flower next to Hawaiian flags and banners reading "Welcome, Kalakaua, Our King" and "Aloha, Kalakaua."⁵³ In the afternoon, "refreshments came pouring in by the cart load, and when they were placed on the table, it did indeed present a feast fit for a King." Outside, the hall was aglow with torches, a "scene of positive splendor, with hundreds of people crowding the space in front, all anxious to obtain a glimpse of their monarch." According to the *PCA*, at least four hundred people gathered outside for dancing,⁵⁴ and while the *mōī* retired early, those of Kohala enjoyed the night. The *Wednesday Express* reported that when Kalākaua departed, "a brilliant torchlight display illumined the hill sides and shores of Kohala, and an outpouring of genuine aloha was borne on the night breeze, as the King sailed away."⁵⁵ He left very pleased by the increased prosperity across the archipelago in places such as Keauhou,⁵⁶ where Kona maka'āinana Chas. Loloulani remembered that "he nui aku na huaolelo waiwai ana i hoike mai ai" (there were many valuable points that he addressed).⁵⁷

In Kōloa in late December of 1880, Kalākaua remarked that he was pleased to see homes constructed of wood and new industries on the land.⁵⁸ In early January, when visiting Maui, he told the people that by traveling abroad he sought greater fortune for Hawai'i nei "ma ka lawe ana mai i na kanaka o na aina e, e hoolaupai i ka aina e like me kona huli ana i ke Kuikahi Panailike" (in bringing people of foreign

lands to develop the land in accordance with his seeking a reciprocity treaty).⁵⁹ In short, he took a domestic tour to bid farewell personally to his people, and their support of him and his journey appears prominently in the newspapers' coverage. *Ka Elele* reported that when Kalākaua visited Hawai'i Island, "huliamahi na makua a me na keiki iloko o ka hauoli a ua ake nui lakou e paa aku i ka Moi aloha me lakou" (parents and children banded together unanimously in joy, and they greatly desired to hold tightly to affirm the beloved king within themselves).⁶⁰ According to the *PCA*, in Ho'okena, before the mō'ī's skiff reached the shore, thirty "loyal and enthusiastic Hawaiians ... rushed into the water and, grasping the gunwales of the royal barge with their strong hands, lifted it out of the water, with the royal party on board, and bore them up high and dry, triumphantly on shore." Once there, two hundred children, "tastefully dressed and garlanded," sang songs to welcome their mō'ī. He addressed the people, revealing to them his plans for traveling the world:

When the father and chief spoke of leaving his native isles, there were loudly uttered *auwes*, and tender alohas, and many a plainly marked tear coursed down the cheeks of loyal and affectionate Hawaiians on this occasion. When His Majesty proceeded to return to the vessel, the same enthusiastic party that had carried the royal company on shore now lifted up the boat and passengers, and, amid loyal song and cheer, carried them onward triumphantly into the water. And loud and warm shouts of aloha went up from the Hookena shore as King Kalakaua sailed away.⁶¹

When the mō'ī anchored in Hilo, a large group of Natives and foreigners cheered, and during his stay at the home of friend and businessman Thomas Spencer, the people serenaded him for two evenings.⁶² Maka'āinana also turned out in large numbers to hear Kalākaua's address at the Haili Church, wrote the *Saturday Press*.

On Kauaʻi, when the mōʻī anchored in Nāwiliwili Harbor, shouts greeted him: “Eia o ka Lani Kauliluaikeanuwaialeale” (Behold the Royal One Kauliluaikeanuwaialeale). People from as far away as Waimea gathered with those in Kōloa to hear Kalākaua’s address, and “e piha ana hoi ke alanui i ka poe ake e ike i ka Lani a kakou” (the pathway was filled with people desirous to see our Royal One).⁶³ In Līhuʻe, Kauaʻi, residents offered their aloha by escorting Kalākaua to the river Kukuilauahinahina, where he bathed in its cold waters. He then retired under an ‘ōhiʻa tree that makaʻāinana had brought down from the mountains to shade Kalākaua as he rested and ate the food the residents had prepared.

Later in Honolulu, his ministers and other foreign officials bid him farewell at a fine dinner at the Hawaiian Hotel on Friday, January 14. About eighty guests enjoyed the six-course meal. Kalākaua thanked the audience for sending him off so well. He then said the following: “I believe that you who come from other lands, bringing with you the large wealth, enterprise and intelligence of those lands, sympathize with me in my desire to protect my native Hawaiian people, and strengthen my nation.” He also remarked that he could “rely upon the best elements in my kingdom to sustain my efforts and those of my government in upholding the independence of my kingdom and the welfare of the people.”⁶⁴ This attempt to suggest that the interests of the wealthy and of the Hawaiian people could be identical would be a hallmark of Kalākaua’s reign—and later one of his most controversial stands. As was by now customary, the mōʻī addressed congregations throughout Honolulu before his departure, seeking their prayers for a safe journey. Close to one thousand people gathered at Kawaiahaʻo Church, where Kalākaua offered them his two reasons for embarking on the tour: “First, to recuperate his own health and second, to find means for recuperating his people, the latter would be done by the introduction of foreign immigrants.” The people applauded. As the *HG* also noted, Kalākaua told his audience that he “considered the position of Monarch of these Islands as a peculiarly difficult one on account of the various

interests and influences which must necessarily act upon him,” acknowledging the pressure applied to him by different factions, including the sugar barons, who demanded more laborers for their plantations. This speech was “received with vigorous applause” and then with a spontaneous rendition of “Hawai’i Pono’i.”⁶⁵ The newspapers also reported that the week Kalākaua departed for San Francisco,⁶⁶ “all classes and races have striven to outvie each other in their expressions of goodwill and affection, in bidding adieu to His Majesty.”⁶⁷ According to *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, “Ua hoopihāia ka pa alii mai ke kakahiaka a awakea, e na makaainana Aloha Alii i lawe pu aku i ka lakou mau hookupu e like me ke ano maa o ko Hawaii nei noho ana makee Alii” (the royal enclosure was filled from morning until noon by the people who love the chief/royalists, who brought their offerings in accordance with the custom of those of Hawai’i who love the chiefs).⁶⁸ Many mele devoted to Kalākaua and his journey also appeared, symbols of maka’āinana aloha for the mō’ī.

On January 20, 1881, Kalākaua departed Honolulu for San Francisco to begin his trip around the world—the first sovereign to accomplish this feat. *Ka Elele Poakolu* remembered that morning this way:

Ua haiaamu ae la he tausani a oi o ko ka Moi mau makaainana, a haiaamu ae la ma na pipa alahele e hoopuni ana i ka pa ‘lii, a ua kuu hamama ia mai la na ipuka nui o ua pa ihiihi nei, e pahola mai ana i ka lokomaikai o na ‘lii imua o ko lakou mau makaainana, e komo ana e hoike i ko lakou aloha hope loa, a e hui pu hoi ma na hauoli ana me ko lakou Alii.⁶⁹

(A thousand or more of the king’s people gathered and congregated on the sidewalks of the pathways surrounding the royal enclosure. The large gates of this revered enclosure were opened, revealing the good will of the chiefs before their people entering to display their final farewells and to join together in the gaiety with their king.)

The *PCA* reported that an hour before the *City of Sydney* was to leave, the wharf was “thronged with people, among whom were Ministers, Nobles, and a representation from all ranks and races in the capital.”⁷⁰ “A i ka hoea ana o ka Moi ilaila, ua poha ae la na leo aloha,” *Ka Elele Poakolu* adds, “a ua hookuu na maka i ko lakou mau punawai e kahe” (And when the king arrived there, loving voices burst out, and eyes released their springs to flow).⁷¹ As Kalākaua boarded the ship, “there sprang forth on both sides what seemed like a fringe of outstretched hands seeking a last touch of the hand of the departing Chief and Father.” A few minutes later, when “the King was seen by the rail with his handkerchief to his eyes, many were pressed to weeping eyes on shore, as the great steamer moved grandly out to sea.”⁷²

To San Francisco and Then to Japan

A local outbreak of smallpox was the top story of 1881 in the Hawai‘i newspapers. Kalākaua’s circumnavigation of the globe was second, and the pride both Natives and foreigners could take from the newspaper accounts of the world’s reception of their mō‘ī may have offered some respite from the grief and anguish of the epidemic. When Kalākaua learned of the outbreak in July 1881 while abroad, he wrote to Henry Severance, the Hawaiian consul at San Francisco, saying that “the small pox at the Islands is the only thing I have been most anxious and to think of it makes me gloomy.”⁷³ The Hawaiian-language newspapers printed accounts of Kalākaua’s travel to California. He passed some of the time on board by sharing mo‘olelo and singing mele, making for “na manawa me na hauoli a me na hoonanea” (moments of happiness and leisure),⁷⁴ and the *PCA* reported that he seemed “to have won only golden opinions from all his fellow travelers.”⁷⁵ After a nine-day journey, he arrived in San Francisco on January 29, but travel being what it was, it was not until the third week of February that Hawai‘i’s newspapers printed accounts of the formal receptions,

banquets, luncheons, and toasts given in his honor—all evidence of Kaleponi's (California's) continuing aloha for this mō'ī. Here is the synopsis the *PCA* took from the *San Francisco Call*: "King Kalakaua has been entertained right royally by our social lions since his re-entry into San Francisco society, and can hardly feel otherwise than pleased at the marks of esteem that he is everywhere receiving."⁷⁶ Such reports informed Hawai'i's readers of the world's tributes throughout his 1881 tour—and of the demands placed on him, for he had little time to rest.⁷⁷

Kuokoa described in detail his visit to Sacramento. The state Senate unanimously agreed to a half-hour recess to meet Kalākaua.⁷⁸ Apparently, the following was the general opinion:

"Why, this King of the Sandwich Islands is a gentleman; and a good fellow; and a ruler worthy of our country's highest regard." And every public man of America, who meets and shakes hands with King Kalakaua, will be inspired by a generous enthusiasm to be his friend and partisan in any fair cause he may present in behalf of his little Kingdom to the Great Republic.⁷⁹

Kuokoa also noted that an American correspondent said of Kalākaua, "He keonimana akahi, naauao a olelo hookaau maoli no oia" (He is a gentleman of the finest class, intelligent and truly witty). On February 26, 1881, *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina* published a letter written by Kalākaua and signed "Kawaihau" describing his arrival in the Golden Gate harbor: "Ua hookipaia makou me ka makahehi nui ia e na kanaka koikoi a pau o ka aina nei, me ka hauoli a me ka oluolu" (We were welcomed with great admiration by all of the prominent people of the land with joy and kindness).⁸⁰ *Kuokoa* highlighted the many banquets given in his honor in California,⁸¹ and the *PCA* reported that the citizens of San Francisco "vie with one another in their attentions to the King and his suite."⁸² Among them was the Chinese consul general, who honored Kalākaua at a Chinese New Year

celebration reception at Hang Fer Low, said to be “the Delmonico of Chinatown.” That banquet, “in the costliness, rarity and delicacy of viands, has not been exceeded by any festivity that has taken place on this coast.” Commodore R. S. Floyd, a former steamship commander between San Francisco and Honolulu, along with other members of the Pacific Yacht Club, hosted a dinner and a sailing trip across San Francisco Bay.⁸³ Elite ladies of San Francisco invited 250 of the city’s leading citizens to a grand reception at the Palace Hotel. When Kalākaua entered the ballroom that evening, “a flutter of excitement was visible, a whispered ‘Here he comes,’ was passed through the parlors, and each couple took their stand to receive His Majesty.” According to the report, “a grander reception it has seldom, if ever, been allotted to a San Franciscan to witness,” and it “will long be remembered by the fortunate guests who were permitted to witness this, one of the grandest social events in the history of the city.”⁸⁴ Later, sugar baron Claus Spreckels threw a “very grand banquet, prepared in the highest style of Parisian art,” inviting the most prominent businessmen of the city. The *PCA* said it best:

Thus every day, and it may be said every hour of King Kalakaua’s stay in San Francisco has been filled up with a grand ovation of festivities. And we feel assured that no potentate of Europe, nor eminent great man of America’s own soil could have received greater and more honorable attention.⁸⁵

As for Kalākaua himself, he wrote Severance that “our reception every where has been more than we expected to have received.... The trip appears as if a mixed panorama and a dream.”⁸⁶

The Hawai’i newspapers could not publish any accounts of the world tour for the rest of March because news of Kalākaua’s travels did not reach Honolulu until the *City of New York* arrived on April 17, 1881.⁸⁷ On April 23, *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina* printed “He Halialia. Kalakaua ia Kapiolani.

[Kakauia maluna o ka mokumahu Oceanic, Feb. 16, 1881]" (A Remembrance. By Kalākaua to Kapi'olani. [Written on board the steamship *Oceanic*]), a poem Kalākaua had written for Kapi'olani while sailing past Hawai'i en route to Japan. Nahinu's and Kauila's mele and four mele written by Mrs. Kalehiwahiwa, said to be a lady-in-waiting to Kapi'olani, were also published in the Hawaiian-language newspapers at this time to honor Kalākaua's 1881 journey.⁸⁸ The antagonistic *Saturday Press*, however, printed the following:

We regret to learn by a dispatch from the Hawaiian Consul in Japan, that that Government intends to set aside the incognito under which H. M. the King was supposed to be travelling, and to receive him with Royal Salutes. ... It can hardly be expected that the great Monarchies of Europe or the Viceroys and Governors of their possessions in the East will undertake to receive the Royal party as the Japanese propose to do, they will therefore be left on the horns of a dilemma.⁸⁹

Such criticism could be expected from the *Saturday Press*, but writer Thomas G. Thrum and owner Robert Grieve were wrong. Rulers around the world would lavishly welcome Kalākaua, the sovereign of Hawai'i. As for the actual reception in Japan, the other kingdom newspapers were soon publishing the information about Kalākaua's March 4 arrival in Yokohama, Japan. On April 20, Gibson's *Ka Elele Poakolu* reported that "he mea kanalua ole, ma na wahi a pau a ka Moi o Hawaii e maalo aku ai, a e loa mai ana iaia ka lima akau o ke aloha a me ka puuwai oluolu o na poo aupuni a me na mea a pau e launa ana me ia" (undoubtedly, in all of the places wherein the king of Hawai'i has passed through, he was receiving the right hand of greeting and the kind heart of the government leaders and all the people he met).⁹⁰ On April 23, *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina* had its own three-and-a-half-column story, including a letter that Kalākaua wrote to his sister, Lili'uokalani, then serving as regent in her brother's absence. Here is a portion of that letter: "Ua hookipa maikai

loa mai ka Emepera o Iapana a me na Keiki Alii ia'u, a ua hoikeike mai i na mea a pau, a ua luakaha au me ka hauoli nui i ko lakou mau lokomaikai."⁹¹ (The emperor and the princes of Japan gave a fine welcome to me and introduced everyone. I have passed the time very happily in their good will.)

Such a reception is especially striking because he had intended to travel incognito; in fact, Hawai'i's legislature had voted that he do so, refusing to fund his circumnavigation of the globe unless he traveled not as a reigning monarch.⁹² But on February 16, Japan's consul general in San Francisco sent word to the Ministry of Foreign Affairs of Kalākaua's impending arrival,⁹³ and on February 27, the Japanese government sent officers from the Foreign Ministry, Imperial Household Agency, and Finance Ministry to Yokohama, where "e hookipa no lakou iaia ma ke ano ku i kona kulana Aliiainimoku" (they welcomed him in a manner fitting this title as ruler).⁹⁴ The Hawai'i business interests had clearly not wanted Kalākaua to be received as the true representative of Hawai'i. Thrum of the *Saturday Press* and Whitney of the *HG* fumed when Japan welcomed Kalākaua as a mō'i.⁹⁵ Whitney openly criticized the Japanese government:

When we have heard what has really occurred we may begin to complain. We cannot understand how it is that the Japanese Government have [sic] displayed such bad taste as to offer a Royal welcome to a visitor who desires to travel incognito.... The mistake certainly does not lie on our side for our Consul at Japan had been specifically notified of the manner in which the King was travelling; and he laid his letter before the Japanese Foreign Minister.⁹⁶

Leaving aside whether Kalākaua ever wanted to keep a low profile, in the *PCA*, Walter Murray Gibson scolded the *HG* and the *Press* for criticizing Japan and assured his readers that the other Asian countries,

knowing how fully [Kalākaua] is recognized as a member of the family of independent sovereigns, far more so, than many of them, who have tenfold, even a hundred fold, his number of people and area of country, —will be proud to welcome in the most royal manner, a brother King, who is their Peer in position.⁹⁷

Whitney, Thrum, and others like them were infuriated that any government would recognize Kalākaua for what he was: the ruler of a proudly sovereign kingdom. This would pose an international obstacle to their developing plans to eventually take over the governance of the kingdom, and they responded with antimonarchy slander. But Kalākaua, Gibson, and loyal subjects of the kingdom realized the need for such recognition, and regardless of the legislature's attempts to contain it, attaining it had always been a primary reason for the 1881 world tour. Japan had now openly received Kalākaua as a mō'ī, and other nations would follow suit, implicitly acknowledging his title and his nation.

One week later, the *HG* spoke of the delight and pride Hawai'i should feel at the Japanese welcome of Kalākaua: "He has been treated right royally, and native and foreigner alike cannot help feeling satisfaction at the manner in which he has been recognized." Whitney felt forced to backtrack but suggested that the honor was the nation's and not the mō'ī's: "We have only to thank that country for so signal a mark of its courtesy, which though offered to the King, may be regarded as a compliment and a sign of good feeling to the whole Hawaiian people."⁹⁸ The newspapers in Japan spoke of that country's sense of obligation to welcome the mō'ī. The *Japan Daily Mail* described Kalākaua as a "most agreeable and accomplished gentlemen and a dignified one to boot; a gentleman who was for two months the honored guest of the United States" and therefore someone the Japanese government quite rightly honored.⁹⁹ The *Japan Gazette* identified Kalākaua as personally responsible for the progress and future of his nation: "He is a liberal and enlightened ruler who has adopted a system of

representative government; displayed much anxiety to promote the spread of education; and is desirous of profiting by the experience of other countries in forwarding the interests of his own people.”¹⁰⁰

Japan was prepared for Kalākaua by March 1, but stormy conditions extended the *Oceania*’s voyage by three days. When he arrived at Yokohama, he was the object of great attention, honors, and tributes. Dr. Judd noted the flags that adorned the dozen or so foreign warships in the harbor and the soldiers who had climbed their yards.¹⁰¹ Hundreds of skiffs, sampans, and other crafts were soon at the steamship’s sides, making such a “clamor” that they drowned out the ship’s own whistle.¹⁰² The Russian admiral came aboard to welcome Kalākaua, followed by the personal representative of Emperor Meiji (Mutsuhito). Because Kalākaua was the first head of state to visit the emperor, even though Hawai’i was a small kingdom, the Japanese treated him as an important foreign leader. He warmly accepted the emperor’s invitation to the royal palace. The band played “Hawai’i Pono’ī,” and “ia lohe ana o ke Alii a me kona mau ukali, hu ae la ke aloha i ka aina, me ka waimaka e helelei ana” (when the king and his retinue heard, a love for the land welled in them with tears falling).¹⁰³ *Ka Elele* informed its readers that “ua haia mu ia ke alanui a hiki i Nogeyama e ka lehulehu o na kanaka” (the street reaching all the way to Nogeyama was crowded by the multitudes of people),¹⁰⁴ and the police had to control the crowd.¹⁰⁵ Hawai’i’s and Japan’s flags were everywhere in sight. That evening, the first of many banquets was given in the mō’ī’s honor. Present were the governor of Kanagawa, representatives from the Finance Ministry, the Imperial Navy, the Imperial Household Agency, and the Hawaiian minister to Japan Robert Walker Irwin.¹⁰⁶ From Yokohama, Kalākaua and his suite took the train to Tokyo. For two miles soldiers lined the street to the palace at Enryokan, the guest home for foreign leaders,¹⁰⁷ and the Hawaiian-language newspapers heavily covered the pomp, ceremony, and celebratory regards the royal entourage received

everywhere. “Ma na alanui kahi i loheia ai e hele aku ana ka Moi, ua laina e ae la na kanaka Iapana, me ka hoike mai i ko lakou makemake nui iaia” (Through the roads where it was heard the king would be traveling, the Japanese people lined up beforehand, displaying their great desire for him),¹⁰⁸ Judd noted, also reporting that Kalākaua attended festivities and banquets night and day, with the Japanese princes accompanying him everywhere he went. The emperor loaned his royal carriage to the mō‘ī, and on March 8, Kalākaua was treated to a fireworks show at the Imperial palace.

Kuokoa reported that the well-respected consul William Irwin hosted a private and expensive banquet where “na poo aupuni kieke o ka Emepire” (the foremost government leaders of the empire) met Kalākaua.¹⁰⁹ At one especially interesting dinner at the royal Akasaka Palace, maka‘āinana farewells to Kalākaua during his recent departure of his kingdom became the topic of discussion, including the “loyal ovation of Kohalans; and especially the incident of the bearing of the King on the shoulders of his people, through the surf by torchlight.” Apparently, the imperial family had read about this in the *PCA*, and the emperor was pleased with Hawaiians’ loyalty to their mō‘ī.¹¹⁰ At still another dinner, cherry blossoms were arranged to form “Aloha” at Kalākaua’s table, and paper lanterns with the Hawaiian and Japanese flags etched onto them illuminated the palace grounds.

A visit not discussed in later histories, but heavily covered by the nineteenth-century Hawaiian- and English-language newspapers, was one made to Dr. Shobun Goto, the head physician at the Leprosy Hospital in Tokyo. Kalākaua wanted to learn about his methods and described Goto afterward as “kaulana a akamai no hoi” (very famous and intelligent).¹¹¹ Leprosy was a topic of great concern in Hawai‘i at the time. While the mō‘ī was on his tour, the *PCA* reported on Regent Lili‘uokalani’s visit to Kalaupapa and on the Honorable John M. Kapena’s speech to the patients there about Kalākaua’s visit with Goto, proof that the mō‘ī “has never forgotten you, and never forgets to look for means to benefit you. He has

been ever inquiring to find doctors and medicines that can cure this disease.”¹¹² In 1886, the Hawaiian government brought Goto to Kaka’ako and Kalaupapa to treat patients there.¹¹³ There could hardly be more compelling evidence that for Kalākaua, the world tour was a vehicle for improving his kingdom domestically as well as internationally.

Kalākaua wrote many letters to his loved ones back in Hawai’i about his trip. He signed them with many names. “Kawaihau” appeared at the end of his letter to Lili’u dated March 14, 1881,¹¹⁴ from Tokyo and his March 26, 1881, letter from Shanghai.¹¹⁵ But his letter from Bangkok on April 27, 1881, addressed to Kaleoaloha was signed “Laamea.”¹¹⁶ Hawaiians commonly used different names in different situations. For Lili’u he was Kawaihau (the Chilly Water), a name given to him in a mele. La’amea (the Holy One or the Sacred One) was one of his given names and often appeared in letters to those outside his family. When maka’āinana addressed him, they often paired David with La’amea.¹¹⁷ As for Kaleoaloha (the Beloved Voice), it was probably his affectionate name for *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, the paper diligently publishing positive accounts of his journey for readers in Hawai’i.

On March 14, the Japanese emperor presented Kalākaua with the Order of the Chrysanthemum. The jewel alone was said to be worth \$4,000.¹¹⁸ Armstrong and Judd received the Order of the Rising Sun,¹¹⁹ more gestures fortifying the relationship between Hawai’i and Japan, according to Kalākaua. The emperor and empress also presented him with “vases, silks, tablecloths, lacquered boxes, and embroideries.”¹²⁰ In a letter to Lili’u, Kalākaua marveled at the compliment the entire Japan visit had paid him: “O na hookahakaha a me na hoohanohano ana i ko makou wa i haalele ai ia Iapana ua like ia me na hoohanohano ana i ko makou wa i ku mai ai” (The pomp and honors at the time we departed from Japan resembled the honors seen at the time we arrived).¹²¹

Through Asia to Europe

On March 22, 1881, the mō'i and his entourage departed Nagasaki for China. In Tientsin, he pursued opportunities to improve his kingdom, including negotiating for more plantation laborers *and* their wives. Kalākaua's letters home offered a different version of the tour than even the Hawai'i newspapers actively supporting him. While selections published in those loyal newspapers highlighted the royal receptions and ceremonies given in his and Hawai'i's honor, such as this one from Hong Kong: "Nui na ahaaina a me na hookipa manawalea i haawi ia no makou" (There have been many banquets and generous welcomes given for us),¹²² his journal entries, and letters meant only for their recipients, provide detailed accounts of his meetings, visits, and interviews intended for the benefit of Hawai'i nei. Perhaps he wanted to keep this business from his legislature. But any business meetings took place in a whirlwind of ceremonies. In Kanahae (Shanghai), he appeared "iloko o ka hanohano a me ka hauoli i ike ole ia mamua ae no na la loihi i apo ia mai ai oia e na kaukau alii a me ka poe kiekie i kapaia na Manadarina" (amid the honors and enjoyment never seen before for the many days when [Kalākaua] was embraced by the nobles and the leading officials called the mandarins).¹²³ At the Gulf of Siam, he was surprised to be greeted by five Siamese princes, who told him that their government had learned from Hong Kong of his approaching arrival. An account of the welcome from King Chulalongkorn appeared in one of Kalākaua's own letters home. In full dress, the prince and his officials greeted him. The mō'i met the entire royal family, including the last Maha Uparaja, the second king to Chulalongkorn. The mō'i also wrote about a silver and gold plate, vase, golden elephant statue, fine silks, and other gifts presented to him and Kapi'olani. Because Hawai'i did not retain a consul in Siam, Kalākaua had actually expected to travel incognito there. But Chulalongkorn heartily welcomed him, and before Kalākaua left for Singapore, he wrote home: "Nui ko makou aloha i na Alii o keia aupuni"

(Our love for the aristocracy of this kingdom is great).¹²⁴

The recipients of Kalākaua's correspondence were chosen for specific reasons. Coeditor Joseph Kawainui told his readers that the mō'i's April 19, 1881, letter from Hong Kong was written especially for *Ko Hawaii*.¹²⁵ There, the respect and generosity that emperors, kings, princes, and other leaders showed to Kalākaua are presented as encouragement for his own and Kanaka Maoli attempts to preserve Hawai'i's independence. Clearly, with his approval, Kapi'olani shared a portion of his letter to her from Singapore with *Ka Elele*. After describing his visit with the maharajah of Johor at his palace, Kalākaua links the meeting to progress for Hawai'i: "Ua oluolu maikai no ka makou huakai e hele nei me ke ano nui o na pomaikai i loa a i ko kakou Aupuni a me ko kakou Lahui me keia huakai kaahele honua a makou e hele nei" (Our present journey is very pleasing along with the great benefits obtained by our kingdom and our nation on this global tour that we are making).¹²⁶ On this stage of his journey, then, Kalākaua describes receiving recognition from much larger, wealthier, and more powerful nations, which could only help Hawai'i maintain its independence in the face of Western imperialism.

Kalākaua traveled on, crossing some 1,305 miles from Aden to Suez. By this point, *Ka Elele* felt it could safely generalize that "ma na wahi a pau a ka Moi i kipa aku, ua haawi ia mai na hookipa hiwahiwa me ke aloha, a ua nui na ma halo ana a kela a me keia no kona kulana, no kona ano a me kana mau hana" (in all the places the king visited, honorable welcomes were given with affection and gratitude of everyone according to his status because of his personality and deeds).¹²⁷ This could serve as a summary for the entire tour—and similar statements would appear frequently in the domestic newspapers over the following months. Kalākaua sent back personal observations as well—he found the Red Sea nani (beautiful). As for his arrival in Cairo, *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina* reported that Kalākaua received a royal welcome even though he had not informed the Egyptian government he would be visiting:

Ua haohao oia, i ka hiki ana aku o kekahi mau elele, a hoolauna aku la ia lakou iho i ka Moi, me ka olelo ana: He mau elele makou malalo o na kauoha a Khedive, (oia hoi ko Alii Kui o Aigubita) i hoounaia mai nei mai Cairo mai, (no ka loihi he 155 mile) e hookipa mai ia oe e ka Moi ma na kaiaulu nani o ke kulanakauhale o Cairo nei.¹²⁸

(He was astonished at the arrival of some messengers, and they introduced themselves to the king, saying, "We are messengers under the khedive's order (he was the second in command of Egypt) sent from Cairo (the distance of 155 miles) to welcome you, the king, to the beautiful communities of the city of Cairo.")

On June 24, as the guest of the khedive of Egypt and Sudan, Tewfik Pasha, Kalākaua attended a large banquet in his honor with ballroom dancing at the royal palace in Alexandria. A twenty-one-gun salute was sounded in the harbor on the day Hawai'i's royal entourage departed.

From Egypt the mō'i went to Italy. On August 13, 1881, *Ko Hawaii* printed a letter from James Kāneholo Booth and Robert Nāpu'ako Boyd to Joseph Kawainui about Kalākaua's June 30 stop in Naples.¹²⁹ Under the mō'i's newly established study abroad program, Booth was attending the Royal Military Academy in Naples and Boyd the Royal Naval Academy in Leghorn.¹³⁰ They had left Hawai'i in August 1880, so one can only imagine their feelings upon seeing their beloved mō'i again. Hoping that all of Hawai'i would read their account, these young Hawaiians celebrated their aloha for Kalākaua and the lāhui:

I ka hookokoke ana mai o ka mokuahi Asia i ke awa ma ka hora 11 A.M., me ka hae Hawaii e welo ana ma kona kia waena, e hai mai ana hoi ei ae o Kalani.... Ia makou i kokoke aku ai ma ka aoao o ka Asia, ua ike koke aku la no maua i ke Alii e ku mai ana me ka hiehie nui.¹³¹

(When the steamship *Asia* neared the harbor at 11 a.m.

with the Hawaiian flag fluttering on its main mast, the Royal One approaches.... When we neared the side of the *Asia*, we quickly saw the king standing in grand magnificence.)

In Naples, the mayor, admirals, and other city officials greeted Kalākaua.¹³² At the hotel, “o ka poe a pau i hele aku e ike a lulu lima me ia. Aole e hiki ia lakou ke umi iho i ko lakou hoomaikai ana ka mahalo piha ana nona” (all the people went to see and shake hands with him. They were not able to restrain their congratulations, full of respect for him).¹³³ On July 1, Kalākaua met with King Umberto and Queen Margherita, “a ua apo mai laua me ka puili pumehana, a hookipa aku la i ka malihini me ka hanohano kiekie” (and they two grasped [him] in a warm embrace and welcomed the visitor with distinguished honors).¹³⁴ Though Boyd’s and Booth’s Italian was rudimentary, they could tell that Kalākaua made a good impression: “Buon uomo. Bel uomo. Bel cuore. A pela aku ma ka waha o na mea a pau” (Good man. Good-looking man. Lovely or good heart. And this was in the mouths of all of them).¹³⁵ On July 8, 1881, Robert Kalanihiapo Wilcox, then training at the Regia Accademia Militare, sent Joseph Kawainui a letter stating that when they learned Kalākaua was coming their way, the people of Milan decorated the streets and were disappointed when he detoured to Turin.¹³⁶ In a second letter to Kawainui and his readers, dated July 12, 1881, Wilcox wrote that the “City of Milan” was still hoping to see Kalākaua when he returned to Berlin and Vienna.¹³⁷ The mō‘ī made his way to Rome, where he met with Pope Leo XIII. Kalākaua’s letter to Severance from there showed that he was following the press coverage of his own journey: “If this is the way and manner by which I am sent away to die, as I see some of the American Newspapers have it, I assure you, it is one of the most agreeable and pleasant ways of dying.”¹³⁸ But he was also there on business. *Ka Elele* reported that he was searching intently for a specialist from Rome to discuss the spread of leprosy in Hawai‘i.¹³⁹

From there Kalākaua went on to England as the special guest of Queen Victoria. In an interview with the *HG*, William N. Armstrong acknowledged that Kalākaua “received a great deal of attention from her Royal Majesty, from the Royal family, and from the nobility.”¹⁴⁰ Here, Kalākaua describes the first moments he spent with her: “Ua hoohaahaa loa iho hoi au i ka’u kunou ana. Ua hele mai oia a imua o’u, lalau mai la i ko’u lima a noho iho la maluna o kekahi punee me ke noi pu mai e noho au i lalo ma ka noho kokoke e huli aku ana iaia.” (I bowed very low. She came before me, grasped my hand and then sat upon a settee requesting that I also sit on the settee nearly facing her.) He added that Queen Victoria was very impressed with his English.¹⁴¹ *Ko Hawaii* reported that in addition to the queen herself and the heir, the Prince of Wales, many English nobility wished to meet, shake hands with, and spend prolonged visits with Kalākaua. Treating him as her personal guest, the queen loaned Kalākaua the royal carriage and her royal box at the theater,¹⁴² granting him access to public spaces where he could see and be seen. *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina* concluded that he responded in the appropriate manner to this attention:

Ua haawi ia mai imua o ko kakou Moi, na hookipa hanohano a me na malama oluolu loa ana a ko kakou Moi i mahalo loa ai. Ua hoike aku hoi oia imua o na aupuni nui, ma na wahi a pau ana i kipa aku ai, i kona malama naauao i kona kulana, he Moi no Hawaii nei.¹⁴³

(Presented before our king were honorary welcomes and exceeding care that our king greatly appreciated. He displayed his enlightened care according to his rank, the king of Hawai’i before great kingdoms at all places where he visited.)

Ka Elele Poakolu’s reprints of European newspapers’ accounts of Kalākaua in London shared with his people the honors he received,¹⁴⁴ and *Ka Elele* also repeatedly shared such accounts.¹⁴⁵ Kalākaua’s own appreciation was great: “O

kekahi hoi keia o na la haaheo loa o ko'u ola ana" (This is one of the most proud days of my life).¹⁴⁶

After England, the royal entourage stopped in Brussels and Vienna. *Ko Hawaii* translated a foreign newspaper account of Kalākaua's visit to Vienna. It declared that "he keu ka hialaai nui o na Keiki Alii o Europa a puni i ke Alii ka Moi Kalakaua o Hawaii, no kona oluolu launaole" (the royal princes throughout Europe are excessively fond of His Majesty King Kalākaua of Hawai'i because of his unmatched kindness).¹⁴⁷ As he toured the Imperial Arsenal, one journalist reported that "His Majesty made everywhere a very favorable impression, and evinced a surprising knowledge of all the technical sciences." At the Imperial Castle of Schonbrunn, another reporter observed that he "made several remarks which showed him perfectly conversant with Austrian history." The *PCA* also quoted a Viennese newspaper: "The King makes a good impression at first sight. A thorough gentleman in dress, manners, and speech; his affability and kindness are such as to make him beloved by everyone with whom he comes in contact."¹⁴⁸ Kalākaua went on to Paris, where he wrote back to Hawai'i, "Ua hookipa hano-hano loa ia makou maanei, a ua haawi mai na makaainana ia makou i na aloha ana ohaoha ma na wahi a pau a makou e kipa aku" (We were welcomed very honorably here, and the people gave us affectionate greetings in all the places we visited).¹⁴⁹

Then it was on to Madrid and Lisbon, where Kalākaua was serenaded with "Hawai'i Pono'i," attended a state reception, and received a royal welcome "greater and more imposing than at any other European capital." He met with King Louis, to whom Kalākaua presented several orders and decorations. As for state business, after his meeting with officials there, the Hawaiian commissioner for immigration negotiated passage for three hundred Portuguese families to Hawai'i. They arrived before Kalākaua returned. Back in Madrid, he met with the minister of foreign affairs. Then, upon his return to Paris, he posed for photographs taken with that new innovation, electric lighting. He sat in the presidential box at the Besselievre concert, listening as "Kalakaua March,"

written in his honor, was played. After visiting the Louvre, more orders and decorations were exchanged.¹⁵⁰ Retracing his steps to London, the mō'i dined with the royal family. In Scotland, he attended a special Masonic meeting, where he was presented the Knight Grand Cross of the Imperial Council of Scotland and congratulated by the "thousands of Freemasons" of Scotland who knew of the mō'i's "great talents as a Mason and the high position" he had reached. At the train station, a large crowd bid him adieu with alohas and hurrahs.¹⁵¹ From Liverpool, he sailed for America—but not before a Scottish journalist had this to say:

His manner and deportment are ... those of a thoroughly well-bred gentleman. He is very affable, while retaining the natural dignity befitting his position. Possessed of remarkable conversational powers, he expresses himself well in English with a slight foreign accent. He is acute in his criticisms, which manifest culture and originality of thought, and when speaking of his travels shows that he is keen-sighted, and has received impressions which are not likely to be lost in furthering the comfort and happiness of the people over whom it is his lot to rule.¹⁵²

The Significance of the Tour and of the Welcome Home

After a swift passage across the Atlantic and across the American continent, Kalākaua returned to Hawai'i on October 29. The *HG* praised his efforts and his success: "That he has been so well received—at all points in his travels must be a matter of pride to the Hawaiian Nation—and that a more intimate knowledge of our affairs as well as interest in our welfare and future will be the result, no one can doubt."¹⁵³ The *HG* published a piece from the *Whitehall Review* in its entirety. Parts were discussed in [chapter 2](#), but its concluding estimation, when published in a Hawai'i newspaper, articulates his own people's pride that their mō'i

was not just treated well but admired as a truly remarkable leader: “I parted from His Majesty with regret, envying his subjects, and with a forlorn patriotic wish that the taste of English country life of which he had spoken so warmly might induce him to settle in our own island.”¹⁵⁴ Kānaka Maoli were surely gratified, though probably not surprised, that their mō‘ī left such an impression with people around the world.

Though the 1881 world tour was seen by Kalākaua’s critics—and many later commentators—as a self-indulgent and expensive publicity stunt, the Hawai‘i newspapers provided compelling documentation that at the time, this journey was recognized as important for Hawai‘i’s future prosperity. “It ought not to be supposed for a moment,” wrote one commentator, “that His Majesty has spent so long a time and incurred so considerable an expense, to say nothing of the inevitable fatigues and inconveniences of such rapid travelling, with no purpose before him but that of pleasure and sight-seeing.”¹⁵⁵ In fact, Kalākaua’s 1881 tour is perhaps the most obvious example of how he used his position and character to legitimize Hawai‘i as an independent nation in the eyes of the world. When, for instance, he saw how important the exchange of orders and decorations was as a symbol of relations between nations, he immediately created such currency for himself and Hawai‘i. On May 12, 1881, Kalākaua wrote from Singapore to officials back in Hawai‘i:

I hope you will impress it upon the minds of the executive Committee the necessity of carrying out my wishes as regards the exchange of decorations. By these exchanges depends the success of any future movement our government may take in desiring to procure immigrants from Japan, China, Siam and Johore. Decorations have a powerfull [sic] weight upon the minds of the Asiatic Prince’s [sic].¹⁵⁶

Very much committed to promoting Hawai‘i’s independent yet friendly status as a nation, Kalākaua was a fast learner.

Note how confidently he deploys such symbols in India at his audience with the maharajah of Johor:

I have invested him and his uncle with the Grand Cross of the order of Kalakaua I. I did not ask for an exchange as he has not established an order but I hear he will establish one soon. I hope you will also impress it upon the minds of the Committee to confer the order of 4th class Kalakaua order upon our consuls. Those decorated gives an importance to the nations they represent and it is but proper during my tour around the world and the services they have performed during my stay in Japan, China, Siam, and Singapore which has contributed greatly to the pleasantness and convenience of our trip around the world should be recognized.¹⁵⁷

When the mō'i arrived anywhere, he almost always requested a tour of the most famous sights, particularly academies and factories—not just to satisfy his keen intellectual curiosity but to gather new ideas for improvements at home. Those requests also allowed him to display his cultured, well-read, and learned mind as well as his appreciation for innovation. His desire to secure his nation's independence by implementing other nations' successful and progressive ideas constantly motivated him—and, to a remarkable degree, in the Hawaiian newspapers his people at home could follow his actions on their behalf.

As always, the space devoted to and the nature of the coverage reflected the publishers' politics. The *Saturday Press* printed a mere two-thirds of a column of coverage on page 5, largely about the mō'i's return to Honolulu.¹⁵⁸ In Gibson's newspapers he powerfully advocated for the lāhui's independence and the wisdom of Kalākaua in embarking on his journey: "The King's tour round the World, may be regarded as an advertisement of this Kingdom of incalculable value. Measures and negotiations are now feasible, which would hardly have been entertained some time ago."¹⁵⁹ Similar contrasts also appeared in what and how much the

three main Hawaiian-language newspapers—*Nupepa Kuokoa*, *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, and *Ka Elele Poakolu*, which the *Saturday Press* noted in 1881 each published three thousand to five thousand copies weekly¹⁶⁰—told their readers about their mōʻī's travels. For the entire journey, Whitney's *Kuokoa* printed fewer than ten accounts—mostly brief—amounting to roughly six columns, or one page from a correspondent, or extracts from secondhand articles. Some articles mirrored those of a gazette, simply listing the monarch's itinerary. Given the paper's politics, Kalākaua was not corresponding with the editors, so nineteenth-century readers relying on *Kuokoa* exclusively for coverage received a sketchy version of the 1881 global tour, with little or nothing about the honors and pageantry that the world's most powerful nations bestowed upon Kalākaua or about the expressed admiration and respect their leaders felt for him. The intention seems to have been to present the 1881 trip almost as if it never happened. To have informed readers would have been to acknowledge a triumph for Native independence and the throne, neither of which *Kuokoa* supported.

But *Ko Hawaii* printed more than thirty pieces, including letters from the mōʻī to the Kawainui brothers that were clearly intended for general publication. The result was six full pages, or thirty-two columns, of Kalākaua's own accounts of his travels, replete with names, places, and minute but meaningful details, such as the prominent yachts, carriages, and theater boxes loaned to him; the impressive decor of the many palaces and grand halls he visited; the large crowds that gathered to catch a glimpse of him; and the countless favors and gifts that many leaders and officials presented to Hawai'i's mōʻī. Gibson's *Ka Elele Poakolu* also had access to the mōʻī's letters and published twenty-four stories, ranging in length from one paragraph to six columns and making up roughly twenty-seven columns, or four pages.¹⁶¹ *Ka Elele* gave a running account of the journey, even if only a single paragraph, assuring readers of the mōʻī's good health and describing his welcome at the last place he had visited. Both *Ko Hawaii's* and *Ka Elele's* accounts display a Hawaiian

nationalism, or aloha ‘āina, which was crucial to sustain within Kanaka Maoli hearts. Or, as Gibson put it:

E hauoli ana na puuwai Hawaii ke heluhelu iho i na olelo o ka Leta Alii a ko kakou Moi aloha, e hoike mai ana i na mea ano nui e pili ana i kekahi mau mea o kana huakai kaapuni honua. Aole wale no hoi o ka hauoli no kona hookipa hanoahano ia mai e like me kona kulana, aka, o na manao hoomaikai a aloha kekahi i na lahui—mai na Poo a i na makaainana—a pau i pahola mai ia mau haawina kilakila e poina ole ia ai e Hawaii uuku nei. He oiaio, ma keia mau haawina kamahao, he aie nui ko keia lahui i ko kela mau Aupuni, no ka lakou mau hana aloha; a o ka kakou wale no, o ka hoolilo ia ana o na hiona a pau i hoea ae ma ko ka Moi kaahale ana, i mau kuni paa e mau ai ke aloha mawaena o kahi me kahi, ma ko kakou hana ana i na hana maikai imua o ko ke ao nei.¹⁶²

(Hawaiian hearts will be gladdened when they read the words of our beloved king’s royal letter relating the rather important things related to certain of the details of his journey around the globe. Not only of the joy of his honorary welcomes according to his rank but the congratulatory and loving thoughts toward all the nations—from the leaders to the commoners—who spread out these majestic honors, which will not be forgotten by little Hawai’i. Truly, through these wondrous presentations, the people of this nation have a great debt to those nations for their kind deeds; and as for us the transformation of all the features upon the king’s travels will become continually perpetuated between one and the other with love in our doing good works before those of the world.)

It is important, therefore, to note that nineteenth-century Hawaiian-language and English-language newspapers differed greatly in their allegiances to Native-based national movements, and furthermore, that the language of publication is not a certain guide to the editors’ loyalties. As

we have seen, the dichotomy between foreigners who desired American annexation and Hawaiians devoted to preserving the nation's independence profoundly affected the coverage of one of Kalākaua's most notable accomplishments in the Hawaiian-language newspapers. Though often referred to as a "native press" because of its important series on Hawaiian history and culture, *Kuokoa* was a business and foreign influence advocate. In its pages, the mō'i's travels were purely recreational, absent of any political significance. Whitney, its editor, would later publish pamphlets attacking Kalākaua and Gibson. *Ko Hawaii's* and *Ka Elele's* articles stressed the public honors and also published Kalākaua's own accounts of his actions on behalf of his nation, clearly a collaborative political act. The mō'i needed to present himself, his journey, and his reception in ways that would make his Native readership feel recognized and secure. Even at a distance, he was working tirelessly for them, and *Ko Hawaii's*, *Elele's*, and the English-language *PCA's* coverage of the 1881 journey provide reasons for Kānaka Maoli to take a legitimate and personal pride in their mō'i and lāhui. Or, as Gibson's *PCA* put it: "The generous and magnificent hospitality of the Emperor of Japan, and of his Princes and dignitaries, to our King, calls for the warmest and liveliest expression of gratitude on the part of the Hawaiian people; because, evidently, the great honor and distinction accorded, was intended for them, as well as to mark a personal regard for the Sovereign."¹⁶³

The celebrations of Kalākaua's return home display maka'āinana unity and loyalty to the throne. Even the *HG* had to admit that "we never remember having seen such an amount of excitement about the streets; the enthusiasm was genuine."¹⁶⁴ As early as August, the people of Honolulu established committees to decorate the city, invited residents of all races to create adornments for the streets, and coordinated the processions escorting Kalākaua from the Ka'iwi channel between Moloka'i and O'ahu to the gates of the palace. One meeting saw his reception abroad as a challenge to his own nation. Thanks to the newspapers,

people had been following the mōʻī “with pride from the East on to Great Britain, where he was received with all the honors of an independent sovereign, and this pride of ours is the same as though we were millions instead of thousands.”¹⁶⁵ Three “roaring cheers” for Kalākaua concluded the meeting.¹⁶⁶ Liliʻuokalani was another eyewitness to the excitement:

With that enthusiasm always shown by the Hawaiian people in doing honor to their sovereigns, the grandest preparations were made throughout the islands to welcome the arrival of the king.... The streets were given up to the people, and were crowned with triumphal arches. The mottoes, in the selection of which numberless parties had consulted me, were displayed in every part of the city, and there was an especial arch designed for each district of the island of Oahu.¹⁶⁷

Evergreens, maile, ti, ferns, and other flowers and plants were strewn along the streets from the harbor to ʻIolani Palace. Dozens upon dozens of inscriptions in Hawaiian and English proclaimed the mōʻī’s subjects’ pride: “Welcome to Our King,” “We Are All the King’s Own,” “Hawaii Kui Lima me Kina” (Hawaii and China Have Joined Hands), “Ka Hiwa Hiwa Aloha” (The Best Beloved), “Long Live the King,” “Aloha nui Oe ka Moi Kalakaua, Koolauloa, Oahu” (Great Love to You, King Kalākaua from Koʻolauloa, Oʻahu), “Mau ka welo o ka Hae Hawaii” (May the Hawaiian Flag Ever Wave), “Welcome Beloved David; King Circumnavigator,” “Aloha Nui ka Moi Kalakaua” (Greetings, King Kalākaua),¹⁶⁸ and, in a significant adaptation of Julius Caesar, “Ua hele, ua ike, ua hoi mai” (I Went, I Saw, I Returned). One hundred Latter-day Saints from Lāʻie traveled to Honolulu for the morning procession, joined by delegates from parts of Oʻahu; from Maui, including residents of Lahaina, Wailuku, Hāna, Kāʻanapali, and ʻUlupalakua; and from Hawaiʻi’s southern Kona District. About one thousand children marched in the procession. That evening, two hundred firemen marched in a

parade to greet the mōʻī in front of ʻIolani Palace. Some of the arches and homes along the streets were illuminated. Aliʻiōlani Hale was lit up with different colors and flags in each of its windows, bonfires were ablaze atop Puōwaina, and Honolulu Harbor was “made as bright as day” by electric lights.¹⁶⁹

As for the newspapers, even *Kuokoa* could not avoid noting the significance of Kalākaua’s trip and the triumph of his return:

Aohe Alii o Hawaii i makaikai nui i ko na aina e a kaapuni hoi i ka honua e like me ka Moi Kalakaua. Aohe no hoi o kakou Alii i hele i na aina e me ka paholaia ana mai o na hookipa hanohano nui imua ona e like me keia. A pela no hoi ma kona hoi ana mai nei, aohe Alii i apo ia aku me na hana hoohiwahiwa ma ka aoao o na makaainana e like me ko ka Moi a kakou i ike pono iho nei ma Honolulu iloko o keia mau la.¹⁷⁰

(No other king of Hawaiʻi has made such an important visit to people of foreign lands around the world as King Kalākaua. Certainly, no other of our kings has gone to foreign lands with the extension of great honors before him as this king. And indeed in that way was his return; no other king was embraced with the honors on the part of the people as those of our king as we personally witnessed here in Honolulu these days.)

Gibson’s *PCA* predictably reported that “loyalty and enthusiasm, and mottoes dictated by the warmest and highest regard for the Sovereign, met the royal gaze on every side, on proceeding up Fort street.”¹⁷¹ Business agent Joseph E. Wiseman, who had already printed up a pamphlet titled *Sketches of King Kalakaua’s Tour round the World*, presented a copy to the mōʻī and distributed one hundred more that morning as he was entering the harbor.¹⁷²

In comparing Hawaiʻi’s newspaper coverage of the 1874 royal tour of the kingdom and the 1881 tour of the world, the

1881 tour more clearly determined a paper's loyalty to the monarchy, so newspapers either outright supported or opposed Kalākaua. For example, in 1881 the English-language newspapers, along with *Nupepa Kuokoa*, took more liberty in disregarding the honorary welcomes and celebrations for Kalākaua. Those newspapers' accounts of people's favor for the mō'ī were more abbreviated than the briefest favorable accounts of the 1874 tour. The publicity of the world's approval of this king and the endorsement of his kingdom meant more danger for the white oligarchy, as the coverage only seemed to validate Kalākaua's ability to rule and justify the existence of the independence of the Hawaiian Nation. And if *Kuokoa* chose not to publish Italy's celebrations of the king, for example, some local readers might never know the difference. In essence, the newspapers' coverage of both journeys attests to the fact that a different account could be read depending on the paper. The favorable Hawaiian-language newspaper accounts of the 1874 tour, describing maka'āinana aloha and loyalty for Kalākaua, and those stories about the awe and respect people worldwide held for the mō'ī imparted pride and happiness in maka'āinana, as seen in their tributes to the king when he returned to Honolulu on both occasions. The newspaper coverage of the journeys enlivened the people of Hawai'i—which was one of Kalākaua's original goals—by awakening them to a sense of hope and nationalism. The newspapers' overall representation of people's reception of Kalākaua in 1874 and 1881 are inconsistent with the image of him described in [chapter 1](#). By 1881, the king was aware of the papers that supported him, and he took charge of the way they represented him by providing personal accounts of his journey specifically for loyal readers.

The culminating honor paid to Kalākaua on his world tour was therefore from his own people, for his service to them, captured in the inaugural edition of the Hawaiian nationalist literary journal *Ke Koo o Hawaii* two years later:

Ma ko kakou Hae i loa'a ai ia kakou ke kahua onipaa o ke kuokoa; a he hoailona hoi e hoike ana ia Hawaii; e ike ia

mai ai, he lala oia no ka poai ohana hookahi, me na aupuni nui a pau o ka honua nei. A ma na wahi a pau e welo ai kona mau eheu, e ike ia mai ana ia, a e haawi ia mai no na hoohanohano, e like me ka hoohanohano ia ana o na Hae o na aupuni e ae a pau i kuleana like i ke kulana kiekie mawaena o ia anapuni ohana hookahi.¹⁷³

(In our flag we have a steadfast platform of independence; and it is a symbol presenting Hawaii; look, it is a member of the one family of nations, along with all of the great nations of the world. And everywhere which its fringes extend, it will be recognized, and it will indeed be given respect, as all the flags of all the other nations of high standing within that same family do.)¹⁷⁴

Notes

- ^{1.} Lili'uokalani, *Hawaii's Story*, 179.
- ^{2.} Kuykendall and Day, *Hawaii: A History*, 109, 110.
- ^{3.} Ibid., 150, 151.
- ^{4.} "At 11 A. M. on Tuesday," *PCA*, November 21, 1874, 2, Chronicling America; see also "Ua Haalele mai ka Moi," *Lau Oliva*, December 1, 1874, 2.
- ^{5.} "The King's Birthday," *HG*, November 18, 1874, 2, Chronicling America.
- ^{6.} "Ua Kau aku ke Alii ka Moi," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, November 21, 1874, 2, Ulukau.
- ^{7.} "Ka Moi o Hawaii. Na Hookipa Ulumahiehie a ka Hoa'loha Amerika. Ka Oluolu Maikai o ke Ola o ka Lani me na Ukali. Ka Holo ana ma ke Kaamahu Alii no Wasinetona," *Lahui Hawaii*, January 1, 1875, 2, Ulukau.
- ^{8.} "His Majesty in the United States," *PCA*, January 2, 1875, 2, Chronicling America.
- ^{9.} "Ka Moi o Hawaii," *Lahui Hawaii*, January 1, 1875, 2.
- ^{10.} "Ke Alii ka Moi Kalakaua ma Kapalakiko," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, December 19, 1874, 2, Ulukau.
- ^{11.} "His Majesty in the United States," *PCA*, January 2, 1875, 2; "The Royal Progress. King Kalakaua in the United States," *HG*, January 20, 1875, 2, Chronicling America; "The Accounts of His Majesty's Journey through the United States," *PCA*, January 16, 1875, 2, Chronicling America.
- ^{12.} "The News Brought by the Mail of Wednesday," *PCA*, January 2, 1875, 2, Chronicling America.
- ^{13.} "Accounts of His Majesty's Journey," *PCA*, January 16, 1875, 2.
- ^{14.} "Ke Alii ka Moi Kalakaua ma Amerika Huipuia! Ka Moolelo o ka Huakai

Alii. Palapala mai ka Lutanela Whiting mai," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, January 30, 1875, 1-2, Ulukau.

- [15.](#) "His Majesty the King Arrived in Washington on Saturday, December 12," *HG*, January 6, 1875, 2, Chronicling America.
- [16.](#) It was said that the US Foreign Affairs Committee set aside \$50,000 to receive and host King Kalākaua in Washington, DC.
- [17.](#) "He Mea Oluolu," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, January 9, 1875, 2, Ulukau.
- [18.](#) "Accounts of His Majesty's Journey," *PCA*, January 16, 1875, 2.
- [19.](#) "The Royal Progress. King Kalakaua in the United States," *HG*, January 20, 1875, 2.
- [20.](#) "King Kalakaua in America. Spirit of the America Press," *HG*, January 6, 1875, 2, Chronicling America.
- [21.](#) "It Is Gratifying to Us," *HG*, January 20, 1875, 2, Chronicling America.
- [22.](#) "The Royal Progress. King Kalakaua in the United States," *HG*, January 20, 1875, 2.
- [23.](#) "Ke Alii ka Moi Kalakaua ma Amerika," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, January 30, 1875, 1.
- [24.](#) "Ma na Lono a me na Moololo," *Lahui Hawaii*, January 21, 1875, 2, Ulukau.
- [25.](#) Lili'uokalani, *Hawaii's Story*, 78.
- [26.](#) "Ke Manaoia aku nei e Hiki mai ana ka Moi Kalakaua ma Honolulu nei," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, February 13, 1875, 2, Ulukau.
- [27.](#) "Hanohano Akea i ka Moi!," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, February 13, 1875, 2, Ulukau.
- [28.](#) "Ke Lii ka Moi Kalakaua. Ka Hehi Lanakila Hou ana i ke One Oihi. Ka Maalahi Maikai o ke Ola o ka Moi me kona mau Ukali. Ka Huliamahi o na Makaaainana me ka Hookipa ana mai ia ka Lani," *Lahui Hawaii*, February 18, 1875, 3, Ulukau.
- [29.](#) "Ke Lii ka Moi Kalakaua. Ka Hehi," *Lahui Hawaii*, February 18, 1875, 3.
- [30.](#) "Return of King Kalakaua! The Popular Uprising to Greet Him," *HG*, February 17, 1875, 3, Chronicling America.
- [31.](#) "Ke Lii ka Moi Kalakaua. Ka Hehi," *Lahui Hawaii*, February 18, 1875, 3.
- [32.](#) "Return of King Kalakaua!," *HG*, February 17, 1875, 3.
- [33.](#) A poetical name for David Kalākaua, as he was the seventh mō'i of the Hawaiian Kingdom beginning with Kamehameha I.
- [34.](#) Kalākaua inherited this name, Kaululiaokeanuwaialeale (Doubly cold is Mount Wai'ale'ale), from a chant.
- [35.](#) "The Arrival of His Majesty," *PCA*, May 2, 1874, 2.
- [36.](#) Kuykendall and Day, *Hawaii: A History*, 108.
- [37.](#) "Ma ka Poano, La 20 o Feberuari," *Lahui Hawaii*, February 25, 1875, 2, Ulukau.
- [38.](#) Kuykendall and Day, *Hawaii: A History*, 109-115.
- [39.](#) US Department of State, "His Majesty's Address," 676.
- [40.](#) Mellen, *Island Kingdom*, 23.
- [41.](#) In taking over the *PCA*, Gibson was instructed to "conduct, manage and edit" that paper in order to "support the Hawaiian Government and its policy, and pursue a line of discussion ... best calculated to carry out the measures of His Hawaiian Majesty's Government," as well as to "be

invariably loyal to His Majesty." Chaplin, *Presstime in Paradise*, 83.

- [42.](#) "A Communication Is Sent to Us from Kohala," *HG*, December 15, 1880, 2, *Chronicling America*.
- [43.](#) "The King among His People on Hawaii," *PCA*, December 11, 1880, 2, *Chronicling America*.
- [44.](#) W. N. Armstrong, *Around the World*, 1.
- [45.](#) *Ibid.*, 3.
- [46.](#) *Ibid.*, 6.
- [47.](#) Lili'uokalani, *Hawaii's Story*, 76.
- [48.](#) *Ibid.*, 77.
- [49.](#) "Ka Huakai Kaapuni Honua a ke Alii ka Moi," *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, January 15, 1881, 2, *Ulukau*; "Referring Again to the Rumor," *PCA*, November 20, 1880, 2, *Chronicling America*; "The Rumors about the Probability of His Majesty the King Making a Tour Abroad," *Saturday Press*, November 27, 1880, 2, *Chronicling America*; "A Council of Regency," *PCA*, December 4, 1880, 2, *Chronicling America*; "The King among His People," *PCA*, December 11, 1880, 2.
- [50.](#) Damon, *Sanford Ballard Dole*, 157.
- [51.](#) "Ka Moi no Europa," *Elele Poakolu*, January 12, 1881, 5.
- [52.](#) "His Majesty the King Was Heartily Welcomed," *Saturday Press*, December 18, 1880, 3, *Chronicling America*; "The King among His People," *PCA*, December 11, 1880, 2; "Ka Huakai Alii," *Elele Poakolu*, December 8, 1880, 4.
- [53.](#) "Kohala Outdoing Itself," *HG*, December 22, 1880, 6, *Chronicling America*.
- [54.](#) "The King on Hawaii. The Grand Ball at Kaiopihi," *PCA*, December 25, 1880, 2, *Chronicling America*.
- [55.](#) "The King at Kohala," *Wednesday Express*, December 15, 1880, 1.
- [56.](#) "His Majesty on Kauai," *PCA*, January 8, 1881, 2, *Chronicling America*.
- [57.](#) "Ka Moi ma Kona Akau," *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, January 15, 1881, 1, *Ulukau*.
- [58.](#) "Ka Huakai a ke Alii ka Moi i ka Mokupuni o Kauai," *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, January 8, 1881, 4, *Ulukau*.
- [59.](#) "Ka Moi ma Maui," *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, January 15, 1881, 2, *Ulukau*.
- [60.](#) "Ua Hoi mai ka Moi," *Elele Poakolu*, December 22, 1880, 4.
- [61.](#) "The King on Hawaii," *PCA*, December 25, 1880, 2.
- [62.](#) "From our Hilo Correspondent," *Saturday Press*, December 18, 1880, 4, *Chronicling America*.
- [63.](#) "Ka Huakai," *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, January 8, 1881, 4.
- [64.](#) "General Enthusiasm for King Kalakaua at Honolulu on the Eve of His Departure for Foreign Lands. Speeches of the King and Cabinet and American Minister and Others," *HG*, January 19, 1881, 3, *Chronicling America*.
- [65.](#) "On Sunday Evening Upwards of a Thousand People, Almost Entirely Natives Assembled in Kawaiahao Church," *HG*, January 19, 1881, 3, *Chronicling America*.
- [66.](#) "Kalani Kamahale a Ukali. Na Hoohiwi mamua o ka Holo ana," *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, January 22, 1881, 2, *Ulukau*; "A Group of Natives," *Saturday Press*, January 22, 1881, 4, *Chronicling America*.

- [67.](#) "Farewell to the King in the Capital," *Wednesday Express*, January 19, 1881, 1.
- [68.](#) "Kalani Kamahele," *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, January 22, 1881, 2.
- [69.](#) "Ka Holo ana o Kalani," *Elele Poakolu*, January 26, 1881, 5.
- [70.](#) "The Departure of His Majesty," *PCA*, January 22, 1881, 3, Chronicling America.
- [71.](#) "Ka Holo," *Elele Poakolu*, January 26, 1881, 5.
- [72.](#) "The Departure of His Majesty," *PCA*, January 22, 1881, 3.
- [73.](#) Kalākaua to Henry Severance, July 1881.
- [74.](#) "Ka Huakai Kaapuni Honua a ka Moi!," *Elele Pokolu*, March 2, 1881, 4.
- [75.](#) "The King's Tour around the World," *PCA*, February 26, 1881, 3.
- [76.](#) "The King's Popularity Abroad," *PCA*, February 26, 1881, 2, Chronicling America.
- [77.](#) "Ka Lani Moi! Na Hookipa Hiwahiwa a ka Mokuaina Gula. Au i ke Kai Anu no Iapana. He Haupū Aloha no Hawaii," *Elele Poakolu*, February 23, 1881, 4.
- [78.](#) "Nuhou o ko na Aina E: Ka Moi ma Kapalakiko," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, February 26, 1881, 3, Ulukau.
- [79.](#) "The Visit of the King to San Francisco," *PCA*, March 5, 1881, 2, Chronicling America.
- [80.](#) "Ka Moi Kalakaua ma Kapalakiko. He 9 La Holo ma ka Moana! Na Hookipa Hanohano i ka Moi. Ka Holo ana no Iapana!," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, March 5, 1881, 3, Ulukau.
- [81.](#) "Huakai a ke Alii Kalakaua i ko na Aina E," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, March 5, 1881, 4, Ulukau.
- [82.](#) "King Kalakaua Entertained at the Pacific Yacht Club," *PCA*, February 26, 1881, 3, Chronicling America.
- [83.](#) "The Chinese Consul-General's Dinner to Kalakaua," *PCA*, February 26, 1881, 3, Chronicling America.
- [84.](#) "A Royal Reception. The First Ball at the Palace within Two Years. A Brilliant Affair Magnificently Conducted—a Scene Long to be Remembered by Those Present," *PCA*, February 26, 1881, 3, Chronicling America.
- [85.](#) "French Ball," *PCA*, February 26, 1881, 3, Chronicling America.
- [86.](#) Kalākaua to Henry Severance, 1881.
- [87.](#) "Ka Moi ma Iapana! Na Hookipa Hanohano Loa! Ka Hoohanohanoia ana me ke Kea o Iapana! Ka Moolelo Piiia mai Kapalakiko a Hiki i Iapana! Ka Haalele ana ia Iapana no Kina! Ke Ku ana i Sanahai, Kina!," *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, April 23, 1881, 2, Ulukau.
- [88.](#) "He Kapa no Kalakaua," *Elele Poakolu*, April 20, 1881, 2; "2 Thoughts on 'Maewaikalani,' 1881," September 11, 2012, *Nupepa-hawaii* (blog).
- [89.](#) "We Regret to Learn," *Saturday Press*, April 9, 1881, 2, Chronicling America.
- [90.](#) "Ka Moi o Hawaii! Hookipa Pumehana ia Kalakaua. Na Leo Kupinai o ka Mahalo!," *Elele Poakolu*, April 20, 1881, 4.
- [91.](#) "Ka Moi ma Iapana!," *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, April 23, 1881, 2.
- [92.](#) "Whilst Naturally Feeling," *PCA*, April 23, 1881, 5, Chronicling America.
- [93.](#) "Ka Moi ma Iapana!," *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, April 23, 1881, 2; Marumoto,

- "Vignette of Early Hawaii," 53-54; Ono, "King Kalakaua in Japan."
- [94.](#) Ono, "King Kalakaua in Japan"; "Ka Moi ma Iapana!," *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, April 23, 1881, 2.
- [95.](#) "We Regret to Learn," *Saturday Press*, April 9, 1881, 2; "We Hear That the Japanese Government," *HG*, April 13, 1881, 2, *Chronicling America*.
- [96.](#) "We Hear That the Japanese Government," *HG*, April 13, 1881, 2.
- [97.](#) "The Emperor of Japan, as Reported, Desires to Receive Our Sovereign Travelling Incog. in His Dominion, as a King," *PCA*, April 16, 1881, 2, *Chronicling America*.
- [98.](#) "The Reception of the King by the Japanese Government Cannot but Be Gratifying to the Hawaiian People," *HG*, April 20, 1881, 2, *Chronicling America*.
- [99.](#) "The King's Tour around the World. Sonnet. Arrival at Yokohama. Extracts from Japanese Journals—Arrival at Yokohama. At the Akasaka Palace. The Masonic Ball. Imperial Court News. Japanese Resources," *PCA*, April 23, 1881, 5, *Chronicling America*.
- [100.](#) "The King's Visit to Japan," *PCA*, April 23, 1881, 6, *Chronicling America*.
- [101.](#) "Ka Moi ma Iapana!," *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, April 23, 1881, 2; Robert Von Olanhoffen claimed seven Russian, four French, one British, and two Japanese warships greeted the king in Yokohama harbor. "Na Nu Hou Hope," *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, April 23, 1881, 22.
- [102.](#) "The King's Tour around the World. Sonnet," *PCA*, April 23, 1881, 5.
- [103.](#) "Na Nu Hou," *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, April 30, 1881, 2.
- [104.](#) "Ka Moi o Hawaii! Hookipa," *Elele Poakolu*, April 20, 1881, 4.
- [105.](#) "Progress of Ke Alii Kalakaua. Brilliant Reception in Japan," *HG*, April 20, 1881, 2, *Chronicling America*.
- [106.](#) Ono, "King Kalakaua in Japan."
- [107.](#) After his term as the eighteenth US president ended, Ulysses S. Grant and his wife stayed at Enryokan when they visited Japan in 1879 on a tour of the world. Kalākaua visited the same places on his 1881 tour of the world. "Progress of Ke Alii," *HG*, April 20, 1881, 2.
- [108.](#) "Ka Moi ma Iapana!," *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, April 23, 1881, 2.
- [109.](#) "Kalakaua ma Iapana. Hookipa Alii Kilakila," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, April 23, 1881, 3, *Ulu kau*.
- [110.](#) "The King's Tour around the World. Sonnet," *PCA*, April 23, 1881, 5.
- [111.](#) "Palapala mai ka Moi mai! Na Launa Aupuni Aloha! Na Limahana Lilo Dala Ole! Ke Ola o ka Mai Pake!," *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, July 3, 1881, 2.
- [112.](#) "Tour of the Princess Regent on Maui. Arrival of the Princess and Suite in Boats at Maliko. Speeches of Her Royal Highness at the Native Church and East Maui Female Seminary, Makawao," *PCA*, September 24, 1881, 3, *Chronicling America*.
- [113.](#) See Okihiro, "Japanese Doctors in Hawai'i," 110.
- [114.](#) "Ka Moi ma Iapana!," *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, April 23, 1881, 2.
- [115.](#) "Ka Moi ma Iapana Na Hookipa Hanohano," *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, June 11, 1881, 2.
- [116.](#) "Ka Moi Kalakaua ma Siama! Na Hookipa Hoohiwahiwa Loa. Ka Holo Elepani Ana. Na Makana i ka Moi!," *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, July 16, 1881, 2, *Ulu kau*.

- [117.](#) "Make ka Moi Kalakaua. Kona mau Sekona Hope ma keia Ola ana. Ka Lahui Hawaii iloko o ke Kanikau. Ka La e Alohi nei, Auhea ia?—Ke Alii Kaapuni Honua ua Hala—Ka Onohi o Hawaii, Aole—Ka Hae Aloha ou e Hawaii ua Hapa—O Hawaii Hauoli ua Kaumaha—A o Kalanikaulilua ua Hala! Ua Hala!! A ua Hala loa aku!!!," *Leo o ka Lahui*, January 30, 1891, 2, Ulukau.
- [118.](#) "Progress of Ke Alii," *HG*, April 20, 1881, 2.
- [119.](#) "Ka Moi ma Iapana!," *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, April 23, 1881, 2.
- [120.](#) Ono, "King Kalakaua in Japan."
- [121.](#) "Ka Moi ma Iapana!," *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, April 23, 1881, 2.
- [122.](#) "Palapala mai ka Moi mai! Na Launa," *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, July 3, 1881, 2.
- [123.](#) Ka Moi ma Kina," *Elele Poakolu*, May 11, 1881, 4. Mandarins were officials of high rank in the Chinese government.
- [124.](#) "Ka Moi Kalakaua ma Siam!," *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, July 16, 1881, 2.
- [125.](#) "Palapala mai ka Moi mai!," *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, July 23, 1881, 2.
- [126.](#) Ibid.
- [127.](#) "Ka Moi," *Elele Poakolu*, July 6, 1881, 4.
- [128.](#) "Ua Loaa mai na Lohe he Nui no na Hookipa Aloha," *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, August 13, 1881, 2, Ulukau.
- [129.](#) The Honolulu Rifles would later shoot and kill Boyd on July 30, 1889, when Boyd joined in Robert Wilcox' attempts to restore King Kalākaua's powers after the Hawaiian League over-threw him via its 1887 Bayonet Constitution.
- [130.](#) See Quigg, "Kalākaua's Hawaiian Studies," 170-208.
- [131.](#) "He Leta mai Italia mai," *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, August 13, 1881, 1, Ulukau.
- [132.](#) "Ua Loaa mai na Lohe," *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, August 13, 1881, 2.
- [133.](#) "He Leta mai Italia mai," *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, August 13, 1881, 1.
- [134.](#) "Ua Loaa mai na Lohe," *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, August 13, 1881, 2.
- [135.](#) "He Leta mai Italia mai," *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, August 13, 1881, 1.
- [136.](#) "He Leta mai Italia mai," *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, August 20, 1881, 2, Ulukau.
- [137.](#) Ibid.
- [138.](#) Kalākaua to Henry Severance, 1881.
- [139.](#) "Ka Moi o Hawaii," *Elele Poakolu*, July 27, 1881, 4.
- [140.](#) "King Kalakaua's Tour: A Talk with," *HG*, October 12, 1881, 4, Chronicling America.
- [141.](#) "Ka Moi Kalakaua ma Ladana. Ka Makaikai ana i ka Paikau Koa Nui—Ka Ike ana i ka Moiwahine Victoria—Ke Kamailio ana o na Moi Elua—Ko ka Moiwahine Hoohuoi no ko ka Moi Ike Namu—Ka Ike ana i ka Hooilina Moi o Enelani—Ke Kuikui Lima ana me ka Wahine a ka Hooilina Moi o Beritania—Na Ahaaina Hoohanohano i Haawii no ka Moi—Na Leta Pono mai ka Moi mai," *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, September 3, 1881, 3, Ulukau.
- [142.](#) "Ua Loaa mai na Lohe," *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, August 13, 1881, 2; "We Have Seen a Very Interesting Account," *Saturday Press*, August 27, 1881, 2, Chronicling America.
- [143.](#) "Ua Loaa mai na Lohe," *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, August 13, 1881, 2.
- [144.](#) "Mailoko (unreadable) o na Nupepa Europa i Lawe Mai," *Elele Poakolu*, August 17, 1881, 3.

- [145.](#) "Ka Moi o Hawaii," *Ka Elele Poakolu*, August 10, 1881, 4.
- [146.](#) "Ka Moi Kalakaua ma Ladana," *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, September 3, 1881, 3.
- [147.](#) "Ka Moi Kaapuni Honua! Ka Ike ana i ke Kahua Kaua o Watalu—Ka Ike ana i ka Moi o Belegiuma—Na Luana ana ma Viena," *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, September 17, 1881, 2, Ulukau.
- [148.](#) "The King's Tour round the World. The King at Vienna Letter from Europe—No. 59 (from Our Own Correspondent)," October 1, 1881, 2, *Chronicling America*.
- [149.](#) "Ka Moi Kalakaua ma Berelina. Ka Ike ana i na Keiki Alii o Geremania—Ka Hiki ana i Viena—Ka Makaikai ana i na Mea ano Nui—Ka Haalele ana ia Viena No Parisa," *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, September 10, 1881, 3, Ulukau.
- [150.](#) "The King's Tour round the World. Letter from Europe—No. 61 (from Our Own Correspondent). The King at Paris. Letter No. 62. The King Again at London. Letter No. 63. The King at Liverpool—Departure for New York. Letter No. 66," *PCA*, October 29, 1881, 2, *Chronicling America*.
- [151.](#) "The King of the Sandwich Islands in Edinburgh (from *The Scotsman*)," *PCA*, October 29, 1881, 2, *Chronicling America*.
- [152.](#) "Arrival at and Departure from Liverpool," *PCA*, October 29, 1881, 2.
- [153.](#) "Our San Francisco Letter," *HG*, November 2, 1881, 5, *Chronicling America*.
- [154.](#) "Portraits in Words—King Kalakaua," *HG*, October 5, 1881, 6, *Chronicling America*.
- [155.](#) "Contemplating the King's Tour round the World," *PCA*, November 12, 1881, 2, *Chronicling America*.
- [156.](#) "1881 King Kalakaua Letters. Trip around World. 12 May 1881. Singapore," *F. O. & Ex*, 2, Hawai'i State Archives.
- [157.](#) *Ibid.*, 3-4.
- [158.](#) "The King's Return," *Saturday Press*, November 5, 1881, 5, *Chronicling America*.
- [159.](#) "The King's Tour round the World," *PCA*, September 3, 1881, 2.
- [160.](#) "Native Newspapers," *Saturday Press*, September 24, 1881, 3, *Chronicling America*.
- [161.](#) *Ka Elele's* columns were shorter than those in *Kuokoa* and *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, so these page numbers are equivalent to *Kuokoa* and *Ko Hawaii* standards.
- [162.](#) "Ka Leta Moi Ka Nani o Roma. Luana me ka Moi Humebato. Halawai pu me ka Pope Leo XIII. Ka Laula o Ladana. Na Hookipa Hiwahiwa. Apo Pumehana ka Noho Kalaunu o Enelani. No Geremania ke Alo o ka Huakai Alii," *Elele Poakolu*, August 17, 1881, 2, Ulukau.
- [163.](#) "The Generous and Magnificent Hospitality of the Emperor of Japan," *PCA*, April 23, 1881, 2.
- [164.](#) "The King Has Returned," *HG*, November 2, 1881, 2, *Chronicling America*.
- [165.](#) "His Majesty's Return. Meeting at the Lyceum," *PCA*, August 20, 1881, 3, *Chronicling America*.
- [166.](#) "Meeting at the Lyceum," *Saturday Press*, August 20, 1881, 2, *Chronicling America*.
- [167.](#) Lili'uokalani, *Hawaii's Story*, 93.
- [168.](#) "The King at Home! Enthusiasm of the People," *PCA*, November 5, 1881, 2;

"Huli Hou mai ka Moi. Na Hana o ka Poaono me ka Poakahi," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, November 5, 1881, 2, Ulukau.

[169.](#) "The King at Home! Enthusiasm," *PCA*, November 5, 1881, 2.

[170.](#) "Ka Hoohiwahiwa Alii," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, November 5, 1881, 2, Ulukau.

[171.](#) "The King at Home! Enthusiasm," *PCA*, November 5, 1881, 2.

[172.](#) A digitized copy of that pamphlet is now available online.

[173.](#) "Ka Hae Hawaii! Ke Koo o Hawaii!," *Koo o Hawaii*, August 15, 1883, 6, Ulukau.

[174.](#) "The Hawaiian Flag! 1883. The Hawaiian Flag! The Support of Hawaii!!," August 15, 1883, *Nupepa-hawaii* (blog).

CHAPTER FIVE

To Preserve the Monarchy and the Lāhuikanaka

Kalākaua's 1881 world tour was not the first time that representatives from Hawai'i went abroad to strengthen the kingdom's independence. In 1824, Kamehameha II and his half sister Kamāmalu sailed to England seeking protection for Hawai'i, but both died before they could return. The traveling companion to Kamehameha II, High Chief Boki, did, however, meet with George IV and other officials and secured British protection of Hawai'i. In 1842, Timoteo Ha'alilio and William Richards procured the recognition of Hawai'i's independence from the United States, France, and Great Britain, although Ha'alilio also died while returning to Hawai'i. Seven years later, Lota Kapuāiwa and Alexander Liholiho 'Iolani traveled with Dr. Gerrit P. Judd on a diplomatic mission to the United States, Great Britain, and France. Those missions also earned Hawai'i greater recognition as an independent nation. But for these earlier missions, newspaper coverage was quite limited, and the distribution was much slower. For several reasons, then, Kalākaua's world tour was more significant and visible on many levels. By 1881, newspaper stories could be wired swiftly over large areas of the world. Because of this, the king successfully gained unprecedented international recognition for Hawai'i and himself when traveling around the world, brought back ideas for modifying his government through innovative and efficient foreign methods, and strengthened the sense of Native nationalism in many Kānaka Maoli. These realizations helped open the door for the next era of the mō'i's reign. Using the authority he still possessed, Kalākaua would attempt to execute his master plan to preserve Hawai'i's independence and strengthen his lāhuikanaka, and Kānaka Maoli would appreciate and celebrate these efforts when they personally

witnessed them or read about them in the newspapers.

Noenoe Silva has noted the king's strategy with regard to the legacies of the past:

He brought the ancient traditions forward even further, off the page and into public performance. The old religion, dance, mo'olelo, mele, and mo'okū'auhau were like the iwikuamo'o (spine) for the lāhui; without their own traditions they could not stand up to the colonial onslaught.¹

Lili'uokalani also commented on her brother's initiatives. As he looked forward to 1883, the year of the kingdom's first coronation ceremonies, she recognized that "this was very properly intended by the king to be a jubilee year with his people, and at the grand celebration nothing was to be left undone which could contribute to the general enjoyment."² Beginning with the 1883 coronation and continuing with the 1886 jubilee, the Hawaiian-language newspapers tell us how Kalākaua and Walter Murray Gibson orchestrated ever more grand and impressive public celebrations to ensure the survival of a sovereign monarchy and a thriving lāhuikanaka in the face of Westernization and the threats of annexation that endangered Hawai'i's independence. And finally, the newspapers reveal how, even after 1887, under an illegally imposed constitution, the mō'i continued to do his best to preserve the monarchy and the lāhuikanaka.

The 1883 Coronation

The changing roster of Hawai'i's late nineteenth-century newspapers reflects Native and non-Native responses to the unstable political, social, and economic changes within the kingdom. Helen Chapin has remarked that the "establishment lineup" of papers "furnished an excellent example of the way a power structure meshes its political, economic, and social interests with journalism." The striking increase in the number of English- and Hawaiian-language

newspapers during Kalākaua's reign mirrors the emergence of different political agendas—most notably, that of Kānaka Maoli and a minority of foreigners who wanted to preserve Hawai'i's independence; Native Hawaiians who wanted independence under a sovereign other than Kalākaua; and foreigners and descendants of foreigners who actively and increasingly sought America's annexation of Hawai'i. For much of Kalākaua's reign, the throne also had its own "organ" or newspaper to represent its interests, usually under the direction of Walter Murray Gibson. Chapin explains that while the "English language journals reached far fewer readers than the Hawaiian language papers," they were sponsored by "the planter-missionary-business alliance," the influences of which were "gathering the power to enforce their will"—that is, to install members of the Hawaiian League in government positions and, eventually, push Gibson and Kalākaua out of power.³

Partly because Kalākaua's 1883 coronation was a key intersection where non-Native and Native criticism of the mō'i collided with nationalist support, four new newspapers appeared that year. Three were published in Hawaiian: *Ka Hoku o ke Kai* (Star of the Sea), edited by Joseph Moku'ōhai Poepoe, Samuel Kaaikaula, and His Majesty Kalākaua;⁴ *Ke Koo o Hawaii* (Support of Hawaii) by Thomas P. Spencer;⁵ and *Ka Nupepa Elele Poakolu* (Wednesday Messenger Newspaper) by Francisco Joseph Testa, John Sheldon, Isaac Sherwood, and Thomas P. Spencer, which replaced Gibson's *Elele Poakolu*. All three supported Hawaiian independence and the throne.⁶ These new papers were in part a response to the growing severity of other journalistic attacks against Kalākaua, Gibson, Kānaka 'Ōiwi, and the kingdom's independence. Some of these attacks appeared in Hawaiian-language newspapers formerly supportive of the mō'i. Whereas the Kawainui brothers and their *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina* (Our Hawaiian Archipelago) served as loyal supporters of the monarchy from the later 1870s up through the 1881 circumnavigation of the world, they then began to lodge protests against the Gibson administration—a critical break

in Native newsprint loyalty to the throne.⁷ In 1883, the mō'i dismissed Joseph Kawainui from the cabinet. In 1893, *Hawaii Holomua* (Hawaii Progressive), a strident nationalist paper run by John Sheldon (Kahikina Kelekona) and Thomas Nakanaela, called Joseph Kawainui a "disreputable sycophant" and "of all Hawaiians the most despised by all his countrymen."⁸ After the imposition of the provisional government, Kawainui was the first Hawaiian to align with it.⁹

Other writers have amply documented the events of the coronation festivities; I will focus on how the English- and Hawaiian-language newspapers presented the occasion as a reflection of the king. The acute partisanship in the press even affected how the papers reported on attendance. Although Whitney opposed the coronation in his *Ka Nupepa Kuokoa*, he did acknowledge that maka'āinana supported it in large numbers.¹⁰ In her memoir, *Hawaii's Story by Hawaii's Queen*, Lili'uokalani recounts that "even in the early part of January, from all parts of the islands, crowds began to flock to Honolulu, impatient for the promised ceremony; and from thence to the 12th day of February, 1883, the number of those visiting our capital city was daily increasing."¹¹ At the time, the promonarchy *Pacific Commercial Advertiser* (PCA) reported that thousands of Natives and foreigners attended, including some eleven hundred schoolchildren who marched in the procession, some four thousand individuals who occupied the amphitheater, and three thousand people who were situated in the pavilion, not to mention the thousands who filled the palace yard—an attendance that "certainly indicates the full and cordial acceptance of this ceremony, and its recognition as appropriate to our King and his sovereignty."¹² The newspaper reports of the coronation ceremonies were all representations of Kalākaua as the embodiment of the lāhui, and the papers presented him as either the hope or demise of the nation. As for the ceremony, the PCA reported that nature itself offered approving hō'ailona (symbols, signs) of Kalākaua's reign:

The brilliant weather continued, and strange to say, the morning star was seen in the heavens at 8 a.m., shining contemporaneously with the sun. The Hawaiians regard this as a happy omen. At 11 a.m. the sun was obscured by clouds, and remained so until the very moment of “Crowning” was being solemnized. Like a mechanical transformation scene to take place at an appointed minute, so did the sun burst forth as the clock struck twelve, and immediately after their Majesties had been crowned.¹³

The oppositional papers saw the coronation as costly and needless, and therefore they presented Kalākaua as wasteful and thoughtless. The *Daily Bulletin* reporter described it this way: “Those who thought the Coronation would be simply attended by Hawaiians must have been disappointed for very few even of these were there.”¹⁴ The antimonarchy papers denounced the event as an example of the monarchy’s irresponsibility. Take, for example, this objection from *Ko Hawaii*: “Heaha la keia mau hana no ka lehulehu? Heaha ka waiwai o keia mau hana a pau i hanaia aku la? Aole he pomaikai hou, he poho wale no ma ka waihona o ka lahui.”¹⁵ (What indeed are these events doing for the masses? What is the worth of all of these events that were conducted? It is not a new benefit, it is simply a waste of the nation’s funds.) During the coronation week, most Hawaiian-language newspapers that opposed it repeatedly used the term “lapuwale” (worthless) to condemn the government’s spending on it—and in turn Kalākaua’s decisions as king. And yet, even as the business faction complained about expenses, Lili’uokalani notes that its members’ shops profited from the traveler influx. “Money was spent lavishly by the visitors; all the stores were thronged from morning to night by eager and easily satisfied purchasers,” and “Honolulu had been benefitted in the mean time [sic] financially, the merchants and traders of every degree reaping a bountiful harvest from the free expenditure of money by every class.”¹⁶ A “J. N.,” perhaps Joseph Nāwahī, wrote to *Kuokoa* lamenting not only

the cost but even the fact that people were celebrating:

Hu ae la na manao aloha a walohia iloko lilo o ko'u waihona ike, no ka puai ana ae o na hoomanao ana no na wahi kenikeni auhau a ka luahine, a me ka elemakule, na wahine kanemake a me na keiki makua ole, a me ka lahui holookoa e uhauha a e kiolaia nei ma na mea lapuwale a kupono ole.¹⁷

(Sympathy and remorse swelled within my memory when I recalled the tax pennies/dimes from the elderly women, elderly men, widows, orphans, and the entire nation that were wasted and tossed away on things that were wasteful and improper.)

Kuokoa grimly predicted disaster for the kingdom and for Kalākaua: “He nui ka hopohopo i keia mau la e nee nei, oiai, o ke kulana o ke aupuni i keia wa, aole ia he kulana maikai; ke alakai ia nei ke aupuni iloko o ka pilikia.”¹⁸ (The uncertainty of these days has been considerable, since the state of the kingdom at this time is not good. The kingdom is being led into a dilemma.) Gibson’s response to such attacks was equally intense as he sought to defend the king: “The unnatural bitterness, savage denunciations and cowardly innuendos of illegitimate opposition have calumniated the nation abroad. Such is the sole effect of an acrimony without reason or excuse, and slanderous vituperation without cause to justify or palliate its shameless utterance.”¹⁹

Though they also condemned Kalākaua’s wasteful spending on the weeklong festivities, the American-edited papers, joined by George Washington Pilipō, were especially upset about the king’s decision to encourage hula performances at the palace.²⁰ As Jonathan Osorio explains, “It was not just that the mission children conceived the hula to be evil, but that its enjoyment was the clearest sign of weakness and degradation of the Natives.” For these reasons, *Kuokoa*, in an article titled “Ka Lapuwale o ka Poaono Nei” (The Foolishness/Vanity of Last Saturday),

denounced “na hula pegana kahiko o ka wa pouli loa” (ancient pagan hula of a very dark age), which it called “haumia” (obscene) for being performed right in the palace’s yard before children and parents.²¹ But Osorio also claims that the hula was especially controversial because it “represented the very finest art of an ancient civilization and was itself political because many of the mele were praises of the Ali’i genealogies and their relationships to the akua.”²² The performances served two purposes. First, they were the first sizeable public presentations of hula to be organized by the crown since its banning due to missionary influence, therefore announcing Kalākaua’s desire not only to preserve Native culture but to celebrate it as a lāhui. By literally putting Native traditions on a public stage at his coronation, Kalākaua sought to restore to Hawaiians the right to practice them on their own terms, defying Western religious impositions and asserting the lāhui’s nationalism. The act clearly shows the king’s agency, and the newspapers became the vehicles to publish those celebratory emblems of Kalani Kalākaua before maka’āinana throughout the archipelago.

Hula specialists S. Kalaimano, Kalua, Ioane, Ehu Keohohina, I, Kaonowai, and S. Ua performed more than two hundred hula in honor of Kalākaua, and the coronation program lists such mele as “O Kalani i poniia” (The Heavenly One Was Crowned), “Eia Davida o ka heke o na pua” (Here Is David, the Greatest of Descendants), “Noho mai Davida i ke Kalaunu” (David Possesses the Crown), “Eia ko Lei Alii Poni” (Here Is Your Royal Crowned Garland), “O ka Pua Kalaunu i Halealii” (The Crowned Flower at the Royal Palace), and “O oe ka ia e Kalani Hoola o ka Lahui” (You Are Him, O Heavenly Savior of the Nation). Another mele, “Hoomaikai oe e Hawaii” (Congratulations to You, O Hawai’i), declares the coronation a victory for the entire kingdom. The arts employed in this celebration continued to do the work of Native nationalism for years afterward. “In the tenyear period between 1883 and 1892, a search through nine Hawaiian-language newspapers yielded a total of 134 mele in the hula ku’i format,” Amy Stillman writes, adding that

the mele were entirely concentrated in five newspapers that backed the monarchy. No mele in hula ku'i format were located in pro-annexationist newspapers, thus demonstrating that the format was very much a channel for royalists and anti-annexationists—in other words, nationalists.²³

To these must be added other mele commemorating the crowning of Kalākaua: “O Kalani i poniia i ka ua noe” (The Heavenly One Is Crowned in the Mist), “O Kalani i poniia i Waiolama” (The Heavenly One Is Crowned in Waiolama), “O Kalani i poniia i ka wai Iliahi” (The Heavenly One Is Crowned in the Sandalwood Water), “O Kalani i poniia i ka wai Aniani” (The Heavenly One Is Crowned in the Cooling Water), and so on.²⁴

Along with the hula and 'oli performances that week, a particular hō'ailona that confirmed the king's right to reign was observed by guests. The sign would have left a deep impression upon Kānaka Maoli and others who were fortunate enough to view it. Lili'uokalani remembered that during the crowning ceremony

a mist, or cloud, such as may gather very quickly in our tropical climate, was seen to pass over the sun, obscuring its light for a few minutes; then at the moment when the king was crowned there appeared, shining so brilliantly as to attract general attention, a single star. It was noticed by the entire multitude assembled to witness the pageant, and a murmur of wonder and admiration passed over the throng. The ceremonies proceeded with due solemnity, and the whole scene was very impressive and not to be forgotten.²⁵

Held a little more than two weeks after the ceremony, the coronation lū'au was hailed as a success. The *PCA* describes it this way:

On the balconies of the Palace, under the covering of

the vast amphitheater, and beneath the shelter of the mammoth tent, there were assembled not less than four thousand persons; while the throng within the Palace grounds, though beyond accurate estimation, may be fairly put down at as many more as were under cover. It was a common remark made during the evening that about two-thirds of the population of the town was present.

Such a display led the heavily promonarchy *PCA* to declare that any objection to Kalākaua is “a loud sound and nothing more. It is substantially played out. This opposition is not an expression of the masses of the people.”²⁶ The significance of the first coronation ceremony in the kingdom of Hawai‘i could not be lost on the thousands who attended the lū‘au and hula performances—or on those who opposed the monarchy or Native rule of any kind. Indeed, Lili‘uokalani adds, “Certainly the coronation celebration had been a great success. The people from the country and from the other islands went back to their homes with a renewed sense of the dignity and honor involved in their nationality, and an added interest in the administration of their government.”²⁷ The event celebrated the authority and legitimacy of Kalākaua as *mō‘ī* of an independent nation of Hawaiians, in part through the performance of hula and mele—traditions freed from banishment that affirmed the power and rightness of the monarchy and its *mō‘ī*.

Kalākaua’s 1886 Jubilee

Kalākaua’s fiftieth birthday on November 16, 1886, was a significant and hopeful milestone for the monarchy and *lāhui*, and *maka‘āinana* paid tribute through mele, performances, and attendance at the many events during the jubilee week. As early as 1860, the Hawaiian-language newspaper *Ka Hae Hawaii* (Hawaiian Flag) had urged the public to help keep mele from disappearing: “O ka mea e mau aku ai a nalowale ole na mele, oia ke pai ana ma ka buke a ma ka nupepa paha;

alaila, he hiki no i na hanauna hou aku ke heluhelu a e kawiliwili iloko o ka manao” (The thing that will continue and keep the mele from vanishing perhaps is printing in a book and in the newspaper; then the future generations will be able to read and integrate it into their thought).²⁸ Kalākaua himself had long been collecting the mele printed in the newspapers,²⁹ and as mōī, he promoted composing and collecting mele, in the face of missionary-influenced opposition. Stillman tells us that “throughout the 1870s and 1880s, the composition of mele in the hula ku’i format was an activity very much centered around the ali’i,” who recorded the mele in books as “souvenirs.”³⁰ And Elizabeth Tartar notes that “King Kalākaua, who reigned from 1874–1891, was, perhaps, the monarch who was the most insistent about ‘perpetuating and preserving’ traditional Hawaiian music and dance; at least he has been characterized as such.”³¹ Although Stillman points out that far more mele were composed in honor of the ali’i wahine Kapi’olani, Emma, Lili’uokalani, and Ka’iulani,³² even so, in its mele index, the B. P. Bishop Museum lists more than three hundred mele under Kalākaua. In 2001, the Hawaiian Historical Society published *Na Mele Aimoku, Na Mele Kupuna, a me Na Mele Pono i o ka Moi Kalakaua I: Dynastic Chants, Ancestral Chants, and Personal Chants of King Kalākaua I*, a collection of mele honoring Hawai’i’s ali’i. Some were composed to honor the mōī on his fiftieth birthday, and the mele written for him include “Kiekie Kona i ka Hapai ia e ka Puhu” (His Majesty Is Carried by the Calm), “He Hume Malo no Kalakaua” (A Bound Loincloth for Kalākaua), “He Inoa no Kalakaua” (A Name Chant in Honor of Kalākaua), and “He Mele Kahiko i Hooili ia ia ka Moi” (An Old Mele Inherited by the Sovereign). This last title emphasizes the way Kalākaua served as a means to pass on and preserve traditional mele. As for the papers, *Ka Nupepa Elele*, produced by Kalākaua supporter and luna nui (editor in chief) Daniel Lyons, printed Aiaumoe’s 179-line mele aloha ‘āina/mele aloha (song or chant of love for the land/song or chant of affection, respect) for Kalākaua for his jubilee over two editions, on December

11 and 18. The first six stanzas of the mele beckon those throughout the kingdom to awake and rise, for the mō'ī's jubilee is here. Stanza one begins with ka moku o Keawe (the island of Keawe):^{[33](#)}

E ala e Hawaii moku o Keawe
Ua hiki mai nei ka Iubile
Ku mai oe e Hilo Hanakahi
Hele mai e Puna Paia-ala
E naue e Kau ua Haao
Eu mai e Kona lai a Ehu
Lokahi na puuwai e Kohala
E kui lima mai e Hamakua
Na wai elua o na pali
I ka la eha o Keohookalani
Ua hiki mai nei ka Iubile
Nou e ka Wohi Kukahi o ka moku.^{[34](#)}

(Arise, o Hawai'i, island of Keawe
The jubilee has arrived
Stand forth, o Hilo Hanakahi
Come, o Puna of the fragrant walls
Move hither, o Ka'ū of the Ha'ao rain
Arise, o Kona, calm homeland of Ehu
Be united in heart o Kohala
Join hands, o Hāmākua
Of the two waters of the cliffs
To [remember] the day of Keohokalōle's pain
The jubilee has arrived
For you, o Wohi Chief, sole ruler of the island.)^{[35](#)}

By declaring the places for each district of Hawai'i Island, this first stanza imbues mana and unites ka moku o Keawe as one supporter of Kalākaua. The two last lines reappear as the last lines of each successive stanza, emphasizing Kalākaua's identity as sovereign.

The rest of the stanzas go on to appeal to the different 'āpana (sections, districts) of Maui, Moloka'i, O'ahu, and Kaua'i. These lines about O'ahu are representative: "E ike i

ke one Kakuhihewa / I ka nuhou nui ma ke Kaona / I ka la kamahao ua hiki mai” (See the sand of Kakuhihewa³⁶ / The important news in town / On the wondrous day that has arrived).³⁷ In this mele aloha ‘āina and mele aloha, each moku also stands for a person who potentially supports the throne, the archipelago or entire island chain is the lāhui, and the lāhui’s collective support for Kalākaua sustains the crown and the independent government. Stanzas eight and nine give this praise to the sovereign:

E ole o Kamanakapu
Ulu ai na hana kaulana
Na hoohiwahiwa laha ole,
Ulu pono ai ko lahui
Ua hiki mai nei ka Iubile
Nou e ka Wohi Kukahi o ka moku
9. Eia o Naloiaehu
Ke ‘Lii poni o ke awakea
Ku mai a paihihi,
A kapukapu ke noho mai.³⁸

(If it were not for the powerful-sacred-one
Famous deeds would not have been known
Such as uncommon displays
And the growth of your people
The jubilee has arrived
For you, o Wohi Chief; sole ruler of the islands
9. Here is Na-la‘i-a-ehu
The chief who was anointed at noonday
He stands in glory
Sits in sacred regality.)³⁹

Lyons’ *Nupepa Elele* demonstrates how the newspapers could highlight one writer’s representation of Kalākaua as sole ruler of their independent nation and thereby potentially influence readers throughout all of Hawai‘i nei.

Three years earlier, the newspapers had celebrated or condemned the coronation festivities as representations of

the king. They gave his birthday celebrations the same treatment. Many English- and Hawaiian-language papers were appearing at the time of the jubilee, among them the *Daily Bulletin* and the *Daily Herald*, edited by Canadian Daniel Logan, who was critical of Kalākaua. Both papers revealed Native disapproval with the celebration of Kalākaua. The *Daily Bulletin* reported that an old Native claimed the rains during jubilee week revealed the gods' anger at the high cost of the celebrations,⁴⁰ and the *Daily Herald* referred to other newspapers' "sneers and misrepresentations" regarding the jubilee.⁴¹ But, generally, newspaper coverage was supportive and concluded that the impressive attendance and participation represented strong maka'āinana support for Kalākaua in 1886. *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, now solely edited by Joseph Kawainui, reported that in the days leading up to November 16, maka'āinana from districts outside of Honolulu were preparing gifts for Kalākaua, as Hawaiians had traditionally done for their ali'i 'aimoku (chief of an island or district).⁴² *Ka Nupepa Elele* reported that as early as November 6, Joseph K. Nahale from North Kona, Kahalu'u, on Hawai'i Island began encouraging those in his district to prepare for the jubilee.⁴³ *Elele's* later descriptions of the celebrations in northern Kona suggest that Nahale's efforts were successful. At midnight on Monday, November 15, the bells of churches from Kailua Kona to Keauhou rang out. Then maka'āinana marched in a parade, beginning in Kahalu'u, where "e aa ana na lama ma ke ala, a he mea kamahao loa ia" (the torches were aglow along the path, and it was incredibly wondrous), continuing through Holualoa, where people playing drums joined the procession, and finishing at Hulihe'e Palace in Kailua. The grounds had been illuminated that evening for the event. There, the crowd enthusiastically chanted three times, "E ola ka Moi i ke Akua!" (God Save the King!).⁴⁴ *Elele* also reported that in Hilo, a thunderous twenty-one-gun salute at 12:00 a.m. on November 16 kicked off maka'āinana celebrations there. At 10:00 a.m., the people excitedly gathered in a church, where they listened to rousing speeches and sang hymns.⁴⁵ *Kuokoa*

reported that the festivities in Honolulu started at the earliest possible moment, for as November 15 came to a close, “a hoomalamalama ia ae la ka pa alii me na kukui uwila” (the royal enclosure was illuminated by electric lights), and “loheia aku la ka leo o na mea kani a me na leo mele” (the music of the instruments and vocalists were heard) performing mele composed for the royal birthday. Speeches were given at the palace, and gifts were presented to the mō‘ī by the different Native societies. From the summit of Puōwaina, “e lele maopu mai ana na ahikao” (fireworks cascaded) in the sky along with “na ahi nani o na waihooluu like ole” (stunning bonfires of a variety of colors).⁴⁶ The *Daily Bulletin* and the *Hawaiian Gazette* (HG)—the latter a major critic of the throne—reported that at midnight the battery atop Puōwaina let out a salute, church bells tolled, the bells of the local firehouses rang out, and the people filled the city with noise for an hour.⁴⁷

The newspapers further tell us that from the early morning of November 16 on, the people gathered to honor their mō‘ī for many successive days and nights. *Kuokoa* reported that as early as 5:00 a.m. societies and other groups were forming lines within the palace’s enclosure to present their gifts to the mō‘ī: “He nani ka huakai, he malie ke kakahiaka, a ua waihoia aku na makana iloko o na leo hoolana manao o ka hauoli” (The procession was beautiful, the morning was serene, and the gifts were presented amid uplifting voices of happiness).⁴⁸ *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina* remarked that “ka poe no a pau i hooulumahiehieia e ke aloha alii e kiai ana iloko o ko lakou mau puuwai” (all of the people were decorated by a royalist love to be safeguarded within their hearts),⁴⁹ and the *Daily Herald* noted that “the Palace within and without was decorated as beautifully as bunting, foliage and flowers, conjoined with tasteful arrangements of works of art, could make it.”⁵⁰ All day long, guards bearing illuminated torches stood at the palace entrance while the royal band played. As *Kuokoa* observed, “He nui na mea hoonani i kinohinohi ia a puni, a ku iho la o Iolani Hale iwaena o kona nani a me ka hanohano” (The beautiful things adorning the surroundings

were many, and 'Iolani Palace stood in the middle of its beauty and magnificence).⁵¹ The *HG* was highly effusive:

Crowds of natives and foreigners flocked to the scene, having donned their holiday attire, the leis and other floral decorations being conspicuous among the personal adornments. As the day wore on the crowd thickened, outrivalling anything of the kind witnessed in the city for many years passed [*sic*].⁵²

Attired in white with red sashes and bearing a variety of kāhili, the Native societies were especially stunning. "Above nine hundred names were entered on the Visitors' Book during the day," the *Herald* reported; the *HG* said nearly one thousand and added that the societies and individual Natives had presented Kalākaua with a great deal of cash.⁵³ These numbers were hardly comprehensive, as a "vast crowd of curious spectators together with the callers surged round the gates from morning till evening."⁵⁴ Throughout the day, "all classes of his loyal subjects and foreign residents of the Kingdom" presented the mō'i with gifts, leading the *PCA* to report that "so numerous were they that the space at our disposal would be utterly inadequate even to catalogue the rich and costly array, much less to attempt anything in the way of a detailed description." Maui, Hawai'i, and Kaua'i had gifts presented as well; Moloka'i sent hundreds of live animals.⁵⁵ Other gifts included gold, silver, a koa table, mats made of sugarcane, two ivory elephant tusks, calabashes, a carriage robe, mele, paintings, a smoking outfit, vases, tea sets, Bibles, live animals, and vegetables. Other unique gifts were the kāhili made especially for Kalākaua and Kapi'olani. Maka'āinana took special notice of the mō'iwahine and through mele memorialized their aloha for her as well.⁵⁶ *Ko Hawaii* remarked that the royal couple patiently stood for the entire day "e hoomaikai aku i ka poe a pau i kipa mai e pahola i ko lakou mau hoomaikai i ka Moi nona ka la hanau" (to show their gratitude for all the people who visited to present their congratulations to the king on his birthday).

Processions, performances, and displays were also important public tributes. The people's visual endorsement of the monarchy further renewed its power and that of the lāhui, as Noenoe Silva has explained: "These public performances demonstrated pride in Kanaka culture, art, dance, religion, and history, and in so doing they strengthen the collective identity of the lāhui as a nation."⁵⁷ *Ko Hawaii* reported that under the direction of the Honorable Edward Lilikalani, the 'Ahahui Ho'oulu Lāhui (Society to Increase the People or Nation) marched from Kalākaua's original home at Honuakaha to the palace bearing 124 kähili created for the procession. The 'Ahahui Ho'oulu Lāhui of Kaumakapili Church had twenty-six new kähili as well. Both organizations had been created as part of Kalākaua's plans to ho'oulu the lāhui. The royal band offered its own tribute to Kalākaua. Printed in *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, the first sentence declares, "Ma ka inoa o ka Puali Puhi Ohe o Kou alo alii ponoī, ke haawi aku nei i ko makou aloha nui ia Oe e ke Alii, me na manao makee a pau i ko makou umauma" (In the name of the band of your own royal court, we are offering our deep love to you, the king, with all the affection in our hearts). They continue:

Nolaila ua kuwili ae makou me ka manao lokahi o ka hauoli no ka manawa mua loa e makana aku ia Oe e ke Alii, i kulike ai me ko makou mau manao ohohia i ulupuni ia e ka hauoli, e haale nei i ko makou mau umauma pakahi.⁵⁸

(Therefore, we stand together in unity in our happiness that for the very first time we present to you, the king, united in our enthusiastic thoughts that are overwhelmed by happiness that is causing each and all of our hearts to overflow.)

During the firemen's evening parade, the firehouses and other buildings along King Street were illuminated by hundreds of colored lanterns. Windows were decorated with wreaths, and the following words were illuminated:

“Kalakaua ka Moi” (King Kalākaua), “1836,” “1886,” “1836–1886,” “Hoomanawanui” (Persevere), “Long Live Our Fireman King,” “Kalakaua,” and “Long Live the King.”⁵⁹ Dressed in soldiers’ uniforms, students of the Kahehuna Royal School also marched, and as the procession made its way to the palace, fireworks of different hues exploded in the sky. *Ko Hawaii* reported that when the parade arrived at the place, “ua oluolu ka Moi e pane pokole mai me na huaolelo kupono a eehia no keia hookahakaha kuikui” (the king was kind to briefly respond with suitable and awe-inspiring words for this united exhibition).⁶⁰ Then the new electric lanterns were turned on, illuminating the palace grounds as if night were day; a fireworks show, said to be “the finest pyrotechnical display ever witnessed in this city,” concluded the evening.⁶¹ Clearly, the result was impressive. The *Herald* declared that “taken altogether, the firemen’s demonstration, the illuminations and fireworks formed a series of spectacular displays, the grand beauty of which could not be adequately described in any pen picture,”⁶² and according to *Kuokoa*,⁶³ “Nani a moakaka na hoikeike ahi, a he nui maoli no hoi na nuhou e pau ole ai i ke KUOKOA ke haano’u aku” (The fire show was beautiful and distinct and so many new things were seen that the *Kuokoa* is unable to boast of them all).⁶⁴ Light, ranging from illuminated torches by day to fireworks, bonfires, electric lanterns, or electric torches by night, was a key component of the fiftieth-birthday celebrations, reminding people not only of the symbols of royal authority first presented during the 1874 royal tour of the kingdom but also of Kalākaua’s introduction of electricity to Honolulu. Thanks in part to this, in the evenings, the palace enclosure was filled with Hawaiians singing, chanting, and performing hula for the mō’ī.

On the following day, Saturday, November 20, the *PCA* reported that “the sun shone out gloriously and shed the radiance of his countenance upon a scene which led the majority of the population of Honolulu to don their holiday attire.”⁶⁵ The schedule featured a regatta of fifteen boat races and a historical procession up King Street to ‘Iolani

Palace. Attired in the ancient style of Native dress, the participants rode in floats, some constructed as long canoes, or by foot. *Kuokoa* told its readers that “ua houluwehi like ia hoi keia mau mea a pau me na kahiko o ke au i hala loa aku la me na luhiehu po o ka waonohela” (all of these [floats] were similarly adorned with adornments of a time long ago with the fragrant flowers of the forests). Such a procession, featuring traditional Kanaka Maoli attire and customs and representing and celebrating such Native heroes as Kamehameha I, Keawenuiaumi, Kaumuali‘i, Paka‘a, and Kuapaka‘a, was designed to spark pride, hope, and a sense of Hawaiian nationalism in maka‘āinana.⁶⁶ Clearly, the parade was a highlight of the celebrations:

An hour before the time announced for the procession to start for the Palace the streets were lined with crowds of whites and natives ... jostling and crowding their neighbors in the most good-natured humor and familiar fashion imaginable, each desirous of getting the best view possible of the historical procession, the like of which had never before been seen in the Islands.⁶⁷

According to the *PCA*, “Rarely has the merry laughter of the vivacious, pleasure-loving Hawaiians echoed and re-echoed on every hand with greater unanimity.”⁶⁸ Kalākaua and the royal family reviewed the parade from the front veranda of ‘Iolani Palace; the mō‘ī wore a white suit and was “loaded” with lei.⁶⁹

The jubilee lū‘au, held on November 23, was another impressive occasion. *Kuokoa* stated that “maloko o ka lanai loihi ma ke alo iho o ka hale alii, ua hoopihāia na ka poe hanohano a haahaa i kono ia a i kuu akea ia hoi e ai e inu i na mea ai i hoomakaukau ia” (inside of the long veranda on the front of the royal palace was filled with the “high and low” who were invited and were allowed free rein to dine and drink the foods prepared).⁷⁰ The three-hundred-by-thirty-foot lānai was decorated with bunting, evergreens, maile, and ferns, and some fifteen hundred guests partook of pig, fish,

chicken, and other foods from two in the afternoon until just after sunset. The affair was a total success for all, and “ua hoomau ia a ... Ilaila no a lawa ka iini; nui na hauoli, nui na kulaia, mahalo, a me na hoomaikai lehulehu” (it was continued ... until desires were gratified, and the festivities, gratitude, and the crowd’s congratulations were amply provided).⁷¹ Long after Kalākaua had retired to bed and on until the next morning, hula performances continued within the palace enclosure before a large gathering of Natives.⁷²

Among the final events of the jubilee was the ball, which the *PCA* considered “one of the most successful of the series of entertainments devised for the gratification of the people in commemoration of his fiftieth birthday.”⁷³ Some five hundred guests attended. On the day featuring athletic competitions, “there was a brisk demand for carriages for Makiki,” where according to the *PCA*, “a large and interested concourse of spectators” watched baseball, a one-hundred-yard footrace, shot put, broad jump, running bases, and other track-and-field events.⁷⁴ A military parade and play at the Opera House in Honolulu were also part of the jubilee celebrations. On November 27, the kingdom honored Lā Kū’oko’a (Independence Day) with hula and a tableau about Kamehameha I. The state dinner at ‘Iolani Palace concluded Kalākaua’s birthday festivities. The menus, place cards, and food were long remembered by those who attended. And *Kuokoa* reported that the celebrations were not confined to Honolulu. Throughout the kingdom, maka’āinana observed the mō’ī’s jubilee with their own festivities.

In his jubilee speech to Kalākaua, the Honorable John Cummins, marshal of the celebrations and someone known for his high standards and talent for executing royal orders, linked the event to the heartbeat of the Hawaiian Nation:

Ua hooko pono ia na hana i na manawa i hala ae, ke manaolana nei makou, me na hooikaika hou ana a me ka ike e loa mai ana, e hiki ai ia makou ma keia mua aku e hoomahuahua hou aku ai me ka holopono i ka maluhia o Kou Aupuni, a e malama hoi me na manao aloha alii i

hoonui ia i ka hanohano a me ka ihiihi o Kou Noho Kalaunu.⁷⁵

(The activities in the times passed were properly completed, and with a renewed fervor and with a forthcoming understanding, we hope in the distant future that we will be able to successfully increase again the peace of your kingdom, and to maintain with thoughts of royalist love increased in the honor and reverence of your throne.)

Ka Nupepa Elele was the only paper to report on the banquet given by Henry A. P. Carter in Washington, DC, in honor of Kalākaua. On November 16, American and foreign officials gathered, and *Elele's* story underscores how the jubilee represented Kalākaua and his kingdom:

I ka wa i inu ia'i ke ola o ka Moi Kalakaua, ua ku kela a me keia a inu me ka lokahi, e hoike mai ana i ko lakou mau manao maikai a aloha makamaka no ko kakou Moi. A pela i inu pu ia ai ke ola o na Poe o na Aupuni e ae; e hoike mai ana, aia lakou a pau me Hawaii ma ka poai hookah.⁷⁶

(When it was time to toast to the health of King Kalākaua, everyone stood and toasted in unison, offering their congratulations and warm regards for our king. And in that manner were the toasts for other heads of nations given; showing that they and Hawai'i were one.)

Taken together, the many newspaper accounts of the jubilee, including in those not supportive of Kalākaua, suggest that in late 1886, less than a year from the Bayonet Constitution, the people of Hawai'i, and certainly maka'āinana, felt a strong affection and loyalty toward Kalākaua and Kapi'olani as the mō'i and mō'iwahine of a proud and independent Hawaiian Kingdom—a picture very different from the one often painted by his contemporary foes and later chroniclers.

The 1887 Bayonet Constitution

At two o'clock in the morning on July 6, 1887, the Hawaiian League and the Honolulu Rifles forced Kalākaua, at gunpoint, to sign their new constitution and install their members in the cabinet. Members of these two groups would later overthrow Mō'iwahine Lili'uokalani in 1893, but this moment in 1887 marked the beginning of the loss of Native Hawaiian sovereignty. The new constitution abolished Kalākaua's veto right, creating the situation advocated by the anti-mō'i HG on June 28, 1887: "Nothing but a Cabinet composed of *upright and able men*, and a distinct understanding that the King shall *reign*, and not *rule*, will satisfy the people."⁷⁷ The mō'i and his cabinet were accused of corruption and a failure to act for the good of the people—that is, the *upright and able men* of the Hawaiian League.

Other scholars have carefully laid out and analyzed the imposition of the Bayonet Constitution.⁷⁸ I will focus on how Hawai'i's newspapers variously represented Kalākaua during this reduction of his powers and authority, for as David William Earle has pointed out, these publications, "imperfect as they may be, provide the best source on the detail and scope of political debate in Hawai'i at that time [1887-1890] and certainly provide us with an account of the major and most influential political viewpoints."⁷⁹

For some time before July 6, 1887, the American-supported English- and Hawaiian-language newspapers had been repeatedly presenting Kalākaua as inept, corrupt, and easily swayed by Gibson and the cabinet. On July 7, they reported that the mō'i had fully cooperated with the Reform Party and signed its constitution. Then, for the most part, Kalākaua was left alone. A few articles criticized him, but most of the attacks were aimed at Gibson and his son-in-law Fred Hayselden. What news there was about the mō'i concerned receiving dignitaries and hosting banquets at the palace. If, however, we look at the papers six weeks prior to the Bayonet Constitution, we can see how the Reform Party was manipulating the newspapers to frighten and even terrify

Kalākaua and Gibson. Lili'uokalani confirms that added to the papers' methodical scare tactics was the constant danger the king found himself in as he moved about Honolulu:

His movements of late had been watched, and his steps dogged, as though he had been a fugitive from justice. Whenever he attempted to go out in the evening, either to call at the hotel, or visit any one of his friends' houses, he was conscious of the presence of enemies who were following stealthily on his track.⁸⁰

In addition to the expenses of the king's coronation and jubilee plus the pageantry of Native nationalism featured at those events, what truly aggravated Kalākaua's enemies was, according to Davianna McGregor-Alegado, his unwillingness to renew the expired Reciprocity Treaty in 1886.⁸¹ The white oligarchy could not take much more. What the Hawaiian League and the Honolulu Rifles—originally formed to be the mō'ī's army but now composed of more than three hundred haole volunteers—did was publish accounts of their activities to fuel “public antagonism, especially in the Haole and foreign community,” against the throne.⁸² While secretive at first about their meetings, in 1887 the League and the Rifles used the newspapers to declare their presence,⁸³ which Jonathan Osorio notes “exemplified the treacherous political climate” of the time.⁸⁴ And in some cases, through juxtaposition and layout, the papers added to the intimidation. The *HG* placed news of the arrival of firearms in Honolulu next to accounts of the Honolulu Rifles' shooting practice, held in lieu of its semiannual July 4 “target practice” competition. On June 29, 1887, the *Bulletin* announced a Honolulu Rifles mass meeting right above a menacing story about the shipment of firearms that had just arrived on the *Australia* for William R. Castle's company Castle & Cooke:

This morning the arms and ammunition were placed on sale, and for several hours a regular run was kept up on

the deadly weapons.... By noon there was but little left of the entire shipment. Men of all nationalities, classes, conditions, and ages could be seen marching boldly off with the formidable implements in their hands or thrown across their shoulders.

The story that then followed the announcement was titled "Barricading." It described how mechanics were securing 'Iolani Palace with barricades against a possible attack.⁸⁵ So entwined were the Hawaiian League and these newspapers that two years later, the *Daily Bulletin* would proudly recall that "when the League was ready for action ... an independent press had long given warning that serious measures would be taken if reform was not granted."⁸⁶ During this same period, as the league was gathering at the Honolulu Rifles' armory and plotting a revolution if Kalākaua did not concede, the *HG*, *Daily Bulletin*, and *Herald* were announcing the meetings, attacking Kalākaua and his advisors, and calling for change. Or, as Thomas G. Thrum put it:

The Government of the country is rotten; that is acknowledged on all hands. From King downward, the Government positions are chiefly held by men who are notoriously corrupt and debauched. There is not a department of the Government that is not honeycombed with fraud.⁸⁷

The *Herald* ranted at Gibson, the cabinet, and Kalākaua: "Doubtless [Gibson] will still cling to office, like the limpet to the rock, if only the King fails to get a quartet subservient enough to pocket Ministerial salaries while wrongs are unredressed and the crown is unpurged of notorious scandals."⁸⁸ This article concludes with a death threat from Thrum: "The people of this country have demands to make and demands which must be listened to, and any trickery in dealing with the taxpayers will recoil on the heads of those who attempt it with *fatal effect*."⁸⁹ The Hawaiian League had

been printing death threats against the king for some time, but the language grew increasingly aggressive, and the accompanying articles about the arrival of weapons hinted that a revolt was on the horizon. The white oligarchy was displaying a new level of boldness and nerve, with its members now daring enough to publish their indignation. That such disrespect could be publicly expressed in itself called into question Kalākaua's title as mō'ī.

These papers all claimed that "the people" included large numbers of Hawaiians and other nonhaole inhabitants, even though there is little evidence to support this. On June 30, 1887, in an account of the mass meeting in which the Reform Party outlined its plans for taking over the kingdom, the *Bulletin* claimed that "the room was jammed full including a large smattering of Chinese."⁹⁰ The *Herald* went further: "Here are gathered people of all nationalities—Hawaiians, Americans, English, Portuguese and Chinese."⁹¹ The *PCA*, which at this time was no longer run by Walter Murray Gibson and did not support the monarchy, agreed that "a large crowd of all nationalities nearly filled the building, but comparatively speaking there were very few Hawaiians," and its list of attendees included only fourteen Chinese men.⁹² Only over one hundred years later did Jonathan Osorio point out the obvious: there were no Native members of the Hawaiian League.⁹³ One of the most insidious influences on Kalākaua's reputation, particularly on the degree of support for him at the time, was the English-language opposition newspapers' habitual practice of claiming that a very small, self-interested minority of the population actually represented the thoughts of the whole. The *Daily Herald* had no problem claiming that "all honest men really want a new constitution, but the point with some is how to get it" while on July 5, 1887, the *HG's* front page screamed:⁹⁴ "Government Reform! The People Roused! 2,500 Freemen in Mass Meeting! A New Constitution and a New Government Demanded! Downfall of the Gibson Cabinet! Gibson and Hayselden Arrested! A New Ministry!" The following article declared that the "largest" and "most enthusiastic gathering"

ever seen in Honolulu had resulted from the supposed people's demand for a new cabinet, led by William L. Green, and a new constitution. But the *PCA* estimated the attendance as 150,⁹⁵ evidence for Helen Chapin's claim that "newspapers inflated numbers of attendees at events they supported and deflated numbers at those they didn't."⁹⁶

Clearly among friends, reporters for the pro-Hawaiian League papers could publish detailed firsthand accounts of this meeting. A committee of thirteen was created to present the *mō'i* with the demands: the dismissal of Gibson, Kalākaua's refunding of \$71,000 to the government, and his vow to remove himself from campaigning for the elections of representatives.⁹⁷ He was also no longer to draw on government funds, supposedly because "the public moneys belonging to the people had been thrown aside and spent in every possible way."⁹⁸ The newspapers published not only the attacks on Kalākaua but the names of the men who made them. While members of the Honolulu Rifles stood with fixed bayonets outside the armory at the corner of Beretania and Punchbowl, those inside listened to Sanford B. Dole and Lorrin A. Thurston stir the crowd into going straight to Kalākaua with their demands. The criticism was personal. Alexander Young declared that "Kalakaua had had a great many years to let us see whether he was a man or not. The tension about our hearts had long been strained, and to-day the strings had broken, and we must express ourselves." Therefore, "If the King would not do what was wanted, he must be made to do it." Cecil Brown added that

we want the King to think of the public good, not of his personal ends. We have just seen the Jubilee of Queen Victoria, and if Kalakaua would follow her example, he might reign as long. But, if Queen Victoria were to act as badly as Kalakaua, she would not live an hour.

E. M. Walsh of the Pā'ia plantation said that although the crowd "did not want to use threats" against Kalākaua, "to-day they were prepared." Lieutenant Clarence W. Ashford

claimed that he had joined the Honolulu Rifles three years before “in anticipation of trouble such as they saw that day” and declared that “King Kalakaua had a great many very pleasant qualities, and many which were not so pleasant.” Ashford agreed that the mō‘ī should be presented a new constitution. These non-Kanaka Maoli residents repeatedly claimed that they were “Hawaiian” by virtue of being born there, or naturalized years before, and were representing the people by resisting not just Kalākaua’s supposed tyranny but the tyranny of monarchy itself. Or as Ashford complained, the current constitution did not protect citizens’ rights because “it gave the King power which no monarch in a civilized country in the present day possessed.”⁹⁹

On the next day, July 6, the Hawaiian League forced Kalākaua to sign what became known as the Bayonet Constitution. Through this extorted document, the Reform Party and the Hawaiian League ended his right to appoint nobles and disband the cabinet. Now made up of members of the Hawaiian League, the new cabinet had to ratify each of Kalākaua’s decisions. Lili‘uokalani’s summary of the league wresting control of the king’s powers is accurate:

The government in all its departments must be conducted by the cabinet. Your Majesty shall, in future, sign all documents and do all acts which, under the laws of the constitution, require the signature or act of the sovereign, when advised so to do by the cabinet, the cabinet being solely and absolutely responsible for any signature of any document or act so done or performed by their advice.¹⁰⁰

As Osorio explains, “The constitution removed every paradox that had previously confounded haole citizens and other white residents by making the nation belong to them without requiring that they belong to the nation.”¹⁰¹ In short, the cabinet, made up of self-proclaimed “*upright and able men*,” became the mō‘ī, leaving Kalākaua to “*reign*, and not *rule*.”¹⁰² In an 1886 campaign manifesto, Kalākaua and

Gibson warned the Kānaka 'Ōiwi that "the foreigners want to get the power in the Legislative Assembly by having the majority in the House on their side so that the Hawaiians cannot have a voice in the administration of the affairs of the government of their country." These foreigners, they said,

will deprive the Hawaiian people from having any voice in the Government, because by taking your lands they rob you of your right to vote and will reduce you to the level of the commonest laborer, depending on your living on the foreigner, the very ones who will rob you of your lands.... If these foreigners who are against the Hawaiian race be victorious, then, as true as there is light in the sun at mid-day, so will it also be true that all native Hawaiians will be kicked out from all Government positions.... And who will fill their places? Who else but the white man? They have not the *greediness that a man has, but the greediness of beasts*, and even those Hawaiians who are helping them and are treacherous to their country will be without anything.... Their (the foreigners') only wish and desire is that all Hawaiians die off, so that they can come in possession of all the natives' lands and money.... If these white people get elected then they will put a tabu on the native Hawaiian.... Going up in the mountains or picking wild flowers will be tabued.... For the white man is now increasing in numbers and is trying to fasten his power on the land.

The *HG*, *Herald*, and *Bulletin* all criticized Kalākaua and Gibson for making such predictions; they would, however, all come true.^{[103](#)}

In keeping with its earlier efforts to suggest "the people" were united against the mō'ī, on July 19, the *HG* reported that when people at Lahaina Harbor heard the news about the new constitution and the Reform Party's success, "The enthusiasm was unbounded, by nearly all present. There were a few 'sore heads' including an ex-minister and the Governor, who apparently did not seem to relish the news

and quietly slunk away.”¹⁰⁴ What is most striking, however, is the lack of a public response from Kalākaua. Earle tells us that he asked for help from foreign representatives but was denied.¹⁰⁵ He certainly did not respond in print to the antimonarchy newspapers’ assaults. Did he fear retaliation? The Hawaiian League had threatened to kill him if he did not sign the constitution. Could a letter to his people in the newspaper cause the same result? One response sheds some light on the subject. Lili’uokalani admitted “without hesitation” that Kalākaua did not know who to trust and was certain the Hawaiian League would revolt and assassinate him.¹⁰⁶ In any case, many interpreted his silence as acquiescence.

Native Response to the 1887 Constitution

Kānaka Maoli and other non-Natives responded immediately to the Hawaiian League’s Bayonet Constitution with petitions, newspaper articles, mass meetings, and campaign speeches. Noenoe Silva notes that Hui Kālai’āina, the first Kanaka Maoli political organization, appeared at this time, with Native nationalist and publisher John Ailuene Bush as its first president. The hui fought for “the preservation of the monarchy, amendment of the constitution, and the reduction of property qualifications for voters for the House of Nobles.”¹⁰⁷ Amy Stillman observes that “the acceleration of political events, beginning with the Bayonet Constitution of 1887 and the insurrection of 1889, commanded everyone’s attention. Nothing less than the future of the kingdom was at stake.”¹⁰⁸ During that period, those who opposed the forced government reforms organized and gained back control of the legislature in 1890. The moment was crucial. As Osorio explains,

This was the true danger for the Natives, who had lived through disease, death, the loss of land, and the steady assaults on their dignity. The constitution, an instrument that they had been taught to respect and

rely on to symbolize their nationhood, had now been used to remove the last traces of their honor as people. Their Mō'ī was now a figurehead; what then were they?
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Davianna McGregor-Alegado elaborates:

If Hawaiian resistance could grow into a broad, active and organized force in the next period, the monarchy might survive the challenge to its power. If the Hawaiian people would not rally to defend the King and government, then the monarch would have to co-operate with the Reform Government and surrender more and more of his power or be overthrown.
[110](#)

People resisting the Bayonet Constitution broke into different groups. Some advocated for a reformed constitution with Kalākaua as mō'ī; others for a reformed government with a new mō'ī. The dissenting groups made themselves heard in the newspapers, largely through detailed reports of their activities.

The newspapers also kept the people informed about continuing dissatisfaction and anger. The *PCA* reported on a July 26 meeting at Kaumakapili Church, where some three hundred Native Hawaiians gathered to nominate candidates for the House of Nobles and Representatives. Joseph Moku'ōhai Poepoe went to the pulpit and rallied his applauding listeners around Kalākaua:

He said that the country which heretofore had been jubilant was now in mourning.... There are two classes of people—the rich and the poor. The former are treading on our rights.... In the next Legislature the new Constitution will be finally approved. Its aim is to make Hawaii a republic. The Americans have no respect for royalty, for they have no King.... We who cherish our King ought not to allow this to be done. Therefore we must unite together, heart and soul, and elect candidates who will remove this oppression.
[111](#)

These Hawaiians clearly still supported Kalākaua and saw the upcoming election as their chance to reverse the Hawaiian League's extorted changes to governance. Thanks to what McGregor-Alegado calls the "inter-island network of communication among Hawaiians,"¹¹² Poepoe and his team gathered signatures from supporters throughout the archipelago, displaying collective support and encouragement for Kalākaua even when the mō'ī himself seemed hesitant to act. After Poepoe gave him the people's petition, he responded with written statements that did not align with the Hawaiian signatories.¹¹³ McGregor-Alegado reminds us, however, that "if one considers the King's weakness at the time of the coup and the unorganized state of the Hawaiian people compared to the better organized armed forces of the Hawaiian League and Honolulu Rifles, his action made good sense."¹¹⁴

But in the face of the chaos, some writers spoke out. The loyalist *Nupepa Elele* editor F. J. Testa sent a sharp rebuttal to the *Daily Bulletin*—a known defender of the Bayonet Constitution—and therefore to the Hawaiian League and its followers. Testa declared that Kānaka Maoli would not stand idly by as the Reform Party attacked their mō'ī. As we have seen, in their newspapers, Kalākaua's enemies had been insulting and mocking him for years. Testa's editorial is extraordinary, not only because it identifies the source and the motive for these attacks but also because it says that Kānaka 'Ōiwi will defend their mō'ī, *even if he himself will not*:

Hawaiians will not quietly permit that their Ruler and Father, shall have base epithets thrown at him, and his kingly seat put in question, upon the affidavit of any number of avowed pagan lawbreakers; and they not resent the base, unworthy, cowardly defamation. If the King is silent, his people will speak for him, through the columns of the "Elele," and elsewhere.¹¹⁵

As this editorial suggests, Kānaka Maoli were passionately

loyal to Kalākaua long after the coronation and remained so after the Hawaiian League's attacks on the mō'i and his cabinet. Take, for example, Elias Helekunihi, who petitioned the legislature in 1887 to reframe the constitution by restoring these parts of Kamehameha V's 1864 constitution that sustained the mō'i and his 'ohana: "1 Pakui o ka pauku 3 o ke Kumukanawai, penei ka heluhelu ana, 'Koe wale no na Kanawai Kuponu e hoomalu ana i ka Moi a me ka Ohana Moi.'" ¹¹⁶ (Appended to article 3 of the constitution, it reads, "Except such laws as may be necessary to protect His majesty the King and the Royal Family.") ¹¹⁷

Other Kānaka 'Ōiwi who immediately responded to the Hawaiian League's coup with support for Kalākaua and petitions for restoration were Enoka Johnson, W. H. Kahumoku, the Reverend D. Keawemahi, and the already mentioned Joseph Moku'ōhai Poepoe. They started up the significantly titled *Ke Alakai o Hawaii* (Leader of Hawai'i) on August 31, 1887, to rally Kānaka Maoli to take their kingdom back from the Reform Party. The first issue was aggressive and purposeful, and the account of its founding shows how Native Hawaiians by this time had fully appropriated the missionary-introduced printing press as a tool for exposing and counterattacking the missionary party's heirs. "E kakoo ikaika ana keia pepa i na kumuhana hooponopono a hoololi Kumukanawai no ka pono like o ka lahui mai o a o" (This paper will strongly support issues concerning altering the constitution for the improvement of the people everywhere), ¹¹⁸ *Ke Alakai o Hawaii* declared, and as the first Native-edited Hawaiian-language newspaper supporting Kalākaua formed following the July 6 coup, its articles filled the apparent vacuum of Native response to the Hawaiian League's illegal government reforms. The front page called for people to reaffirm their loyalty to the mō'i through a parody of the Ten Commandments. Here are the most striking:

I: Aole ou Moi e ae, o ka mea wale no e noho ana ma ka Nohoalii o Hawaii

(Thou shalt have no other king, only the one reigning on the throne of Hawai‘i),

II: Mai hoohiki ino oe a hailiili i ka inoa o kou Moi kou Alii ma ka noho Aupuni ana

(Thou shalt not take violent oaths nor revile Your Majesty your king on the throne),

IV: E malama oe i kou Moi Kane a me kou Moiwahine i loihi ai ko kakou mau la e noho aupuni Moi ai

(Thou shalt protect your king and queen in order to lengthen our days to rule),

V: Mai pepehi Moi oe, aole hoi e hookahuli i kona Aupuni

(Thou shalt not commit regicide; certainly not overthrow his government), and

IX: Mai kuko oe e hookahuli i ke aupuni Moi o Hawaii i aupuni Ripubalika

(Thou shalt not overthrow the monarchy of Hawai‘i to a republic).

The first and second “commandments,” or oaths, hearken back to Kanaka Maoli ideology, wherein the marrow and the sinews of maka‘āinana were loyal to their mō‘ī. The fourth “commandment” underscores the mō‘ī’s existence relative to the lāhui’s survival, for as Jonathan Osorio explains, “For Hawaiians, the king was not an office of the government; he was the symbol of the Hawaiian people.”¹¹⁹ As the first article in the first column on the front page of its first issue, these nationalist and monarchial Ten Commandments are essentially the editorial policy of *Ke Alakai*, and the principles advocated for “ke kanaka Hawaii, ka oiwi” (the Hawaiian people, the Natives) who in 1887 desired an independent Hawaiian Nation under a mō‘ī, not a republic.

On page 3 appears a letter from a Lahea (the stench),

calling on Kānaka 'Ōiwi to rise from their slumber. Lahea denounces the Hawaiian League's insatiable greed for Hawai'i's land at a time when, as Osorio explains, the league's "lack of commitment to the nation became more explicit."¹²⁰ Lahea declares that two opposing groups have come into existence: "Ka aoao hoomaemae aupuni" (the Reform Party) and "ka aoao hoomaemae Kumukanawai" (the party to reform the constitution). The first faction is the Hawaiian League, which undermined Kalākaua, threw out his cabinet, installed members of its own circle, and replaced the constitution created by Lot Kapuāiwa Kamehameha V with one of its own creation. Lahea denounces this group. By curtailing the authority of the mō'ī, it had also crippled Native Hawaiians' rights to vote and to determine the uses of their own lands. As for those in the second group, Lahea explains that because these Hawaiians already have "o ke aloha paa i kakia ia iloko o ko lakou puuwai no ko lakou Moi a me ko lakou aina hanau" (a steadfast love secured firmly in their hearts for their king and their birth land), at this time, "ke imi nei lakou i ke kahua kaulike o ke hoonipaa ana i ke aloha alii, ke aloha aina no ka wa pau ole" (they are searching for a just foundation to firmly establish love for the chiefs and love for the land forever). Lahea urged those Native Hawaiians who could still vote to take back the government at the polls and restore Kalākaua's powers: "E kupaa e Hawaii Pono no kou pono pilipaa a hiki i ka hopena" (Be firm, Hawai'i's people, in your moral tenacity until the end).¹²¹

Swearing to their steadfastness, *Ke Alakai* printed a list of candidates for districts on O'ahu, Maui, and Molokai'i who supported the mō'ī, land, and a reformed constitution:

No Hawaii lakou i keia la! No Hawaii lakou i ka la apopo!! No Hawaii lakou i na la a pau. A e paio ana lakou no ka hoonipaa ia ana o ka Nohoalii o Hawaii, ka hoomau ana i ke Kuokoa o ke Aupuni Moi, a me ka Pono Kaulike o ka Lahuikanaka o ka aina. "Imua a Lanakila."¹²²

(They are for Hawai'i today! They are for Hawai'i tomorrow!! They are for Hawai'i every day. And they will contend for the firm establishment of the Hawaiian throne, continuing the independence of the monarchy and the rights of the people of the land. "Forward until victory.")

Despite these efforts, in the 1887 election, the Hawaiian League-created Reform Party did well at the polls because the new constitution allowed more foreigners of "the right sort" and those newly arrived in the islands to vote. Years later, Commissioner James Blount confirmed in his report that "large numbers of Americans, Germans, and English and other foreigners unnaturalized" before 1887 "were invited to vote ... to neutralize further the native voting strength."¹²³

Robert Wilcox's 1889 Coup

Another Native Hawaiian who protested the Reform Party's actions and attempted to restore Kalākaua's authority was Robert Kalanihiapo William Wilcox, whose military training in Italy ended when the government cut funds for the mō'i's study abroad program after the Bayonet Constitution.¹²⁴ Several authors have presented the history of Wilcox;¹²⁵ I will examine how Hawai'i newspapers of the time presented Kalākaua in the wake of the Wilcox rebellion. Only two Hawaiian-language newspapers, *Ka Nupepa Kuokoa* and *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, were operating then. The major English-language newspapers were the *PCA*, the *Daily Bulletin*, and the *HG*. Of these, only the *Bulletin* was somewhat "neutral."¹²⁶ The remaining papers opposed Kalākaua, with the *PCA* changing dramatically after Gibson's fall. The newspapers' accounts of Wilcox's failed restoration present two conclusions not yet drawn by others who have written about the event. First, all the papers present Kalākaua as unaware of and then unsupportive of Wilcox's plan, out of fear for his personal safety.¹²⁷ In his later influential

character assassination of Kalākaua, however, Lorrin A. Thurston claimed that the mōʻī supported Wilcox's revolutionary plans and therefore was violently antagonistic to the current government.¹²⁸ But in 1889, the English-language newspapers strongly declared the mōʻī innocent, at least partially because of their own earlier claims that he had willingly signed the July 1887 Bayonet Constitution and then generally accepted the Reform Party's new government—part of the papers' ongoing attempts to deny Hawaiians a mōʻī willing to lead them against his enemies. Second, whereas the accounts of the July 30, 1887, coup provide little or no description of the Hawaiian League and Honolulu Rifles breaking in to ʻIolani Palace and holding the mōʻī at gunpoint, the coverage of Wilcox's actions meticulously details the stakeout of the palace, framing him as a “native” captain of the “armed native rioters” whose “insurrection” or “rebellion” not only failed but was utterly without precedent: “This is the first time, in the history of civilized Hawaii, that Riot and Rebellion have shaken their gory locks at constitutional reform, and assayed to destroy the Government and the peace of our hitherto peaceful isles.”¹²⁹ The extent of the coverage was remarkable. The papers published special issues covering Wilcox's rebellion—the *Bulletin* called its own the Insurrection editions¹³⁰—suggesting that the relatively small numbers of English-language readers were intensely interested. The *Bulletin* boasted of selling more than twenty-six hundred copies of its July 31 edition,¹³¹ while the *Advertiser* reported selling twenty-five hundred copies of its morning edition¹³²—undoubtedly, to many of the same people.

At issue here is how closely the motives attributed in the press for Wilcox's and the mōʻī's actions align with their real intentions—and why. One thing is clear. When Wilcox and his supporters initially created the Liberal Political Association, designed to “obtain the rights of the natives by legislative or some fair ways,” they knew that the mōʻī was crucial to their plans: “I saw that some Hawaiians were not satisfied with the affairs of the present Government. They said the whole power

was taken away from the King.” When more Hawaiians were invited to the planning meetings, Wilcox later recalled, “They agreed to join as they thought it was for the good of them and the King.... I told them the object of the meeting was nothing but to uphold the King and the people, both natives and whites.”¹³³ McGregor-Alegado argues that “a sense of patriotism for the Hawaiian people and loyalty to the King” motivated this group: “They seemed to think that the interests of the Hawaiian people and that of the King were inextricably linked.”¹³⁴ In fact, Wilcox believed that the restoration of the mō‘ī’s authority would make Kalākaua a more effective ruler. When Testa read the constitution proposed to replace the Bayonet, Wilcox “thought it good, approved of it and thought that the King might change for the better when he got into his new position.”¹³⁵

But what about Kalākaua himself? Some writers have argued that his decision to go to Honuakaha, his private residence in Kaka‘ako, and then to Healani, his boat at Honolulu Harbor, on the night of Wilcox’s rebellion was an act of cowardice. But the *Daily Bulletin* reported that “one of the native women within the Palace” telephoned the mō‘ī at the queen’s private residence at Honuakaha, where he was slumbering. (They rarely slept at ‘Iolani Palace.) Rumors of a plot were already circulating around town,¹³⁶ and after the woman informed him of “the situation,” Kalākaua “immediately” telephoned Jas. W. Robertson, vice-chamberlain, “who repaired with all haste” to the mō‘ī, and they “hurried off” to Healani.¹³⁷ McGregor-Alegado suggests that this relocation to Healani “seems to imply that he had already made up his mind not to co-operate with Wilcox and his forces.” Healani has often been branded a heathenistic hideaway for Kalākaua; McGregor-Alegado more accurately identifies it as a strategic location on the night of July 30 because it “allowed for ample notice of intruders,” as well as “afforded the possibility for escape to the U.S.S. Adams, which was anchored in the harbor, should the rebel forces attempt to coerce the King into signing their constitution.” Finally, though, “it would have been more difficult for the

King to move from this location should he have changed his mind and decided to join the Hawaiian insurgents.”¹³⁸

This reading agrees with the PCA’s report of the order of events according to Wilcox’s testimony. Specifically, Kalākaua had warned him “not to put my soldiers in the palace. It was understood I must get more men before the favorable opportunity arrived.”¹³⁹ McGregor-Alegado suggests that when Wilcox sent Robert Hoapili Baker to Healani with a message to Kalākaua, Hawaiian League-supported cabinet members were there with him, and

if the King had still been undecided about lending his support to Wilcox and signing his constitution, the conference with the Cabinet members probably convinced him that the Cabinet was prepared for a confrontation and that he could not side with Wilcox without jeopardizing his position on the throne.¹⁴⁰

Wilcox had only half as many men as the Honolulu Rifles, and he sensed that Kalākaua would not go along with the revolution until he was sure Wilcox’s association had enough men and arms to carry out the takeover without endangering Hawaiians. While *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina* and *Kuokoa* reported that “he nui ka hoohuoi mawaena o kekahi poe, ua komo pu no ka Moi iloko o keia hookahuli aupuni” (there is a lot of suspicion among some people that the king joined together in this effort to overthrow the government), in actuality, “ua hoole loa ka Moi ma kekahi palapala i hoolaha ia ma ka nupepa haole, aole oia i lihi launa iki aku i keia hana ino” (the king vehemently denied through a document that was published in the English-language newspapers. He was not in the least part of this terrible undertaking).¹⁴¹

Kuokoa also asserted the mō‘ī’s separateness from Wilcox, printing the mō‘ī’s letter to Samuel Damon insisting on his noninvolvement: “Ke hai aku nei Au me ka oiaio loa,—aöhe oiaio o ia mau lono, a aöhe no hoi he like me ka mea i waiho ia aku imua o ka Aha Kuhina ma ka la inehinei” (I make this solemn declaration that this report has no truth nor is there

resemblance with the matter before the cabinet yesterday).¹⁴² Remarking that “we are glad to be able to contradict the report which was certainly current yesterday,” the *PCA* also published his letter on July 31.¹⁴³ In the August 2 special Insurrection edition, it further insisted on Kalākaua’s lack of involvement by reporting that when on his way to Healan Tuesday morning, one of Wilcox’ accomplices tried to speak with the mō‘ī, but he refused.¹⁴⁴ What is important here is that by denying his involvement, all the papers, regardless of their politics, supported retaining Kalākaua as mō‘ī, however reduced his power might be. As for Wilcox, though, in what was “clearly an affront to the Reform Government which had been the target of the July 30 uprising,” he was acquitted of all charges, implying “approval by the jury of the ‘Wilcox Rebellion.’”¹⁴⁵

Within weeks of Wilcox’s attempt, on August 19, 1889, John E. Bush, J. W. Mikasobe, F. Meka, J. K. Kaunamano, S. P. Kanoe, and Thomas Spencer started *Ka Leo o ka Lahui* (Voice of the Nation), a daily Hawaiian-language newspaper “devoted to the best interests of the Hawaiian nation and maintenance of its autonomy.”¹⁴⁶ *Ka Leo* represented the resilience of the support for Kalākaua and Kānaka ‘Ōiwi and became another print forum for Native Hawaiians to resist the Bayonet Constitution—with Kalākaua still in place as a symbol of the desired independence.

Notes

- ^{1.} Silva, *Aloha Betrayed*, 88.
- ^{2.} Lili‘uokalani, *Hawaii’s Story*, 100.
- ^{3.} Chapin, *Shaping History*, 77.
- ^{4.} Mo‘okini notes that *Ka Hoku o ke Kai* was a “literary paper for the amusement and instruction of Hawaiians” that translated “European stories into Hawaiian.” Mo‘okini, *Hawaiian Newspapers*, 16–17.
- ^{5.} *Ke Koo o Hawaii* published “patriotic Hawaiian articles” and “mele.” Mo‘okini, *Hawaiian Language*, 21.
- ^{6.} Chapin, *Guide to Newspapers of Hawai‘i*.
- ^{7.} “Ka La 12 o Feberuari,” *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, February 24, 1883, 3, Ulukau.
- ^{8.} “Another of the Saints,” *Hawaii Holomua*, February 8, 1893, 4, Ulukau.

- [9.](#) Mo'okini, *Hawaiian Newspapers*, x.
- [10.](#) "Ka Poni Moi," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, February 17, 1883, 2, Ulukau.
- [11.](#) Lili'uokalani, *Hawaii's Story*, 101.
- [12.](#) "The Coronation. 12th February, 1883. Processions, Salutes, Decorations, &c., &c," *PCA*, February 17, 1883, 2, Chronicling America; "The Ceremony of the Coronation," *PCA*, February 17, 1883, 4, Chronicling America.
- [13.](#) "The Ceremony of the Coronation," *PCA*, February 17, 1883, 4.
- [14.](#) "Those Who Thought," *Daily Bulletin*, February 13, 1883, 2, Chronicling America.
- [15.](#) "Ka La 12," *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, February 24, 1883, 3.
- [16.](#) Lili'uokalani, *Hawaii's Story*, 101, 104.
- [17.](#) "Nawai e Uku na Lilo," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, February 24, 1883, 3, Ulukau.
- [18.](#) "Ke Kulana o ke Aupuni," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, February 24, 1883, 2, Ulukau.
- [19.](#) "The Chief Bugler of the Stalwarts," *PCA*, February 17, 1883, 4, Chronicling America.
- [20.](#) Osorio, *Dismembering Lāhui*, 204-205.
- [21.](#) "Ka Lapuwale o ka Poaono Nei," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, March 3, 1883, 2, Ulukau.
- [22.](#) Osorio, *Dismembering Lāhui*, 203.
- [23.](#) Stillman, "No ka Po'e," 19.
- [24.](#) More examples of mele were "O Kalani i poniia i ka wai Liula" (The royal one is crowned in the twilight waters), "O Kalani i poniia i ka wai Kuauhoe" (The royal one is crowned in the waters of Kū'au hoe), "O Kalani i poniia i ka ua Kiowao" (The royal one is crowned in the Ki'owao rain), "O Kalani i poniia i ka ua Paliloa" (The royal one is crowned in the Paliloa rain), "O Kalani i ponoia e ka ua Paupili" (The royal one is crowned in the Pa'ūpili rain), "E poni ia ana o Kalani" (The royal one will be crowned), "Poni ia oe e Kalani" (You, Royal One, are crowned), "He poni hanohano nou e Kalani" (A glorious crowning in your honor, O Royal One), "Eia ko poni e Kalani" (Here is your crowning, O Royal One), "Eia ko la e Poni ai" (Here is the day of crowning), "Poni Kapulani a Hawaii" (Crowning Hawai'i's heavenly sacred one), "Kau oe i ka Poni Hanohano" (You are presented in a glorious crowning), "Noho oe i ka Poni Ihiihi" (You reign with a revered crowning), "Ua poniia o Davida i ka la umikumalua" (David was crowned on the twelfth day), "Ua poniia o Davida imua o ke Akua Mana Loa" (David was crowned before Almighty God), "Ua poni ia Davida i ka Aila Mura Oliva" (David was consecrated by an olive tree), "Ua poni ia Davida i ke Ala Kupaoa" (David was crowned in Kūpaoa fragrance), "Ua poni ia Davida i ka Lauae o na Pali" (David was crowned in laua'e of the mountain peaks), "Ua poni ia Davida me ke Ala o ka Mokihana" (David was crowned with the fragrance of Mokihana), and "Ua poni ia Davida me ke Ala o ke Kupukupu" (David was crowned with the fragrance of Kupukupu). Kaonowai performed these last two mele three times in his presentation.
- [25.](#) Lili'uokalani, *Hawaii's Story*, 103.
- [26.](#) "The Scene of the Luau," *PCA*, March 3, 1883, 2, Chronicling America.
- [27.](#) Lili'uokalani, *Hawaii's Story*, 104.
- [28.](#) "No na Mele," *Hae Hawaii*, March 21, 1860, 204, Ulukau.
- [29.](#) See Hawaiian Manuscript Collection, storage case 4, *Kalakaua: Legend, History & Mele*.

- [30.](#) Stillman, "No ka Po'e," 7-8.
- [31.](#) Tatar, *Nineteenth-Century Hawaiian Chant*, 29.
- [32.](#) Stillman, "No ka Po'e," 14.
- [33.](#) A reference to the island of Hawai'i. Keawe'īkekahiali'iokamoku, the great grandfather of Kamehameha I, maintained a peaceful reign as chief of that island, and the well-known phrase "moku o Keawe" is a tribute to him.
- [34.](#) "He Inoa Iubile no Kalani," *Nupepa Elele*, December 11, 1886, 2, Ulukau.
- [35.](#) "Mele Iubile" (Jubilee chants), *HEN*, vol. 3, 1184. Hanakahi was a famous chief of Hilo, and this line honors him. The reference to the fragrant walls of Puna speak of the aromatic pandanus blossoms that people of long ago would adhere to their walls. The Ha'ao rain falls in Ka'ū. Chief Ehu ruled over Kona. The two waterfalls of Waipi'o are Hi'ilawe and Kaluahine. Keohokalōle was Kalākaua's mother.
- [36.](#) A celebrated chief of O'ahu and therefore a reference to this island.
- [37.](#) "He Inoa Iubile no Kalani," *Nupepa Elele*, December 11, 1886, 2, Ulukau.
- [38.](#) "He Inoa Iubile no Kalani," *Nupepa Elele*, December 18, 1886, 3, Ulukau.
- [39.](#) "Mele Iubile," *HEN*, vol. 3, 1187.
- [40.](#) "Two Views," *Daily Bulletin*, November 23, 1886, 2, Chronicling America.
- [41.](#) "The Luau," *Daily Herald*, November 24, 1886, 3, Chronicling America.
- [42.](#) "Ka Makahiki Iubile o ka Moi," *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, November 20, 1886, 4, Ulukau.
- [43.](#) "He Ui, He Ninau ia Kona Akau," *Nupepa Elele*, November 6, 1886, 2, Papakilo Database.
- [44.](#) "Ka La Iubile o ka Moi ma Kona Akau Hawaii," *Nupepa Elele*, December 18, 1886, 3, Papakilo Database.
- [45.](#) "Hoomanao ana i ka La Hanau o ke Alii ka Moi," *Nupepa Elele*, December 11, 1886, 3, Papakilo Database.
- [46.](#) "Ka Iubile La Hanau. Na Hauoli Hapalua Keneturia. 1836-1886," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, November 20, 1886, 2, Ulukau.
- [47.](#) "His Majesty's Jubilee Birthday! The Reception. The Firemen's Parade! The Fireworks!," *Daily Bulletin*, November 17, 1886, 2, Chronicling America; "1836-1886. His Majesty's Jubilee Birthday! Handsome Display of Presents. Magnificent Display of Fire Works! Grand Torchlight Procession of the Honolulu Fire Department Incidents, Etc.," *HG*, November 23, 1886, 1-2, Chronicling America.
- [48.](#) "Ka Iubile La Hanau," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, November 20, 1886, 2.
- [49.](#) "Ka Makahiki," *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, November 20, 1886, 4.
- [50.](#) "The King's Jubilee. Celebration of His Majesty's Fiftieth Birthday. Festivities of the First and Second Days. Reception—Torchlight Procession—Regatta," *Daily Herald*, November 18, 1886, 3, Chronicling America.
- [51.](#) "Ka Iubile La Hanau," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, November 20, 1886, 2.
- [52.](#) "The King's Birthday. How the Event was Observed in Honolulu. A Largely Attended Reception at the Palace. Yacht and Rowing Races in the Harbor—Baseball and Torchlight Procession, Etc.," *HG*, November 18, 1890, 9, Chronicling America.
- [53.](#) "1836," *HG*, November 23, 1886, 1-2.
- [54.](#) "The King's Jubilee," *Daily Herald*, November 18, 1886, 3.
- [55.](#) "Na Komite a me ka Poe i Makana mai no ka La Iubile o ka Moi mai

- Molokai mai," *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, November 27, 1886, 3, Ulukau.
- [56.](#) Pukui, "Aia i Waimānalo," 134-135.
- [57.](#) Silva, *Aloha Betrayed*, 121.
- [58.](#) "Haiolelo o ka Puali Pui Ohe ma o ka Hooilina Moi La," *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, November 27, 1886, 4, Ulukau.
- [59.](#) "The King's Jubilee," *Daily Herald*, November 18, 1886, 3.
- [60.](#) "Ka Makahiki," *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, November 20, 1886, 4.
- [61.](#) "The King's Birthday Grand Reception at Iolani Palace. An Immense Concourse of People to Present Their Alohas. Hundreds of Rare and Costly Gifts Presented to His Majesty. Magnificent Pyrotechnic Display and Torchlight Procession of the Fire Companies, Etc.," *PCA*, November 17, 1886, 3.
- [62.](#) "The King's Jubilee," *Daily Herald*, November 18, 1886, 3.
- [63.](#) "Ka Iubile La Hanau," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, November 20, 1886, 2.
- [64.](#) *HEN*, vol. 1, 2865.
- [65.](#) "Saturday's Parade. History of the Hawaiian Islands Symbolized. The Barbaric Past Exhibited Side by Side with Modern Civilization," *PCA*, November 22, 1886, 2, *Chronicling America*.
- [66.](#) "Ka Iubile La Hanau," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, November 20, 1886, 2; see Noenoe Silva's discussion of the parade in *Aloha Betrayed*, 113-116.
- [67.](#) "The Historical Procession. Fine Weather and Happy Hawaiians," *Daily Herald*, November 22, 1886, 3, *Chronicling America*.
- [68.](#) "Saturday's," *PCA*, November 22, 1886, 2.
- [69.](#) "The Historical," *Daily Herald*, November 22, 1886, 3.
- [70.](#) "Ka Iubile la Hanau," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, November 20, 1886, 2.
- [71.](#) *Ibid.* Other accounts confirmed its success: "Jubilee Luau," *Daily Bulletin*, November 24, 1886, 3; "The Royal Luau. Elaborate and Tasteful Decoration of the Lanai in the Palace Grounds. Infinite Variety of Native Dishes. Fifteen Hundred Guests Entertained by His Majesty the King," *PCA*, November 24, 1886, 2.
- [72.](#) "Hoiikeike Iubile o ke Au Kahiko me ke Au Hou," *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, November 27, 1886, 4, Ulukau; "Ka Iubile la Hanau," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, November 20, 1886, 2.
- [73.](#) "Birthday Ball. A Brilliant Gathering at Iolani Palace. The Palace, Lanai and Grounds Illuminated by Electricity," *PCA*, November 26, 1886, 2, *Chronicling America*.
- [74.](#) "The Athletic Sports. Delightful Weather—A Great Crowd—Spirited Contests," *Daily Herald*, November 27, 1886, 3, *Chronicling America*.
- [75.](#) "Ka Makahiki," *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, November 20, 1886, 4.
- [76.](#) "Ka La Hanau o ka Moi ma Wasinetona," *Ka Nupepa Elele*, December 25, 1886, 1, Papakilo Database.
- [77.](#) "Report That the Gibson Cabinet Is Dismissed," *HG*, June 28, 1887, 4, *Chronicling America*.
- [78.](#) Osorio, *Dismembering Lāhui*; McGregor-Alegado, "Hawaiian Resistance," 33-75; Earle, "Coalition Politics."
- [79.](#) Earle, "Coalition Politics," 36.
- [80.](#) Lili'uokalani, *Hawaii's Story*, 181.

- [81.](#) McGregor-Alegado, *Nā Kua'āina*, 41-42.
- [82.](#) Earle, "Coalition Politics," 41.
- [83.](#) Osorio, *Dismembering Lāhui*, 235.
- [84.](#) Ibid., 239.
- [85.](#) "Public Meeting," *Daily Bulletin*, June 29, 1887, 2, Chronicling America; "A Run on Firearms," *Daily Bulletin*, June 29, 1887, 2, Chronicling America; "Barricading," *Daily Bulletin*, June 29, 1887, 2, Chronicling America.
- [86.](#) "A Great Mistake Is Made by Some People When They Look upon Wilcox's Attempted *Coup d'état* as a Similar Movement to the Reform Revolution and Justifiable by That Event," *Daily Bulletin*, August 2, 1889, 3, Chronicling America.
- [87.](#) "The Government of the Country Is Rotten," *HG*, June 28, 1887, 5, Chronicling America.
- [88.](#) "A Cabinet Shuffle," *Daily Herald*, June 29, 1887, 2, Chronicling America.
- [89.](#) "Report That the Gibson," *HG*, June 28, 1887, 4.
- [90.](#) "Mass Meeting. A Large Gathering! Pointed Speeches. Resolutions Adopted. All Business Suspended. The Liquor Houses Closed! The Military under Arms. Great Excitement," *Daily Bulletin*, June 30, 1887, 2, Chronicling America.
- [91.](#) "Reform! Immense Mass Meeting. Under Military Protection. Radical Resolutions. Strong Speeches. A Firm and Formidable Front," *Daily Herald*, July 1, 1887, 3, Chronicling America.
- [92.](#) "Mass Meeting," *Daily Bulletin*, June 30, 1887, 2.
- [93.](#) Osorio, *Dismembering Lāhui*, 237.
- [94.](#) "The Programme," *Daily Herald*, July 1, 1887, 2, Chronicling America.
- [95.](#) "Local and General: The Honolulu Rifles," *PCA*, July 6, 1887, 3.
- [96.](#) Chapin, *Shaping History*, 82.
- [97.](#) The committee of thirteen consisted of Paul Isenberg, W. W. Hall, J. A. Kennedy, W. H. Rice, James King, E. B. Thomas, H. C. Reed, John Rivas, W. F. A. Brewer, W. B. Oleson, Cecil Brown, John Ross, and J. B. Atherton.
- [98.](#) "Mass Meeting," *Daily Bulletin*, June 30, 1887, 2.
- [99.](#) "Government Reform! The People Roused! 2,500 Freemen in Mass Meeting! A New Constitution and a New Government Demanded! Downfall of the Gibson Cabinet! Gibson and Hayselden Arrested! A New Ministry!," *HG*, July 5, 1887, 1, 8, Chronicling America.
- [100.](#) Lili'uokalani, *Hawaii's Story*, 191.
- [101.](#) Osorio, *Dismembering Lāhui*, 197.
- [102.](#) "Report That the Gibson," *HG*, June 28, 1887, 4.
- [103.](#) "The Other Side," *HG*, June 28, 1887, 7, Chronicling America.
- [104.](#) "The News on the Other Islands," *HG*, July 19, 1887, 3, Chronicling America.
- [105.](#) Earle, "Coalition Politics," 42.
- [106.](#) Lili'uokalani, *Hawaii's Story*, 181, 182; see also Silva, *Aloha Betrayed*, 126n12.
- [107.](#) Silva, *Aloha Betrayed*, 127.
- [108.](#) Stillman, "No ka Po'e," 17-18.
- [109.](#) Osorio, *Dismembering Lāhui*, 245.

- [110.](#) McGregor-Alegado, "Hawaiian Resistance," 47.
- [111.](#) "Mass Meeting. Held by Native Hawaiians at Kaumakapili Church," *PCA*, July 26, 1887, 3.
- [112.](#) McGregor-Alegado, "Hawaiian Resistance," 50.
- [113.](#) Earle, "Coalition Politics," 83.
- [114.](#) McGregor-Alegado, "Hawaiian Resistance," 52.
- [115.](#) "The Editor of the 'Elele' Speaks," *Daily Bulletin*, June 25, 1887, 2, *Chronicling America*.
- [116.](#) "Petition No. 11 for Amendments to Constitution Presented by E. Helekunihi. 7 Nov. 1887," *Petitions to King 1887 Legislative Assembly Extraordinary Session 1887*, Foreign Office & Executive Collection 1887, Local Officials, King, Hawai'i State Archives.
- [117.](#) Hawaii Const. of 1864, art. III.
- [118.](#) "Na Kahua i Kukulu ia ai ka Nupepa 'Ke Alakai o Hawaii,'" *Alakai o Hawaii*, August 31, 1887, 4, Ulukau.
- [119.](#) Osorio, *Dismembering Lāhui*, 150.
- [120.](#) *Ibid.*, 180.
- [121.](#) "E Ala e Hawaii!," *Alakai o Hawaii*, August 31, 1887, 3, Ulukau.
- [122.](#) "Ka Balota Alii Aloha Moi, Makee Aina a me na Makaainana, a e Hoomaemae ana Hoi i ke Kumukanawai" and "Ka Balota Lunamakaainana Aloha Alii, Makee Aina a Lahui Hoi, a Hoomaemae Kumukanawai," *Alakai o Hawaii*, August 31, 1887, 4, Ulukau.
- [123.](#) US Department of State, *Papers Relating to the Mission of James H. Blount*, part 2, 13.
- [124.](#) After July 30, 1889, the American-backed *PCA* criticized Wilcox for rebelling against the very government that had sponsored his education in Italy. See "Great Riot! Attempt to Overturn the Government by Bob Wilcox and 150 Natives. The Palace Grounds and Gov't House Taken Possession of by Armed Rioters. The Honolulu Rifles Called Out. The Opera House Bombarded by the Rioters. 7 Hawaiians Killed and 12 Wounded! The Queen's Bungalow Ruined by Dynamite Bombs. Surrender of the Rioters. Notes and Incidents," *PCA*, July 31, 1889, 3; "The Events of the Past Twenty-Four Hours," *PCA*, July 31, 1889, 2; "A Great Folly of the Past Is Illustrated in Bold Relief by This Squelched Uprising," *Daily Bulletin*, August 1, 1889, 2; "The Riot, or Insurrection as It May Be More Properly Termed," *PCA*, August 1, 1889, 2, *Chronicling America*.
- [125.](#) Nakanaela, *Ka Buke Moolelo*; McGregor-Alegado, "Hawaiian Resistance"; Chapin, *Shaping History*; Dukas, *Military History of Sovereign Hawai'i*.
- [126.](#) See "A Great Mistake," *Daily Bulletin*, August 2, 1889, 3, wherein the *Bulletin* criticizes the Reform Party for failing to make good on its promises of government reform.
- [127.](#) McGregor-Alegado has asserted that "there is no tangible evidence for the claim that the 'Rebellion' was another plot to replace the King with Lili'uokalani. All of the testimony presented in the trials made it clear that the express purpose of the 'Rebellion' was to support King Kalākaua and the Hawaiian people, as a whole." McGregor-Alegado, "Hawaiian Resistance," 96.
- [128.](#) Thurston, *Memoirs of the Hawaiian Revolution*, 193. To note, on July 31, 1889, Thurston happened to be on Moloka'i.

- [129.](#) "The Events of the Past," *PCA*, July 31, 1889, 2.
- [130.](#) See the *Daily Bulletin*, August 2, 1889.
- [131.](#) "Yesterday's Edition of the Bulletin Consisting of 1400 Copies Was so Quickly Exhausted That Sales Had to Be Stopped to Ensure Our Subscribers Being Served," *Daily Bulletin*, August 1, 1889, 3, *Chronicling America*.
- [132.](#) "The Issue of the Advertiser Yesterday Morning Was 2,500 Copies," *PCA*, August 1, 1889, 3.
- [133.](#) "Supreme Court: October Term," *PCA*, October 12, 1889, 3.
- [134.](#) McGregor-Alegado, "Hawaiian Resistance," 88.
- [135.](#) "Supreme Court," *PCA*, October 12, 1889, 3.
- [136.](#) "Great Riot! Attempt to Overturn," *PCA*, July 31, 1889, 3.
- [137.](#) "Unsuccessful Attempt at Revolution! An Armed Force of Natives Take Possession of the Palace Yard at Three in the Morning. Lieut. Robert Parker with Twelve King's Guard Holds [sic] the Palace. The King at His Boat House with Twelve of His Guards. Sharp Skirmishing since 10:15 O'clock A. M. Several Insurrectionists Killed and Wounded. Surrender of Rebels," *Daily Bulletin*, July 31, 1889, 3, *Chronicling America*.
- [138.](#) McGregor-Alegado, "Hawaiian Resistance," 97.
- [139.](#) "Supreme Court," *PCA*, October 12, 1889, 3.
- [140.](#) McGregor-Alegado, "Hawaiian Resistance," 97.
- [141.](#) "Kipi Kuloko ma Honolulu! Wilikoki a me kona Poe Kipi! Na Koa Kumau Puuwai Koa! Aole Haawi Pio a i ka Hopena! Ua Pau ke Kipi a ua Hoka! Kela a me keia Mea!," *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, August 3, 1889, 2-3, *Ulu kau*.
- [142.](#) "Ka Haunaele Kuloko," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, August 3, 1889, 2, *Ulu kau*.
- [143.](#) "The Impression Was Very General," *PCA*, July 31, 1889, 2.
- [144.](#) "More Particulars," *Daily Bulletin*, August 2, 1889, 2.
- [145.](#) McGregor-Alegado, "Hawaiian Resistance," 107.
- [146.](#) Chapin, *Guide to Newspapers of Hawai'i*, 54.

CHAPTER SIX

The Final Days of Kalākaua

The English- and Hawaiian-language newspapers published in Hawai'i during King Kalākaua's reign provide a more complete record of maka'āinana aloha and kūpa'a (loyalty) for their mō'i. Whether devoted to Kalākaua for the sake of the lāhui, the monarchy, personal affection, or all three, Kānaka Maoli supported this seventh mō'i, Kahikukapuonālani (the seventh of the sacred kings).¹ Chapter 6 follows the mō'i during his final days in Hawai'i and California, then focuses on the newspaper accounts of maka'āinana response to his death and how Kānaka 'Ōiwi weaponized the Hawaiian press to attack the Bayonet Constitution, the Hawaiian League, and the king's cabinet for sending him to his death in late 1890. Chapter 6 also examines how Hawaiian-language newspapers articulated the ideologies of aloha 'āina, an intimate oneness with the physical entity known as the islands of Hawai'i; aloha lāhui, a loyalty and love for the independent Hawaiian Nation and people; and aloha ali'i, a deep affinity with the supernatural or divine authority of the ali'i and mō'i, from precontact chiefs to Kamehameha and on through to Lili'uokalani.² The newspapers are part of a rich archive that can more clearly explain nineteenth-century Kānaka Maoli, and as Ron Williams notes, this depository "reflects a national identity of Hawaiians, a nation of Hawaiian intellectuals, political leaders, and an active populace ... as an almost fully literate, outspoken, and informed citizenry, rightfully tied to its 'āina (land), and its lāhui (nation)."³

Today, we may find it difficult to understand how aloha 'āina, aloha lāhui, and aloha ali'i together constituted the core, essence, and memory of most nine-teenth-century

Kānaka ‘Ōiwi, manifesting as an unconditional love and respect for and a sense of participation in sustaining the Hawaiian throne. As Noenoe K. Silva explains, “The processes of settler colonialism disrupt our connection to our kupuna and our ‘āina. No less important, those same processes have disrupted our ability to understand our kupuna’s ontologies and epistemologies.”⁴ This chapter will also discuss Kanaka-published responses to the Bayonet Constitution’s reduction of the governing power of their mō‘ī. Kalākaua headed for Washington, DC, in 1890, but died unexpectedly in San Francisco. When Kānaka in Hawai‘i learned of his death, they were thrown into a national crisis. How did the mō‘ī die? When did he die? And who was responsible for his death? These were the questions of his most loyal followers, and one detailed answer was Joseph Moku‘ōhai Poepoe’s biography *Ka Moololo o ka Moi Kalakaua I*. Published before and distributed at the funeral, this substantial pamphlet displays Poepoe’s adept use of language, culture, and composition to honor the departed mō‘ī according to Native tradition.

The Hawaiian-language newspaper articles examined here also document the last grand public opportunities for Kānaka Maoli to show their aloha to their mō‘ī. The published palapala hoaaloha (letters of condolences) following Kalākaua’s death demonstrate ‘Ōiwi aloha and expert deployment of the written word. They further reveal maka‘āinana compassion and loyalty for the royal family. Even during the rapid, unforeseen collapse of their monarchy, Native Hawaiian intellectuals were accurately and compassionately responding to the tumultuous political, economic, and social climates in ways that informed their readership. That more than one hundred years later, at a time when some suggest that the value of the written word is declining, scholars are still examining the arguments published by *Ka Leo o ka Lahui* defending the Hawaiian monarchy in 1891 shows the proficiency and intellectual mastery with which Native Hawaiians employed the foreign-introduced printing process. This is their story—and as Ngūgĩ

Wa Thiong'o has written, "The story of the struggle will finally glorify the people's heroism and their resistance spirit."⁵

Hawai'i's Celebration of Kalākaua's Last Birthday and His Travels to California

On November 16, 1890, before departing for California, Kalākaua enjoyed one last birthday celebration with his people. The *Hawaiian Gazette's* (HG) account of the events appeared on page 9 of its twelve-page November 18 issue—a sign of its continuing campaign to downplay public support for the mō'i.⁶ But the other newspaper reports of the tributes and merriment confirm Hawaiians' steadfast aloha for him, sixteen years into his reign and even after the failed Wilcox rebellion. Thomas Cummins was once more in charge of the celebrations. Preparations began on November 1. Because the sixteenth was the Sabbath, Honolulu businesses closed on November 15, when most of the events took place. The activities were familiar—ho'okupu at the palace, sailing and rowing races, baseball, railway excursions to the countryside, a torchlight procession, speeches, a banquet and feasts throughout Honolulu, and music by the Royal Hawaiian Band. The next day, services were held at Saint Andrew's Cathedral, Kawaiaha'o, the Latter-day Saint Church, and the Roman Catholic Church, followed by dinner at the Cummins residence. Honolulu was adorned with colorful flags. The warships docked at Honolulu Harbor sounded their salutes to the mō'i on the fifteenth. *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina* reported that the people sleeping within 'Iolani Palace's enclosure woke up as early as 6:00 a.m. and began to present their gifts to Kalākaua. Among them were the Native equestrians.⁷ For six hours, the mō'i received the consular and diplomatic corps, foreign dignitaries, military officials, local government leaders, and maka'āinana bearing gifts. The warships *Charleston*, *Mohican*, and *Tsukuba* sounded a total eighty-four-gun salutes. According to the newspapers, at least, this last day honoring Kalākaua was entirely agreeable and

successful.

Two weeks after his fifty-fourth birthday, Kalākaua readied himself for California. Convalescence was the goal. *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina* reported that the royal family met for several hours at 'Iolani Palace on the morning before his departure. *Kuokoa* did not cover his leave-taking, but thanks to *Ko Hawaii*, we know that people were already gathered at 'Āinahou to say farewell when the royal carriage arrived at Honolulu Harbor.⁸ Hawai'i's newspapers did, however, report on his every move in California and recorded the people's fondness for him there at his arrival, during his activities, and through to his final illness and funeral services at Trinity Church in San Francisco.

As they had on all previous visits, the people of California honored and entertained him. Indeed, their affection remained constant throughout his reign, even as his opponents in Hawai'i increasingly attacked or mocked him. One California reporter described his welcome in 1890 this way:

It is no exaggeration to say that no visitor to the Pacific Coast has ever before received such a magnificent reception as was accorded the King by the people of California. There seemed to be a universal cordiality.... He was always greeted enthusiastically by the audience; again when the King and his suite visited a baseball game ... ten thousand people arose in their seats and cheered lustily for five minutes, while the bands were playing the Hawaiian ode.⁹

Arriving in San Francisco on December 4, he traveled south, then returned to San Francisco, where he died on January 20 of what sources identify as Bright's disease. A discussion of the king's death according to Joseph Moku'ōhai Poepoe is forthcoming. When he first stepped ashore, a twenty-one-gun salute from Fort Alcatraz and the American warship *Swatara* greeted him. *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina* reported that the welcoming crowd was anxious to receive its guest.¹⁰ As he

moved around the city, spectators crowded the streets, hoping for a glimpse,¹¹ and the *Pacific Commercial Advertiser* (PCA) noted that “he has attended everything in sight, and has been received everywhere with the eminent respect due his royal rank.” In the south, he visited San Diego, where he toured the dam and an orchard in Sweetwater, then made his way to Tijuana. As always, “All who met the King were impressed with a sense of his social and intellectual accomplishments.” According to the PCA, “several thousand” people were at the Santa Barbara train station to greet him.¹² On January 1, 1891, Kalākaua, “the cynosure of all eyes,” was the honored guest at the recently built and stunning Loring Opera House in Riverside, where famous opera voice Emma Juch presented Gounold’s *Faust*. The mōī’s name appeared on the handbill, and he himself was described as “an intelligent looking, polite and affable gentleman, well dressed, wearing on his breast a number of decorations of honor.” In an almost deliberate insult to the perpetrators of the Bayonet Constitution, San Diego’s press described Kalākaua as “probably the most democratic king on any throne today ... (he was) well educated, easily approached and not given to offensive presumption” and noted that “he played polo, poker and other social games with American and English people of social standing.”¹³ George E. Whitney, a former resident of Hawai‘i and friend of the mōī, joined other Freemasons in accompanying the royal entourage to Southern California. Here is a portion of his description of Kalākaua to the *Tribune*, reprinted in the PCA:

He is a very agreeable traveling companion; a quiet, observing man, not given to gabbling, but is appreciative and interested.... There were indeed more proffers of attention and hospitality than the limited time at his disposal would permit him to accept. He is a careful traveler, all the time looking out for ideas to incorporate in his plans for the improvement of his islands.¹⁴

Even in his last few days, this is how Kalākaua struck his contemporaries—as an inquisitive and observant man, always learning from the successes of other nations, kingdoms, and principalities and always looking to benefit his country. His enemies and the later writers who relied on them have ignored or suppressed such portraits.

Kalākaua’s Death, January 20, 1891, and the Aftermath

David La’amea Kamanakapu Māhinulani Nāla’ia’ehuokalani Kalākaua died on January 20, 1891, at 2:30 p.m. in the Palace Hotel in San Francisco. On January 26, Honolulu merchants were raising flags, banners, arches, and other decorations to welcome him back from California, not learning of his death until January 29, when the *Charleston* arrived in Honolulu Harbor with his remains.¹⁵ They had been expecting him on January 31, when the battery at Kaka’ako would fire three volleys, notifying them of his arrival. They knew something was wrong because the “beloved” Hawaiian flag was flying on the *Charleston* at half-mast. *Nupepa Elele* noted that “the King was reported last mail as being indisposed.”¹⁶ *Ka Leo o ka Lahui* captured the scene this way:

He manawa keia no ka pioloke o ka lehulehu o ke kulanakauhale nei, e ninau aku ana a ninau mai, e ui aku ana hoi a ui mai aka nae i ka loa ana mai o ka loa ano nui a kaumaha e pili ana i ko ke ‘Lii make ana ma ka aina malihini ana i hoona aku ai me ka manao e loa ke ola kino lanakila, ua aahu iho la ke kulanakauhale nei a me ka Lahui Hawaii i ke koloka o ke kumakena a me ke kanikau—Auwe! Lihaliha wale ia oe “DAVIDA LAAMEA E.”¹⁷

(This was a time of confusion of the populace of the city, asking here and there, appealing everywhere, but, nevertheless, when the important and sad details were obtained concerning the king’s death in a foreign land to convalesce, the city and the Hawaiian Nation were

draped in a cloak of grief and mourning—Alas! We are devastated because of you, “David Laamea.”)

The *PCA* declared that “the announcement yesterday of the death of Kalakaua fell like a clap of thunder from the skies.”¹⁸ The unexpectedness and the reversal were particularly hard for makaʻāinana: “Instead of triumphal arches, gaily decorated with evergreens and incised [sic] with joyous inscriptions, the ominously black draped them ... and in place of the smiling faces that would have beamed with pleasure and voices strong with cheers, the mournful countenances of the immense gathering, hushed to quietness by awe, lined the way from the wharf to the Palace.”¹⁹ Kalākaua’s opponent *Ko Hawaii* lamented his death: “Me ka luuluu, ke kaumaha a me ka mokumokuahua makou e puka aku nei i keia kakahiaka, ma ka hoike ana aku imua of ka Lahui Hawaii o Kalani Kaulilua” (With sorrow, grief and pity we appear this morning in our reporting before the Hawaiian Nation of the Royal One Kaulilua).²⁰ The lengthy subtitle of the *Ka Leo o ka Lahui* story mirrored the people’s confusion and suffering: “Ka La e Alohi nei, Auhea ia?—Ke Alii Kaapuni Honua ua Hala—Ka Onohi o Hawaii, Aole—Ka Hae Aloha ou e Hawaii ua Hapa—O Hawaii Hauoli ua Kaumaha—A o Kalanikaulilua ua Hala! Ua Hala!! A ua Hala Loa aku!!!”²¹ (The Day of Shining, Where Is It?—The King Who Traveled around the World Is Gone—the Beloved of Hawaii, No Longer—Your Beloved Flag, Hawai’i Is at Half-Mast—Hawai’i’s Happiness Turned to Sorrowing Grief—and Kalanikaulilua Has Died! Has Died!! And Is Gone Forever!!!). Perhaps most tellingly, although *Nupepa Elele* had ceased operations on October 25, 1890, it started up again on January 31, 1891, to report on the death of Kalākaua.

In their ongoing coverage, Hawai’i newspapers reprinted accounts from California of the San Francisco funeral services and the honors and tributes shown him there.²² The shock of reversed expectations remained a subject for commentary. “One of the saddest events that Hawaiian historians will ever be called upon to inscribe on the annals

of the history of the Hawaiian Kingdom occurred yesterday," wrote the *PCA*, stressing that "for some time past preparations were in progress to celebrate the return of Hawaii's King; his reception to have been one of the grandest gala days Honolulu ever would have witnessed."²³ As Kalākaua's body was conveyed from the harbor to the palace, "piha kumakena ka uwapo ma ka la inehinei i na ewe pono makee Alii i ka wa i manele ia mai ai kona kino make" (the wharf yesterday was filled in grieving with the Native royalists at the time when his remains were carried).²⁴ The *PCA* observed that "every available point of view at that wharves was literally crowded, as well as the streets and buildings along the route ... by an immense throng, perhaps the largest Honolulu ever witnessed."²⁵ *Ka Leo* commented on the hō'ailona: "Mai ka wa a ka moku 'Kaletona' i hoea mai ai, pela iho la i nee malie ai ke anuenue, a hiki i ke komo ana o ke kino make o Kalani Kalakaua i ka ipuka o ka Pa Alii Iolani" (From the time when the ship *Charleston* arrived, a rainbow peacefully moved along until the moment the remains of King Kalākaua entered the gate of the grounds of 'Iolani Palace).²⁶ Several rainbows arched over the city. One sat just above the palace, the center directly over the flagpole. Another, a perfect bow that vaulted the sky, appeared as the sun was setting: "Probably a more perfect picture of the king was never seen, and this occurred just as the coffin was taken into the Palace. There must have been fifteen or twenty thousand spectators present. The natives call it an omen of peace, and certainly a more beautiful omen could not have been desired."²⁷ *Ka Leo* saw it as a symbol of nobility as well: "I ka ikeia ia ana o ka hoailona o ka lani mai, ua ku-ia iho la na mea a pau, a me he la, a hooia ana lakou i ke kapu a me ke alii o ka mea i make" (When the sign of the heavens was seen, all people were astonished, and it was as though they confirmed the tabu and royalty of the one who died).²⁸ Another familiar hō'ailona welcoming Kalākaua home began at the gate: torches, lit during the day, lined the palace yard.

Once the mō'i's body was at 'Iolani Palace, Kānaka Maoli

gathered in the unrelenting rain, filling the palace's enclosure and thronging the streets.²⁹ Over the next two weeks, Kānaka Maoli would gather and sleep there; in the evenings, they would form choirs to chant and sing mele, many recently composed for Kalākaua. On the next day, his body lay in state. The *PCA* reported that people silently filed through the throne room, with handkerchiefs and in tears, until two o'clock that afternoon.³⁰ *Elele* explained the response this way: "Kalakaua was endeared to the people of this country both foreign and native, not so much for his statesmanship as for kindness of heart and gentlemanly deportment, and a friend to every one in need."³¹

Immediately following the announcement of the mō'ī's death, the mele "Kalani Kaulilua," written for Kalākaua supposedly by Queen Kapi'olani, appeared in *Ka Leo o ka Lahui* on February 2, 1891. It is said that the mele was composed just after the king left for San Francisco in November 1890. The twenty-six-line mele declares love for the mō'ī: "He manao he aloha / No ka ipo lei manu" (I have a feeling of love / For my cherished sweetheart) and honors Kaua'i wahi pana (noted, legendary places), the home of Kapi'olani's ali'i ancestors, including her grandfather, the last independent king of Kaua'i, Kaumuali'i. *Ka Leo o ka Lahui's* printing of "Kalani Kaulilua" immediately after his funeral most likely strengthened the lāhui's aloha for their mākua, the mō'ī, and his mō'īwahine and united the nation in a terribly confusing and distressing time.

The extent of the newspaper coverage suggests just how important an event this was for Hawai'i. The *PCA* almost bragged about its attention to Kalākaua's funeral services: "There is not a doubt but the largest edition of any Honolulu paper was put out by the Advertiser yesterday," with sixteen hundred copies of its daily edition and thirty-one hundred copies of its weekly two editions, for a total of forty-seven hundred papers.³² Whitney, one of the mō'ī's severest critics, was editing both the *Advertiser* and the *HG* at that time, so their stories were the same length: three and one half columns, which was generous for Whitney.³³ As for the

Hawaiian-language papers, *Ko Hawaii* devoted four columns of coverage, but *Kuokoa*'s coverage was only one and one-third columns. *Nupepa Elele* had two columns in English and three columns in Hawaiian. Kalākaua's main advocate, *Ka Leo o ka Lahui*, described his death in three columns but also reported on the events in California and commented on the significance of the loss for the lāhui 'ōiwi.

Kalākaua's death marked a transition in how the newspapers represented the current political situation. That Kānaka Maoli so swiftly and so astutely learned the publishing process from early missionaries, then printed their own nationalist papers, underscores Native intellect and initiative. The collection of Hawaiian-language newspapers would become the largest collection of indigenous writing in history.³⁴ In 1891 the nationalist press held the white oligarchy and cabinet accountable for humiliating and all but murdering the mō'ī and grimly began predicting that if these forces could get away with this, they were capable of almost anything. The language became direct and precise. Kānaka Maoli declared that they were fed up with decades of haole efforts to acquire Native land.³⁵ Of all the Native-edited Hawaiian-language newspapers appearing during Kalākaua's reign and after, *Ka Leo o ka Lahui* was the most emphatic in expressing its disgust with the post-Bayonet white oligarchy. As Noenoe Silva has noted, "It was also Kalākaua's misfortune that the sons of the first missionaries came fully of age during his reign," but largely in response, in the later stages of this same period, *Ka Leo* featured some of the most explosive and exhilarating nationalist writers and editors—John E. Bush, J. W. Mikasobe, F. Meka, J. K. Kaunamano, S. P. Kanoë, and Thomas Spencer. They publicly declared their deep-seated Hawaiian nationalism, expressed anger against Kalākaua's opponents, and were often fearless in their language and accusations. They could be meticulous in their investigations and were steadfast in their devotion to the mō'ī and Kānaka 'Ōiwi. Like Silva's brilliant 2017 examination of nineteenth-century Native Hawaiian intellectuals Joseph Kānepu'u and Joseph Moku'ōhai Poepoe, my analysis

of the editors' fearless loyalty to the monarchy and lāhuikanaka in 1891 seeks to present a more complete picture of "the full and dynamic intellectual lives" of these Native Hawaiians as "public intellectuals, producing and engaging literature and politics in their own native language."³⁶

Printing its allegations in English as well, *Ka Leo* boldly called out the Hawaiian League. Take, for example, this attack on the hypocrisy displayed during Kalākaua's funeral procession:

It is scarcely more than three years since, when some of the very man [*sic*] who are now conspicuous with their mourning and their resolutions in honor of the departed, raised the red flag of revolution in Hawaii, and placed a price on the head of the same King, at the point of the bayonet, they forced the King to sign a Constitution, which is faulty and unjust and is not respected by the Hawaiian people. They continued to belittle the person and the dignity of the Sovereign, and made him the appendage of the four unanointed monarchs whom they save [*sic*] to the country in the persons of four unpopular Ministers. Are these then crocodile tears that we have been witnessing, or the conscientious regret of repentants who try to atone for the deeds that helped to hurry the King to his grave.³⁷

This resistance continued into Lili'uokalani's reign. Bush and his team used *Ka Leo* to fight against annexation, even printing the queen's "protest" and "appeals." Eventually, Bush himself would go to jail for the paper's protests against the provisional government and then the supposed republic.³⁸

Hawai'i paid its last respects to Kalākaua on February 15, 1891. Given their politics, the newspapers' accounts naturally vary. Whitney's papers describe the casket in detail but pass over the huge numbers of Kānaka Maoli present or their tributes and expressions of aloha for their mō'i. Nor

does Whitney or Kawainui mention the thousands of people who turned out early.³⁹ *Ko Hawaii* tells us that men, women, and children were filling the street fronting 'Iolani Palace well before the mō'i's services,⁴⁰ and they began lining up for the funeral procession long before its start.⁴¹ Thousands of flowers surrounded the casket in the throne room when the royal family, kingdom officials, and foreign dignitaries attended the service. The next day, after the funeral, *Ka Leo o ka Lahui* protested the premier's decision to let only kingdom officials attend the ceremony, barring Kalākaua's own people.⁴² *Ko Hawaii* reported that at the end of the service, "Keiki Oiwi o Hawaii" (The Native Children of Hawai'i) carried the coffin to the carriage outside while "ua mele ia mai ke mele kahiko o na kupapau kaulana e himeni ia ai" (the ancient mele of the famous remains were chanted).⁴³ Native societies, schoolchildren, and choirs accompanied the casket to Mauna 'Ala in Nu'uano. "The procession was one of great length, taking one hour and fifteen minutes to pass a given point," the *PCA* observed, adding that

at no other time during the past history of Hawaii has been or is likely to be for some time in the future, such a large cosmopolitan concourse of people assembled in Honolulu. Thus has been the last look of the public upon the remains of Kalakaua.⁴⁴

Ko Hawaii estimated that eleven thousand maka'āinana were gathered on the sides of the procession, watching the mō'i's remains carried to Mauna 'Ala. Warships sounded farewell gun salutes from the harbor, church bells tolled, and the minute guns atop Puōwaina shot out where bonfires burned. When the casket arrived at Mauna 'Ala, according to *Ko Hawaii*, the enclosure was immediately filled with the sound of the people's weeping—something Whitney ignored.⁴⁵ After most people had left the area, the Freemasons performed their own funeral service, with the royal family in attendance. On February 16, a mele kanikau appeared in *Ka Leo*, written by Mary Kinimaka from

Kawaiaha'o.⁴⁶ The PCA's summation was a telling one: "The death of Kalakaua will go down in the history [sic] of Hawaii, marking the end of an epoch that during his seventeen years' reign has been a prosperous one."⁴⁷

On the day of the funeral procession, a biography of the mō'i, titled *Moolelo o ka Moi Kalakaua I: Ka Hanau ana, ke Kaapuni Honua, ka Moolelo Piha o kona mau La Hope ma Kaleponi, Amerika Huipua, na Hoike a Adimarala Baraunu me na Kauka, Etc., Etc., Etc.: Hoohiwahiwaia me na Kii* (The History of King Kalākaua I: The Birth, the Journey around the World, a Full Record of His Last Days in California, United States of America, the Reports of Admiral Brown and the Doctors, Etc., Etc., Etc. Illustrated with Pictures) and written by Hawaiian intellectual, teacher, attorney, newspaper contributor, editor, publisher, and legislator Joseph Moku'ōhai Poepoe, was sold for one dollar. The thirty-nine-year-old Poepoe already had thirteen years of print experience, beginning with translating European tales into Hawaiian to be printed in Hawai'i's weekly newspapers.⁴⁸ In her recent work, *The Power of the Steel-Tipped Pen: Reconstructing Native Hawaiian Intellectual History*, Noenoe Silva observes: "In Hawaiian language and Hawaiian studies more broadly, Joseph Moku'ōhai Poepoe is likely the most respected writer and newspaper editor of the late nineteenth and early twentieth centuries."⁴⁹ Poepoe's seventy-four-page biography contains a kanikau, newspaper articles documenting events of the mō'i's life, and doctors' letters describing the days leading up to Kalākaua's stroke and death in California. One was written on the *Charleston* on its way to Hawai'i from San Francisco with the mō'i's body. The swiftness with which Poepoe completed the mo'olelo is astounding. Printed by the Gazette Publishing Company in time for the king's funeral, it was "met with a ready sale."⁵⁰ The result stands with biographies published about Robert William Kalanihiapo Wilcox, Kaluaiko'olau, Joseph Kaho'oluhi Nāwahīkalaniōpu'u, and Kamehameha I, also by Poepoe, that served "to inspire Hawaiians and call them to action during a time of great social, political, and

cultural unrest.”⁵¹ Silva explains that during Poepoe’s “times of struggle for the pono of the lāhui, which he saw as springing from our native language, literature, and knowledge, times that were sometimes dangerous to his life, he fearlessly put forward our ancestral knowledge.”⁵² In this specific national crisis that the people of Hawai‘i were suffering—and in response to their question of how their beloved mō‘ī had died—Poepoe wrote *Ka Moolelo o ka Moi Kalakaua I*. Deploying nineteenth-century Hawaiian-language rhetorical and poetic styles, the result is the longest and most significant nineteenth-century Kanaka Maoli narrative about King David Kalākaua.



The catafalque containing Kalākaua’s remains reaches Mauna ‘Ala. February 15, 1891. Courtesy Hawai‘i State Archives.

Just short of four pages, the first section of *Ka Moolelo* is the mele kanikau, a form of mele oli, or funeral chant. In the shortest section of the book, Poepoe describes the land’s mourning for its mō‘ī and the mō‘ī’s own devastation upon departing from his land. Like most nineteenth-century mele

kanikau, this one honors the places the deceased once frequented and visited. C. Kanoelani Nāone has said, “The significance of ‘āina for Hawaiians is made apparent through its abundance and prominence in mo’olelo, mele, oli, and mo’okū’auhau,”⁵³ and because Kalākaua traveled so extensively throughout Hawai‘i nei, Poepoe’s references to place names are numerous. Most cannot be found on contemporary maps of Hawai‘i; for others, the spelling has changed. *Place Names of Hawai‘i* by Mary Kawena Pukui, Samuel Elbert, and Esther Mo’okini, one of our primary sources on place names, is missing some of the names in the *Moolelo*’s kanikau. But the allusive richness of such references was well known. Samuel Kamakau once said, “If I were to tell the story of each place in this archipelago from Hawai‘i to Ni‘ihau, I would not be finished in twenty years.”⁵⁴

The kanikau also records the people’s love for their mō‘ī—a nineteenth-century mourning tradition no longer practiced to the extent it once was in Hawai‘i. Such kanikau appeared daily in Hawaiian-language newspapers of the nineteenth and early twentieth centuries. Commenting on their value, John R. Clark writes that at their height in the mid- to late 1800s, kanikau “served as permanent eulogies.”⁵⁵ Rubellite Kawena Johnson adds that

between 1834 and 1900, kanikau were the most voluminous compositions found in the Hawaiian language newspapers. As the art of writing became a ready skill and the poetry of the kanikau was widely practiced, the liberal policy of Hawaiian language newspapers was an open door to publication of these creations. Many people even had the advantage of writing their own farewell pieces.⁵⁶

The disappearance of kanikau in the mid-1900s has been largely attributed to the closing of Hawaiian-language newspapers.⁵⁷ As for Poepoe’s contribution, specifically, “A kanikau for the ali‘i also expressed pride in the greater Hawaiian family and nation.”⁵⁸ Written immediately after

Kalākaua's death on foreign shores and just two years before the overthrow, this kanikau was a political call for the Hawaiian Nation to rise up together. Poepoe's text is also different from every English-language biography on Kalākaua because it is so Hawaiian in nature. The *Mooolelo* "is typical of traditional Hawaiian stories, which is in contrast to the narratives that were created *about* Hawai'i by nonindigenous people."⁵⁹

Its second section is a brief prose biography of the mō'i, covering from his youth to his ascension to the throne, his travels to the United States and abroad, and his eventual death in San Francisco. The third section contains Poepoe's Hawaiian translations of the secretary's and doctors' reports to Minister of Foreign Affairs John A. Cummins concerning the mō'i's illness and death in San Francisco. First came the letter of George P. Blow, secretary and escort of the admiral of the US Pacific fleet, which records Kalākaua's travels in Southern California from December 26, 1890, to January 3, 1891. One interesting observation is that Kalākaua abstained from alcohol the entire time, explaining to Blow, "I promised the Admiral [Brown] not to drink anything." When he toasted, the mō'i lifted the glass to his lips but never drank. The second letter was by Admiral George Brown of the American war fleet and captain of the USS *Charleston*, who had joined the mō'i and his entourage on January 3, 1891. His account ends with the evening of January 13, when a Mr. Gillig and Mr. Unger arrived at the Palace Hotel to escort Kalākaua to a banquet. Both Admiral Brown and Dr. George Woods told them about the mō'i's serious medical condition and implored the gentlemen to postpone the banquet. They refused and took Kalākaua to their dinner. A medical inspector for the US Navy, Woods wrote the last letter in this section, which provides a detailed medical summary of the mō'i's symptoms beginning on January 4 and continuing to his death. Adding a line to his translation of Wood's letter, Poepoe clearly absolves all correspondents from any blame for the mō'i's sickness and eventual death: "In my conclusion of this account, it is necessary I say, the King was a truly sick man

before His departure from Honolulu for His convalescence, moreover, that illness continued to afflict the King for more than a year before His death.” The final part of the biography includes a timeline of the mō‘ī’s life, extending up to his funeral procession on February 15, 1891. A literary jewel that reflects both Poepoe’s intellectual mastery of composition and publishing and the importance of the nineteenth-century newspapers, *Ka Moolelo o ka Moi* is a substantial record of Native aloha for David Kalākaua and the lāhui kū‘oko‘a (independent nation).

The day after the funeral, the Hawaiian-language newspapers began publishing letters from maka‘āinana throughout the kingdom. These letters of mourning and condolence actually continued a tradition. When former mō‘ī Lunalilo and Lot died, maka‘āinana sent letters to the papers; now in 1891, they were publicly grieving for this mō‘ī of the Keaweaheulu, rather than the Kamehameha line.⁶⁰ Addressed to Kapi‘olani, Lili‘uokalani, and Po‘omaikelani, they expressed condolences for the family’s loss, asked God to comfort the ali‘i women, and most importantly for my purposes, declared their own profound grief and steadfast aloha for Kalākaua. The number of letters published was substantial.⁶¹ On February 16, *Ka Leo* published letters from Hāna, Maui, Kōloa, Kaua‘i, and Moloka‘i and from Hansen’s disease patients in Kalihi. Very familiar with feeling alone, separated forever from loved ones, the patients’ empathy for the mourning ali‘iwahine was strong: “O makou pu me oe iloko o ke kumakena, a ke noi nei makou i ke Akua mana loa e hoomana mai i kou naau luuluu, a nana no e kiai mai i kou maluhia” (We are together with you in grief and we beseech the omnipotent God to strengthen [you] in your bereavement, and may he take care to guard your rest). A letter from Hawaiians in Kōloa declared their devotion and loyalty to Kalākaua as mō‘ī⁶²—a very different response from the Kāne‘ohe natives’ letter of 1887, which claimed that Kalākaua was never a chief and certainly not their choice in the 1874 election.

These 1891 letters also show how maka‘āinana used the

newspapers to form alliances and express solidarity with others in the kingdom. For this reason, the letters kept coming—and not just to *Ka Leo*'s office but to *Ko Hawaii*'s as well, which on February 21 published five letters from maka'āinana in southern Kohala, Kōloa, and Ka'ū, reexpressing the aloha for Kap'iolani and Lili'uokalani offered earlier, in another paper. Through repetition, the declarations became bolder. A letter to Kapi'olani referred to Kalākaua as the Father of the Nation from Hawai'i to Ni'ihau.⁶³ On page 4 of the same issue of *Ko Hawaii*, seven more letters appeared, from places including Kailua-Kona, Miloli'i, and Kapua, Hawai'i. Even *Kuokoa* felt it necessary to publish, on page 3, two letters from maka'āinana in Hilo 'ākau (north) to Kapi'olani and then ten more letters from Wailau and Waimea, Kaua'i, and even from wāhine with Hansen's disease on Moloka'i.⁶⁴ One letter was addressed to Po'omaikelani.⁶⁵

* * *

Hawai'i's newspaper industry grew exponentially in the late nineteenth century, partly due to the controversies that came to a head during Kalākaua's reign and certainly due to the intensity of Hawaiians' desire to regain their national sovereignty after 1893. Looking at *all* of the coverage and debate in the English-language newspapers and, above all, in the Hawaiian-language newspapers results in a far more nuanced and accurate understanding of how his contemporaries understood and debated the role and nature of this mō'i. Over 140 years ago, lunamaka'āinana elected Kalākaua as mō'i of Hawai'i. Writers have recorded their impressions of him ever since—many exaggerated and insulting, created specifically to undermine this mō'i by providing a counterfeit. Presented loudly and insistently, these contrived representations have often drowned out far different ones.

One of the boldest reactions to Kalākaua's death appears in *Ka Leo o ka Lahui*. On January 30, 1891, the day after the

USS *Charleston* appeared off Lē‘ahi with the Hawaiian flag at half-mast, *Ka Leo* publicly accused the current cabinet of opposing the mō‘ī’s efforts to help his people during his reign and of sending him off to America to die. The article addresses the dead Kalākaua directly:

Ua kua ia e lakou kou makemake e hoopomaikai i kou lahui pono, a ua hoouna ia oe e hele ma kahi o ka make, no ka imi hou i pono no ka poe nana i kuko e lawe e kou kalaunu. Ua a’o aku o Dr. Trousseau, aole oe e ola ke hele, &c, a ua kau’a aku ia oe aka ua pai mai ka leo mana o ke aupuni mamuli o ka makemake ia e hoolaulea ia aku ko Amerika poe i loa hou ona pono no lakou, e puipui ai na aoao a huli hou mai e nahu ia oe e powa i na pono o ko lahui, ka lahui a ou mau kupuna a me na kupuna o ko lahui e eha ai ka ili.⁶⁶

(Your desires to benefit your own people were opposed by them, and then you were sent off to a deadly place, in order to seek benefits for the good of the people who yearned to take your crown. Dr. Trousseau advised that you would not survive if you went, & etc. and commanded you [to stay] but the powerful voices of the kingdom urged it out of a desire that the Americans be entertained in order to obtain more profit for themselves, and to build up their sides to turn again and bite you, so as to plunder the assets of your people, the nation for which your own ancestors and the ancestors of your people suffered.)⁶⁷

The only value of David Kalākaua to such men was as a tool for their interests—and then as a corpse.

Referring to a time before Kalākaua, Kamanamaikalani Beamer called the mō‘ī “a centralizing political force in the ancient Hawaiian governmental structure.” But this thought continued long into the nineteenth century. For many Kānaka ‘Ōiwi, without a mō‘ī, Hawai‘i could not be a nation, and with one, it could never become a part of the United States.⁶⁸ Support for Kalākaua as an essential component of the lāhui

surfaces in many places but, most notably, perhaps, in many of the Native-edited Hawaiian-language newspapers. The facts are clear. Through gossip, newspapers, periodicals, books at home and abroad, and later written narratives by writers dedicated, sometimes unconsciously, to criticism and defamation, his enemies actively tried to drown out and then silence that support. But during his reign and beyond, many—and, arguably, the vast majority—of Kalākaua’s people remained loyal to him—for some because he was Hawai’i’s mō’ī and for others because he was the active and effective protector of Hawaiian independence. Even a pragmatic figure like Theo. H. Davies admitted that “the Hawaiian throne is not a piece of personal property. It is a trust, and is as much the embodiment of Hawaiian nationality as the Hawaiian flag.”⁶⁹ In 1883, just after the midpoint of Kalākaua’s reign, *Ke Koo o Hawaii* celebrated his centrality as mō’ī to the idea of a Hawaiian Nation. “O kekahi o na hana mua loa a na makua i ka wa e kuhikuhi ai i ka lakou mau keiki, oia no ke ao ana ia lakou e aloha i ka Moi” (One of the first tasks of parents at the time they instruct their children is teaching them to love the monarch),⁷⁰ the writer declares and then suggests what binds all Hawaiians together:

Ma na wahi a pau o ka honua nei a ke kanaka Hawaii e hele ai, ke halawai oia me kekahi kanaka i hanauia noloko o kekahi lahui naauao, e halawai pu ana oia iloko o ua kanaka nei me kana mau mea i hiipoi mau ai ma kana mau wahi a pau i kaahele ai malalo iho o ka la, oia hoi—ke aloha i kona Moi; ke aloha i kona Aupuni; ke aloha i kona Lahui; ke aloha i kona Aina hanau.⁷¹

(Everywhere in the world where the Hawaiian travels, whenever he meets with another person born in an enlightened nation, he converses together with that person about those things he cherishes in all the places he has traveled under the sun—love for his king; love for his kingdom; love for his nation; love for his birthland.)

The marrow in the iwi (bones) of the nineteenth-century

Kānaka Maoli was made up of several elements. One was love for the mō'ī. Unabashed, *Ka Leo* declared everlasting loyalty and aloha for Kalanikaulilua, and for his memory, before all of Hawai'i. In this, the paper spoke for the Hawaiian Nation—those men, women, and children who throughout Kalākaua's reign were demonstrably constant to him, loving and admiring him even as the tide of traditions rose and fell, driven by hardships, attacks, disagreement, and doubt. “Me oe e Ka Lani Kalakaua ko makou aloha a hiki i ko makou hopena” (With you, King Kalākaua, is our love until *our* end),⁷² *Ka Leo o ka Lahui* stated, looking with hope as well to his sister Lili'uokalani—now mō'ī and also the newest and most important hō'ailona of the Kalākaua regime. *Nupepa Elele* agreed: “His mantle falls to Her Royal Highness the Heir Apparent Princess Liliuokalani, who has on more than one occasion presided as Regent with becoming, [sic] dignity, intelligence, firmness, and at the same time in a conservative and constitutional manner.”⁷³ Like her brother, she was recognized as a sign, symbol, and emblem of a regenerative hope for the lāhui. She would work to restore, the people believed, Native rights and entitlements through the power of the throne. Like her brother a descendant of ali'i and ali'iwahine, into her hands passed the responsibility for the kū'oko'a of the lāhui, as she became the next hō'ailona for Kānaka 'Ōiwi:

E ola ka Moiwahine Liliuokani i ke Akua. Aia maluna ou e ke Aliiwahine a na 'Lii Kapaakea a me Keohokalole, e kau aku nei kahi manaolana hope loa o ko olua lahui, ma keia poepoe honua. E lilo oe ma kou ano hou, i milimili na ka Lani, a i Alii i hoonohoia he Moi no keia lahui, ma ko ke Akua lokomaikai, i Makua no keia lahui mahope o ka Leo o ke Akua.⁷⁴

(God save Queen Lili'uokalani. O Chiefess, of Chief Kapa'akea and Keohokālōle, placed upon you is the very last hope of your people on this earth. You will become anew, a favorite of the heavens and a chief appointed as

a ruler for this people, through the grace of God, as a parent for this nation in accordance with the voice of God.)

What happened next is another intimately related story. But this invocation confirms that for all the challenges he faced, all the public controversy, and all the efforts to erase parts of his legacy forever, Kalākaua preserved and passed on intact the lāhui's understanding and representation of mō'ī.

Notes

- [1.](#) Nineteenth-century mele refer to David Kalākaua this way because he was the seventh king after Kamehameha I.
- [2.](#) "E Like me ka Hoea ana," *Ka Lahui Hawaii*, January 1, 1875, 2, Ulukau.
- [3.](#) Williams Jr., "'Ike Mōakaaka," 68.
- [4.](#) Silva, *Power of the Steel-Tipped Pen*, 83.
- [5.](#) "Ngūgī Wa Thiong'o," foreword to Silva, *Power of the Steel-Tipped Pen*, x.
- [6.](#) "The King's Birthday. How the Event Was Observed," *HG*, November 18, 1890, 9, Chronicling America.
- [7.](#) "Ka La Hanau o ka Moi. Na Hoohiwahiwa o ka La. Na Hookupu me Ike Alii. Na Heihei ma ke Awa. Ka Huakai Kai Kukui. Ka Panina o na Hana," *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, November 22, 1890, 2, Ulukau.
- [8.](#) "Ka Moi Kalakaua," *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, November 29, 1890, 4.
- [9.](#) "The Announcement Yesterday of the Death of King Kalakaua Fell Like a Clap of Thunder from the Skies," *PCA*, January 30, 1891, 2.
- [10.](#) "Ka Moi Kalakaua ma Kapalakiko. Ka Pii Maikai ana o kona Ola Kino ma ka Moana," *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, December 13, 1890, 3, Ulukau.
- [11.](#) "Paani me ka Inoa o ka Moi," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, January 24, 1891, 2, Ulukau.
- [12.](#) "King Kalakaua. His Movements in Southern California. San Diego, Los Angeles, San Bernadino and Santa Barbara Visited—Comments on the Trip," *PCA*, January 23, 1891, 2.
- [13.](#) Tom Patterson, "Out of the Country's Past: A Night to Remember with Royalty," *Press Enterprise*, March 20, 1983, B2.
- [14.](#) "King Kalakaua. His Movements in Southern California," *PCA*, January 23, 1891, 2.
- [15.](#) "Quite a Number of Honolulu Merchants," *PCA*, January 26, 1891, 2.
- [16.](#) "Death of the King," *Nupepa Elele*, January 31, 1891, 2.
- [17.](#) "Make ka Moi Kalakaua. Kona mau Sekona," *Ka Leo o ka Lahui*, January 30, 1891, 2, Ulukau.
- [18.](#) "The Announcement," *PCA*, January 30, 1891, 2.
- [19.](#) "Procession to the Palace," *PCA*, January 30, 1891, 2.
- [20.](#) "Make o ka Moi Kalakaua ma Kapalakiko, Ianuari 20, 1891. Kuana mai o ke Kaletona me ka Nu Hou Naauauwa a me ke Kino Wailua Pu," *Ko Hawaii*

Pae Aina, January 31, 1891, 2, Ulukau.

- [21.](#) "Make ka Moi Kalakaua. Kona mau Sekona Hope Loa," *Ka Leo o ka Lahui*, January 30, 1891, 2.
- [22.](#) "San Francisco's Eulogy," "Arrangements for the Funeral," "Funeral Ceremonies," "On the Way to the Cruiser," and "On Board the Charleston," *PCA*, January 30, 1891, 2; "Kalakaua Dead. Last Hours of the Hawaiian Monarch. Solemn Scenes at the Royal Bedside. The Succession and the Political Situation. Sketches of the Dead Sovereign and of the Heirs to the Throne," *Nupepa Elele*, January 31, 1891, 2; "Religious Services. Substance of Sermon Delivered by Rev. Dr. Reed," *PCA*, January 31, 1891, 2; "Na Kahiko o ka Moi," *Nupepa Elele*, January 31, 1891, 2; "Make ka Moi Kalakaua, ma Kapalakiko, Ianuari 20," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, January 31, 1891, 2.
- [23.](#) "Procession to the Palace," *PCA*, January 30, 1891, 2.
- [24.](#) "Piha Kumakena ka Uwapo," *Ka Leo o ka Lahui*, January 30, 1891, 2, Ulukau.
- [25.](#) "Procession to the Palace," *PCA*, January 30, 1891, 2.
- [26.](#) "Ka Pio Oiaio," *Ka Leo o ka Lahui*, February 2, 1891, 2, Ulukau.
- [27.](#) "A Right Royal Bow of Promise," *PCA*, February 2, 1891, 2.
- [28.](#) "Ka Pio," *Ka Leo o ka Lahui*, February 2, 1891, 2.
- [29.](#) "A Large Number of Natives," *PCA*, January 30, 1891, 3, Chronicling America; "Notwithstanding the Inclemency of the Weather," *PCA*, January 30, 1891, 2.
- [30.](#) "Lying in State," *PCA*, January 31, 1891, 2.
- [31.](#) "The King's Death," *Nupepa Elele*, January 31, 1891, 2.
- [32.](#) "There Is Not a Doubt but the Largest Edition," *PCA*, January 31, 1891, 2; "There Has Been a Large Demand," *PCA*, February 18, 1891, 2.
- [33.](#) See "King Kalakaua Dead. The King's Sad Bereavement. Death at San Francisco, Cala. Arrival of the US Flagship 'Charleston' with the Remains. The Gala Holiday Changed to Mourning. Removal of the Remains to the Royal Palace—An Imposing Military Procession—The Town Draped in Mourning—Notes, Etc.," *PCA*, January 30, 1891, 2; "King Kalakaua Dead. The King's Sad Bereavement. Death at San Francisco, Cala. Arrival of the US Flagship 'Charleston' with the Remains. The Gala Holiday Changed to Mourning. Removal of the Remains to the Royal Palace—An Imposing Military Procession—The Town Draped in Mourning—Notes, Etc.," *HG*, February 3, 1891, 12; "The Announcement Thursday of the Death of King Kalakaua Fell Like a Clap of Thunder from the Skies," *PCA*, January 30, 1891, 2; "The Announcement Thursday of the Death of King Kalakaua Fell Like a Clap of Thunder from the Skies," *HG*, February 3, 1891, 4.
- [34.](#) Dawrs, "For the Record."
- [35.](#) "O ke Koho Balota ana ma keia Kulanakauhale," *Ko Hawaii Pono*, February 4, 1874, 2, Ulukau.
- [36.](#) Silva, *Power of the Steel-Tipped Pen*, 3.
- [37.](#) "Tempora Mutantur," *Ka Leo o ka Lahui*, February 16, 1891, 4, Ulukau.
- [38.](#) Chapin, *Guide to Newspapers of Hawai'i*, 54.
- [39.](#) "Moe i ka Maha. Ka Moi Make no ka Ilina ma Maunaala. Moe ka Mea Aloha, Aloha, Aloha," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, February 21, 1891, 2, Ulukau.
- [40.](#) "Kuu e ka Luhi. Kalakaua. Na Hoohanohano Hope. He Hoolewa

Makolukolu," *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, February 21, 1891, 2, Ulukau.

- [41.](#) "At Rest. King Kalakaua Interred in the Royal Mausoleum. The Last Honors. An Imposing Funeral Procession," *PCA*, February 16, 1891, 2.
- [42.](#) "Ka Hui Oiwi Holehole Iwi o Hawaii," *Ka Leo o ka Lahui*, February 16, 1891, 2, Ulukau.
- [43.](#) "Kuu e ka Luhi," *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, February 21, 1891, 2.
- [44.](#) "At Rest," *PCA*, February 16, 1891, 2.
- [45.](#) "Kuu e ka Luhi," *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, February 21, 1891, 2.
- [46.](#) Kinimaka was the daughter of David Leleo Kinimaka, the son of Ha'aheo and Kinimaka, the hānai parents of Kalākaua. David Kinimaka was the commander in chief of the royal troops and served in the king's privy council, and Mary was very close to Kalākaua and the royal family. In 1891, Mary had already lost both of her parents, so her kanikau has layers of meaning here. "Dr. John Atcherley of Hawaii and his Family," Atcherley.org.uk.
- [47.](#) "At Rest," *PCA*, February 16, 1891, 2.
- [48.](#) Silva, "Nā Hulu Kapuna," 47-48.
- [49.](#) Silva, *Power of the Steel-Tipped Pen*, 105.
- [50.](#) "Biography of the Late King," *PCA*, February 17, 1891, 3, Chronicling America.
- [51.](#) Kuwada, "To Translate or Not," 55.
- [52.](#) Silva, *Power of the Steel-Tipped Pen*, 105.
- [53.](#) Nāone, "'O ka 'Āina," 317.
- [54.](#) Kamakau, *Tales and Traditions*, 16.
- [55.](#) Clark, Introduction to *Hawaiian Surfing*, 6.
- [56.](#) Johnson, "Keeping Maui's History Alive."
- [57.](#) Leidemann, "Hawaiian Chants of Life & Death."
- [58.](#) Johnson, "Keeping Maui's History Alive."
- [59.](#) Nāone, "'O ka 'Āina," 318.
- [60.](#) "Na Manao Hoalohalo," *Ke Au Okoa*, December 19, 1872, 2; "Na Manao Hoalohalo," *Ke Au Okoa*, December 26, 1872, 2; "Na Olelo Hoalohalo," *Ko Hawaii Pono*, December 11, 1874, 2. My search for those condolences that appeared in the newspapers after 'Iolani Liholiho, Kapuāiwa, Lunalilo, and Kalākaua died proved that maka'āinana wrote the most condolences for Kalākaua, but that may be due to the increase in Hawaiian-language newspapers printed during this last mō'ī's reign and to the nature in which Kalākaua died.
- [61.](#) See "Na Palapala Hoalohalo," *Ka Leo o ka Lahui*, February 17, 1891, 2; "Na Palapala Hoalohalo," *Ka Leo o ka Lahui*, February 18, 1891, 2; "Na Palapala Hoalohalo," *Ka Leo o ka Lahui*, February 19, 1891, 2; "Na Palapala Hoalohalo," *Ka Leo o ka Lahui*, February 20, 1891, 2.
- [62.](#) "Na Palapala Hoalohalo," *Ka Leo o ka Lahui*, February 16, 1891, 2.
- [63.](#) "Na Hoalohalo," *Ko Hawaii Pae Aina*, February 21, 1891, 3.
- [64.](#) "Ho'alohe'lohe," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, February 21, 1891, 3.
- [65.](#) "Na Piha Kumakena. Hue'a ke Aloha. Ka Makee Alii. Ike'a ma ka Waimaka i ko Hooheanini mawaho," *Nupepa Kuokoa*, February 21, 1891, 4, Ulukau.
- [66.](#) "Ua Make ke 'Lii, E Ola ke 'Lii," *Ka Leo o ka Lahui*, January 30, 1891, 2,

Ulukau.

- [67.](#) A reference to Kamāmalu's speech.
- [68.](#) Beamer, *No Mākou ka Mana*, 21.
- [69.](#) Davies, *Letters upon the Political Crisis*, 6.
- [70.](#) Stillman, "No ka Po'e," 20.
- [71.](#) "Ke Mele Hawaii," *Ke Koo o Hawaii*, August 15, 1883, 5, Ulukau.
- [72.](#) "Ua Make," *Ka Leo o ka Lahui*, January 30, 1891, 2.
- [73.](#) "Death of the King," *Nupepa Elele*, January 31, 1891, 2.
- [74.](#) "Ua Make," *Ka Leo o ka Lahui*, January 30, 1891, 2.

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